The Queen and I

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Explicit

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The Queen and I

by GarbageFanfics

Summary

Queen Angella has assigned Adora to be her guard on her diplomatic mission against the Horde. Adora will do anything to make Queen Angella proud of her. As well as develop an overwhelming crush on the Queen of Brightmoon in the process.

Shower with my queen

The teen was mesmerized by the queen. It was an understatement. The propaganda posters that filled the cadet barracks in the freight zone did the beauty of her majesty a huge disservice. It was nerve racking to be in her presence. She craved the Queen's approval in a way she never craved approval before. No praise from Shadow Weaver, nor the new praise of being She-ra could compare to the attention the Queen gave Adora. All she wanted was a simple word from her. The Queen's silent nods of approval over successful missions made the girl heat up inside. Her emotions sometimes got the better of her. After the success of battle of Bright moon. Queen Angella's gesture to embrace her and sweetly say "Thank you" put Adora to tears to hear that praise. Glimmer assumed it was just Adora's relief of winning getting her misty eyed—when it was the Queen offering kindness to her. This was a feeling Adora never felt before. Someone's approval that was easily given. Expectations and standards that if they weren't met where not punished with physical and mental violence. Queen Angella would scold the three of them; Glimmer, Bow, and herself only out of care. This feeling was new to Adora. And she wanted more. She wanted the Queen's approval. She wanted the Queen's praise, but there was a third thing she wanted. She just didn't know what to call it.

A meeting in the Princess alliance hall began. Everyone still on a high from the victory. Spinneralla and Netossa embraced each other again and praised each other for how brave and valiant they were. The other Princess took this time to talk to one another and enjoy the company of each other.

Adora felt distracted. She looked at the door nervously—anticipated the Queen's arrival. Guards entered as her royal majesty followed. A soft smile graced her feature—she walked over to the greet the other Princess at started the meeting. Adora couldn't take her eyes off her.

Angella began “I would like to congratulate everyone’s hard work in our victory”

The room roared with claps and cheers; she turned to Adora “Especially you, Adora. This couldn’t have been done without you”

More cheering filled the room. Adora sat there. Wide eyed and turning red in the face from the compliment. Glimmer placed her hands on Adora’s shoulders.

“C’mon, don’t be so modest”

Adora patted glimmer’s hand resting on her shoulder and looked around to everyone smiling at her. The Queen smiled as well. Her blush was partially from the praise—it wasn’t known to anyone else that is was also due to Queen Angella.

The smiles faded slowly as they began to discuss the plans moving forward.

Bow and Glimmer will be assigned with Perfuma to work on restoring the Whispering woods and making sure no horde invasions occur.

Mermista and Frost will work on all marine based security with Seahawk.

Spinnerella and Netossa will remain in Brighmoon to handle any emergencies that require delegation.

While for the first time in many years Queen Angella will leave Bright moon to travel to another Kingdom Beyond the Whispering woods in Horde territory to discuss peaceful options to neutralize a potential enemy threat. She will be accompanied by Adora.

Adora and the Queen.

Alone.

Adora went red again—fear of being alone with her was an overwhelming sensation and Glimmer protested that Bow and her need Adora.

Adora quickly retorted back that the Queen should have She-Ra in this delicate situation. Also, many people do not know of the legendary She-Ra's return.

Glimmer did not protest further.

It was settled, everyone knew where to go next.

Adora was nervous and excited to be alone with Queen. This feeling was new. Still unsure of what it was yet.

She was back in her room packing for the trip out of Brightmoon when she heard a knock at the door.

"Adora, can I come in?" It was Glimmer.

Adora opened the door to greet her friend.

"My mom asked if you wanted to join us in her bath house. We aren't going to see each other for about a month so it out last time for all three for us to bond"

"Bath house?" Adora questioned.

Glimmer explained excitedly "Yeah, my mom has her own private spa chamber in her bathroom. She invited you"

Adora raised her eyebrow "Is it like the steam thingy at your aunt's place?"

Glimmer rolled her eyes "Oh, Adora. Have you never been to a bath house before?

Adora shook her head.

Glimmer then took Adora by the hand and dragged her out of her room.

“Wait! Glimmer I haven’t finished packing yet”

“C’mon do that later. We only have a little bit of time together after this”

Adora nodded but didn’t fully agree to going with her. She was going to shower later anyways so there was no point in taking a bath now.

They arrived at the Queen’s room and entered without knocking; Adora found that to be impolite but Glimmer—being her daughter did not care. Glimmer took Adora by the hand and walked over to the far-right corner of the room to a door that lead to a much larger room. It was warm and steamy. A large elevated pool was in the middle with a fountain pouring a stream of water into the pool. Glimmer then ushered her into another small room with steam coming from it. The room had a wooden with folded towels and clothes folded on them as well. Adora then saw Angella come in with a thin and slightly sheer white robe. Adora looked at her then quickly away. She glanced over to Glimmer who was removing her socks and gloves. Adora now frozen in discomfort.

“Adora” Glimmer began “You got undress and wash up. After you rinse up you can jump in the tub with mom and me”

Adora; still frozen in embarrassment looked around “Um, don’t we wear spa clothes in the grotto?”

Glimmer—now naked and only covered by a towel replied “No, Adora. That’s not how baths work. Didn’t they have baths in the freight zone?”

Adora went red “N-no, we had showers, shower stalls, and we never really got naked in front of each other, so—this is new. Very new for me”

Angella then approached them in a sheer white spa robe and Adora felt she could die right there. No battle could prepare her for being in presence of the Queen like this. Angella could see the discomfort in Adora and suggested to be covered up like in a

Grotto to make her more comfortable. Adora assured them she was fine, and they didn't need to do that for her. She then slowly took off her clothes and placed a bath towel around her. She looked over to see Angella washing Glimmer's hair. The Queen had her daughter sitting between her legs as she massaged the shampoo through Glimmer's hair.

"You have your father's hairline you know, so you scalp will get really dry during winter"

"hmmm, okay, mom"

Adora turned away from them to wash up cleaning her body and trying her best to keep the towel on. She washed her legs and arms and her other parts of her body as soon as she went behind the room divider where the shower head was. She could hear Angella comment on her shyness and this made Adora turn red almost all over. Of course she was shy! She is in the same room as the Queen naked. Did they see her? Oh, God. Did Angella see her butt? She wanted to die. She never felt like this in front of anyone. Glimmer saw her in underwear once, but it wasn't made out to be a weird thing. Why was she acting this so weird? She felt the touch of two hands on her shoulders "Adora, let me wash your hair for you" the soft voice of the Queen said. It wasn't a request either. Adora felt tense as she nodded. Not looking at her; she handed Angella the shampoo bottle and could feel the closeness of the Queen behind her.

"I can't see anything if this that makes you feel better" She assured the shy girl.

Adora looked down "Sorry if I'm acting weird"

She couldn't help but feel she needed to apologize for this.

She heard her Angella chuckle.

"Nothing to apologize for, this is new for you. I certainly don't want you to be uncomfortable. Now if you would. Please lift your chin for me, please" She instructed as she softly started to

massage the shampoo into Adora's hair. Adora felt a different warmth coming over her body from the touch. It was in her lower body and she felt like her knees could buckle on her at any second as the Queen ran her fingers through her hair. She took the shower head and washed it over Adora's head and then applied conditioner.

"Your hair nice hair, Adora" Angella complimented.

"She-ra has better hair" Was the only comment Adora could think to say. She instantly realized it wasn't a proper response to a compliment and facepalmed. "S-sorry. That – I, um. I—"

Angella then handed her a towel. "I should have figured you wouldn't handle compliments well. Come. Let's meet Glimmer in the bath"

Adora nodded and walked behind the Queen. The young hero's eyes wondering up and down her majesties' frame from behind. Adora knew she was still red from before and couldn't control her blush at this point. This was making her feel a very different kind of way for the Queen.

She sat adjacent to Angella and glimmer was on her left. Glimmer began to talk about the mission while Adora just nodded in agreement. Secretly glancing at the Breasts of the older woman sitting away from her. Angella caught this and gave Adora a smirk. This made the younger one just ducks her head down lower until her mouth was covered by the water. Glimmer paid no mind to this and continued talking. The bath didn't last very long as Adora finally couldn't take the embarrassment and asked to leave. As soon as she did Angella playfully slashed in the face.

"Leaving so soon?" Angella teased.

Adora was surprised by this and replied; attempting to have some sass in her voice; but it was more stuttering then anything.

"I—I still have p-pack, so—so, here" She splashed back. Glimmer than joined in with them and the three had a good laugh to end

the night.

Glimmer got dressed and teleported to her room. She asked Adora if she wanted to teleport her as well, but she declined the offer. She chose to walk down the corridors herself. She was now dressed in a robe as she had her dirty clothes in hand as she took a left outside Angella's bedroom door.

"You will want to take a right, Adora" She called out to her.

Adora quickly made a turn and started to walk down the hall.

"Adora" Angella called.

Adora turned to her "Yes, Queen Angella?"

Angella stood her doorway; still in just her bath robe "May be talk for a bit?"

Adora mentally gulped but nodded and made her way back to her. "Yes, your majesty?"

Angella then motioned for Adora to sit on her couch with her. "I feel we never really talked much after your first night here; I never asked you much about how you feel and how you have adjusted while living in Bright moon"

Adora looked away and let out a nervous laugh "Well, I mean the first few weeks were rough. But now I can go into town without someone following me and giving me dirty looks" Angella frowned at this knowledge. Her Kingdom's people did not welcome Adora at first—She felt she should have corrected that sooner. Worst of all why didn't Glimmer mention anything?
Adora than looked up at her and finished "I have people say hi to me and ask if I can turn into She-Ra for them. I get free snacks—So I feel that's good"

Angella still looked saddened.
The girl who almost died to save her kingdom is happy over snacks and praise. That's enough for her?

Adora then looked away "I know—you didn't like me much at first but I hope after all that has happened……..I hope that I won over your trust and approval"

Angella now felt awful.

She should have talked to Adora more. Why didn't she?

Angella than moved to embrace Adora with her wing closest to her.

"I am very proud of you, and I'm very sorry for not being so inviting to you Adora. I hope you can forgive me"

Adora nodded "I mean you had ever reason to not like me—I'm from the horde. I was supposed to be bad. And I still was when I got here—" Adora went on. Her body was shaking a little and her mouth was feeling dry "I made so many mistakes as She-Ra when I started. I made Catra's life worse and made her become evil—I got Glimmer and bow hurt and even endangered everyone at least ten times—I almost lost at Bright moon—" Her face winced in pain as she realized she was about to burst into tears in front of Angella. She buried her face into her clothes and began to sob. Angella took the girl into an embrace.

So much for making her feel better—she made the girl remember all her regrets.

"Adora, I'm so sorry you feel that way"

What else can she say? Glimmer and her never had these hearts to hearts; also Glimmer never gave her the time of day to talk to her.
Was she this emotional as a teen herself?

Adora sniffled and pulled away from. "I'm sorry—I keep making tonight weird"

Angella rubbed the girl's shoulder for comfort "Oh, no, Adora—I'm the one who should be saying sorry. I should have been making sure you are alright emotionally"

Adora gave a weak smile and then replied "Its fine"

Angella hugged the girl—Adora still had in dirty clothes in hand.

Adora then commented "I can smell your hair—it smells nice"

Angella grinned and decided it was a good time for some light teasing to fix up the mood "Thank you—I can smell your hair as well, but—also your socks"
Adora then realized her dirty clothes were only a few inches away from the Queens face and pulled away to drop them.
"What—" she exclaimed in embarrassment "They're that bad?"

Angella laughed.

"No but they were just close that's all"

She examined the ex-horde soldier's under clothes to see that Adora wore boxer shorts.

"Was it a Horde practice for women to wear male underwear?" she continued to tease.

Adora; blushing scooped up her clothes quickly and replied "They are unisex—but, yes. This was a Horde thing"

Angella shook her head "I will make sure you more variety in clothes moving forward"

Adora looked over to Angella "I –I think I should head back to my room"

Angella nodded and at up and walked her to the door "Very well, get some rest for our mission tomorrow"

Adora nodded and exited her room making a left out the door.
Angella watched her and smiled.
"Adora, you're going the wrong way"

The teen spun around and shuffled down the hallway in embarrassment to her room.

"Tonight, hasn't been my night" She said quickly as she left the Queen's sight.

Angella couldn't help but laugh.

Adora was a sweaty. Adora was cute.

Adora was very cute.

A short time in Town Together

Chapter Summary

Adora gets to be spoiled by Queen Angella while shopping in town.

Chapter Notes

Re-uploaded. Now I have a Beta reader/Editor

Angella walked into the throne room to brief the princesses before they are sent off onto missions around Etheria. Her voice was powerful yet soft; Adora thought for herself, unaware of her

"Princesses, today we depart from each other for some time—in our time apart we must stay strong and be brave to whatever comes our way" She went on, making Adora's brain get lost in her melodious voice. Too bad she didn't listen much to the words. After the meeting, Adora went to hug everyone goodbye.

Angella firmly embraced Glimmer, to her annoyance.

"Mom? Seriously?" She tried to move out of her mother's embrace "You're embarrassing me! C'mon! Let me go!"

Angella ignored her plea, as well as the other princesses giggling at their love display. Angella then gave her a kiss on the forehead —which unconsciously made Adora become jealous of Glimmer.

Glimmer and the others were now off, leaving Adora and the Queen alone.

"Adora" She called the blonde ' before we depart for our mission —I would like us to go into town, together, by *ourselves,*" Angella said, waiting for her response with that signature calm smile of hers.

The younger girl turned to her with a confused look, fixing her gaze into hers "Do we need to get something? I could go alone if you need me to get you something before we depart." Adora offered. Queen Angella was- well, is royalty, and as one she shouldn't be with peasants like Hordak does. He has never shown his face around the quarters, never getting involved with no one but high-rank people.

Angella gave her a warm smile and then lightly tugged on Adora's shirt sleeve, inspecting her fashion taste. Not that she had one, anyways, she had always used whatever the Horde had in stock "I did promise you a more extensive wardrobe, did I not?" *And expensive*, she thought, grinning for herself. This was not the fright zone, and having those clothes were a grim reminder of her past.

Adora then looked up to her with a sweet yet shy smile. "Yes, you did. Thank you, your highness",

Angella smiled, a warm feeling sat on her chest when she saw the heroine's smile "No need to thank me, Adora. Now let's go"

The last time Angella went into town was with Micah. Glimmer never wanted to go out with her but Adora eagerly accepted the invitation to spend time with Angella. *A very well educated girl, kind of heart too, impressive how she has remained this way even while being a soldier her whole life*, she thought.

In town, the marketplaces were filled with food vendors and tiny shops with hand made assortments. Adora instantly gravitated towards the food. A woman stopped Adora as soon as she saw her, waving at her eager to get the hero of Brightmoon to try her homemade pastries.

"She-Ra, my dear. Please come try my newest baked goods" she then handed Adora a baked treat shaped like the sword of

protection, that Adora accepted with non-spoken happiness. Angella noticed how the woman said She-Ra and not Adora and wasn't exactly happy about that. But Adora was happy to get treats, so she remained silent and maintained her smile on her face towards the stranger, letting it go with a sigh as soon as they were out of the vendor's sight.

Adora stuffed her face with the baked good getting some sticky syrup on her face, and the Queen noticed that with a soft smile as she raised her hand towards Adora's cheek. Angella then went to wipe the syrup off Adora's face. The girl simply let out a squeak and blushed. Angella realized this and quickly retracted her arm, opening her mouth as she began to form an apology.

"Sorry, Adora," She said with a worried face." I can't help it, Glimmer gets made when I dote over her"

Adora shrugged, scratching her cheek where syrup used to be, relaxing her voice so the 8 octaves that it grew when the Queen caressed her cheek. "I don't mind it, but… yeah. '' A sigh came out of her throat. '' I guess I'm more embarrassed about being a mess in front of you and it surprised me, that's all."

"Oh, Adora it is nothing to be embarrassed about." She shoved it off with a hand movement and a smile, making Adora's shoulders relax." You're so cute it is hard not to mother you"

The blonde couldn't say anything but give a shy smile and look away.

Angella couldn't help but find this to be adorable. Her reactions where everything she always wanted to cause on Glimmer. But she had matured too early, and when she still was a child she didn't have any time to actually bond with her as a mother would normally do. Being a queen meant having everyone respect you, and respect comes with time, time that she had to spend being a royal instead of a mother.

She kept silently watching Adora eat more baked goods that the villagers kept shoving in her face, not that Adora minded because even if Angella found it extremely disrespectful the blonde was enjoying it. But, she had to cut one of the villager's that was bragging about his 'perfectly made' pastries that by the look of the blonde's face, looked like one of the worse she had tasted in a long time, because she had seen a shop that sold what she had told Adora she would buy for her. Clothes.

"I know dresses are not your typical style, so don't be pressured to buy a dress, and don't mind the price." She told the girl, as she began to search for some clothes for the blonde to try on.

Adora smiled at her and nodded. She liked this attention from the Queen. She just liked being near her. Her voice and smile were something so powerful it just made Adora lose the ability to talk and just sit there and smile, nodding at everything she said. It just felt right for Adora.

Angella found this to be a very earnest and sweet feature of Adora. Adora was more obedient and a better listener than Glimmer was. She felt Adora would be more open and honest on how she feels.

One day this could be an advantage for her.

She secretly wanted to ask Adora if Glimmer had a crush or was doing anything Angella would need to worry about.

After a couple of minutes of Adora staring indecisively at a couple of dresses, Angella decided that it was her time to step in. Adora definitely didn't seem excited about wearing dresses, so she asked Adora to try on some pants and a few tops to make sure they fit. Adora did as she asked and while the young girl was in the changing room Angella walked over to see some red sundresses. She thought Adora would look cute in them.

She waited for Adora to finish with her first batch of clothes before she asked her to try on a dress. Adora complied without

thinking of why Angella would want her to try on dresses, and Angella felt selfish about it. She knew how the girl felt about dresses, thinking that they were useless in battle and uncomfortable to run in. A chuckle escaped her mouth, she is probably going to have to help Adora realize that dresses are used on occasions where you are not supposed to fight or/and with them on. Once she was dressed in it, she presented herself to Angella—The queen smiled at her fondly.

"You look precious Adora," She said mindlessly of the reaction she would generate on the Adora.

Her compliment went heard from the other people in the shop. They had a lot of town folks' attention. The Queen and She-Ra being in the same shop at the same time was gossip fuel for Bright moon. Adora kept her cool and her blush down while they were in town.

Angella paid for the clothes and left with Adora—to where they were stopped by another street food vendor that wanted to give Adora some brownies shaped like shields. She couldn't decline the and the vendor gave several brownies that Adora had to give her bags to Queen Angella so the food shouldn't stain the clothes. Angella gave the vendor a warm smile, mostly directed to Adora's reaction, and offered to pay but they declined since it was for the hero of Bight moon.

Adora quickly stuffed her face on a brownie, that disappeared as quickly from existence. Angella chuckled at Adora's lack of grace when it came to eating. Adora didn't catch this and handed her a brownie "Want one? They have nuts in them" she said not minding the fact that she spoke while she was still eating.

Angella nodded and took one, smiling at the girl as she began to eat her brownie. It tasted good. It brought her back to a memory of Micah. She laughed at this memory.

Adora then frowned, trying to hide her face from the Queen. She feared that Angella was laughing at her "Sorry, Glimmer told me I

eat like a pig sometimes”

Angella shook her head “I wasn’t laughing at that, although you do need to focus on taking smaller bites, but...—”A pause was made with a sigh from Angella’s part,” ...—I was actually thinking about when I was pregnant with Glimmer, I would only want to eat brownies, So Micah would always get them for me. It ended up being our nightly reunite to have a brownie before bed. We both gained a bit of weight before Glimmer was born” Angella admitted flustered by the memory of how hard those pounds were to lose.

Adora smiled “Aww, that’s cute. Brownies have special meaning to you then!”

Angella smiled and felt a slight blush come over her cheeks. ‘’Yes, you could say that.” She said, ending the phrase with a chuckle.

Adora brought a happy memory of Micah into her mind and she enjoyed it. Adora brought such a familiar feeling to her.

A Micah feeling.

Micah.

Adora didn’t notice the flush as she asked, “So smaller bites?” She asked.

Angella chuckled “Yes, Adora. I’ve sat with you for dinner before and I assure you next time you eat chicken—the chicken is already dead, so you don’t need to eat it in one bite”

Adora let out an embarrassed laugh “S—sorry”

When they finally made their way back to the castle Angella chose to place one of her wings around Adora, embracing her with her wing. “I enjoyed today with you,” she said to her softly, maybe too close of her ear for Adora’s sanity.

Adora froze and looked up with a red face “I—I did enjoy it too, yes” she replied. As soon as Angella retracted her wing, Adora quickly made a clumsy turn and she began to make her way to her room to collect her things. As soon as Adora disappeared in the corner, she heard a faint thud, which made her frown, ‘’—Oh, I- I’m okay! Was this table always here? Oh god...—” Angella heard her reassure her safety with her voice maybe a couple octaves higher than it usually was.

Angella smiled at that clumsiness, so Adora’s, but at the same time...

...she still reminded her of Micah.

Then her frown returned for the first time today.

Micah.

Road Trip

Chapter Summary

Adora is crushing on the Queen.

Swiftwind attempted to kick off his saddlebags as he protested "I'm not some back mule, Adora!"

Adora chuckled "Sorry. But I need you to carry our supplies. It will be a big help" she assured him.

He made a horse sound that reminded Adora of a tired sigh and trotted in place "It wouldn't be so bad if it was just the two of us, but the Queen is coming and—and I don't think she likes me very much." Swiftwind said in a concerned tone masked with a neutral expression.

Adora rolled her eyes "She might have liked you more if you didn't decide to let all the other horses in the stable out and run around the castle grounds"

Swift Wind's wings frilled up in defense, with indignation of Adora's reaction of his "Hey, I liberated them!"

"They pooped everywhere!" She said with a hand motion that made clear her disgust '' And they all decided to go in the stables anyways!" Adora exclaimed. She wasn't too happy with him. The Queen had ordered her, Glimmer and Bow to clean up the mess. She wasn't upset with the Queen. It was a fair punishment.

Swift Wind then sighed and looked over to Adora again. She was taking off her red jacket to reveal that her usual white turtle neck was replaced with a sleeveless one instead. It also had a keyhole on the chest. A more mature and fashionable piece of clothing for Adora. And Adora was no one for fashion. Glimmer once had to scold her for trying to wear her socks with sandals. Well, not exactly once, maybe two or three times.

Adora looked over and saw the Queen coming their way. She had several bags with her. She saw Adora and smiled at the young girl, to which Adora smiled back and placed her hands on her hips, flexing a bit, hoping the Queen would compliment her on her clothing choice. And maybe her muscles, too. The Queen's smile faded while looking at Swiftwind with bags around his saddle. Not that she was smiling about Adora's muscle, no, a grown woman like her? Pfft, what a joke.

"Oh, I see we are taking..." The Queen said with a disgusted grin,‘'...the horse?" She asked in a muffled scoff not even attempting to hide her disdain for him.

Adora blinked and looked back at him. His face looking directly at the Queen not hiding his dislike to her either. "I have a name" he stated harshly.

Ignoring him, the Queen looked at Adora. "I assure you, He…" Angella looked at the horse through her peripherical vision, squinting before looking back at the blonde ‘'...will not be needed for the entirety of our mission. The area has been mapped out to perfection in timing. Two days travel by carriage, a carriage that is in fact powered by magic," Angella relaxed her shoulders, ignoring the presence of the talking animal. Seeing Adora's frown made her add in "It wouldn't be fair to let him carry us for such a long amount of time"

It was a lie. She just really didn't want the extra company. The talking horse to her was in no way charming. A rainbow palette that was the opposite of fashionable, a sarcastic voice that reminded her of some misogynistic moron that probably made fun of the dead once or twice, who probably thought that being gay was a personality trait. For She-Ra, she just despised the horse with all of her might. But Adora always seemed to lit up when the horse was around her, so she kept her desire to banish the horse from Brightmoon's surroundings to herself. How could she allow herself to destroy the blonde's happiness? She at least owed her that from saving Brightmoon.

Adora nodded, turning to Swift Wind—who was already removing his saddle with his own teeth, tearing the leather and grossly leaving saliva on what was left of the belt.

"Fine, I get it," He said throwing his head back, making his hair flow against the wind." The Queen hates horses " once the bags were off, he started to trot away, telling the Queen "Gumdrop always hated her name, by the way" with disdain impregnated in his voice before flying away.

An offended look came over Angella's face. The look of absolutely being mortified came over Adora.

"Your majesty! I'm so sorry—He's just—"

Angella shook it off. Her wings fluttered a bit in annoyance.

"Not to worry, Adora. It will take a lot more than insulting my choice in names to upset me"

She then motioned for Adora to follow her. Adora saw a bit of a smile come over her face as they walked away.

"Your majesty?" She dared to question after a few seconds of silence.

Angella looked at her, allowing her to ask her doubts away with a soft hum.

Adora rubbed her forearm, contemplating the grass beneath her steps, "I—I uh," She stuttered, '' I was wondering… What exactly is our mission about?" Adora finally dared to ask.

Angella gave her a bit of perplexed look "You forgot already? I addressed it in the meeting with the other Princesses's. You were looking at me the whole time, I thought that you were paying attention to me, I mean…" Angella looked forward once again, a small playful smile covering her face. ''...what else would you be doing looking at me with such attention?"

Adora went red at that declaration. In the meeting she was awestruck and the Queen had taken notice of it. Angella gave her a smile before walking forward, her smile fading slowly until a small frown occupied its place completely,

"The Scorpion Kingdom is breaking ties with the Horde. They have requested our assistance in having the exit of the horde in their kingdom. The Horde has no intention of leaving peacefully" That name reminded Adora of someone. She knew that name. She didn't make it to force captain orientation, but that name made something tingle in the back of her mind. ' and well, in the Horde, there was a Force Captain from that Kingdom"

Maybe it was Scorpia? If that was true. Was Scorpia still with Catra?

She really didn't want to run into Catra while going on this mission with the Queen.

After a moment of silent meditation from both women, Adora spoke once again, "What do you think is going to happen once we get there?"

Angella's wings slightly fluttered "We are only there for negotiations into the Rebellion and not conflict, Adora"

The younger girl flinched a bit. The Queen's stern voice and obvious discomfort were clear to Adora. Angella didn't want conflict. And Adora obviously didn't want to disappoint her. A silent nod was everything that Adora responded to the Queen with. In silence, Adora allowed the Queen to guide her to the carriage that would get them to The Scorpion Kingdom.

"These are a bit outdated and not very appealing—" Angella admitted," but they are operated on magic so it will move on its own. Oh, and the inside is larger than what it appears to be" The Queen said with an approving nod for herself.

Adora quickly grabbed her and the Queens bags and placed them in, eager to see something that worked with magic as close as she

could.

“Wow, it even has a bathroom and little stove!” Adora stated with her first peek inside the vehicle. She noticed there were two hammocks for sleeping adjacent from each other. She was going to be sleeping in the same small space as the Queen. That surprised her, leaving her frozen on the doorframe.

“Adora” The Queen softly called. The young girl rushed to her, leaving her frozen state as quickly as she heard the voice of her highness. “Adora,” She repeated to make sure she had her full attention “We will be spending much of our time together these next few months, so I think I have to be honest with you on some things,”

Adora’s eyes went wide “...Like?” Being the confidant of the Queen somehow excited her in ways she could not describe.

The Queen took a deep breath and continued “I have never faced the Horde myself directly, I will need you to assist me with all protocol and warning signs of trouble, I’m not one for fighting—I am hardly combat trained, mostly because I never needed to use it...” She trailed out with some sorrow in her tone as she rubbed her forearm.

Adora assured her, placing her hands on her own hips and flexing a bit

“Queen Angella,” Adora’s voice roared, ‘’ you don’t need to worry. I’m here for you on this mission, I won’t disappoint you” She stated in her She-Ra-like voice. Angella looked at her and smiled.

“That’s why I wanted you to come with me, I know you are no one to judge, but I would have liked this time to bond with Glimmer—but I couldn’t handle the idea of her looking down on me for being afraid or ignorant, useless...” Angella closed her eyes as she sighed the last word, opening them softly to look into Adora’s eyes for a moment making the two smile at each other.

“You don’t know how grateful I am about you being so understanding and kind to me, Adora.”

Adora nodded and smiled, her chest aching from the praise those words meant for her “Anything for you, my Queen” She replied smoothly, a smug smile creeping into her lips.

A small giggle escaped the Queen’s lips “Thank you, Adora, now, please, no need to flex your arms at me”

The blonde instantly went pink; and crossed her arms “S—sorry, I guess it’s a She-Ra side effect” she tried to laugh off the embarrassment, all of her high plummeting down into the ground quickly.

Angella smiled and made her way to the carriage. “Or is it the new clothes?” Angella covered a teasing laugh with the back of her hand, ‘’ you look very nice, by the way.” she said, peeking into Adora’s keyhole before she went into the carriage.

Adora tried to shake off the blush as she made her way to the carriage. Was her clothing choice too provocative for a diplomatic mission?

Several minutes into their journey and the vehicle was dead quiet. Adora felt awkward and didn’t know what to say. She wasn’t a person of casual conversations, chit chat, and it wasn’t hard for anyone who talked to Adora when she wasn’t She-Ra to notice that. Angella, who was in the back of the carriage, came back to where Adora was silently staring into the floor.

“Are you usually this quiet with Bow and Glimmer?” Angella asked, trying to start a conversation with the younger girl.

Adora looked away to answer “A little in the beginning, I just asked them a lot of questions and Bow answered most of them. Glimmer at first was annoyed but got used to it. I try not to ask

too much since it usually annoys her." Adora admitted with embarrassment taking her voice.

Angella sat next to her "Well, do you have any questions for me?"

Adora looked at her, mouth half open as if she was insulted by the statement. "I couldn't ask you personal questions! You? The Queen? Answering personal questions for me!?"

Angella grinned at her reaction "Don't be so prudent with me. Say… '' Angella moved closer to her, making Adora's heart go ballistic inside her chest, ''...just ask me questions that you are curious about?"

Adora fiddled with her hands, looking away from Angella "Uh— okay, umm, what's a good question to ask you?"

Angella smiled at her and placed her hand on Adora's shoulder "May I ask you some questions, then?"

Adora nodded, ignoring the feeling in her lower stomach that began to burn her guts.

"Okay then, first…" Angella fiddled with the textile of the turtleneck, thinking of something she could test the waters with, '' In the Horde, did you attend school?"

Adora nodded "Yes, I did. We had academic time in the morning and after lunchtime, we had combat training. I did well in class"

"Good, what is your birthday?"

"January 19th, Bow told me that you people of Etheria celebrate birthdays. So, I'm looking forward to having a birthday party soon." Adora said with a bittersweet feeling spreading across her chest.

Angella gave her a warm smile. "Your birthday is coming up soon. I suppose we will be celebrating your 16th or 17th birthday, then?"

Adora's eyes widen a bit "Oh, no, I'm 19-years-old now. I'll be 20 in two months"

Angella's eye went wide "I didn't realize you were that much older than my Glimmer! She's just 16!"

"Oh, I didn't know that. I know Mermista and I are the same age"

Angella was still a bit shocked to realize Adora was older than what she had expected. The girl was so innocent faced and baby-like. It's hard to believe Adora, was an adult technically"

Adora then asked her a question—be it a slightly rude one "How old are you?"

Angella's eyebrow raised "Well. If you'd like to know. I'm 42"

Adora could see some slight displeasure in Angella's face after answering that "I'm sorry, was that rude of me to ask?"

Angella sighed "For many women, it would be a sore subject—but I don't take offense" She gave Adora a wink and finished with "I know I look good for my age"

Adora giggled at that "You're right" the blonde confessed.

Angella then took Adora being more relaxed to ask typical embarrassing mom questions.

"So, any boyfriends in the horde?"

Adora looked confused "Huh? I had two guys in my squad. Is that what you mean? A friend whose gender is male?"

"No dear," A snort escaped Angella's mouth ' did you date anyone in the Horde?"

Adora chuckled "What? No way! Shadow Weaver said I couldn't waste time on such thing. But cadets do typically date each other

if that is of your interest."

Angella questioned, raising an eyebrow, "Why were you told you couldn't date?"

"Because I was supposed to be a Force Captain. Which is odd, since many force Captains get married to one another" she paused before asking her question "How did you and your husband meet?"

Angella smiled at her. Adora was worried that a question like that was one that she shouldn't ask. But Angella was actually quite happy to answer that. It was nice to bounce on the good memories of Micah.

"We met when I was a little bit younger than Glimmer. It was a strategic meeting between the angelic group of Brightmoon and the Sorcerers of Mystacor" she chuckled a bit at the memory "My mother was in no way shying away from the idea of me finding a betrothal—"

Her face started to flush a bit at the retelling "She decided it was best to walk me over to a group of sorcerers in training and announced I was the Princess of Bright Moon and I need to find a husband"

Adora gasped slightly, "Oh, no!"

"Oh, yes." Angella closed her eyes as if that action would help her revive the memory better. '"Then she decided to leave me there, completely red-faced. In front of about seven or eight handsome dark-haired boys. I panicked. I apologized for my mother's intrusion and left as soon as I could"

Angella looked at Adora to see her shocked expression "I would assume you would have done the same in my position? Right?"

Adora nodded "I guess I would. Catra and Lonnie used to say boys have cooties, and you must punch it out of them. So, I got in trouble once for being too forceful in combat training with the

male cadets. Shadow Weaver still rewarded me, but no one except Catra would sit and have lunch with me for about a week after that"

Angella let out a light laugh "Oh, well that's something I suppose a young child would fall for, right?"

Adora bit her lip and averted her eyes before replying "Heh, well, you see…" She bit her lip before quickly answering; '' I was told that two months before I left the Horde, actually"

The two looked at each other for a moment and laughed at that.

Once they stopped Adora finished her question "So, After that. How did you and Micah start to date?"

Angella rolled her eyes a bit, remembering what followed "First off, the boys all fawned over me for days. Showing off, using magic to do ridiculous things, bringing me flowers, trying to wrestle on another in front of me to see if I was paying attention, and *flexing*" She put a little more emphasis on flexing to bring a point to Adora, which Adora read loud and clear as she relaxed her arms again and her ears where now as red as her face. She quickly moved her face away, staring in the opposite direction of the Queen.

She continued, inspecting Adora's jawline "Micah was the most humbling. He was sweet and polite. He could relate to me when it came to embarrassing families can be, I'm sure you've seen how charming Castaspella can be. We kept our meetings in secret"

"Then you told them?"

Angella let out a slightly nervous laugh "No—no, actually. '' she coughed, '' We kept it secret for several months after. I would attend Mystacor meetings on my own as Princess and Micah would be my guide through the city. Eventually, they caught on and spied on one of our dates and… saw us kiss" she finished in a slightly embarrassed tone.

“How bad was that?”

Angella deadpanned to Adora “Put it this way. It was Castaspella’s favorite story to tell people at our wedding”

Adora chuckled “I’d like to share the embarrassment with you, but I’ve never kissed anyone yet, so I don’t know the feeling...” Adora confessed.

Angella then snuck in a tricky question “Well, but I’m sure Glimmer and Bow have kissed in front of you?” She asked this in a sneaky way. She had a feeling that Glimmer and Bow had something for each other. It's not like Glimmer would tell her. Maybe Adora could of.

Adora fell for the bait quite quickly and replied with a shrug “Oh yeah they have, only twice but it wasn’t right in front of me. It was like, off to the distance. Mermista and Sea Hawk are the same”

Angella raised a brow. Her assumption was correct. Adora’s eyes came back to the Queen’s when she stayed in silence for more than a few seconds. Adora tilted her head to the side, not exactly knowing what she did for the Queen to react that way. The Queen then gave Adora a coy look and that’s how Adora realized she had said too much.

“I—I feel like that thing with Bow and Glimmer was supposed to be secret”

Angella smiled as she shook her head softly, “No, I always knew. Glimmer denies it, though.”

Adora looked away “She’s afraid you’ll be more restrictive of him being around if you assumed something was going on” Adora admitted. She knew it was a secret but Angella was a lot more reasonable then Glimmer lead her to believe.

Angella nodded “Bow is a gentleman, he knows better. Glimmer has always been smitten with him. I could tell by her several slip-

ups in front of me”

“Like?”

Angella chuckled “She tends to spark a bit when she becomes flustered. It was a feature of her father’s”

“Oh”

“It’s very cute. Next time you’re with Glimmer you should ask her how her secret dates with Bow are” She said with a wicked grin.

“Oh, I see. Let me do the dirty work, huh?” Adora questioned with a sly smile.

“For your efforts, I will assure you that when you decide to start dating anyone I will make sure no one will tease”

They laughed.

Hours into the journey Angella made them tea— or more like showed Adora how to make tea and stopped her from eating the tea bag. The younger one’s ignorance was blissfully adorable. Adora was charming. Sweet and eager to make people happy. She was reminded of herself at that age. But Adora—despite being raised in the cruel world of the horde, was not emotionally hardened by this. She was always so wide-eyed when it came to new things. She was far from stupid—but she was definitely no genius when it came to social cues. She could tell by this since Adora was practically sitting on top of her while they drank tea inside the carriage. This was an affection no one has shown to the Queen in years.

She didn’t want to ruin it by asking Adora to move away—so she embraced it. She draped a blanket over the two of them and they were able to sleep for a bit. After resting in a slightly uncomfortable position, Angella carried Adora to her hammock so she could sleep through the night. Angella settled into her bed too, looking over at Adora she saw how peaceful the girl slept. An incredibly cute sight, to be truthful.

Her company was nice. She would have tried to take this opportunity for the mission to be with Glimmer, as it intended her original plan, but she knew by this time of night they would have at least argued for the entirety of the day.

Adora was enjoyable to be around. She was a sweet girl.

Girl? Wait. She's two months away from being twenty. She was a sweet young adult. Just knowing her age made Angella feel a slight relief she never had before.

It was nice to have someone lower their own guard and just act casual with her.

Adora didn't realize it, but she made the Queen's night.

In the morning when they woke up Adora—found herself laying by herself. The Queen was already awake and brushing her wet hair from her early morning shower. The Carriage had a shower. Odd since it was so tiny. She guested for Adora to do the same. Stepping into the small bathroom she undressed and ran the shower head; feeling the warm water come over she noticed all the body and hair care products out where what Angella used. She would have all those same smells on her own body. She lathered her hair with shampoo and began to wash her body with the body wash. It smelled like the Queen.The amount of familiar and *surprisingly pleasant* smells made a strong heat came over her lower body. She felt her cheeks flush – she realized what was going on with her. She let the shampoo rinse out of her hair as one of her hands made it to her private area.

Am I really going to do this? Oh, god, she might be in the carriage! Adora thought.

But her hormones got the better of her and she began to massage the built-up tension out of her. Her fingers rubbed her clitoris softly as she thought to herself;

The bonding, the talking, hearing her laugh, watching her smile, being too casual with the Queen made her feel special. Like,

Adora was more than just She-Ra to her. Adora's mind began to fantasize, with such things like *What would Angella do if it was just the two of them in this tiny shower together? Maybe act motherly. Probably wash Adora from behind her. Tell her how strong she was, how brave she was, how her ni—*

Angella decided to sit in front of the carriage to drink her tea. Her usually attire was replaced with dark blue pants, normal boots, and a light purple top. A dark purple clock covered her wings. After hearing Adora's tiny moans—she figured she shouldn't stay in the carriage while the young lady showered.

The girl probably didn't realize she was doing It so loudly. Angella felt her face burn as she heard Adora through the thin walls.

She's a young lady, never had a boyfriend and clearly had some needs. Angella flushed at the idea of what Adora was doing to herself.

It is natural. But still embarrassing! What in Etheria could this girl be thinking of?

Adora's behavior has been like that of someone having a crush.

If Adora is pining for someone; then who?

Angella's thoughts were cut short as she heard something rushing up to where the carriage was. On her right—absolute fear came over her as she saw a Horde land cruiser behind the carriage. It was so silent she could have mistaken the sound for a wild animal. Her heart dropped and she froze. Unable to speak—unable to call for Adora. She saw as the cruiser door opened and a soldier in full Horde armor emerged with a blaster gun in hand.

"Stop this contraption— you dirty magic user!" He commanded.

Her eyes were filling with tears now, being so far from her kingdom, unable to use her magic at its fullest, she placed her hands on the carriage and her hands began to glow. It was slowing down. The Cruiser did the same. Her heart was racing.

As soon as the cruiser stopped behind them, she quickly made the carriage speed forward—several times faster to what the carriage was going prior.

Adora—still in the shower was confused as she fell out of the bathroom with only a towel wrapped around.

"Angella! What's going on?" she called.

"The horde!" Angella yelled back. Adora quickly grabbed her sword.

"Don't worry I can handle this—Ah!—"

The two fell forward out of the carriage as the cruiser hit them with a blast. Angella without thinking jolted into the air and revealed her wings to the oncoming vehicle.

"Its Queen Angella of Bright moon!" she heard him call as he took his blaster and aimed it for her. Trembling with fear she held her hands up, her hands glowing with her magic as she began to shoot at the vessel, aiming to the cannon blaster. The blaster moved and directly shot at the carriage.

"Adora!" She cried. Fearing the girl was injured.

The soldier ran to Angella with a stun gun in hand, ready to strike her down. She had to fly through several blasts, avoiding the incoming fire from the Horde soldier. Then, a muffled scream came from the inside of the carriage, her salvation;

"For the honor of Grayskull!"

And then a beam of light came from the wreckage of the carriage and She-Ra stood up. Swinging her sword, she rushed over to the solider and disarmed him. Now the only one afraid was him. Adora made her way to the cruiser and destroyed it. Leaving in unable to drive. She then rushed to the Queen's side.

"Are you okay?" she asked.

Angella fell to her kneels still shaking a bit, but now breathing loudly. "Fine, fine. Just taken for the surprise, I guess. And you, Adora? How are you?" Adora kneeled next to her and returned to her regular self

" I'm fine" she stated, shuddering, suddenly feeling very cold. Angella quickly took her cloak off to wrap around the younger girl. Adora squeaked when she realized she was naked outside. Looking at the carriage she assumed most of their stuff must be ruined. As Adora kept her gaze on the wrecked vehicle, Angella did the same, sighing with annoyance.

"It's wont drive now" Angella stated.

Adora looked over to the cruiser "Neither will the cruiser. But we can take his supplies. He will be out cold for at least an hour" She said going into the turned over cruiser. After several minutes she returned with black pants and a black tank top since she had no time to do her hair when she let the shower, her hair was down. Angella was very fond of it, she may have been a little fonder of Adora being naked, but she wasn't going to dwell on those thoughts. The girl was only 19 after all.

Angella was able to get a few things from the damaged carriage that weren't destroyed. Now the two were ready with what they had left for their journey, but they were still at least another day away from coming close to the Scorpion Kingdom.

Angella then motioned to Adora "Come, Adora. I'll fly us the rest of the way"

Adora was not a fan of this idea. "Wait, like, you're going to carry me?"

"More like a piggy back ride"

Adora's face went a dark shade of red. "Is there a second option one that isn't so embarrassing, for me at least?"

Angella's eyes narrowed "Stop acting like Glimmer and just get on" She instructed sharply.

Adora gulped and stepped closer to the Queen. "Okay, how?"

Angella kneeled "Get on my back, use my arms to move your feet into and that will support you from walling once I get us off the ground"

Adora did as she was instructed. Angella had two bags that she would carry with her while flying and Adora had the rest on her own back. This wasn't an ideal way to travel but as soon as they could spot the Kingdom from this high level, they would be able to figure out how much time in the sky they would be in.

Angella looked over and saw the beginning of where the kingdom was situated "Ah, look, this will be a short flight, we are going over these mountains here, so I assume it will take us an hour, to say the least."

Adora nodded and buried her face into the Queen's neck. Unknowing to her, this was a very sensitive spot for her majesty. It used to be one of Micah's favorite places to tickle and tease with his beard.

Maybe flying was a bad idea.

If she kept feeling Adora's breathe on her neck; she may need to relieve herself in the same way Adora did early in the shower.

They finally made it to the first town into the castle. Exhausted Angella finally landed to rest. Adora quickly got off her back and grabbed the backs in Angella's hands.

"Thank you, your high--...Angella"

Angella took a few deep breathes, managing to smile through the process "You're Welcome, Adora. We are closer now"

Looking around they saw some villagers whispering and staring at them. One approached them. He was A Scorpion person. Small black claws and a small tail, a bit of an overbite and scraggly black hair.

"Ladies, Welcome to sharp Town; the first village of the Scorpion Kingdom."

The two smiled at the warm introduction. Several others, both Scorpion and Lizard people began to walk over to them.

Angella took this moment and politely bowed "Thank you for your kind introduction, we are from Brightmoon, and we are here to speak with the King"

Adora heard from behind them that someone had called the Queen beautiful. She turned to look at who said it—it was two young Scorpion teenage girls. Adora couldn't help but give them a sour look for looking at Angella like that. She didn't realize Angella was walking away during this and Adora quickly rushed over to them.

A feast was being made in their honor for coming at such a dreadful time.

"The king is unable to speak with you at this moment. The Scorpion Princess will be here with her escort shortly. I should advise you—she is accompanied by the most feared member of the horde, the second in command after Hordak"

Angella was unfazed by this information.

Adora's heard started to swirl.

This means; it is indeed Scorpia, and Scorpia means Catra.

If Catra is here, this won't be easy.

The two were led to a table surrounded with other Horde and civilians around it.

The man from before introduced them "Everyone, Queen and Adora and her guard from BrightMoon"

No one knew Adora was She-Ra, and this would be beneficial for later if they needed to escape.

The two sat close to one another. Bags still in hand. Adora's sword was wrapped up. No one suspected anything strange from her having a sword. She was introduced as a guard Afterall. Adora noticed there were a lot of more random species here in the town, maybe all the Scorpion people lived in the castle?

Her thoughts were interrupted as he then introduced;

"Princess Scorpia, retired horde Force Captain" Scorpia then entered the room by herself. In a black bodysuit and kneels, ruby earrings and a dark red shawl around her shoulders. She sat next to Queen Angella and nodded to her.

"Thank you for your attendance, your Majesty, I know the last time I was in your Kingdom, was not for the best reasons. I hope you can forgive me"

Angella nodded and patted her claw as a sign of motherly affection.

"We will move forward from that. Thank you for having us"

Scorpia looked over and grated "Hey, Adora"

Adora awkwardly waved and returned the greeting "Hi, Scorpia. Is Catra—"

They were interrupted by the man introducing another person "Please welcome with us, the Second in Command from the Ev—I mean the Horde's Army, second on Command Captain Catra, the feared"

Adora felt her heart drop as she saw Catra.

She had on a black cape, and she was wearing metal boots with matching arm protectors. She looked meaner and menacing since the last time she saw her.

All she saw were her eyes and her signature smirk “Hey, Adora” was the only thing she heard in the entire room.

Catra was here and this wasn’t good.

Dinner with Catra

Adora’s body became tense as Catra sat next to her. She felt the feline girl’s tail brush against her thigh. The grin on Catra’s face was telling as to what she wanted to do. Catra looked at her, two different colored eyes going up and down to see the former Horde soldier in nothing more than a black tank top, no bra and black pants. Not to mention her hair was windswept and not pulled back in her regular fashion.

Adora was as uneasy as possible and couldn’t obvious contain it.

She turned and gave Catra a serious look “Why are you here?”

The phrase in question was more of a command. Catra removed her head gear, her bangs pushed back, and her forehead was visible, showing a new small scar on her left side to her hairline. She wasn't on her Horde attire.

“Well, Adora," She said on that tone that made Adora want to kill her right there in front of everyone," In cases like this it would be accustomed to greet someone properly before demanding questions” she coolly replied, signaling Adora to look behind her.

Adora glanced over to see that Angella and Scorpia had seen the whole interaction. Adora’s face burned as she saw Angella’s eyebrow raise to her. A clear indication of her disappointment. Angella spoke softly.

“Commander Catra, thank you for your attendance in this time of peaceful negotiation” Angella stood to bow in respect as Catra did the same.

Catra giving a quick look at Adora replied to the Queen “I thank you for your attendance as well, Queen Angella of Bright Moon. These next several days should be pleasant for both sides. Your attendance is an honor, your Majesty.”

Adora looked down at her lap. Catra was so calm and respectful to Queen Angella. She couldn’t detect the fakeness and snark in her voice and that troubled her. No, that was driving her crazy.

The Horde is evil and by default Catra and Scorpia are too. So why is she the only weary of them? Why aren't they acting evil in the slightest? They should be, at least, rude towards Angella. They should act as one would expect an enemy to act.

A server came over and presented them with plates of food. Nothing Adora has ever seen on Bright Moon before. It looked… Odd, to say the least.

Angella placed a napkin on her lap and instructed Adora to do the same. The blonde received a snicker from Catra. Adora was out of her element. Clearly Catra became classier then her in the time apart, having risen to a higher level of maturity. Adora felt she had become less mature while being around teenagers. Glimmer and Bow were younger than her and the other princesses were more relaxing to be around. It didn’t dawn on her until now that

she was out of place between everyone there. No one was on her level. Not in a good way. She felt below everyone.

Adora just felt out of place.

Angella was then introduced formally to Scorpia and the two shared a brief conversation on how nice everything looked.

“I haven’t been home since I was seven” the soon-to-be Queen of the Scorpion Kingdom said.

Angella nodded and replied, “I haven’t visited this kingdom since I was about seventeen, diplomatic missions and such. Never for my own pleasure, though.”

“You should come here more - with the Horde leaving and all...” She trailed off awkwardly. For Scorpia this was nerve wracking. To have the Queen of Bright moon present was something the Horde taught her to fear. Meeting her in real life was so calming and nice. It was like talking to her mom again.

Angella could see her discomfort and patted her claw and agreed with her and smiled warmly.

“I will definitely make the trip more often, as should you with Brightmoon”

Scorpia nodded and smiled back brightly.

"Y-yes, I will definitely" Scorpia replied back.

Catra just rolled her eyes.

'Oh, Please. Like you really want to come here. Yeah right!'

There wasn't an award silence at the table for long as the last one to arrive to the table was Scorpia's father; The King. Scorpia clearly took after him, with her large red claws and white hair. He was also very tall. Angella found him attractive due to his beard being styled the same as Micah. Although he was indeed much older.

Adora—well, she was a mess as she watched in awe how linguistically skilled Angella was. She was charming and calm, and she spoke with confidence and wisdom when discussing matters of both Kingdoms and what the Rebellion can offer their kingdom.

Adora continued to stay quiet, she just watched and listened. This started to annoy Catra as she realized her once dominating and bold friend was now relitigated to someone so mindless, so submissive, to just sit and watch the grown-ups talk.

If she was a Force Captain, she would be different. Why does Queen Glitterbomb bring her here if Adora wasn't going to be She-Ra?

Wait? Why are they looking us now? What are they talking about?

Catra thought to herself. She noted the tip of Adora's ear turn red and Angella gestured to Adora.

"My guard Adora is fantastic in combat and she will accompany me everywhere I will go" Angella said to them. Everyone now looking at Adora.

Scorpia knows Adora is She-Ra, why didn't she tell her dad?

Another thought that went through Catra's mind.

The King nodded and looked to Catra. He then spoke, perhaps a bit louder then needed.

"Ah, Such strong young ladies! My Scorpia is very fond of Catra— It's good to see they are still friends despite this conflict and that Catra insisted on coming here with Scorpia"

Scorpia and Catra looked at each other, giving each other and all-knowing look that whatever the King would say next would most like be inappropriate.

"I mean those have been inseparable since they got here" He said pointing one claw to Scorpia and another at Catra "In fact they best friends in the Fright Zone. Isn't that wonderful!"

Adora felt the Catra's tail twitch upward and touched her back unintentionally —this was an old indication to Adora that Catra was flustered, possibly embarrassed and/or uncomfortable.

Scorpia shot over a nervous glance to Catra who looked away to take a sip of her drink. The king then corrected himself by clearing his throat and turning to Scorpia who wanted to be anywhere but here after him saying that.

"Sorry, sweetie" he said with a laugh.

Angella smiled at this.

Nothing is more fun than when parents get to embarrass their children. In his very few words he clearly painted the picture that Scorpia and Catra were very fond of one another. Angella saw how Scorpia's face turned a deeper shade of red.

The king was able to shift the conversation back to delegations quickly, much to Catra and Scorpia's relief.

The conversation continued as the food came. Adora was silent, failing to keep any eye contact at all when she accidentally started it, or when someone asked her something. Her answers were vague, not going past five or six words limit per response. Catra

found this annoying - this wasn't the person she had grown fond of. This wasn't the person she had relied on for so long.

Catra was one to pay attention to social interactions better then Adora ever was. In the Horde, everything felt like it was custom made for Adora. Here in the real world it wasn't that way - you had to adapt. Not just take orders and go blind into anything your superior said you had to do. No one was on Adora's time anymore. Shadow Weaver couldn't elect Adora the team leader and they listen to her whatever she wanted to do. She could feel Adora's nervousness next to her and to prove she was the superior force captain and leader she was going to enjoy making Adora was uneasy as possible. Just like at the Princess Prom.

She was going to enjoy tonight.

Despite Angella not knowing much to anything about Catra she was no fool to the mischief smirk of a trouble maker. Angella was not born yesterday and she will be damned if this young lady would bring discomfort to her or Adora.

Angella made it a point to shoot Catra a serious look—to which Catra caught on and simply smiled in her face.

This girl is trouble. *I'll have to keep her under my sight.*

Thinking about that, she carried on her conversation with the King as Scorpia chimed in several times to bring up points about the

Horde and their exit strategy. The girl was smart, she wasn't one to lie when she saw intelligence on a person's gaze, and she made it clear every time Scorpia stopped talking, complimenting her whenever she said something clever and well-meant.

Adora listened to them as Catra nudged her several times in the leg to get her attention. Adora didn't want to engage with Catra and miss anything Angella would say, but eventually she gave in after having a lump of something grey landing on her plate. Adora glared at Catra who grinned back. Adora flung some back at her when no one was looking and Catra was about to give it back to her until she saw the Queen's disapproving gaze.

"Having fun, Commander Catra?" she asked. Her prim and proper accent making the word commander sound so regal. Adora smiled as Catra got caught by the Rebellion's Queen.

Scorpia shot Catra a glare while her father just chuckled

"Oh, good, Catra made another friend!" He exclaimed as more food came to the table.

Adora noticed that Angella wasn't eating anything more than salad. Adora hadn't put anything on her plate since she didn't know what was good or not. Nervously, she placed some spicy food on to her plate and tried to eat it normally. To her dismay she did not have the palate for spicy food and quickly rushed to a drink. She was not discreet in this at all and Angella frowned at her lack of class. Catra chuckled to herself and ate the exact same thing as Adora did and didn't react at all to the spice. Clearly

Catra had a high tolerance for spicy foods. "*Idiot"* said Catra's burlesque expression when Adora stared at her awaiting for Catra to react the same way she did. It didn't happen, for Adora's dismay.

While the King was talking to another person Angella whispered in Adora's ear "If you're unsure of something don't let it touch the tip of your tongue. If you can't swallow it place your napkin over your mouth and spit it out."

Adora nodded and smiled, "I take it you are familiar with that practice?"

"Micah and I would always do this on our travels or dare each other on how many new foods we can try without feeling sick." Her eyes traveled to her lap, smiling as she felt the memory of Micah and her ages ago creeping slowly into her mind. Taking a small sip from her cup she shook it off.

"Who would win those?"

"Micah of course!" she replied with a laugh. Her darling Micah had the palate for almost anything. Angella on the other hand was sensitive to spices, fatty food and anything with onions or garlic in it. She put on a brave face anytime she had to eat something she hated. Micah would do the same. Mostly she stuck with salads. Everyone just would assume the Queen was watching her figure. Unknown to them she was bandit for sweets. Micah was to, but his weight showed more on him. Despite being muscular he was a stocky man and after Glimmer was born, he was teased

between their closest friends about when he would lose the baby weight.

She found herself smiling while she watched Adora try to be discreet with eating another intensely spicy food.

Catra watched how poorly Adora handled her spices and then mockingly asked a server to bring the “youngest” member at the table something more kid friendly.

As much as Adora wanted to remind Catra that she was older then her, she stopped herself and accepted defeat. She was served something that looked close enough to a plate of French fries and chicken nuggets. Just what an eight-year-old would eat.

As much as Angella found this disappointing she couldn’t blame Adora for it. On the other hand, Angella found Catra to be a smart-ass and she wasn’t going to let Adora feel embarrassed and asked for one of her fries. Adora got the treat and shifted her position to hand feed it to Angella. The Queen didn't flinch at how informal the people around her could think they were being, The Queen of Brightmoon being hand fed by her guard? *Unthinkable!* But she enjoyed Catra's reaction - how she narrowed eyes and how her lips curved downwards in disgust and understanding, and how finally she took her eyes off Adora.

Adora, you are such an ass kisser! Catra thought to herself.

The King just beamed “Who doesn’t love a good fry once in a while, am I right?”

Angella settled herself back in her seat and smiled “your right”

Catra wanted to throw a bread roll at her.

‘How!? How does anyone not know your full of shit?! You just pulled that little stunt because you didn’t want Adora to feel like crap!’

After drinking wine to help the people digest their meals easier, the King made a toast honoring Queen Angella’s arrival and how grateful he was of her presence, and most importantly, how finally it was time to mingle. Adora gulped. Social interaction. Extravagant social interaction among the high class.

But she wasn't one of them, what was she supposed to do but follow Angella around like a puppy?

Angella decide it could be great to have her introduced to other diplomats in the Kingdom. She was surprised by the lack of grace and tactfulness by the Kingdom’s high officials. They seemed in awe with her, and despite their lack of curtesy she kept her cool and spoke as if they were talking with the same level of vocabulary as her even when they cut off each other while they spoke, standing too close for her comfort and even going as far as one to lift her off the ground to embrace her. Adora didn’t like this

one bit and could tell Angella was extremely uncomfortable and made it a point to get Angella away from them.

She put her hand in between Angella and another gentleman and excused her and the Queen from the crowd.

“Thank you, Adora, I mean it.”

She sounded relived to be away from people for a bit.

“They didn’t give you any space to breathe, it was just—question after question. I’ve never seen anyone act like that over you. And that lady grabbed your wings and—” Adora was more offended by everyone’s fawning over the queen, and she wasn't one to hold her disdain from the whole situation.

Angella waved her hand to her “Adora, I have not seen anyone of this Kingdom since I was crowned Queen. Customs in each Kingdom are very different, as you have seen. The lack of manners is something I cannot be offended by, everyone here is happy for our presences.”

Adora casted her eyes downward “I guess, but that doesn’t mean it’s okay”

“Adora, everything is well, I don’t have to worry if you’re here with me. " Lifting Adora’s chin she assured her. For a second, she

got lost in her eyes.

Nodding, she extended her forearm towards the Queen, looking forwards in a manner to keep herself from losing her mind on the older woman's gaze.

“Shall I escort you back to the others?”

Angella smiled and wrapped her arm around Adora’s arm

“Please, Adora. That would be lovely”

All the while Catra watched this from across the assumed to be empty hallway.

“Oh, Queen Angella, please say that I’m a good little solider and how special I am, I’m the She-ra, blah blah, blah, and I need to feel important” mocked out loud while Scorpia listened from behind her.

“Still hate her, huh?”

Catra chuckled and crossed her arms “I don’t hate her, I pity her. Adora was supposed to be Shadow Weaver’s prized pupil,” she

laughed to herself, “Oh, and if Shadow Weaver could see her now. Playing guard duty for the worst leader in Etheria's history”

Scorpia looked puzzled “Uh, worst leader goes to my Dad, The Bright Moon Kingdom is actually the wealthiest Kingdom besides the Ice Kingdom”

Catra shrugged and turned to her “Yeah! But the Rebellion is a shit show! And your dad’s a cool guy. It’s not his fault Hordak crash landed here.”

Scorpia rolled her eyes “Yeah, but my dad shouldn’t have let them take the Black Garnet or build all those factories here. It's done terrible things to the land.”

Catra didn’t respond to that. She just jumped off to another subject “So, what? Are you going to pull an Adora and run off to Bright Moon?” she questioned while turning away from her.

Insulted, Scorpia instantly turned around to face her.

“Hey! My family's home is in danger because of the Horde. My dad isn’t in the best shape and I need to be prepared for the worst and—”

“Woah—Scorpia cool it! I get it. You’re under pressure” Catra assured her and patted her claws. “You act like you’re in this

alone. I’m here”

That changed Scorpia's mood almost immediately. Her body moved entirely by itself, coming closer to Catra's. And Catra didn't do anything to change the fact that they were getting closer by each second it passed.

“That begs the question…Why did Hordak ask you to come here? It’s a departure from the War. Shouldn’t you be in another colony?”

Catra grinned pressed her body up against Scorpia’s and gave her a smug look and replied “Hordak thinks I’m at another colony. He doesn’t know I’m here. Entrapta is covering for me.”

Scorpia did her best not to notice the lack of space between them when she pressed for an answer again.

“But what made you want to come here?”

Catra’s eyes flashed a bit of worry as she thought about her real reasons.

An assassin wants to Axe you and your dad

An invasion is on its way in ten days

The factories have a self-destruct setting

All thoughts Catra wanted to say but couldn't right now. She just rested her head on Scorpia's chest and replied.

"Cuz I gotta be here for you. You were there for me. It's only fair, right?"

Scorpia felt her face heat up at all this affection. She accepted her and didn't move. Loving it but also dreading when it would stop. Hopefully Catra wouldn't see her blush.

"Hey?"

"Hmm?"

"Level with me on something"

"Okay"

Catra snorted "Okay, is it me or does Adora look like total crap! I mean she's not even wearing a bra and her hair—oh don't even get me started – back in the Freight Zone Adora had this thing about making sure her hair poof was extra poofy and—"

Scorpia just deadpanned through the whole rant.

Her secret longing for a romantic moment with Catra was ruined by non-other than Catra herself. Was she here for her or just to taunt Adora?

A long groan came out of her throat when Catra was in the middle of her hate-induced rant about Adora's shoulder blades. Scorpia just walked away, leaving Catra to lose herself on her hate alone.

She wasn't going to be Catra's comforting shoulder.

Not when her kingdom was hanging from her hands.

The Suite

Chapter Summary

Adora and Angella share a room together.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

After three long hours constantly being barraged with question after question and several clawed people asking if she can fly with her wings for the 40th time in a row that night. Adora let out a loud yawn and this gave Angella the green light to ask about their living arrangements, indicating that her guard needs to rest.

Adora wasn't too fond of being the scapegoat for Angella wanting to leave, but that was the call Angella decided to make and Adora was not willing to protest to any of it. After all, she was indeed very tired. And bored. Mostly bored.

A butler to the royal family brought them to their rooms. To Adora, he looked like a very skinny and short Regalio. To their concern and confusion, they noticed the castle seemed to have been severally damaged recently as they were an shown a smaller portion of the grounds, Adora examined as they walked past a major opening in the castle's walls. So far they had a full view of the Kingdom from the opening but it was clear from the scorched stones around it that this was not an intentional design. Neither were the damaged statues and frames decorating the very drab halls.

"As you can see we are renovating" the Butler commented with a bit of humor in his tone trying to ease the uncomfortable feeling that had appeared between them as soon as they seen the state the castle was in. It was clear he was uneasy to have them see the castle in this condition.

Adora in her best attempt to seem like the fierce and protecting guard that she is she inquired "And when did this renovate start?"

Angella smirked and raised an eyebrow to Adora, clearly pleased by her confidence in how she addressed the obvious situation.

The butler just looked to the ceiling and answered with discomfort "Well—uh, you see. The Renovation happened about, uh, two weeks ago?" he said with a shrug, clearly unable to give a direct date.

It made sense to Angella. Whatever did happen triggered the Kingdom to contact Brightmoon. Therefore, this means this wasn't as peaceful as it was laid out to be. Fear then slowly crept up inside her, burshing it off as Adora walked in front of the small lizard man. Her arms obviously flexed and her hands-on-hips. She looked down at the man with a serious look.

"Well, let assure no renovations come about while my Queen and I are present, shall we?"

Angella felt a bit of heat come over her after hearing Adora use such a tone. Especially over saying my Queen.

This girl - No, this young lady is something fierce when she wants to be .

The timid man was clearly uneasy with such a display from Adora. He walked them quickly down the corridor to the royal family's private quarters. Or what was left of it.

They were brought to a joining bedroom suite with a tiny kitchenette and a shared bathroom. It wasn't as nice as Angella was hoping for but it wasn't unlivable. Adora mentally thought about how close she and Angella were now and all her butterflies and inner crushing monologues took over again, just like when they shared a bath together.

I'm going to pee in the same bathroom she does. Is that even allowed? Oh my - Oh my gosh ! what if she hear s me snore?

How thick are these walls? What will she say if she finds out I can't make tea right? Fuck!

The butler quickly excused himself before Adora could interrogate him some more. Leaving the quiet Adora and unimpressed Angella alone to themselves.

Angella inspected the table by the kitchen and ran her gloved finger over the counter "Well, it is clean at least" she said trying to bring some assurance to Adora. Or at least, to bring her back from the moon she seemed to be exploring so fondly inside her mind.

It took her a couple seconds to realize she had been spoken to, quickly asking, "Um, I—I –are you sure this is okay for you? to be this close to me?"

Angella blinked in confusion "Pardon?"

Adora then started to flail her arms around as she tried her best to sputter out some coherent explanation.

"No—no you see! I just don't understand the protocol for being in the presence of a royal that's all!"

Angella then smirked and crossed her arms. There is no possible way Adora just said that. She has lived in the castle of Brightmoon for almost a year and she really just said she doesn't know what do around a royal. Queen Angella was starting to get why Adora is so flustered around her and only really her.

She had placed her on some type of pedestal just like her entire Kingdom and daughter. She isn't seen as Angella, and only perceived as Queen Angella the Immortal Angelic being. She chose to have some fun with this.

"Really? Why would you ask that of all things, Adora, *princess* of Power, member of the *princess* alliance?"

Adora felt the tips of her ears red again, an action she was now starting to dread since the all-knowing eyes of the Queen could see through her embarrassment. She found adorable how someone who was born and raised to be so intense could come apart so easily.

Adora made one of her signature adorable squeaks as she responded “That’s different! You’re the Queen!" a chuckle came out mixed with a sigh as Adora paused to inhale before finally whispering; "Who doesn't get nervous around you?”

Adora instantly regretted saying that—watching the Queen’s smile grow she realized she was embarrassing herself yet again in front of Angella.

Angella jut grinned at this. Adora had fallen completely into her trap.

“Nervous around me still, I see?” she felt like letting out a small laugh at that but decided against it, covering her mouth with the back of her hand, an action that almost drove Adora crazy. She doubts the nineteen-year-old can barely handle anything else. She walked over to Adora and placed her free hand on her chin and warmly replied. “Well, the more time we spend together will help that change, won't it?” *my little soldier* Angella thought, feeling tempted to say something that would drive Adora completely over the edge. Stating that Adora belonged to her. *So submissive.*

She could practically see the gears in Adora’s head turn—watching the girl flush at the touch. Angella then let her hand slip down Adora’s neck before she let it fall back to her side and turned herself away from the girl to walked over to the other side of the room to inspect it.

“As for this protocal you're reffering to—I'd like to say I’m easy to live with,” She tuned back to Adora who for some reason was standing at attention, *how cute.* “Are you one to make messes?” Angella asked with her eyes staring directly into Adora's.

“No” Adora shook her head.

"No, who?"

"No, Queen Angella."

“Do you leave clothes around?”

“No, my Queen.”

“Leave dirty dishes in the sink?”

“No, your Highness.”

“Walk around naked?”

Adora then shrugged and smiled “Only if you want me to?”

Angella crossed her arms and laughed at that. Good, she’s lightening up. “Good to know, but other than that I’d say you’re the perfect roommate for this, Glimmer would have already kicked her shoes off to some random corner and try to argue with me over who gets which room.”

Adora sat herself on the couch and chuckled “Glimmer can’t be all that bad to travel with,”Angella sat down next to her and gave her a ‘who are you fooling?’ look. Adora glanced away before finishing with "then again we travel all the time, and she’s the boss.”

Angella chuckled and casted her eyes upward. “I always hated to travel," she complained, "Micah insisted we at least visit one or two other places throughout Brightmoon a month and traveling with a four-year-old Glimmer was not as cute as one would except.”

She watched as Adora stared at her with a smile. She enjoyed that Adora was listening to her and seemed to enjoy her stories. If Glimmer were here she would be furious, but lucky for the Queen her temperamental daughter was not here.

“Glimmer would often lie about having a nightmare and coming in between her father and I at night or leaving her toys and clothes around the hotel rooms on purpose. Or at least I assumed on purpose. Her room to this day is a disaster”

Adora chuckled “Well the worst Glimmer has done to me is steal my blanket at night once while we were camping out.”

Angella then quipped back with “At least she never wet your bed.”

“What?”

Angella then laughed as she remembered then incident all too well. “She was only three at the time. She slept in between Micah and I, but one night she had a little accident." Angella caught Adora's face as she closed her eyes and chuckled. Cute. " When I woke her up, she blamed her father and went back to bed.”

Adora couldn't hold her laughter anymore, “Seriously?” She didn't believe how the respected general of the Brightmoon's rebellion and heir of Brightmoon's kingdom had done something so - something so mundane! It somehow seemed hilarious in her mind.

Angella ran her finger through her hair and continued “Oh yes, and then when I brought her back to her room to clean her up and she cried and called me a ‘meanie head’ it didn’t help that Micah sided with her the next day and even played along with it and apologized to our three-year-old that he was the did it!” she exclaimed.

The two laughed at that. Adora caught a glimpse of Angella's lips as she laughed. *Extraordinare*.

Angella placed her hand on Adora’s shoulder “Please don’t tell her I told you about that.”

Adora promised she wouldn’t and followed it up with “Have any more stories you wanna share?”

Angella beamed at this. Finally—after years of not having anyone to talk to she could finally speak with someone of her joyful nostalgia. Even better, she was able to speak freely and free of the constant *high-class etiquette* with Adora she had become used to. This was a warm and inviting feeling she hadn't felt in years.

After three more embarrassing stories of Glimmer as a child she informed Adora that her back was aching and she was going to shower and rest.

Adora told her she wanted to explore a bit of the castle grounds to ensure it was safe. Angella remined her to not draw attention to herself and imply they don’t feel safe.

Adora agreed and left Angella alone.

She watched as the young lady leave the room. Now alone to her thoughts she could finally slouch a bit and extend her wings more. That piggy back ride from earlier in the day really did a number on her back. She assumed by how slender Adora was that she would be lighter to carry than Glimmer, but Adora was very lean and was still quite heavy for the Queen. She was completely worn out. Relying completely on her physical strength and not on her powers will be a very taxing for her during this mission.

She went into the bathroom and smiled at the tacky décor of moon cactus wallpaper and little toiletries packaged with cactus flowers on them. She smelled the shampoo and was surprised that it was similar in scent to what she typically liked her hair to smell like. She undressed and made her way into the shower. A copper bath tub with several faucets and a large cactus themed curtain for privacy awaited for her to relax in for the next few hours. She felt her body relax under the water washing over her. The secret anxiety she had been feeling since news arrived to Brightmoon over the Desert Kingdom's issues with the Horde had weighed on her mind. She felt Adora was the perfect person to be with on this mission and she was right. She would not have felt this comfortable with anyone else. Not even Glimmer.

Not even Micah.

Adora was examining the dilapidating parts of the castle. Adora's former Horde knowledge could confirm it was an explosive attack. It made the hair on the back of her neck stand up. It was terrible, to say the least.

A type of bomb was set off—meaning this could have been an assassination attempt. She kept looking around at the rubble. They didn't do a very good job fixing this up after it happened. It would have been in better taste to fix this up before inviting a Queen to their castle. As she looked over the opening she felt the presence of someone else watching her. She looked up to see the ever so coy smile of her once beloved friend Catra standing on what was left of the balcony above her.

"What do you want?" Adora spat out.

Catra chuckled "Oh, wow. Not even when we are alone you can show the tiniest bit of respect."

Adora rolled her eyes "Oh please! Like you are anyone to talk!"

Catra jumped down from where she was prowling and commented "Oh, look. You're wearing a bra now. Did mommy make you put one on?"

"Don't refer to her like that"

Catra then smirked as she walked away from Adora and mimicked her voice "Only if you want me to Angella. I'll walk around naked for you!"

Adora's face colored—Catra had eaves-dropped on her conversation with Angella in the room. Were the walls in this castle that thin? Adora was quick to shove her forward

"Were you spying on us!?"

Catra snickered "Well I'm applying guard duty like you—so I got to make sure Scorpia is safe."

Adora gulped. She didn't know what to say to her. She was out of her element and the feeling of Catra being dominating over her in maturity and tack were overwhelming. Catra tilted her head and gestured her to follow her.

"Come on nerd, I was asked to show you around. King Sabara's orders."

Adora followed her after taking a deep breath to control her anger. This was going to be a long night.

Angella had gotten out of the shower and began to dry her hair. The towels provided were a little too small. Good thing Adora wasn't here to see her like this. She might have fainted seeing *her* Queen like this. Although they did bathe together in Birghtmoon. She was a flustered mess though. Angella would like to pretended it was just because it was modesty but she was no fool to pining.

She could tell by the way Adora looked at her that it was far from just simple admirations and that is was the formation of a tiny and harmless crush.

She knew exactly when it began to. Right after the battle for Brightmoon. Angella was much kinder to Adora and made more effort to speak to her. After all, she owed her that much. This made Adora more excited for the Queen's praise and satisfaction. She would often ask Glimmer to report to the Queen herself instead of Glimmer and whenever the Queen was around the castle grounds and found Adora training she would often try to show off her sword skills. It did fail her once though, just as Adora tied to back flip with the sword in her hand she lost balance and ended up stumbling over and falling. The sword luckily not harming her in the process of her fall but she did land on a rock

when she fell. Angella's motherly instinct kicked in as she rushed over to check on the girl.

Adora hissed in pain while Angella rushed to lift her up. Taking her hand and holding it.

"Are you alright?" she asked soothingly. Adora just stammered and blushed, assuring she was fine. She still ended up tripping as she rushed away in embarrassment and from that moment on Adora became incredibly shy around her. Glimmer had mentioned to Angella how badly Adora wanted her to like her and it was clear why. The Princess of Power had a crush. On her. How cute.

She got dressed—someone had been kind enough to bring in their luggage, or what was left of it after the attack they endured prior their arrival. They didn't have much options for fashion. Angella decided to keep her lovely and also very ugly white robe with green cactus print on while she went to bed. She placed her clothes away in her wardrobe and she took the larger room in the suite because it had a desk in it. She knew Adora wouldn't mind. She then grabbed Adora's bag and placed it on her bed in the other room. Her temptation to peak in and see exactly what Adora brought overcame her and she opened her bags to see very neatly folded clothes. A pair of pink fuzzy slippers; from Bow no less, a map with some notes on it, and snooping in further she found Adora's undergarments and instantly closed the bag up after that.

No, I don't need to see those thank you very much

She felt guilty for invading Adora's privacy. As she usually did when she went through Glimmer's room. How else would she have known about her secret armory and also her diary of how much Glimmer loathed her mother. Glimmer had several private journals but one in particular was labeled "Dear Mom" and it was nothing but venting letters on how much Glimmer thought Angella was not taking her serious and not leading the Rebellion into battles. With Adora being around her journal entries stopped, but it still hurt. She loved Glimmer with all her heart and it broke her

own to know Glimmer would grow to have such disdain for her. It is all well now but these are feelings Angella cannot express to anyone.

She might be the Queen of Brightmoon and adored by thousands, but it was a lonely life without Micah. As elegant as she was she also had her own insecurities and disdain for social interactions. She can play her part beautifully but she enjoyed it more with Micah around. He had the sense of humor, the quick wit and charm that left a room in laughter. She wasn't one for that. After he died she felt a part of her immortal self-die. It was hard to be happy.

How bad was it that only an hour ago she was laughing and smiling with Adora to now come back into her own thoughts and wish to cry again?

Adora made her think of Micah, not in the grieving sense but in the loving memory sense. She should be grateful, but right now she was alone and she dreaded it. Her only option now was to rest.

Catra made sure to take full advantage of Adora's ignorance and was able to trick her to walk into the male guard's locker room.

"AH! Why didn't you tell me that *downward tail* meant *men's*!?" Adora said chasing Catra down the corridor.

Catra had a hard time out running Adora while laughing.

"I thought it was obvious! Pfft - Hahaha!" Catra wheezed out as she stopped down the hall. Adora swiftly kicked her in the behind. Not enough to hurt her but enough to make her stumble forward. Catra then composed herself and made a turn to head down a staircase. Adora followed.

"Okay, in all seriousness you've seen where everything is now, so I can assume you're all set to get some rest, I got to check on

Lonnie and everyone else”

Adora stopped and asked “Wait? Lonnie, Kyle and Rogelio are here too?”

Catra scoffed “Uhh, yeah. They were directly under me. They had a choice. Me”

Adora smiled and continued to follow her “I’m glad you finally connected with them”

Catra rolled her eyes “Yeah, we all get along pretty well. I mean Lonnie and I tolerate each other a lot more." She made a hand gesture as to say 'it's not that much', "I guess you can take credit for that” Catra ended with a half whispered sentence.

Adora then gave Catra a pleading look. Since they were on natural grounds there was no reason for anyone to be cold to one another.

An annoyed sigh came out of her throat,“You want to see them, don’t you?”

Adora nodded.

The feline girl just leaned against the wall and scoffed “Okay, then. C’mon. They are finishing up a night training drill.”

A smile appeared on her lips, and she quickly went to hold her hand kindly.“Thank you, Catra.”

She missed these moments. She couldn’t deny she missed her friend, after all it wasn't like one year could erase many years of trust and friendship. She knew Catra well, and so was the other way around. Catra wouldn’t be this relaxed with her if she didn’t truly want to be non-confrontational. This was really feeling more like a diplomatic mission now.

Chapter End Notes

Angella knows Adora is pining for her; but she thinks it's a phase and she will get over it soon. get ready for a slow burn everyone.

Remember Micah

Chapter Summary

> Angella dreams of the first time she met Micah while Adora gets dissed by her old Horde Solider friends.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Angella had a hard time falling asleep. She was alone in a different bed and far from home. She hated this feeling and knew it all too well. Times like these makes her think of happier moments. Adora had brought that back to her. She felt happy thinking of all the good times she had before the war.

Twenty-six years ago in Mystacor

She could remember that day like it was yesterday. And at first, she hated it. Angella walked beside her mother while a member of the Mystacor welcome committee greeted them.

It was a really, really hot day.

Her mother insisted she cut her hair short to shoulder length and the humidity made it frizzier. She hated having wavy short hair. To make matters worse her tiny wings which were only about a quarter the size of her mother's were sore. She had been warned it would hurt but she hadn't assumed it would be *this* painful after they finally came in. Her mother didn't pay much attention to her worries. She had told her that it would be impolite to miss out on invitations. The Queen knew the Princess was miserable but being

a royal was not always about luxury. She knew her daughter well enough to know Angella dreaded meeting new people and was feeling uneasy about her wings being so small compared to other Angelic beings. But this wasn't about what Angella wanted today. They had this planned for months and Angella had to be present for this.

The welcome committee started to brief them on the purpose of this meeting. "Mystacor would like land in Brightmoon for crops. A price that is fair is needed, since such the amount of land is important to our expansion, of course."

The Queen nodded "Understandable. But this is a request we have denied to even our own neighboring villages, "she turned to her daughter and continued ''That is why, you, Angella will lead this meeting."

Angella's wings fluttered open, but soon they were on their original place once again, she forgot how much they hurt. "M - Mother? Is this - Is that really for the best?"

She waved her hand to dismiss Angella's concerns "That is Queen Archellia in public, Princess Angella, and I have already decided that this is good for you."

Angella just cast her eyes down and looked into hands folded in front of her as she walked.

“Stop looking down,” She shoot her a glare, intense enough to make Angella’s eyes wet, ‘’eyes forward and shoulders straight.” her mother snapped.

The guide gave her a nervous glance before looking away from the scolded Princess. She hated when her mother did this in front of people. Angella did as she was told, just in time for them to be greeted by the head of Mystacor’s grand sorcerer and his two children; Castaspella, and - Mike?

Or something like that. She didn’t have any interest on knowing, anyways.

She had to focus on the conversation the father wanted them to have. Angella hated this. The head sorcerer went into a closed room with several other people and left her mother and her alone for several minutes. Her mother handed her a scroll to read off. Everything on it sounded so rude and awful and wasn’t something that Angella would or could say.

I Princess Angella must inform the people of Mystacor that your request for Brightmoon land must be denied on the simple grounds of -

Angella sighed. She hated to be mean and even worse she hated public speaking and, her mom knew it. She made the mental note that she would to never do this to her children. Not that she really thought of having children. Not because she didn’t want to, but rather because no suitors wanted her as their wife. Oh, bother.

It wasn’t pleasant to read to them what was being said. Watching an entire room of people sadden, while her mother beamed at her.

Walking out of that room made the sixteen-year-old want to cry.

To her luck her mother spoke for a while with the Head sorcerer and assured him that the answer was temporal, only until it can be proven to be extremely necessary. Angella finally had the chance to excuse herself walk around by herself. She saw a group of female sorcerers in training and judging by the dirty looks they were giving her she knew to not bother to introduce herself. She turned into her heels and went in the opposite direction only to walk in the direction of the male sorcerers training. Her face gained new color when she saw them. Shirtless, dark haired, handsome boys of her age.

She wanted to run away from the sight out of pure embarrassment. One boy saw her. It was Mike – Mark – Whatever his name was, waving at her. She bashfully waved back, not sure if she waved back out of politeness or embarrassment. She then tuned to walk away only to be stopped by her own mother. The queen towered over her and took her arm and walked her over to them. Her mind raced in fear. What will mother say? What will mother do? She expected a lot of things from her – And none had a nice outcome for her.

Another boy signaled that the Queen and Princess were coming. All of them bowed in unison. The Queen smiled at them.

“Gentlemen, I would like to – ”

Oh no –

“Meet my daughter Princess Angella. She will be the official member of the Brightmoon family to be present for all of Mystacor’s needs. If you have any questions please direct them to her instead of me,” She paused and looked to Angella who was now sporting a bit of pink on her cheeks. She then finished with “Also she is sixteen and one of you lucky boys could become her betrothal!” she said with a laugh. She walked away quickly and left Angella completely red faced covering her mouth in horror. Angella watched as some boys smiled while others just rolled their eyes and walked away from her. She bowed apologetic.

“Forgive my mother and me for our intrusion”

She said before leaving as well. She wanted to cry. The looks they gave her were worse than what she felt at the meeting. This was rejection, not the discouragement that the adult’s looks gave her for both her young age and insecure body language. As a Princess she was not used to feeling that from anyone but her mother. She wanted to be alone for a good hour to clear her head before returning to her mother. Sitting on a marble bench by the pond, perhaps sounded as a good plan, so she did said plan. She watched ducks swim. Interested on the idea of how a floating city has a pond. She finally was started to cheer up until she heard the voices of teenagers coming her way. Uneasy she left the bench and moved closer to the trees and topiary near her. She should

have left the location; she shouldn’t have heard their words. Loud and clear, sadly.

“I mean, who do they think they are!?” She heard a boy say on a mocking tone, ‘’First, the Queen has the nerve to come up to the elite sorcerer's team and tell them her daughter is single? Like who does that, ‘’ A round of *ews* proved that everyone agreed to his opinion, ‘’ and two, who would date a Birghtmoon snob?”

Those words hurt. She ducked down in hopes to slip away when she heard what another girl said.

“The Princess isn't all that pretty, she’s like six feet tall and wears heels! Who in their sane mind does that?”

They laughed at that “I know right? How uppity do you think you need to be? Like what? You think you're not tall enough? Showing off her legs in that skirt. What guy wants a girl that skinny?”

They laughed and walked passing Angella without even spotting her presence.

She was glad they didn’t see her. She was too hurt by their words to keep her composure. Good thing her mother didn’t see Angella back away from a conflict. Her mother would have exchanged words if she was in her predicament – No, she would have beaten them up rather than sticking to dialogue.

She slid down the tree and hugged her knees to her body. She rested her head in her hands and felt her tears take control of her eyes, and as she blinked some fell onto her cheek. She wanted to go home but she couldn't get up to leave this spot before she gets back on her feet. The Queen would be furious to see Angella in tears over some harsh words by commoners. A small rustle came from behind to. Thinking it was a bunny or one of the ducks she didn't bother to look up. To her dismay it was the son of the head sorcerer. It was a bad moment to not have bothered to learn his name.

Gladly, it was him of all people to see her upset. *Just perfect.*

She turned her head away from him hoping he would leave. Instead he offered a light blue handkerchief to her. Angella accept not wanting to be rude, and wiped her eyes dry hoping she wasn't ruining her makeup in the process.

"You know, those girls are just jealous. I've known most of them my whole life and they can't walk in a straight line, let alone high heels."

Angella scoffed at that "Yes, well, their feelings for me are evident," she said fiddling with the handkerchief before adding in a saddened tone, ''and what about you? You must know by now Brightmoon declined the proposal."

The young man shrugged and sat closer to her. The closest she had ever been to a boy her own age.

"Well dad knows it wasn't you saying no. So, I don't see any issue. Besides the exact words were *not at this time* so I'm not going to be mad" His voice was calm. It was the exact opposite of the tone the group of bullies had used when talking about her.

Angella gave him a puzzled look "Your father told you all of that?"

"No, I have a spell that gives me super good hearing through walls, so my parents hate me during holidays. I always know who is getting what."

They both chuckled at that.

He stood up and offered his hand to her. She accepted, and once she was in her feet the two of them were able to look into each other's eyes for a bit. It took them a few seconds before realizing they were still holding hands. Angella instantly took her hand away and felt her cheeks heat up.

Please don't notice whatever ridiculous color my face is turning right now

He smiled at her, and all she could do was reply "Thank you Michael."

He blinked and smiled at that "It's Micah, actually"

"Oh, I'm so sorry!" Her faced turned a darker shade of red.

He was still smiling, so he clearly could see how embarrassed she was.

"It's fine, Princess Angella."

Great. He got my name right. But I couldn't get his?

She had finally fallen asleep thinking about him.

Adora finally got to meet up with all her former Horde teammates. As always, Kyle was happy to see a friendly face with Rogelio following him making sure he didn't hurt himself with his posture stoic as usual. She knew he was slightly happy to see her on these terms since they were currently now allies. Lonnie and Catra just gave each other smirks. Adora picked up on this and smiled.

Did they finally become friends? She thought.

Lonnie and Catra did become friends, but more in the fact they shared mutually loathing for Adora's departure from the Horde than actually having *friendship making moments*. Plus, they thought She-Ra looked stupid. So, they usually got a good laugh out of making fun of Adora's hero transformation.

"Adora" Lonnie greeted.

"Lonnie, how are you all doing?"

Catra just walked away. "Have fun you three" they heard her say before disappearing from the room.

Lonnie clicked her tongue at the question "Well, we're good" she had walked over to grab a large medicine ball and tossed it to Adora. "We were just playing Tap out, if you're in."

Adora nodded, a warm feeling growing inside her chest from the thought of doing something she had stopped doing since she left the Horde. She followed her to the middle of the room. High ceilings and nothing but some loose gym equipment around made this room a perfect training room.

The four then stood in a corner each and began to toss the heavy ball back and forth. The purpose of the game was to choose to throw at random and see who doesn't catch it until only one was left.

Kyle typically lost first. Which he did. All the while Adora and Lonnie talked to each other.

"We – Hmpf – Were assigned to another force captain after Catra left. He was terrible to us, I radioed Catra and asked if she needed backup and she practically made me beg for her to station us with her." She threw the ball at Rogelio and in return he threw it to Adora.

"Do you like being stationed under Catra?" She questioned throwing it back to Rogelio.

Rogelio nodded and threw it to Lonnie.

Lonnie then added in "Catra isn't like when we were younger, she's still the same asshole we grew up with from time to time, but it's not as bad as she did before you left. We get along so much better now."

Adora smiled as Lonnie threw it back to her.

Adora then threw it back to Lonnie who finished "Something got better, once you left."

This stung Adora. She didn't even pay attention as Rogelio threw the ball toward her and it hit her directly in the stomach. A fitting place since she felt like Lonnie's words had literally punched her in the gut.

She was out. Out of the game and out of her mind.

Lonnie was a bit surprised since Adora was once really good at this game. But it seems either she was too tired to care or Adora had gotten sloppy after her time in Brightmoon.

Adora excused herself from the room and walked back to the corridor. Lonnie and Rogelio didn't put up much resistance to her leaving them for the night assuming she was tired.

She hated this lonely feeling. No Glimmer, no Bow, and the feeling of Catra being oh just so delighted to probably know Adora was uncomfortable made her chest feel empty. This must be payback for leaving the Horde, she thought. But Adora would have never gone out of her way to deliberately hurt Catra, despite doing it. She did still love Catra. Why was Catra this cruel?

She made her way back to the bedroom.

Adora noticed that Angella placed her bags in the other room. By the closed door to the left she can assume Angella was already asleep. Adora went into her room to put on some night clothes. Her standard grey tank top and grey shorts.

She made her way to the bathroom to do her basic hygiene routine for bedtime.

While Angella slept she finally drifted into a dream. A dream of her husband in the most sexual way she could think – Or remember – Him being.

Two years into dating the young couple now both eighteen where sneaking off into an empty horse carriage in the stables. Unable to contain their excitement they began kissing the moment they got. She giggled as he trailed kisses down her neck.

“The look on your mother’s face when I gave you that dead land in Brightmoon!”

“The look on my father's face when I denied being gifted 600 acres of farmland!”

The two kissed passionately for a brief moment after Micah closed the carriage door behind them. Angella began to straddle him as he ran his fingers through her hair. She did the same. She broke the kiss and asked him.

“After all this time dating, they really thought you were only doing this for real estate?”

Micah chuckled and began to kiss her neck. She replied in-between kisses

“They did. But they. Were wrong. So was your mother.”

Angella sat up for a quick second.

“You’re right, she was. I’m still upset she tried to get me to date the Princess of – ” she was stopped by a kiss his as he climbed on top for her. She chuckled in the kiss.

“She says I'm too short for you”

Angella giggled as she felt his chin stubble tickle her neck.

“She says a lot of things, which does not make them true. Your –” She stopped when she felt something brush up against her thigh. She looked down and saw — Oh, goodness.

He moved off her and looked down trying to adjust his pants. In embarrassment she instinctively covered her face with her hands.

“Sorry Angella” He sputtered out.

She removed her hands from her face and placed them on his forearms.

“Micah...”

“Yes, my love.”

Angella gave him a shy smile as she bit her lip.

“Let’s disobey another one of my mother’s rules tonight.”

Adora heard some light moans coming from Angella’s room. She assumed she was having a bad dream and peaked inside her room to see what the matter was. She saw the Queen stirring in her sleep. Her wings covered her. She couldn’t see much else so she didn’t think of another option but to get closer to her.

“Micah....” She called out “*Please”*

Adora's heart sank a bit. Angella must be having a bad dream about Micah’s death. She walked closer to her Queen and heard the sounds of her pleas for her dead husband.

Unknown to Adora because she couldn't see it, Angella's right hand was rubbing her lower body in a pleasuring manor. Her wing covered this gesture, so it wasn't Adora's common denseness that made her not notice it.

Whatever made Angella awake it made her look directly at Adora the young girl just — watching her! Like some sort of pervert!

How long has she been in here? What did she see? What did she hear? Honestly, Adora! I know you have a sweat for me but this is completely unacceptable!

Angella practically jumped at the sight of her. Her wings now extended out in rage. Her feelings of being watched and embarrassed took over her and she was ready to snap. She would always blame Micah for Glimmer's hot-headed personality, but she knew it was her who had the temper.

"I did not ask for you to enter my sleeping quarters, Adora!" Her tone clearly angry made Adora take a few steps back.

Adora flinched as she was not expecting this reaction from the Queen. With a shaky voice she replied.

"You – You were calling out in your sleep – I – I thought you were having a nightmare, I – I thought you needed –"

“I needed nothing Adora! Except my privacy!” she spat out. The coldness in her voice terrified Adora in a way only Shadow Weaver could do. Adora slowly backed away.

“I – I’m sorry” The young blonde whispered out before leaving the room.

What did she do to upset the Queen so much?

Angella sat down on her bed thinking about what just happened. Why did she over react like that? Did Adora actually see what she was doing? If she did, which she hoped for, she felt like she reacted accordingly to the situation.

If she didn’t, then –

As her anger began to fade away, a new feeling began to overcome her. A sense of guilt sat in her chest. It made her head light.

Maybe she needed to sleep a little more.

Chapter End Notes

Should Angella Apologize in the next Chapter? Should Adora try to ask her why she was upset?

Sorry My Queen, Sorry My Adora

Adora didn't understand what she did wrong and why the Queen was so cruel to her. Her eyes watered at the memory of her coldness towards her when all she did was make sure she was okay. She couldn't sleep much after that. The thought of the calming and soft voice of the Queen now shattered by the harshness of what Glimmer would once describe to her.

"Once you see the wings flair up you know you've fucked up"

Glimmer once told her. But Adora didn't know what she did wrong. Was it so bad to enter Angella's room without asking?

Adora shook her head with a displeased look on her face, meanwhile, Angella tossed and turned. Humiliated at the idea Adora might have accidentally seen her pleasing herself and hearing her during her intimidate dream. The sheer lack of boundaries Adora had was unheard of. Adora knows what self-pleasure is clearly — Angella couldn't help but blush memory of Adora's moans when she was showering suddenly appeared on her thoughts—, but what if she didn't know the Queen was doing it to herself at that moment?

In that case, was fair to snap at her? She would have to face her in the morning, something she did not look forward to since she really didn't want to be cold towards Adora. The girl's company was most pleasing, and she would feel bad for making her distant. Her guilt was now settling in and now the worry that she snapped at Adora for no reason started to eat at her. She stopped moving, keeping her eyes on the ceiling. She wasn't going to sleep much with so many thoughts running inside her head. In

the end, she did sleep, not enough for her to be fully rested, but at least she didn’t spend the whole night feeling guilty.

That next morning Angella awoke to the sound of muffled talking. She heard a voice thanking someone else, and Angella quickly understood that Adora had woke up before her. She exited her room to see someone had brought them breakfast to the room along with a note attached to the food tray. Adora had placed the tea in a cup for Angella. The Queen looked up to Adora who quickly turned away from her gaze. If Adora was feeling guilt or regret from last night, it must mean she saw what Angella was doing. She saw clear discomfort in her eyes and Angella scowled at her. Adora bowed and hurried up to leave to her room.

“You should eat.” Angella’s eyes glared at Adora’s attempt to flee the scene.

Adora turned back and bowed again.

“I will, ‘’ Her hands nervously rubbed each other, ‘’But only once you're done, your majesty.” Adora’s tone was respectful yet she was obviously still hurt from last night. If the Queen’s lack-of-enough-sleep induced anger hadn’t been present, she would have felt the guilt overcoming her as soon as she spoke.

But instead, Angella's eyes narrowed. She rose her hand to signal Adora to wait a moment. And Adora did just that as she waited like the soldier she was.

You don’t get to make that call, is what Angella wanted to tell her, *If Glimmer can't walk away from me then neither can you.*

Yet she couldn’t get herself to be that harsh towards her guard who had been nothing but loyal. She had misbehaved in more than one occasion, but what did lack of manners had to do with being always by someone’s side in the best manner they could offer?

As she closed the distance between them Angella’s eyes slowly lowered until they caught the note and took it in her hands to read to herself. Adora’s uninterrupted stare made her feel annoyed despite herself making it clear she was not dismissed. The letter asked for Angella to be in attendance for Horde Generals Exit meeting at noon and the Horde Soldiers exit meeting at 6 pm tonight.

Angella looked at Adora and said flatly “I suppose you will not attend the meetings with me.” Adora flinched slightly at the uninterested tone she had used. It was not even a question; she had already assumed her response. And Adora couldn’t do but oblige what her Queen ordered.

Angella mentally kicked herself for saying that. Of course, Adora should be with her. She was her guard and insight on how the Horde works. She needed her. She couldn’t understand why she told her it was an option not to attend.

Adora shook her head “No, your majesty.” *She had to oblige. What her Queen desired was above of anything she could ever want.*

And that was the last thing Angella wanted Adora to say. She wanted to hear the sweet girl’s eager tone to insist on going.

Instead, she received a painful rejection. *But she couldn't show weakness.*

So Angella scoffed and turned away, hiding her

"Very well, you are dismissed then, Adora."

Adora had hoped Angella would have asked her to sit and eat with her. Likewise, Angella hoped Adora would have sat with her as well. But both were too hot-headed to give in to their feelings. Adora's feelings were hurt and Angella was stubborn due to feeling embarrassed.

She took a sip of the tea Adora had made. The Queen regretted not thanking her, now she just felt plain rude for not doing so. She thought so, at least until the flavor hit her tongue.

My word! Angella thought as she forcibly swallowed*, this is awful!*

She smiled at this. The girl can't even make tea! TEA of all things. It's just some dried leaves and hot water. It was funny and she wanted to laugh but it wouldn't matter, it wouldn't make Adora come out of her room and ask her what was funny, they couldn't have a good laugh about how undrinkable the tea was. Now she was mad again. She took her frustration out on some parchment, writing down in her elegant handwriting for Adora to be present with her. She wanted her company and to be denied it

this morning was something the Queen was not used to, and Adora had no right to take herself away from Angella.

She should have asked me if I wanted her to sit with me. It was not her call to excuse herself. Not even Glimmer has that right.

Angella sat and ate alone while Adora sat in her room waiting for her to finish. Adora was saddened by this whole scene of Angella being mad at her, not even giving her a polite indication that she was leaving. She just heard the main door slam loudly against the doorframe. As soon as she peeked out of her room, her heart was rammed against her chest with sadness. She hadn't even bothered to say goodbye. A sigh allowed her perfect soldier posture to break, slouching in defeat as she walked to the nearest chair. The sound that came from below her startled Adora slightly, making her quickly reach down her body and search for the culprit of the sound; the note Angella had written for her.

You are required to be present with me at all events, make sure you are present with me tonight at the Exit Plan Meeting. This is no request.

Adora's heart skipped a beat, her upper torso hurting from how cold Angella could be even just by writing precise words filled with disdain. But that was not what Adora should be worried about now, instead, she should be worrying about the Queen's mixed messages. If Angella wanted her to come with her this morning all she had to do was tell her to straightforward. Reaching for the lonely fruit bowl that rested silently on the table she began to chew on a grape in silence. It couldn't be any worse if she tried. Angella was upset at her, Lonnie is happy she's gone, Catra wants to see her fail, and no one else wants her around.

Adora was extremely sensitive at times. One thing that never failed to let her hopes down was the feeling that she had failed someone. Like when she didn't complete the obstacle course at age eight in the Horde — she wanted to down for a whole week sulking. Catra used to cheer her up, but now Catra was her enemy and that friendship was gone. How could she even be so selfish to think of Catra supporting her right now? They were in the middle of a war, they were enemies, they were—

A knock on the door and a call for

"Hey, A—dork—a, are you in here?"

They were at a few steps of distance.

Adora despite knowing Catra has no good intentions still was compelled to rush to the door and see her. Catra was just as surprised to see she didn't leave her hanging, so she grinned at the desperate look Adora sported.

"I was expecting you to slam the door in my face after opening it, but okay," Her eyes moved from her shoes to her guilty looking face, her grin never leaving her face, ''this is better."

Adora just rolled her eyes and walked away from her leaving the door open. Catra knew Adora well enough to take that as an

approval of her presence.

"So, how much of your training have you slacked on? Lonnie told me you didn't even win in tap out last night. Even Kyle said you were slow, Kyle!" A dramatic hand motion followed the sentence. Catra looked around and commented "Oh! This is one of the nicer rooms— Hey did you get one of the cactus print robes in your closet too? Because I did and—Man, Adora, let me tell you, that thing is ugly!" Catra extended the pronunciation of the last word before she gave herself the time to laugh vigorously until she noticed Adora's frown.

"What's your deal?" Catra asked after cleaning a laugh-induced tear. Her body language changed slowly, it went from chaotic, to curious about Adora's behavior, to concerned about her state now.

Adora didn't look at her as she answered and sat back down at the table "I had a lot on my mind."

"Seriously? Like what?"

Was Adora was ready to spill her heart out to Catra? Her throat answered with a grunt. No, her body didn't want her to trust in her again.

Not like back when they were both young and would tell each other everything. Those times were long left behind.

Catra let out an annoyed sigh. Rolling her eyes, she approached her, her tail reaching for Adora's leg as she became closer. A throaty hum came out of her before she spoke as if she was looking for the right words to address the elephant in the room.

"Y'know, I can just leave you alone if you want. I just figured since you're a fish out of the water it would benefit me to be nicer to you."

Adora raised a brow "How does it benefit you to be nice to me?"

Catra snorted and crossed her rolled her shoulders back "Heh, easy. I'm going to be the one who ends this war, obviously!"

Adora just rolled her eyes and looked down at her food.

"Besides it will look good for my image to be nice to you She-Ra, Princess of— '' Her eyes lowered a little, then looked up to stare Adora in her eyes, ''sulking in a fruit bowl." Catra retorted in a rather disgusted tone.

Adora shot a glare "I'm not sulking!"

"Then oh, tell me, what's your deal?" Catra's hand slammed itself against the table, '' This being kind thing isn't fun if you don't at least give me a challenge!"

Adora stared back at Catra's tail. It was moving from side to side aggressively, signaling that Catra was indeed agitated by this whole thing and not faking it. After a second of thinking, Adora ended up giving in and telling her everything. And by everything, she really did mean everything. From leaving Brightmoon, missing Glimmer and Bow, being nervous around the Queen all the time, being sad that Lonnie likes things better without her around, being yelled at by Angella to all-around feeling like she isn't doing her job well at all. Catra, surprising just listened. No snark remarks or teases. She just listened to her like when they were kids stressing out over Cadet Exams and training courses. It was refreshing to see Catra like this after almost a year of fighting and trying to punch each other's guts.

Catra finally added in her thoughts.

"Adora, your magical destiny is the reason you're so stressed out, all this magic bullshit and expectations has your head all messed up."

Here she goes.

Adora didn't know how to take that. Was Catra implying She-Ra was the reason for all of this? Of course, who was she fooling? She-Ra is the reason for all of this. If she never found the sword, she would have never joined sides and none of this would be happening. Even though being She-Ra was stressful she wouldn't change it. The only thing she wanted to be was something, someone, that could stop people from getting hurt.

“Hey,” Catra began to talk again. Her voice is softer than before as she extended her hand on the table to reach Adora’s. “Remember, when we were kids? We always said we would call the shots one day. if you didn’t leave the Horde, we could have taken out Shadow Weaver and Hordak together.”

Adora took her hand into her own and exhaled loudly through her nose.

“Catra, I can't go back to the—”

“I’m not asking that. But you do remember, right?”

“I do, but things are different now Catra.”

“You’re right. But... We can still call the shots on this whole thing. Just on our respective sides.”

Adora’s eyes went wide “What do you mean with that, Catra?”

Catra looked at her and then away to the floor “Look, we all know how bad the Horde can be. In my current position, it’s been stressful but also rewarding in a way where I can say I know what I need to be fixed.”

“Meaning?”

Adora was hoping she was going to say she would join the rebellion, but Catra made it clear she wasn't going to join.

"Meaning, I will work on my end, and you will work on yours and in time we will be calling the shots, like we promised each other, got it?"

If what Catra is saying is true that means Catra had come to sense how bad the Horde is and wants to change it and herself for the better. She wants to do right and be selfless. This was the Catra she always thought she could be. She knew Catra wasn't a bad person. After all this hurt and pain, as she finally got her best friend back? Adora lunged over to embrace her. She missed Catra so much. The feline girl returned the embrace but quickly ended the moment.

"Okay, enough being sappy, we gotta get to that second meeting. There's no way in hell I'm leaving Scorpia alone in a room full of assholes."

Adora snorted at that and got up from the table to clean up the dishes. Catra just smirked and sat down. Adora could hear a faint purr coming from her, and she chuckled quietly enough for Catra to not hear her. After all, she knew Catra was watching every movement she made.

Adora could sense this and asked in a teasing voice "So, you and Scorpia, huh?"

Catra just scoffed and looked away "What about us?"

"You're close?"

"She was the Force Captain assigned under me since I became a Commander, so yeah, close I guess."

"Is she more than you're—"

Catra waved her hand to cut off Adora. "I know what you are implying and I'm going to tell you to drop it, Scorpia is my friend, nothing is changing that."

Adora grinned and raised an eyebrow. She saw Catra's tail move around in an irritating way, slowly enough for her to notice how it had gotten all fluffy. Adora knew she had flustered her a bit. Just like when anyone dared to give attention to Adora while they were children. Catra hated to share Adora with anyone back in the day. Especially Lonnie. If Lonnie even dared to play with Adora, Catra would come in and ruin the fun.

Classic Catra, Adora thought suppressing a laugh.

Scorpia was a little odd to Adora. Even with their very few interactions, it was clear Scorpia admired Catra. She doted over her and idolized her in a way that she could understand in a way. Catra didn't seem to care for her much at first but after some very painful moments being in charge and dealing with stress Catra

finally let her guard down and opened to Scorpia and embraced their friendship. Now Catra's feelings have shifted. She now wanted Scorpia to be happy. She accepted hugs and all Scorpia's little doodles of the stick figures holding hands. They were each other's confidants now and when Scorpia chose to leave the Horde Catra knew she couldn't let her leave her sight. Catra didn't feel rejection from her leaving. Scorpia didn't blindside her with this information. She told her a long time ago if her family left the Horde she would too and Catra had insider information on what the Horde wanted to do in the desert.

Hordak wanted to destroy that Kingdom so it could become a second Fright Zone.

Catra couldn't let that happen. So, she made sure Entrapta could cover for her while she lied and said she was in the colony making sure it was all up to standard. Entrapta should be joining them soon anyway. But for now, Catra, Adora, and Scorpia oversaw trying to resolve this conflict the best way they can. Catra then changed the subject back to Adora's worries from earlier.

"Hey, About the Queen. Just tell her off, it's not like you were peeping on her or something creepy like that. You were just trying to make sure she was okay"

Adora shrugged "Won't that be rude?" She paused when she remembered who she was talking to. "Oh, never mind. You're the master of rude"

Catra chuckled at this.

"And sadly, you never learned a thing from me" she replied.

The two former pals made their way to meeting rooms, they could hear shouting. Both stood by the door to overhear what was going on.

The Horde Generals were yelling at whatever was being said that the Scorpion kings' Royal court was demanding.

"The factories need to be gone! Gone! You expect your children to play in a cesspool of waste? They need to be demolished and the land must be restored! No exception!" they heard one-man roar to the people of the Horde.

Another voice, a female from the Horde obviously snapped back with "The factories were built on the damaged and run-down property, to begin with! The Horde will not waste the money to improve on what your Kingdom never could!"

The girls wanted to go in, but they couldn't risk ruining the meeting. They waited in silence for the right moment to enter. They kept hearing them shout harsh snide remarks to one another before Angella spoke up. Adora's heart fluttered when she heard her Queen's soft yet controlling voice. *Am I horny?*

“May the conversation be guided to a more reasonable agreement?” Angella inquired.

A Horde official called back to her “We will if only the Royal Court could be more reasonable”

Before the King could respond Angella stepped in to remind the Horde General that this was a peaceful negotiation and there is no need for such hostile vocabulary — *Man, was Catra feeling the suddenly high temperature of the room or was it her having a fever?* — so she should mind both her vocal and body language. The General scoffed and mumbled something which prompted the conversation to stop and the King then said this conversation will continue later in the evening at dinner once the passions had died down.

Catra and Adora heard the shuffling of all the members getting up from their chairs and making their way to the door. The two girls quickly made their way down the hall to not be seen. When Angella exited the meeting room she was clearly uneasy from what she just had to sit through. It would have made things easier to have Adora in her corner when things got bad, but she couldn’t allow herself to have that luxury anymore after how she treated her. This was something she would have to deal with later. On her way back to the room she was greeted by the sight of Adora and Catra sitting together in the couch in the living room by the fireplace.

The room grew quiet and awkward once the Queen arrived; Catra made sure to make her exit known by calling for Adora be at the meeting and to wear something nice. Adora glanced nervously as Angella walked to her room without saying a word to her.

This was unbearable for the two of them. Angella opened her door and instructed Adora to wear the dress that was in her brown travel bag.

Adora blinked “Oh, I didn’t even know you knew I packed it”

Angella didn't reply and just went into her room to get ready for a shower. Those always made her feel less stressed. She stepped out of her room to see Adora wearing the same Cactus print robe she was wearing heading to the bathroom as well. Angella’s scowl turned quickly to a smile as she saw the blonde girl with her hair down wearing the ugly house robes. It felt less royal, structured, less mandatory. It was domestic. Something Angella had craved since Micah’s death.

Angella just raised a brow as Adora looked at her with her mouth gaped open. Angella was also wearing one of those ugly robes. The only thought Adora had was —

“Did your robe come with holes for your wings?” *Of all the things to say, Adora, you ask that?* She yelled inside her head.

Angella annoyance and anger instantly washed away with that innocent question. Adora was too sweet, she couldn’t keep being mad at her for last night. She smiled at the girl and replied with a laugh.

“I made some adjustments but it--” she spun around to reveal her back with two slits for her wings to be out “I believe this works just fine.”

Adora gave her a meek smile and moved away from the bathroom door “You first, your Majesty.” Adora said.

Angella then shook her head “No, dear you go ahead.” She assured her.

Angella went back into her room to wait for Adora to finish first. Before she could sit down on her bed, she heard a loud thump and an “Ow” come from the bathroom. She made her way to check on Adora by knocking on the door.

“Adora, sweetie? are you, all right?”

Sweetie? Have I ever called her that before? Hope it doesn't come of odd.

She heard the thumbing around some more as Adora answered with a bit of a squeak in her voice

“I think Catra lined the shower with soap when she used the bathroom here, I should have known she would pull a prank! She was way so happy to spend time with me!”

Angella laughed at Adora.

"Ah, was this the way she was back in the Horde?" Angella asked concerning Catra's mischievous behavior.

Adora replied from behind the door "Well, yes, but usually she would pull pranks on other cadets, usually not me."

Angella heard Adora's voice drop in sadness. It must be tough for Adora... She had friends and somewhat of a family in that horrible training base. But, now...

"Adora?"

A soft hum came from Adora's direction signaling Angella to ask away.

Angella took a deep breath before she spoke again. What was about to come out of her mouth was a far too strange of a request for her ask any bodyguard to do for her, but since this was Adora—

"The shower needs to be rinsed out well, so why not use the bathtub and get ready together, like back in Birghtmoon?"

Why would I even suggest this?! I am not still upset at her for last night?! She can't possibly agree to this.

Adora's thoughts were the same. Angella was so mean last night but now she is acting like it never happened. But Adora was eager for some attention from Angella.

Adora creaked open the door and gave a sheepish response "Yes... Yes! Uh… '' Adora's face suddenly went red before she could figure out a decent answer, ''I mean! That sounds like a good, a perfect idea!" She wanted to kick herself, *Adora, can you stop being so thirsty? You're just going to be with your Queen on the same room, naked… Oh She-Ra,* not even her mind was playing in her favor.

Angella smiled at her and nodded, *This might be a bit compromising but it could help us to just be in the same room. I might be able to slip out an apology while I'm with her.*

Angella's thoughts were more recollected, while Adora's where;

She's going to see me naked again—shit!

What if we touch by accident?

Oh God, what if I accidentally moan!?

Fuckfuckfuckfuckfuck

‘’Shall we enter the bathtub?” The kind voice of Angella asked. After all; ‘’*She had to oblige. What her Queen desired was above of anything she could ever want.”*

But damn, how could she not want this?

“Your shower doesn’t run out of hot water, so I am totally using yours after you're done!” Catra snapped walking into Scorpia’s room. She had been in her room several times before but couldn’t get over the fact that Scorpia hasn’t even considered the thought of redecorating it since returning after fifteen years. It still had the look and feel of a child’s room. Bright colored walls, cute stuffed animals and flower pictures everywhere. Odd, how Scorpia never made her Force Captain barrack look like her room at home, but that wasn’t the point. The point was; Catra’s room was on the side of the castle that had water issues from the blast on the wall and she wasn’t going to take a shower and have the water run cold after five minutes again.

Scorpia didn’t put up any resistance to that suggestion. She liked having Catra around. Their time in the Fright Zone was more dedicated to the Princess alliance and Adora specifically. So now that Catra was here with her— By choice no less — it was nice. Even though Catra still acted like she was Scorpia’s boss, it was better than having her not be there at all.

“Okay, Catra. Just don’t leave any hair in the drain.”

Catra just let out a hiss before heading to the bathroom.

Scorpia just sat there and watched as her former boss and current pinning crush walks into her private bathroom in a cactus print bathrobe and green fuzzy towel.

Scorpia then sat down and sighed.

How can anyone survive being so close to a crush?

Little did Scorpia know the Rebellion's Princess of Power was going through the same thing. Sitting in a bubble bath with her superior officer. Angella had zero regards towards modesty as she dipped her head into the water to damped in her hair giving Adora a very exposed shot of her chest. Adora just submerged her entire body at once to avoid the exposure. She quickly covered her chest as she came up from the water. This tub was half the size of the one in Brightmoon and it showed since even if it granted Angella and her weren't even close to touching they were still closer than last time.

Angella could pick up on Adora’s discomfort but didn’t cover herself. In her own mind, this was punishment for Adora

embarrassing her. All be it a mean punishment. Adora still had no idea why Angella was upset at her from the previous night.

"This tub is quite large for just two people isn't it?" Angella asked Adora.

Adora looked to her and nodded "Yes, it is, but the one in Brightmoon is a lot bigger."

Angella agreed. "That tub was something Micah wanted — he loved swimming and always went to the steam grottos as a young man, so he felt it was necessary to have such a large spa in our private living area."

Adora looked away unable to say anything else. Angella tilter her head. "Adora?"

The shy blonde turned to face Angella and asked, "Can you pass me the shampoo?"

Angella nodded and passed it to the young lady. Adora's hand slipped and it dropped in the water. Adora gulped and apologized and dunked her hand into the water to retrieve it. She grazed Angella's leg in the process and quickly squeaked and retrieved her hand "Sorry!" She squeaked out.

Angella shook her head and chuckled "Seems you reverted back to being nervous around me, it seems."

It seems, Angella thought, *that you feel guilty over something. Is it because you saw me, you little pervert?* — But of course, Angella would never say something of that degree, so instead she just silently grabbed the shampoo bottle and handed it to Adora. Adora frowned at this and poured some shampoo into her hand.

"Yes, but with all due respect, your majesty— '' A cough came from her throat before speaking, '' you are hard to read sometimes," Adora said looking away while massaging the shampoo through her hair.

Angella blinked and couldn't think of a response and just sighed, "I suppose I can be."

I can't bring myself to be cold anymore to her. She really didn't do anything wrong. If anything, I did! I was the one who was...

"Your majesty?"

Angella looked and her slightly shocked "Yes, Adora?"

Adora scooted closer to Angella and gulped. Nervously she looked up. Her expression then turned to seriousness as spoke "With respect. I know you were very upset with me last night and I know it's not my place to question you but — I feel I did nothing wrong as your guard — I only entered your room because I

thought you called out for someone and I don't feel I deserved to be snapped at." She paused to look at Angella's expressionless face and continued.

I hope I'm not going overboard with her by saying any of this, "I'm your guard and as your guard, on this mission, I need to make sure you're okay — I can't do that if you put up this barrier of not disturbing you! I mean—C'mon what do the guards of Brightmoon do? Pretend they don't hear something and go along with their day?"

Angella's expression changed to a frown.

Adora is scolding me? This girl, this — This child!

"Adora." *But she was right.*

Adora then cast her eye down and asked in a hushed tone "I'm sorry if that came off as rude. I — I just felt you needed to know where I stood about the situation. I'm here to make sure you're okay. That's my job, isn't it?"

Angella then nodded, *Of course, it is, dear. I don't even need to explain anything...*

Angella then lifted up Adora's chin to make her look into her eyes.

No, she deserves something.

"I owe you an explanation. My outburst was unacceptable. I was ashamed to have called out in my sleep and snapped at you out of my own embarrassment and not out of anything you did wrong."

Angella caressed Adora's cheek and Adora placed her hand on Angella's hand and asked.

"I understand. I didn't mean to make you apologize to me. I was the one who bothered you."

Angella sighed and moved her head closer to Adora so their foreheads could touch. This made the blonde girl flush.

"I'm sorry that you've had to deal with my most unflattering self. My temper is my least charming feature according to my late husband."

Adora chuckled and moved away a bit "Well according to Glimmer my obliviousness stops being *cute* after so many slip-ups. I've run into Glimmer's room a few times without kicking and she yelled at me."

Angella laughed "Yes. She's done that to me as well. I caught her playing with these little action figures a week ago and she

snapped and told me she was busy. Clearly embarrassed I caught her playing with dolls.” she said with an eye-roll.

Adora laughed “Those might have been what Bow made for her. We have our own tiny action figures. Usually, when she yells at me it’s because she’s getting dressed or when her and Bow want to be alone for a while.”

Angella let out a nervous laugh “Alone? Why would the two of them need to be alone?”

Oh, for the love of Etheria—Adora please don’t tell me my daughter is being deflowered

Adora just shrugged “I dunno—last time I walked in Bow and her were half dressed and trying to wrestle each other. I asked why they were fighting, and they told me to leave”

Angella just let out a small gasp. Adora saw this and smirked.

Angella was about asked Adora what else she saw but then stopped when she saw the girl was trying to hold in a laugh.

“I’m joking!” she said and then laughed.

Angella sighed in relief and then laughed as well. “I suppose that was your way of getting back at me, huh?”

Adora laughed and nodded.

Angella quickly splashed her in the face.

“I suppose I deserved that” Adora giggled.

Angella splashed her again “I think you deserve a few more!”

The two women enjoyed going back and forth splashing each other for a bit until the remembered they were on a time limit and needed to get ready for tonight's dinner meeting and event.

Back with Scorpia — Catra had just opened the bathroom door with only her fuzzy green towel hugging her body and another smaller white towel covering her head.

“Hey, Scorpia, I’m using one of your towels for my hair.”

Scorpia just looked at her with her jaw practically dropping to the floor.

Why did she leave the bathroom without her robe? Scorpia's mind screamed, no, burst.

Catra started to towel off her hair in a chair near Scorpia not caring that her towel covering her body was becoming loose and dropped into her lap as she flipped her hair and shook it around.

The Scorpion Princess got a clear view of Catra's chest and quickly rushed to the bathroom to get Catra's robe.

"H-here Catra!" She sputtered out flustered trying not to have her eyes dart towards her breasts.

Catra smirked when she realized how flushed Scorpia was getting and stood up and allowed the towel to drop to the floor as she grabbed her robe

"Aw, thanks!" Catra teased and turned around to re-robe herself. She had successfully given Scorpia a 360-degree view of her body which also made Scorpia's own body rise in temperature. Specify in two parts.

Man, I am going to make good use of the bubble jets in my tub after she leaves.

Catra turned to her and grinned. "Well, thanks for letting me use your shower. I'm heading back to my room now."

Scorpia nodded and walked back to the bathroom where she could finally catch a break from Catra. She pulled the shower curtain back and groaned.

"Seriously! Catra? I asked for you to not leave hair!"

A faint giggle could be heard in the distance. But Scorpia couldn't get around being as mad as she should. She was in love, after all.

Let's get ready to party

Chapter Notes

re-uploaded

Catra had made her way back to her room but made the decision of going over to Adora's and Angella's shared suite to grab a wastebasket from down the hall and place it in front of their door. She made her way down the hall and smirked to herself. She loved messing with Adora. It was her petty way of getting revenge on her for leaving the Horde.

Why do I still miss her? Catra thought. She couldn't deny she enjoyed Adora being around with no other friends to get in the way.

Did she have to be so mean though?

Yes, I do! Adora is a big girl, she can handle a bit of teasing while we are in the same castle together.

Adora missed Catra too. All be it she missed the Catra she thought she knew. The friend that supported her and wanted her to be the best Force Captain she could be.

If Adora knew how Catra really felt, she would have done things differently. Deep down Adora knew Catra wasn't a bad person. If Catra was so bad — why was she here anyway?

She knew all she had to do was manipulate Scorpia and take control over the Desert Kingdom in one easy swoop. But she wasn't going to do that. She cares far too much about Scorpia to ever hurt her or her family.

Despite Catra becoming more cruel and cunning she also was learning to be more protective and empathetic towards others. Namely, Scorpia, who was a good friend for Catra. If only Catra

saw that, she may slowly start to break down her walls and become something greater than the Horde's number one bully.

Adora had gotten dressed quicker than Angella did and peeked outside to see the wastebasket in front of their door.

"Ugh, Catra!" She sighed and moved the wastebasket out of the way.

She went back inside to see Angella stepping out of her room and Adora's jaw dropped when her eyes met Angella's. She saw the Queen in a gorgeous sparkling dress that was strapless. It matched her wings beautifully and Adora couldn't help but gawk in awe.

The Queen smiled almost bashfully as she looked away from Adora's pining gaze. She quickly snapped back to her regal self and informed her.

"I'm almost done — I just need to finish with my hair. Would you like me to do yours?"

Adora nodded "I… I guess — I usually just do my little poof thing with my hair, but… " she replied nervously.

Oh no, she calls it a poof thing. How can anyone be this cute? … Don't gush over her, Angella! You're not some hormonal teenager having a crush. Gosh, calling a nineteen-years-old cute… Way to go, Angella.

Coughing she focused back onto her task. Angella motioned for Adora to come into her room. Being greeted by Angella's sweet perfume smell was delightful to her nose and Adora secretly wished she wore perfume so she could have a signature scent to her — all she had was basic soap and deodorant to make sure she smelt good.

Angella had Adora sit at the vanity and took her hair out and began to brush it. Angella enjoyed this as it reminded her doing Glimmer's hair when she was a little girl.

She allowed herself to get lost in the memories of Glimmer asking for her mother to braid her hair and tell her how she wants to have long pretty hair like her mommy when she got older.

To her displeasure Glimmer decided to cut her hair short without even telling her. It bothered her on several levels. One is that their hair was a signature trait of their Angelic heritage and showed they were related. Two, Glimmer took so much after her father in traits some people had confused Glimmer being Castaspella's daughter instead of her own. and thirdly, how dare Glimmer cut her own hair!

Admittedly she did a good job but styling her daughter's hair was fun for her and Glimmer took that away from her.

Angella smiled as she finished Adora's hair with a half up and half down style with her bangs to the side covering her right ear while the rest was pulled back.

"There. You look gorgeous, Adora."

Adora's eyes went wide as her cheeks flushed a vibrant shade of red that matched her dress just like the one she wore at Princess' prom.

Angella saw this and teased "Oh, did I make you blush?" *She blushes in the most charming way. She is so easily flushed. She would certainly be the type to go red over a little bit of romantic affection…*

She coughed again, as a way of telling her subconscious to stop throwing those random thoughts her way.

Adora let out an embarrassed groan — looking at herself she cursed how her face became as red as her dress. *Oh great! Now, out of all times? Seriously!? Can you not blush every time you're near her!?*

Angella smirked and rubbed Adora's shoulders. Not giving the girl a chance to retort she sweetly spoke into her ear "You're easily

flustered and it's a quite endearing feature of yours, Adora."

Adora could do nothing except hide her face with her hands. She let out an embarrassed whine. Angella just rubbed her shoulders and smiled.

"Sorry, sweetie, I'll ease up on the teasing."

Adora then let out a whine before replying with the most damning statement against herself.

"I only get this embarrassed around you so —" Adora covered her face with her hands*. Why say something like that out loud?*

Angella giggled and patted her shoulders "Okay, I won't tease you for the rest of the night, sound far?"

Still, with her face behind her hands, she nodded.

Tonight was going to be a fun night.

Catra was less enthused. The outfit Scorpia gave her to wear was a stupid red strapless dress with the Horde's crest on the front. She demanded Scorpia to come to her room after she got dressed.

She used the room phone to bark at her. Scorpia arrived in Catra's room fearing something was wrong, only to find the feline in a b{ack pair of Horde unisex underwear and a black strapless chest cover. Scorpia didn't want to gawk but her mouth did drop a bit seeing the half-naked feline.

"The fuck is this!?" Catra snapped as she held up the dress in her hands.

"That would be… your evening wear. Lonnie is wearing a dress too, so are all the females…"

Catra then flung the dress on the floor "Yeah, well I'm not wearing that. I got a suit somewhere so I'm going to wear that."

She turned around and went into her closet. She shuffled around to see it wasn't there and snarled at Scorpia "Did you hide my suit on me?"

Scorpia rubbed the back of her head with her claw and let out a surprised scoff. "What? Me? Really? I would never, Catra."

The feline girl then growled again and grabbed the dress from off the floor "If look dumb or if the hole for my tail is down too low, I'm going to make you regret it." she threatened.

Scorpia nervously tapped her claws together. "Well, good thing these are customized then."

That statement caught her by surprise "Custom, you say? Makes sense, you've been undressing me with your eyes long enough to know my size." she teased.

Scorpia started to flail her arms around "N - no! I didn't get the sizes! Your armor measurements for the underclothes are what was used!"

Catra laughed and started to put the dress on "Jeez, you get so frazzled over a joke. I know you're no creep about that kind of stuff, relax" Catra said, as she finally managed to put the dress on.

Scorpia suggested a new hairstyle for the meeting and banquet. Catra informed her she didn't really know how to style her hair. Scorpia then offered to do her hair and make up for her.

Catra was surprised at how well she did, you know, given the fact Scorpia has claws.

But as meaty and large as they were, she had such a tender touch. Granted seeing her hold a thing, do her make up, and hold

a brush was funny as hell, it was also surprising to how good Catra looked after.

No headpiece. Just her hair pulled into a neat bun. A style she thought was impossible with her thick mane, her bangs brushed to the side to draw attention away from the scar on her left eyebrow — she felt pretty and almost dignified. Like a second in command should feel. Her vanity now made her feel powerful. She turned to thank Scorpia.

She felt really good today.

As everyone started to mingle it was informed the meeting for Horde separation would be postponed until tomorrow night. Apparently, a general had Skiff issues and wouldn't make it until the morning. This was more of a relief to Angella. Her mood had changed drastically in the short few hours she had had with Adora. The young blonde was her current distraction and all Angella could think of.

What kind of things does Adora like? Does she have any other hobbies than sword fighting? Favorite foods? Can she make sure the cooks prepare her favorite things for her?

It seemed odd how Adora now consumed her thoughts. She surmounted motherly affection. No, she couldn't treat her less than the same love she would show Bow or Glimmer. Nothing more, nothing less. She would find Glimmer or Bow just as precious at this moment. All be it Glimmer wouldn't be using a salad fork for soup. Granted no one was watching except Catra. The feline girl gave her an interesting vibe.

A cruel and cunning young lady — the opposite of Adora. She could tell by her incessant teasing towards her blonde companion she missed her greatly. Angella felt no threat from this girl. She could just feel the loneliness and desire for acceptance coming

from her. This child wasn't bad or a villain, she was deeply misunderstood.

After watching Catra and Adora flick Edamame Beans at each other for a brief time until the kitchen staff brought out the wine for a tasting party. Odd, how in this time of urgent solutions, the king could just postpone the impending threats for a drink.

She remembered her first wine tasting with Micah and Casta. Castaspella was just of drinking age and was unfamiliar with the concept and ended up heavily inebriated after several glasses. Angella, still a Princess at the time, helped her get back to the hotel room and watched as Casta expelled all her dinner and dessert into the toilet.

Thanks, Angie. If you ever marry my brother, I will totally be your bridesmaid!

It was a sincere comment, one she would later regret as the time for the wedding came along and Casta had enough embarrassing stories about them to write a book about their hijinks. She really couldn't understand why Casta needed to tell everyone about the time she lost her composure flying and twisted her ankle, leaving her much shorter boyfriend to carry her bridal style back to the castle doors. Or the time Micah truth spelled himself and accidentally let it slip that he thought his girlfriend had *A nice rack*.

Brushing off those memories she found herself smiling warmly at the Horde children laughing and having a good time. Lonnie and Catra commenting on how they haven't worn matching outfits since they were six and daring each other to drink as much as they could out of a red wine bottle.

Oh dear… they don't know what a wine tasting is, do they? Oh, no. Adora probably doesn't know either.

Before she could go over and find Adora before she got invited to drinking wine shots, she got intercepted by the king.

“My dear Queen Angella, will you join my daughter and I at our private table?”

Before she could respond, he had clasped on to her wing — which by the way hurt a lot due to the lack of gentleness the king had — and escorted her over to the other side of the room.

He separated her from Adora.

Angella couldn’t help but look back, hoping to catch a glance of Adora one last time before being taken away.

For her claw in marriage

Chapter Summary

After a long wait. Watch Catra be an idiot.

Adora wished she didn't leave Angella's presence. She excused herself for a moment as Angella assured Adora to not be so on edge during their visit. If Adora came off too much of a bodyguard, it could lead to offending the Scorpion Kingdom. In reality, Angella could tell Adora needed to pee and didn't want her to do the *potty dance* for two-hours so she played it off as if Adora roaming around the village grounds was expected. Some of the things Adora did were similar to Glimmer as a baby—others were more like Micah when they first started dating. She debated on what category of person to place Adora in. She felt Adora was childlike for a young adult but also charming like her dead husband. Still, Adora was hands down *Adorable~*

Adora felt embarrassed to need to be excused. She knew Angella could tell what was wrong. At least Angella spared her the embarrassment of not asking her if she needed to "go". She didn't give Glimmer that. She once asked Glimmer if she needed to "go" during a meeting which caused the purple Princess to be embarrassed as the rest of the alliance giggled at Angella's doting.

But to be away from Angella for only a few minutes……

Maybe it was a blessing in disguise? Adora was coming off more awkward and shy in front of Angella. It was bad enough Angella caught her blushing earlier, having Angella see that side of Adora more and more would only lead Angella to the proper conclusion that Adora was *pinning* for her.

What ridiculous thoughts kept swarming through Adora's head of Having a crush on Angella. *Her boss! Her commanding officer!* The mother of her best friend, a woman almost doubles her age. A woman who *looks great* for her age and with one hell of the body to match in those tight clothes. Her eyes couldn't get enough of. All be it; Catra had the most skintight and sexually invoking uniform of any cadet—but that wasn't enough to get Adora in a tizzy. Something about Angella's modest covering yet tight-fitting clothes was appealing to her.

Wait? Why am I thinking about her clothes? Wasn't I just trying to rationalize how silly it is to have a crush on her? And now I'm just mentally drooling over her body? Geez, what is wrong with me? Gosh! A thing of something else Adora!

Her nurturing soul that can be stern and praising was something Adora craved in a friendly and mentoring way.

Yes! Normal thoughts!

and sexual.

Fuck!

Something she never desired from anyone in the Horde; not even in Catra; all be it rumor has it that she and Catra were a thing at one point. *I bet Catra didn't help in denying those claims.* Her romantic and sexual thoughts were for her and only her to know. No one would ever look at Adora the same if they knew the almost-twenty-year-old had naughty thoughts of her boss. The part of Adora that just wanted Angella to tell her she did a good job was one thing. But the thoughts of Angella ordering Adora to her knees and having her lick her—*Oh No! no one could ever know that!* She would never be able to show her face in Brightmoon again if Angella found out about Adora having wet dream fantasies of her.

All her embarrassing thoughts aside she managed to run into where everyone else was. She was managed to get some snacks off a passing vendor carrying trays of food around to people and got to see where all her old friends were hanging out. She technically should have had to pay for those snacks, but the guy said her in a dress was payment enough. She didn't fully get that, but he could understand that the men in this place are horny as sin. She got whistled at by at least four guys in forty-minutes. She wondered if it was only the men who were this forward. Scorpia seemed slightly direct in her feelings but not like she was going to hump anyone at a moment notice. It might be nice to hit on by a woman while being here. Wait? If she was getting hit on, then wouldn't it make sense that Angella would be getting hit on too?

I will punch someone!

When she made her way over to see her former friends, she noticed something was slightly off with Catra.

She snorted out a laugh when she saw that Catra and Lonnie were wearing matching dresses and—also Catra in a dress was funny. Her tail swaying back and forth slightly was an adorable feature of hers that she missed. She looked less intimating in this attire than at Princess Prom. Today she looked more like a sweet little teenager girl and less like the Commander of the Horde Army.

Her laughter was noticed by Catra instantly with a slight wiggle of her ears she spun around to see Adora in a dress and walking towards them with a hand full a snack.

"What kind did you get?" Catra asked. After four shots of red wine, she had no real desire to be confrontational and granted no one wanted her to pick a fight or be an ass, so for her to ask Adora a simple question was just fine with everyone. A tipsy, well-mannered Catra is desired more than a brash and angry, Catra.

This politeness to the blonde by surprise. Adora looked down "Oh? Um? The fried ones are called croquettes and green ones are rice with veggies wrapped in lettuce"

"Cool," Catra commented, "Can I have one?"

Adora blinked in shock to how *normal* Catra was being and offered her the choice in whatever snack she wanted. She even received a thank you from her which was also a surprise.

Adora commented that she liked Catra's dress—slightly curious if that would send Catra on the offense but instead she laughs and pointed to Lonnie "We were just talking about how they used to force us all to match as toddlers. Hey, do you remember those grey and red jumpers we all had to wear for physical training when we were all seven?"

Lonnie and the rest joined in on the conversation as Adora commented that she remembered and also how they all hated them because they were so constricting.

Somehow that conversation jumped to ration bars and time Catra put a snake in Octavia's bunk as a prank.

The laughing from nostalgia was cut short by four guys approaching them. All Scorpion men.

Adora thought they were kinda cute for guys, but then they started talking and that's when things when from fun to annoying.

One guy started with "You're all the Horde underlings for Princess Scorpia? What's she like as a boss?" His question was more geared to the guys in the group and all Rogelio and Kyle did were look at each other with unease. Catra shoved them aside and placed her half-eaten croquette in Kyle's hand and approached them.

She growled at them and began her rant "THEY are soldiers of the Horde army! *Not underlings*, and second I'm Scorpia's boss and thirdly—"

Before her rant could continue another guy laughed loudly and placed his claw dangerously close to the top of her head "You're the boss! You're, like, a tiny kitty-cat girl" he almost cooed in a mocking sense.

One of his friends commented "Nice one, Chad"

Gasped were coming from behind her as the three Horde and former Horde soldier looked on in shock at how stupid these guys were. Catra was ready to kick some ass if they didn't stop.

Catra shoved his claw away from her "You got a problem asshole!?" Catra shouted.

The third guy laughed along with his friends "Even her voice sounds tiny!"

Catra growled and stepped forward—only to be held back by Lonnie and Rogelio.

The one who started the initial conversation seized his laughter to tell them.

"We just wanted to scope out what is new entourage was going to look like, once one of us wins the competition for Princess Scorpia's *claw in marriage*. You'll be seeing me, Todd, or Rodd a lot more in the castle"

Everyone looked confused by this information.

Scorpia has to marry one of these guys? Does she even know these guys? And why the hell did they think mocking Catra's height was a good idea!?

Catra then shouted at them "Not if I have anything to do with it! You three get lost! You're not worthy of Scorpia!" Catra commanded as she pointed in the opposite direction.

Lonnie nodded in agreement. She liked Scorpia as a Force Captain and did not like the idea of Scorpia being around one of these jerks for the rest of her life.

Todd or Rodd—whoever then took his claw up to his mouth and made a very dirty gesture with his tongue "*Oh~ trust me I'm worthy or some of that Princess Pu—*" Catra broke away from Lonnie and Rogelio's grasp and rushed over to him to swat his claw away and grab his shirt collar.

She yelled in his face “I will kick your ass in front of your entire Kingdom and then I’ll kick it again in front of the Horde and then I’ll—” she was once again stopped by one of his friends who grabbed Catra off of him and teased “Don’t get worked up, kitty. You're too far away from your litter box!” the three guys burst into laughter as Catra jumped back in rage. Red flushing from anger and embarrassment. The litter box jab hit a little too close to Catra’s nerves as she was once a victim to some cruel locker room hazing as a preteen and Shadow Weaver did little to nothing to stop it as two older cadets tried to force her to pee on some sawdust for getting on their nerves. When they couldn’t force her to pee, they just beat her up. Leaving her on the locker room floor and Shadow Weaver floated in to tell Catra to clean up the sawdust and to not be foolish and let her guard down again.

Lonnie and Adora gave each other the knowing look that Catra was going to go off and tried to grab her to stop her from completely losing it on them.

Catra then declared “You three are going down at this competition!”

The three laughed some more and shrugged. One replied, “Good, see you outside the castle under the red Horde tent in an hour!”

She stormed off in a huff leaving the four to look on in worry.

While Adora worried for her former friend while Angella faced the discomfort of being around a less than glamorous host.

In many visits to other kingdoms, Angella and Micah would often be surprised by the behaviors and hospitality of other rulers. By far The Plumarian's were the most welcoming and the Frost Kingdom were the most extravagant—but the Scorpion King's kingdom, she was beyond unimpressed. King Sabara was loud, he reached over people's plates, talked with his mouth full, and was not the most elegant of host—he was far from the royal edict that Angella was used to. She could see by the unease in the Princess Scorpia's eyes. Her father was an embarrassment to her.

Poor child, I can't imagine the shame she feels being around him

She tried to remember her father. Angella didn't remember her father all that well. He was an immortal Angelic man—but her mother and he were not very close. Their marriage was arranged. She was around him as a toddler—more for family photos and holidays, but when she grew into adolescence he chose to move back to his other Kingdom. Rumors that he was having an affair and left the Queen; her mother denied these claims and said he was needed elsewhere. Sadly, he died during the Hordes expansion.

That memory was enough to give Scorpia an undeserved glare to which the Princess took as an annoyance. Scorpia tried to shush her father or at the very least not make another comment about what a beauty Queen Angella was and that she must have her team of *servicemen* lining up for her. As rude as that was given

the fact that she was still a grieving widow—the last thing on her mind was sex with any man. For a man with a dead wife, he seemed desensitized by the notion of grief.

He finally ended his long and unpleasant rambling with informing Angella that the Horde meeting with General was pushed back until the next day due to a Skiff attack in the woods.

Unable to hide her annoyance any longer she stood up and her wings flared slightly.

"Your majesty Sabara! This would have been vital information earlier today; I am quite exhausted and would have stayed in for the night and—"

Sabara unable to read how angry Angella was jumped up and extended his claws "You do not need to worry about your beauty sleep Angella! You're pretty enough as it; besides tonight will be even getting than a military meeting. Tonight will be the tournament to see which one of my many strong young male subjects will have my daughter's claw in marriage" he said turning to Scorpia.

Modified and shocked Scorpia cried "W—what?! Wh—when was I going to find out about this dad?!"

He snorted "Now I suppose—Surprise, sweetie"

Angella sat back down and lowered her wings. She frowned when she realized this was news to his daughter to, how unfair of parent to arrange a marriage in this day and age. She'd be damn to ever allow something like this to happen to Glimmer.

Scorpia sputtered out "D—daddy. I—Uh, your majesty I don't believe this is a good time to even think like that—Besides no one wants to see a bunch of guys fights over me" her eyes kept nervously darting back to Angella. Scorpia was more embarrassed that her dad declared this in front of her of all people. Rumor has it; Angella has no sense of humor. Having her father act a fool in front of her was only making her fear the worst in what Angella's opinion was shaping out to be.

Sabara didn't pay his daughter's discomfort and assured her she will have a great time.

It came to Angella's realization that Sabara was not cruel, but he was without a doubt an *idiot*.

He excused himself to the "*Wizz".* A detail he did not need to share with anyone but still did. She sat with Scorpia who had her head hung in shame. Angella's motherly instincts kicked in and she went over to sit closer with Scorpia.

"Are you unhappy with this arrangement?" Angella questioned. She reached her gloved hand over Scorpia's claw which resulted in

the girl flinch. Scorpia instantly regained her composure. She cleared her throat but looked away.

"Dad, uh—the King doesn't have such good timing when it comes to things…." She trailed off. Angella knew she wasn't happy about what was going on and patted her claw.

"Would you like me to say something?" Angella offered. Scorpia was surprised to receive such motherly kindness from a woman she just met yesterday. Wasn't Angella supposed to be a bitch? Turns out the horde got that wrong too.

Scorpia looked away nervously and tapped her claws together and moved her chair away. "Oh," Scorpia didn't know how to respond to that. Angella in her eye was supposed to be a cruel tyrant and diva. Instead, she was kind and sweet. This disrupts the whole Brightmoon is evil propaganda that Hordak implemented.

Scorpia sputtered out "I—I'm fine, I don't want to bore you with dumb—uh, un-dignified Princess stuff" She quickly got up made her way to the door. Angella walked over behind her slowly. She knew Scorpia wanted to open up about this but kept reserved due to not knowing Angella very well. Horde propaganda didn't help this either.

"You know," Angella began. "Both armies are dominated in teenagers, I've had to sit and hear many different teen-based arguments and conflicts"

"Really?" Scorpia asked. Almost surprised anything in Brightmoon was less than perfect.

Angella let out a small laugh as she replied "Oh you would be surprised with what a group of girls can find to yell at each other over"

Scorpia's face brightens up a bit after hearing this.

Angella continued with "I had to break up a heated argument between Mermista and Perfuma on letting Seahawk run a kissing booth"

Scorpia chuckled

Angella nodded "Yes, my fair resolution was to shut it down. I feel I might have saved a relationship of some type between the Princess of the Sea and that gentleman with the boat"

Scorpia then moved a bit closer to Angella and they walked out of the room "So…. Is that pirate guy and the Sea Princess something?"

Angella smirked. Of Course, a teen would want to gossip. Wait? How old is Scorpia? Older than Catra and Adora for sure but she can't be anywhere near her late twenties yet. She was another cute child from the Horde

"Oh, those two are Exes. I think they are in the, *will they? won't they?* The phase of their relationship" Angella answered.

This prompted a smile on Scorpia's face.

The best way to get a young lady to open up is with a little gossip. She looked over to Scorpia and smiled. Angella noted her features. The young lady was tall. Broad in the shoulders with a muscular build. She was feminine without a doubt. The way she carried herself in high heels made it known she was comfortable and her with make-up, earrings and lipstick also showed she was one to relish in her vanity. She had delicate features. Angella thought that Scorpia had a somewhat model-like face. If she was someone in Politics, she would get definite votes, she was pretty and likable. One of the few like this from the Horde. Only Adora is someone else she finds charming.

Scorpia then asked "Um, is it allowed for Alliance members to date? In the Horde, they had a strict policy on fraternizing. A lot of Force Captains just end up marrying each other to not get in trouble"

"Marriage is allowed in the Horde?"

"Yes, to breed more soldiers; plus, you get better living arrangements"

“Ah, so it’s a perk out of luxury, not love”

“I guess so, I had this one guy pushing the whole time I was in Force Captain training to marry me, but I declined the offer all four times—he wasn’t my type,”

Angella smirked. She debated for a second if she should show some motherly affection and throw a light tease her way or just compliment her.

“Ah, so they are already lining up for you then, huh?” implying Scorpia was a catch for the Horde Captains. Scorpia shook her head profusely. A bashful smile came over her face.

“No—no, just like one guy, and whoever my dad got to compete in this thing,” her voice dropped a bit.

Angella could tell this was not something Scorpia was looking forward to.

“Perhaps if you inform your father, you’re not planning on betrothal…. He may reconsider?”

Scorpia shook her head “No, he is looking forward to this. I can’t hurt his feelings”

"But at the cost of your own?" Angella questioned. She couldn't handle to see the young lady being forced into doing something she didn't want to do. Even if Scorpia was not her child. She felt compelled to protect her.

Scorpia signed "this is…. The only time I've spent with my dad in five years. If him setting up me up for a husband at *the worst possible time* makes him happy. Then I'll do it,"

Angella didn't pry any further on that subject. Before the awkward silence could sink in, they were greeted by the other Horde cadets that were Adora's former friends. All seemingly worried.

"Scorpia!" Kyle cried.

"Kyle? You three okay?" Scorpia asked. A bit surprised by how frantic they were acting. Like as if they just witnessed a crime.

Lonnie then dropped all the exposition possible in one sentence "Catra met your boyfriends and is now going to fight them"

Scorpia glanced over to Angella then cleared her throat "Umm, guys I don't have—"

Adora stepped in and offered "The guys in your betrothal thingy pissed off Catra and now she's going to fight them!"

Scorpia's eyes narrowed to annoyance at Adora. She didn't want to talk to her. *Adora sucks*.

Before the conversation could go any further. The King arrived to inform Scorpia.

"Sweetie! That feline girl your so fond of wishes marry you" he practically slurped his words. Angella narrowed her eyes in disappointment and disgust. *Is she drunk? My goodness, he is drunk!*

This man is the King! The royal who represents this Kingdom is waltzing around drunk as sin and in front of young adults no less. Angella, herself would never parade her won castle drunk. She rarely drinks. The only person was ever intoxicated with was Micah and that was bad enough.

She shook off her nostalgia and spoke to him directly without any restraint in her disapproval of his behavior.

"King Sabara, the cadets had a very unpleasant situation with the men you wish your daughter to marry me. I strongly suggest you speak with them and ensure they respect her better than how they treated her colleague"

Adora looked on in awe of how powerful Angella came off. Her smile went noticed by Lonnie who nudged her playfully to which Adora snapped back to normal. She watched as King Sabara told to brush off Angella's concerns.

"Boys will be boys, *Angie—"*

"Do not! Call me that" she snapped back. Sabara's eyes went a little wide as he stepped back and waved his claws in defense "Woah, a temper on you Brightmooners"

Scorpia shot Adora look to which Adora just shrugged too. *What? What am I supposed to do when your dad is the one being a jerk?*

Kyle then tapped Lonnie on the shoulder and asked, "Should we be watching this—This doesn't seem to involve us,"

Lonnie snorted back and replied with "Sshhh, I want to see if it's true that Queen Angella can throw hands a moment's notice"

Adora rolled her eyes. *Throw hands? More like raise her voice and wing flutter. Come to think of it can Angella fight? Because if she can that would be hot. Okay! Again? Why does my mind keep coming back to these thoughts?*

Sabara then offered "Look, how about you and I go over to the arena and see how this will all play out. Shall we?" he extended

his claw to her. She turned away.

"Very well" Angella answered but she did not take his claw. She walked with them and looked back at Adora.

Adora turned back to her former friends and they all followed.

Tonight, was about to get interesting.

At the arena; which was just red tent some dirt with a bunch drunk people around it. Adora was offered a drink along with Lonnie and Rogelio. the three drank it.

Adora's eyes went wide as she felt the burning sensation on her throat.

"What was this?" Adora asked looking at her glass.

"Sangria, it's wine, juice, and some other stuff mixed in" Lonnie answered.

"Oh," Adora took another sip. It tasted good and sipped some more of it. This was better than the time she drank whatever Seahawk had stored in on a ship that one time that Mermista kept asking for. *Rum was it?*

Kyle commented, “Wasn’t the meeting supposed to be going on right now?”

Lonnie whipped back “Shut up, Kyle”

Angella gave her a disproving look and stood closer to the poor boy “Yes, dear. The meeting was supposed to be happening tonight, but it was postponed until tomorrow”

Kyle smiled at her and stood closer to her as the crowd began to form around them.

The Horde cadets and Adora stood closely next to Angella. Adora shot a glare at the guy who was ogling Angella from behind. Gesturing to him she will have his eyes on him for the night. Angella smiled to herself. As someone who knew very well, she was active; having men stare at her was common. Despite the Scorpio men having zero subtlety, it wasn’t completely unwanted. As shallow as it can be, she does enjoy some attention and how protective Adora was becoming. Like a jealous lover. Adora made the bold move to have her arm latch around Angella’s arm. When Angella raised a brow, Adora informed her it was a safety measure. Then she shot back a look at the guy who was checking out Angella earlier.

Angella wanted to laugh at this—Micah was one to do this when he felt that certain guests' eyes would wander around his wife's frame.

A screech came over a speaker and a man in the middle of the dirt arena. "I am pleased to announce that Princess Scorpia had three—no four suitors who will fight for her claw in honor for marriage!"

Everyone started to look at Scorpia and clapped and whistled. she desperately tried to avoid everyone's gaze. This was so embarrassing.

Angella continued to find things to dislike about this Kingdom—in the way they treat their Princess in such a misogynistic way. fighting for her was so low brow and uncouth She felt bad for the young Princess. She would be livid if she ever discovered Glimmer being subjected to such treatment. But, according to Adora; Glimmer was a bit of a flirt and Bow and she makes it very clear she is unavailable. The details on how that is done were something Adora had carefully left out. Probably a good choice.

A bit of laughter came as the four entered the arena—mainly laughing at Catra because she was much smaller than the other contestants.

Scorpia then crocked out "Seriously!?"

Lonnie offered "You thought we were lying. Those guys pissed her off and now she wants to fight them"

Scorpia facepalmed with her claw the best she could "Does she even know what she's doing?"

Lonnie deadpanned "You need to ask that?"

Kyle then tried to offer some assurance to Scorpia "At least you know with Catra the fight will end quickly, Y'know. Given her claws, agility, and her ability to be very—"

"Mean? Lonnie finished.

Rogelio nodded.

Scorpia signed "The bell just went off. I guess we will see"

Angella wasn't so enthused to see this fight. She found it gross and barback. Watching Catra fight for her friend's honor was something noteworthy. Adora had her arm locked on hers and watched carefully as Catra jumped on one guy's back and threw a sandal at one guy, another at the other guy. The two tried to tag team and get off her off their friendly she managed to claw him in the face and jump above the other two guys and grabs their heads and knock them together. All while wearing a dress—and now everyone got to see her black underwear. Which only caused

more perverts to cheer louder. One guy went as far as to say "Rip her dress" to which Adora and company turned to give the guy a "shut the hell up" look.

Angella looked down at Adora to see her eyes were focused a bit too much on Catra's poor wardrobe choice. The men aren't the only perverts in the crowd as she followed Adora's line of vision to see Adora was hyper-focused on Catra's butt.

Well, this young lady has a fancy for ladies. Or how would my daughter call this? "Your gay is showing?" oh goodness.

She overheard the commentary coming from Lonnie Scorpia.

"At least when she wins you know she can fight anyone and everyone for you"

"If she can do that to those guys—imagine what she will what she'll do to my dad when he pisses her off?"

"At least you know someone's got your back?"

"I guess…. I just don't think she knows what this whole fight I for"

“Trust me…. She doesn’t”

The group watched as Catra single-handedly took out the three large Scorpio men and the crowd cheered. Much to the confusion of Scorpia, her father rushed over to embrace Catra. Which was just as odd for Catra as it was for everyone else to see.

“Everyone,” he stated “My new Daughter-in-law! From this moment forth she will be now be referred to as Princess Catra!”

Catra instantly backed away “Wait? What?!” She didn’t want to be called a Princess! Adora snorted out a laugh.

Scorpia smacked her claw to her forehead and groaned. Catra had no idea what she was doing.

Angella raised a brow. Her patience for some strange reason has come back to her. Admittedly she was no fan of the feline Horde Commander. That little nightmare caused misery to Glimmer while captured by the Horde as well as shooting a tank cannon at Angella herself while under the Moonstone during the attack on Brightmoon.

But Catra did have some charm to her. Not attraction charm like Adora but something different. She looked at the feline-like a child. Angella looked over to the other Horde children and thought the same. Children. Then she looked down at Adora and smiled. Adora was a child compared to her too, but something

about her was different. Adora was trying very hard to stand out like more of an adult in front of Angella. Maybe this was because she wasn't around her friends or maybe because she was still battling her feelings about the Horde and the feline girl around her—all Angella knew was Adora's arm was getting sweaty and she was mildly grossed out. But just like when Glimmer would run-up to her with sticky hands as a toddler, she brushed it off for the sake of her younger companion's happiness to be close to her.

Catra approached Scorpia. She looked almost sheepish as she tried her best to come off as confident. She leaned over and stated "Well I guess I'm now your—" before she could finish Scorpia backed away and walked off.

"H—hey! where you are going!? Scorpia! Hey! don't run off like that I kicked three douchebags for you! Hey!" Catra rushed after her.

The group looked at each other in confusion before Lonnie commented.

"Bet you Catra screws this up"

Adora nodded "I give it a week"

Lonnie snorted "I give 10-minutes"

Drunken Cat and idiot Blonde

Chapter Summary

Chapter re-uploaded

Scorpia had enough of today. First, her dad embarrassed her in front of everyone and then Catra embarrassed her. Why? Why did Catra have to go in a fight and win? It's not like Catra even knows what being married or what a wedding is.

It hurt her in a way she couldn't vocalize properly. She liked Catra — really liked Catra. But she knew Catra was limited in her feelings.

Romance was never an option.

She knew Catra would never feel the same way about her. Even if she secretly longed for her too.

When news of the Horde's actions in her desert homeland became clearer to her, she decided to leave the Horde. Hordak seemed to not care in the slightest. He also seemed almost surprisingly "chill" at the idea of the Scorpion Kingdom withdrawing from the alliance to the Horde. All while she started her resignation steps from the Horde, she felt saddened by it. After years of dedication she though the other Force Captains and Cadets would be sad for her or at least say goodbye properly.

Nope—the nicest thing said to her before she left was Octavia telling her she is going to love calling dibs on her room since it was the second biggest next to Shadow Weaver's old room. Not a goodbye or even *It was nice working together* was said.

Just an unsavory *I call dibs on your room.*

It only got slightly better when Lonnie offered a hushed *You will be missed*. That was good.

When she went to say goodbye to Entrapta and Catra she was surprised to see that Catra was visibly the most upset. She even declared that she was going with her to make sure she was settled in.

This came as a shock to Scorpia that Catra would even consider leaving the fight over the Rebellion to assist her in the desert. Was it that Catra cared for her as more than just a co-worker or was it that she knew more then she led on?

In truth, Catra knew that Hordak was issuing a strike on her Kingdom and wasn't going to let Scorpia leave the Horde so easily. Catra was assigned by Hordak himself to ensure the defense would be down and an invasion would be easy and with Queen Angella being there alone it was even more perfect.

Catra would be responsible for the downfall of Etheria if she betrays Scorpia.

But that's not her plan.

She has grown tired of being talked down to and not being as respected as she believes she should be. Having the chance to rule and be in charge was far greater than just being submissive to Hordak.

Although she was still confused as to how marriage worked, she wasn't going to pass up the opportunity in power.

Ruling over the Scorpion Kingdom on her own was easier than just bossing and manipulating Scorpia and her dad around. As a new titled *Princess,* she would have more authority. Although she hated that new title, she would need it in order to stop the invasion of the Horde.

But first things first.

Catra wanted to see why Scorpia ran off like that.

Shouldn’t she be happy with the arrangement?

She always figured Scorpia would love an excuse to hang around Catra more. Them being married is like glorified best friends, right?

Right?

After leaving villagers and all the drunks around the town she made her way back to the castle.

She found Scorpia was in the room with the door locked.

She got annoyed after knocking a few hundreds of times and decided to take the alternate route to her room, jumping out on the window and two ledges away to Scorpia’s bedroom window.

She landed on her feet in front of the balcony doors. She walked in without knocking to see Scorpia sitting on her bed — visibly upset.

The proper thing to do would be to comfort her and ask what’s wrong, but Catra doesn't always grasp what is proper. She whistled to her and made Scorpia jolt up visibly startled.

“Hey, Wife! Your Princess wife is here!” she bellowed. A smug grin came over her face as Scorpia just scowled at her and turned away.

Catra grunted “Hey, why aren’t you happy to see me? Isn’t this something you would want? A wife?”

“No, not like this.” She replied coldly

Catra came and stood in front of her and inquired “Not like this? It was either *me* or one of those dumbasses”

Scorpia shot up a look of defense “Those dumbasses actually wanted to marry me, ma-maybe even love me! I dunno! Have kids with me, something! But with you - you just can’t show up,

ruin a betrothal battle and act like it's all fine!" Scorpia desperately wanted to sound serious and angry over what had just transpired, but It came off as more flustered and nervous with her fidgeting with her claws and eyes darting around the room.

Catra's tail swayed side to side with annoyance as she huffed and pinched the bridge of her nose "Look," she shook her head and stared Scorpia "This is the best chance we have at the Horde not screwing you guys over, just let me run things my way and you won't have to worry." Catra patted the side of Scorpia's face. To her, it seemed affectionate but to Scorpia it was more condescending.

Catra retracted her hand and smirked "Besides, you know this works out for you? Right? I mean, how stupid do you think I am? *I know you like me*." she purred.

Scorpia's eyes went wide as she backed away from Catra on the bed. Only to have the playful feline place her knee in between Scorpia's legs. The taller woman fell back a bit and her claws held her up from falling completely on her back.

Why would Catra say it like that? She knew I liked her this whole time and just didn't bother to address it? What kind of friend does that?

Scorpia looked down at where Catra's knee was and then back up to her. She saw her eyes glow with some type of smug satisfaction that she did not like at all.

Catra then leaned in closer to Scorpia. Her gleefulness in making Scorpia uncomfortable was unsettling. Scorpia felt her bottom lip tremble almost as she sternly moved forward to say

"I want you to like me – the – the way I like you," She closed her mouth shut for emphasis, swallowing loudly," If you can't do that then you can't be my wife." Scorpia said as sternly as she could possible muster up.

Her serious face was not as intimidating as she would have hoped.

Catra moved her head back and laughed. “Oh, seriously?” She said moving off the bed and turned sideways to walk over to Scorpia’s room desk to pick up a bottle of wine “You really think that’s how this is going to work?” she said now turned to Scorpia “The Horde is up to something and I’m here to take care of you, so just let me be in charge and do this. We don’t need to waste time with all this lovey pining stuff when I can be taking charge of the Horde and the Rebellion.”

Scorpia just glared at her “Why does it always have to be about you? Don’t you care how I feel?”

Catra just scoffed “Like you ever have an opinion on anything” her jab struck a chord with Scorpia. For such a tall, strong, and loyal person, no one ever gave her much thought to her own feelings.

First, her dad springs the idea of engagement on her without her knowledge or approval.

Then Catra busts in to take charge like she always does! It was clear to her now that one thinks of her and it hurts – and she won’t stand for it anymore.

She stood up from her bed “Catra!” she shouted causing the Feline to jump a bit. “If you don’t like me enough to want to marry me then you won’t! You can’t just boss me around and be mean to me!”

Catra growled and threw her hands in the air “Mean? I just saved you from being stuck with one of those meatheads and I’m trying to get the Horde to not wreck this place and you think **I** am treating you badly?”

She huffed out a small laugh before turning back the table to grab Scorpia’s old Horde Badge communicator off the desk “See? Every time I try and do the right thing, no one! And I mean, no one! Ever cares!”

Scorpia's heart sank a bit.

Even though Catra can be selfish she was trying to do something, slightly nice despite it being unlined in selfishness.

She got up from the bed and made her way over to Catra who was already walking towards the door with the communicator in one hand and the wine in the other.

Before she left the room, she yelled back "I'm taking your wine and communicator, don't follow me!" and with that, she slammed the door.

Scorpia gulped and stuttered out a quip right back at her "I wasn't going to! A – and – and – that wine sucks!"

She then groaned and flopped down on her bed. Being home was supposed to make her happy, instead, she was now even more uncomfortable and miserable and no one else understands how she feels.

While she continued to sulk Catra made her way through the castle.

Being called *Princess* got old much faster than she thought.

But getting people asking how they can serve her was a bit of an even trade for the unlikable title.

She ordered a kitchen servant to get her another bottle of wine to which he did gleefully, and another servant got her snacks. Now with an arsenal of snacks and booze at her disposal, she decided to see where Lonnie and the others were at. In reality, she wanted to run into Adora.

Not to talk to her, no, she just wanted to show off that she was a Princess, soon to married, and was a superior leader.

Much to her dismay around the corner in the meeting room of the castle, Adora, A.K.A *She-Sucks Princess of poop* was getting all chummy with Lonnie, Kyle, and Rogelio. A little too chummy.

She hated the sight of seeing Adora being so close to all their – no, *her* old friends. Catra's fist clenched as she took a strong gulp from the wine bottle and turned away to walk in the other direction.

Damn this stuff burns and tastes so good.

It wasn't fair that everywhere Adora went she was able to make friends and long-lasting relationships. Just by the way they were all talking and laughing she could just feel the sting of rejection all over again.

It wasn't like the trio hated Catra, but in her eyes, they looked at her as second best. Lonnie only asked to be assigned to Catra due to hating working under Octavia. It wasn't like they were friends really.

She felt herself getting angrier and the tears were starting to form. She turned away from them only to see Angella, *Queen Glitter Bomb* standing right behind her with a concerned look on her pretty face

Wait what? Crap. She is really pretty. No wonder Adora wanted to work for her instead of Shadow Weaver.

Angella asked in a soft voice "Are you alright?" quiet enough to not draw attention to the rest of the group that the two were just around the corner of the room.

Catra gave her glare and just spat "Just because Adora chose you, doesn't make you or the Rebellion special!"

Angella's mouth opened a bit by that statement, unsure as to how to respond to such words and also wondering where all this came from.

She had hardly spoken to Catra up until this point and it seemed so strange for her to say something like this to her.

"Pardon?" Angella questioned crossing her arms. Just like with Glimmer she would not allow such verbiage in her presence.

Catra took another gulp of wine from her bottle, to which Angella found to be extremely unladylike.

"You heard me, we get it! You're pretty, Brightmoon is pretty and everyone freakin love you! But not me, just because Adora has it bad for you doesn't mean everyone else does!" Catra slightly slurred her words towards the end.

Angella raised a brow in confusion. She saw the feline's tail sway in an almost drunken state as she walked past Angella in the opposite direction away from everyone.

She mumbled loudly "Miss perfect with her shiny hair, smelling nice, having great calves and a perfect butt, and you think everyone freakin loves you – ah – shit!" She tripped slightly on her own feet as she walked away which made Angella grin.

She's definitely nothing like Adora.

She walked made her way back into the room with the Horde cadets and Adora. She smiled as she saw Kyle pull out a chair for her.

"Aw, you're such a gentleman" she complimented her and received a shy smile and small blush from the boy to which Lonnie smirked and Adora's eyes narrowed in dislike.

This was cute. It seemed the Horde children had taken a curious interest in the Queen. She saw how the stared at her wings and every time she spoke, they gave her their full attention. It was nice to have the same respect that the Princess gave her outside Birghtmoon.

Adora asked, "Were you talking to someone just now?"

Angella took a second to reply as she was watching Lonnie use a tracker pad. "Yes, Commander Catra was just here. She seemed to be heading off to the East Wing of the Castle."

Lonnie didn't look up from her tracker pad as she spoke "East Wing is her new brooding spot. It's a huge balcony that looks over the village were the vendor stands are - she took us there to throw water balloons at the fruit vendor"

"Wait? Wasn't that target practice?" Kyle asked.

"No, it was revenge on the guy who called Catra *kitty-kitty meow-meow* and all it was pretty fun. She and I did an extra target practice session after the guy from the flower stand got mad I wouldn't go on a date with him"

Angella hid her smile behind her hands.

Adora saw this and got a fluttering feeling in her chest from it.

Angella liked being around her old friends and her old friends were super cool around her. The brilliant idea of bringing up old nostalgia came to mind and without much thought, she brought up one memory of her young cadets pulling a prank together.

"Hey, remember the time we put smoke bombs in the senior cadets' lockers?" Adora sputtered out in a slightly higher speaking voice than necessary.

Angella raised a brow and Lonnie grinned "Yeah," then her grin turned to a deadpan look "Remember how when we got caught; Shadow Weaver asked you who did it and you just cried and told her everything"

Adora's smile dropped when she realized she had somehow forgotten that part of their hijinks.

She also forgets the last part.

"Yeah we all got stuck on latrine duty for a month and Catra had to sit alone at lunchtime for a week, and after you were done crying, you farted" Kyle then added.

Leaving all three Horde Cadets to laugh at that. The blonde now shrunk a bit in her seat and glanced over to Angella who seemed still oddly humored by this.

Shit – Angella is laughing at me too? She has to be at the very least disappointed in me! I'm an idiot!

"And then you cried more after that" Lonnie laughed out.

The three laughed some more until Angella cleared her throat to ask "So Adora was a sensitive child?"

The blonde's eyes went wide.

Lonnie doesn't know anything about what to and not to say and she's known me since I was four! No, no, no! Please no! She has no idea what to not say in front of a Queen!

Lonnie shook her head "No way, Adora was the goody-good who was first in everything; first to get her Skiff license, first to get a stun baton, first at finishing tests, first to get up in the morning, first to wear a bra, yeah Adora kinda was the first lady of everything in our squad"

Adora used her hand to hide her face from Angella's gaze.

The Queen seemed amused by hearing this. Lonnie then finished with a jab at Catra "If anything Catra was the sensitive one out of the group besides Kyle, until she got her boobs then she became, well, whatever she is now." Lonnie finished with a shrug.

Kyle added in one last quip "I never got boobs so I'm still sensitive!"

Everyone except Adora laughed at that.

The Queen found them funny.

Queen Angella laughed at a boob joke! It's weird how Glimmer told Adora so many times her mother had no sense of humor.

Angella caught in the corner of her eyes Adora's discomfort.

With that, the Queen stood up "It has been an absolute pleasure to meet you all, I should be retiring for the evening, Adora may you escort me to my room?"

Adora shot up "Yes, your majesty"

The two began to walk out of the room and Lonnie stood up "Your royalness, Angella? One more thing"

Angella turned to face her while Adora facepalmed.

Royalness? That's not even a word Lonnie!

Lonnie then smirked "Adora also once gave herself bangs and they were uneven and too short"

The three Horde cadets laughed together and Angella smiled at Adora and left the room with her.

In the hallway, Angella out a light giggle "They seem to miss you"

Adora crossed her arms and grumbled "Doubt it, or else why bring up my bangs – and for the record! They grew in just fine after a few weeks"

Angella smiled "I think the teasing is a sign they miss you, why else would Catra be so unhinged when she sees you"

Adora walked closer to Angella. "Catra? No, she hates me, ever since I left the Horde, she's been nothing but mean to me" Adora said.

Her tone saddened by the realization that her former best friend was mean to her.

Angella extended her wing out to pull Adora in closer "Relationships can be hard, Adora. I'm sure it has been a painful breakup for you as much as it has been for her"

Adora blinked "Breakup? No – no I said before I never dated anyone in the Horde, Catra was my best friend – I mean it was kind of like a breakup and I do miss her, but the real her. Catra isn't really always a jerk, she used to be really nice and that's the best friend I wish I had back"

Angella stroked Adora's shoulder.

"Perhaps you should tell her how you feel. It's better than her throwing water balloons outside the West Wing balcony"

"You think she's doing that?"

Angella then pointed behind her "Yes, our paths crossed briefly when I re-entered the room. She seemed slightly upset and quite inebriated"

Adora rubbed her temples and groaned "Oh no, She wasn't rude to you, was she?"

Angella looked away slightly "Uh, I believe she was trying to insult me but instead she just listed compliments, about my hair, perfume, and my other various attributes and how much you *adore* me"

Adora's mind went into overdrive and panic as she feared what would come out of Catra's mouth.

Adora's eyes narrowed and she stood at attention to Angella "Your majesty, may I be excused to speak with Commander Catra"

Angella raised a brow and smirked. She moved away "Go right ahead, Adora"

Adora saluted and dashed down the hall still in her dress. She had fumbled a bit running in sandals, but she managed to make it

down the hall without tripping.

She walked down to her room to see Scorpia walking down the hall dressed in casual clothes. Tight black stir-up pants and a red tank top. She seemed to be holding something in her claws and with her eyes focused on whatever that was, she didn't realize Angella was coming towards her.

"Princess Scorpia?" Angella called. Startling the tall Princess.

"Ye – yes, Queen Angella?"

Angella got to a better look at the Horde communicator she was holding. She knew what they were due to Glimmer bringing one to her after a mission.

"Is everything all right?" knowing all too well something was not. Judging by the recent events Angella was aware of, she figured it must have something to do with her new wife.

"Oh, uh, yeah, sorta, I'm fine. Just trying to find Catra… You haven't seen her by chance, have you?" she asked with a nervous shrug of her shoulders.

Angella answered "She may be with Adora on the West Wing – possibly ignoring her or arguing with her"

Scorpia snorted "If I know Catra I'd say it's a little of both"

Angella let out a light laugh.

Just then the communicator blinked and a sound came from it.

"PFFT" Catra made a fart sound using her mouth. Charming.

"Catra! quit making fart noises and come back to the room so we can talk"

"PFFT"

"Catra!"

"PFFT"

"Catra?!"

"Eat a dick!"

And with that last rude remark, the signal was lost again.

Scorpia sunk her head in defeat. Then looked up at Angella with a nervous smile. "Th – this is how she, uh, gets sometimes. She's under a lot of stress, it's understa-"

Angella nodded and cut her by placing a hand on Scorpia's shoulder "So are you" she offered.

Scorpia averted from her gaze a bit and answered "Yeah, but it is not like I have anyone to talk to about this"

Angella then lightly caressed her shoulder "Perhaps you should come to my room with me so we can speak in private. I must retire into some more conformable garments anyways. I can assure you it is no trouble"

Scorpia gulped "Oh, um, okay! Sure, that sounds great"

Angella smiled and walked with Scorpia down the hall.

Angella felt satisfied in her ability to connect with the younger generation of Princesses and Horde cadets so well. She hoped Adora would be able to connect with Catra in a way to get the rest of the Horde on the Rebellions side.

Eavesdropping

Chapter Summary

Scorpia and Angella hear Catra and Adora's whole conversation after Catra butt-dials Scopria with her communicator badge. re-edited.

Rumors were starting to circulate.

Angella, Princess of Brightmoon, was seeing the Head apprentice sorcerer of Mystacor.

These rumors were hard to verify since all of Angella's personal guards were loyal to the kind Princess and didn't report to Queen Archella of any misdeed the Princess and her honorable guest made when he was in her carriage while roaming the roads of Brightmoon.

While one guard rode the horse that pulled the cart the two lovers were able to share some light kisses in private with the shades drawn.

Her guard didn't mind. Keeping the Secret of the Princess was more pleasant than being around the Queen. The shades were drawn so no one could peek inside the carriage. Those days, Micah chose to wear a buttoned vest and loose pants, easy to take off when needed, while Angella wore a slightly shorter shirt and strapless top under her royal cape.

Her mother would have screamed if she saw her little Princess in such a flirtatious outfit. She would have fainted if she saw where Angella had her hands now on Micah. She was unbuttoning his vest and touching his toned chest while kissing him, her mouth wide open, his tongue wandering around hers, and no hesitation on where else her other hand was roaming.

His hands were now roaming up her skirt and shirt. Moving away from her soft lips Micah planted his lips on her neck. Angella

letting out the tiniest giggle as his goatee was tickling her neck.

She loved him and the tingles his beard gave her in her lower regions were amazing.

She sat up to straddle him as she felt his manhood through his pants and continued kissing until she heard a whooshing sound and the carriage being halted.

Some chatter from a panicked guard indicated for the two to look presentable as possible. Not enough time was given before carriage shades were drawn up and her mother. Angella's face palled at the sight of her wings extended out and her face red with rage.

"You two! Get out! Now!" she barked.

The larger woman was Queen Archella. She had short pink hair and a bit of a heavier build than Angella's and a more serious and unpleasant demeanor. Her skin was more peach colored, whereas Angella's father was a purple haired and pinkish skinned man with a slender frame.

Despite her parent's vast contrasts, they still had one thing in common; their temper.

As the humiliated early twenty-year-old Princess left her carriage. Disheveled and covering herself with her cloak, she heard her mother snark a curse.

"Angella, what are you wearing?" Her mother asked as she grabbed Angella's robe to reveal her outfit. Angella felt her face burn with embarrassment as her guard looked away with unease. Archella snarled at her attire. "Look at you, this is no way for a Princess to dress!" she said before violently grabbing Angella by the wrist and pulling her forward to her.

Angella looked at her mother fearfully as her mother brought her other hand to cup the Princess's face "You will not bring me shame, Angella!" before releasing her, she looked over to Micah

and spat at him "You, vile boy, use your sorcerer charm on someone from your own class, you're not worthy of a Princess."

In her anger she ordered Micah to leave Birghtmoon, leaving the young man on the side of the road while Angella and Archella took the carriage back to the castle.

She spent the whole ride yelling at Angella and making her cry.

This memory flooded back to Angella while she sat with Scorpia as she talked about her stress and worries about her leadership role and her conflicting feelings with Catra.

Catra. Why her? Angella thought to herself.

This feline troublemaker sure knows how to make a girl fall to her knees for her.

Adora had been one in the list of *How do I feel about Catra?* conflicted with her feelings of platonic love for the cat girl.

However, Scorpia seems to have mustered genuine feelings for her.

As preposterous as it is…

Scorpia nervously tapped her pinchers together "I mean have a thought about dating her and going on a romantic night through the Fright Zone and kissing under the hydroplane dock—but, I mean *who hasn't* thought about that before right?"

Angella's smile made the Scorpion girl flush. Scorpia instantly regretted being so open with Angella.

What was she thinking when she thought it would be *okay* to vent to The Queen of Birghtmoon?

This is an immortal Queen who can transform into a falcon and her powers can turn a grown adult into goo, let alone her endless concubines and male harems.

She couldn't understand the simplicity of having a crush on a co-worker.

Angella let out a light chuckle before adding in "For me, it would have been a night under the second moon rise at the peak of Mount Brightmoon. That was where my husband and I would frequent when we were still in our pining phase"

Scorpia blinked "Oh? So, you do… You do know what I'm saying, right?"

Angella nodded "Indeed, the placement of work and romance does intertwine when we least except it. I do suggest talking to her about what you except out of this arrangement. You've worked so hard, you deserve happiness, Scorpia"

The white-haired girl smiled at her. It was a small one, but it was strange to receive such genuine positive enforcement from someone who barely knew her.

"T-thank you, Queen Angella," Scorpia smiled. Angella smiled back until Scorpia commented "You're really nothing like they describe you on Hordepedia"

Angella deadpanned "I beg your pardon?"

''Oh! Well – Uh, you see – I mean…" Scorpia trailed off.

While Scorpia inadvertently caused a whole new conversation to form, Adora was searching for Catra.

She heard the muffled sound of Catra's voice. She could recognize her whines and complains anywhere. She came in to see what was most likely the end of an argument between Catra and two vendors bellow the balcony. She heard Catra rant.

"Seriously, why does there need to be two apple carts next to each other? Just guy one, you go over there and you go over

there!”

Adora head a voice call protest “But I’ve had my cart here first for days, why can’t he just leave?”

Catra pinched the bridged of her nose “Because neither of you two need to be there, just do as I say, okay? Princess orders.”

Adora snorted at hearing Catra say this. She saw Catra’s ears twitch before she turned around just to snarl at her.

Her attention was taken back from her to the original issue as another voice called “Well, his cart is ugly so I should stay!”

Catra snapped back “Both your carts look like crap now both of you can leave, each guy gets a new vendor corner and you can sell your sucky fruits somewhere else.”

“Yeah, but—”

Catra let out a hiss and the two men in fear bowed and ran away.

“Wow, already on diplomatic missions, Your majesty?”

Catra groaned at her “Ew, I’ll leave it to you to find the fun in this. Do you have any idea how annoying people have been since I got this new title a few hours ago? No one has left me alone and everyone has been asking me for stuff!”

Catra sighed, taking a sip out of a bottle of wine Adora hadn’t seen before.

“Where did you get the wine?”

“Oh, I asked for it. Want some?”

‘’I’ll… pass - Where’s Scorpia, by the way?”

Catra sighed and leaned back onto the rail of the balcony. Her butt pressed the communicator pad to Scorpia, signaling her that she was talking on the other end of the communicator.

Scorpia had muted Catra so she didn't hear her and Adora talking. Instead she was focused on Angella dispelling rumors of Brightmoon.

"No, there is no Harem of men waiting for me at the castle. Yes, my guards are paid, yes, Glimmer is my biological daughter. No, I did not *steal* my husband from Mystacor despite what my sister-in-law might think, and no I cannot transform into a falcon and no, my powers do not consist of laser acid beams, goodness! Who came up with this stuff? A child?" She snapped her wings slightly raised in annoyance.

She didn't mean to snap at Scorpia, but the fact that Horde propaganda made her out to be a deviant temptress with a cruel magic abusing side made her blood boil.

Scorpia just nodded and then leaned back in her seat "Wow, I can't believe they got so much wrong about you. Shadow Weaver was terrible at her job if she didn't know anything about you."

Angella felt a smile tug at her face. Scorpia was far too good for the Horde. Her sweet demeanor was something that could be treasured in the Rebellion. You know, instead of her being surrounded by cruel people.

Scorpia looked down and noticed the communicator blinking red.

"Oh, Catra is finally calling back," Scorpia said fiddling with the communicator "Dang it, I muted myself!" she fumbled more with comminutor and raised the volume to hear what was going on. Angella raised a bow slightly. Scorpia apologized.

"Sorry, I hope this isn't rude."

"Not at all, please go ahead, talk to her."

Scorpia nodded "Catra? Can you hear me?" she into the communion, unsure if she was still muted. She pulled another

communicator from her pocket to adjust it. "I always bring two of these just in case. Sometimes I can't get the buttons to work all that great." she placed the first communicator on the table and played with the second one. She cursed under her breathe "I – I jammed both mute buttons…"

She then hears Catra's voice along with Adora's as she seemed to be having a conversation with her. It didn't sound like Catra was trying to talk to Scorpia. Instead it was more of Catra telling Adora her dress was stupid and how great it was being able to drink wine out the bottle. *The best thing ever*, as Catra said.

Scorpia then blinked and looked up at Angella "I think she pocket dialed me."

Angella smiled and leaned back in her seat "I suppose it would be rude to eavesdrop," Scorpia then looked down at the communicator and back up and Angella

"But she technically did call me." Scorpia added.

Angella gave her a coy smile "So, eavesdrop until you're satisfied?"

Scorpia gave a sheepish smile. The Scorpion woman stood up "It would be rude to have all this noise in your room, heh, I'll just, uh, head back to my room then" she said trying to come off as polite and not wanting to discomfort the Queen.

Angella gave her a nod and stood up to walk her to the door. Angella heard the muffled chatter of Catra and Adora go on.

Once Scorpia was in the hallway she began to listen what the two were saying.

She heard Catra talking, of course.

Scorpia had left the other communicator on the table, which meant Angella was able to listen even with the princess leaving her bedroom.

She peeked outside the hallway to see Scorpia was already gone, and she smiled to herself as she raised the volume to see what was being said by Adora out of her presence.

This reminded her of the time she read parts of Glimmer's diary. To her dismay she found out Glimmer thinks her mom is too uptight and unfun. She also found out Glimmer teleports over to the male Guard training ground for shirts vs. skins day.

The volume was raises and she was still muted. She heard the voice of Catra first and as mean as it sounded, she felt Catra sounded annoying. Like a whiny child.

"I'm just going to come to her room later. Maybe I'll bring he something…I dunno, she likes all that Princess stuff I don't understand. I'll bring her snacks and wine and maybe she'll be cool after that. What do you think?" Catra said

She heard Adora snort *"So that's how you'll say sorry?"*

Catra huffed *"I'm not saying sorry! I just don't want her to feel bad about me being right. I'm saving her the embarrassment of having to apologize to me. It's the mark of a great leader to do stuff like that."*

Adora chuckled *"Right, this has nothing to do with you liking her?"* she teased.

Catra growled *"What does it matter to you? Scorpia is likable, she knows a thing or two about loyalty. Something that not a lot of people seem to have nowadays, y'know like, integrity, self-respect, selflessness… but those are things you wouldn't get."*

Scorpia covered her mouth with her claw. She knew Catra's rage over Adora was always a storm ready to unleash and she would unleash it at any chance she had.

Adora then defended *"The Horde is bad Catra! I know you can see it! Scorpia and her Kingdom are no longer with the Horde. They get it! Why would you want to stay with people who have been nothing but cruel to you, me, Lonnie, Kyle, Rogelio and Scorpia? Why do you still choose the Horde over us?"*

Catra paused before answering. An exhaled from her could be heard by Scorpia as Catra coldly replied *"Just drop it!"*

Adora didn't reply quickly enough to that, as Catra let out a groan and restarted the conversation *"I got more important stuff to work on. Scorpia is kind of my new priority at the moment. She can't run this kingdom without me. She needs me and besides… being married can't be all bad. I mean, Force Captains get so many perks for being married so it makes sense that outside Horde territory it would also be good."*

Adora asked *"So you **do** care about her?"* her tone borderline not believing Catra. That tone made Scorpia mad. It was as if Adora was implying it was impossible for Catra to like her.

"Duh, why else do you think I'm still here?" Catra replied with no discernable emotion in her voice.

Adora asked *"You're happy about being married?"*

Scorpia felt her heart skip a beat. Was Catra not responding fast enough for Scorpia and she started to shake the communicator in anticipation for a response.

Catra finally spoke *"Well, I mean, yeah… it's Scorpia and she isn't half bad to hang out with..."* She trailed off. Her voice showing somewhat embarrassment.

Adora then teased *"Sooo… you like her."*

Catra didn't reply so quickly to that either. She must have been thinking. Adora then started to speak again. This came as an annoyance to Scorpia, because in her mind *Adora f-word sucks.*

Catra then replied with annoyance *"Shut up! She's pretty. None of your business if I like her!"*

Adora then teased *"Oh! Catra likes Scorpia! Our lone-cat has the hots for our local Scorpion!"*

"Shut up Adora!"

"Can I be invited to the reception?"

"No!"

"C'mon, please!"

"No! Go to your own wedding"

Adora grumbled *"I don't even know if She-ras can get married"*

Catra then let out an annoyed groan and replied *with "I'm sure **Adoras** can get married, just because you put on that stupid persona doesn't mean you're only bonded to your She-ra life. You're still your own person, the overachieving spazzy-self you were before She-Ra."*

"Aw, Catra! That's the nicest thing you've said to me since I left the Fright Zone!"

"Yeah, I know… I must be drunk or somehow damaged my brain after the fight. Maybe both."

The two girls laughed at that.

'' Scorpia finally fried your brain?"

Scorpia was in her room sitting on her bed listening to this whole conversation. She fell on her back the second Catra said *"Shut up! She's pretty!"*

That was the nicest thing Catra had ever said to her besides the time she said she needed to have Scorpia on her missions because she was so tall.

The only part that mattered to her was the part when Catra said she *needed her.* It made her heart jump inside her chest. Catra found her attractive and that was something her feline superior never implied before.

In Scorpia's insecurities, she knew she stuck out and was different from everyone. With being away from her Kingdom she never felt connected or desired. She did sort of like being flirted with by men in her homeland, but it was nice to finally get some adoration from someone other than a fellow Scorpion person.

She was starting to lose interest in the conversation after it turned into being more about Adora. She was still not her biggest fan after all.

She covered her face with a pillow the second Catra bet Adora she couldn't drink as much wine as she herself could.

Angella on the other side of the castle facepalmed at this. She really didn't want to have a hungover bodyguard in the morning.

The sound of Adora's coughing could be heard from the communicators.

"Oh, jeez! Ugh! It's like drinking fire! It hurts like – Bleh!" Adora coughed.

Catra then commented, "But the after taste is good though."

Adora regained composure and agreed with her. Catra then threw out the big question, although it was meant to be more of a jab *"So… If you were going to marry one of the Princesses, which one would it be?"*

Adora let out a shy giggled *"All the princesses are pretty and all but – No! They all have someone special in their lives, well, most of them. They're my friends and nothing else."*

Angella and Scorpia were pleased with this answer. Angella was happy Adora was giving a polite deflection on her type and not

resolving to locker-room talk about the Princess Alliance.

A majority of them Angella was in attendance for their christenings while Scorpia was just happy Adora didn't ruin this moment to confess some secret deep-down love to Catra.

Her fear of Catra and Adora being a thing was still not entirely out the window though, rumor has it they showered together in the Fright Zone before.

Catra seemingly surprised asked "Wait? So, you and sparkles aren't a thing?"

Adora then hiccupped but then cleared her throat and sternly said: "Her name is Glimmer and you know that!"

Angella felt pride in Adora's protectiveness over Glimmer. Indeed, her name is Glimmer. Micah and her came up with that name after sorting out through some other less favored names.

Since she was going to be their glimmering little princess, they needed something to reflect that. Her in-laws suggested a Mystacor origin name like *Spellora* while Angella suggested a more regal name like *Amelie*. After several times going back and forth, Glimmer ended up being their favorite option.

Adora then added in *"She's the Princess of the biggest Kingdom in Etheria! She deserves respect"*

Catra then *huffed "Okay Adora, I get it, Brightmoon is nice, I figured, but you know what gets me mad? Your Queen"*

Angella tense a bit. She knew she wasn't going to like what Catra was going to say next.

"My Queen?" Adora asked.

"Yeah, your Queen. How is she so nice? The Horde told us she was a bitch and it turns out she's the opposite of that. She's so freakin nice to everyone! Heck! Even Kyle is all goo-goo eyes for her!"

"Ew, Kyle better not be!"

"Oh, he is. And Lonnie, even Rogelio, maybe? Everyone is all awestruck by her like she's so freakin special!"

"She is special! Everyone loves her, she has that natural talent, y'know… like, she can be pretty and nice and that makes everyone want to be around her."

"Adora! You are so freakin' bad at this." She started laughing.

"I'm making a point why Brightmoon is a great place to live" She huffed

"No, you're making every point possible to say how much you love Queen Glitter bomb"

"Hey! She has a name! Respect your fellow royalty!"

"You do you, you respect her!"

"I do!"

"No, you like her."

"She's my boss!"

"No, you like her, like-like her, just like when we were kids and you had a crush on that Force Captain with the black hair and blue eyes, remember?"

Adora signed lovingly *"Force Captain Monica. She was so pretty…"*

"You wanted to be assigned under an apprenticeship with her after you turned fifteen and Shadow Weaver said no because she didn't think Monica was a competent enough trainer and you got

*so mad that you **actually** talked back to her an refused your latrine duty!"*

"Catra-" Adora's tone turned into warning.

"Then Shadow Weave gave in and let you and your first day in training you almost got electrocuted, almost burnt your hand off, and got hit with a stun baton and after all that she had to bring you to see—"

"Catra!"

"-her girlfriend in the medical unit! Once you got all healed up you got Shadow Weaver to terminate your apprenticeship because you got all salty about her having a girlfriend" Catra said before she busted out into a fit of wine-induced laughter.

Adora let out an embarrassed whine "It wasn't funny! I still had to finish out my apprenticeship for two whole weeks as punishment from Shadow Weaver!"

"All because you didn't get the girl in the end. She was twenty-six by the way,"

"She could have waited three years for me"

"Ew, Adora!"

A slight shuttle was heard as if the two seemed to be play fighting.

"Hey, it's not my fault older women are pretty!"

"Leave it you to be one of those girls who likes older women!"

"Scorpia's older than you and you like her!"

"Scorpia is three years older than me and that is not weird!"

"Crushes on older people aren't weird, Catra!"

"You make It weird!"

"I do not! I—admire from a distance and no one will know"

"She totally has to know!"

"No, she doesn't!"

"So, you admit you have a crush on Queen Angella?"

"Only if you admit you have crush on Scorpia"

"Fine! As of an hour ago I thought long and hard and, yes, I like Scorpia. What about you?"

"After the battle of Brightmoon…"

Angella then turned off the communicator. Her stomach fluttered at this notion. Adora admitted openly to having feelings for Angella. The Queen then pinched the bridge of her nose when she realized that Adora let her trouble-making friend know her feelings.

She knew that will come back to bite her in the future.

The Queen pondered for a brief moment. Adora's attraction seemed a little more charming when it was only speculation.

The verbal confirmation put her on an uncomfortable position. This young lady has seen her naked and might have pleasured herself to the thought of her.

An unsettled shiver ran through Angella's wings.

Being admired or having someone sexually attracted to her was one thing, but those actions crossed the line - Angella was never one handle those cases too well.

She had her own run in with male soldiers becoming too causal with her. Thankfully her female General never let them slip through the cracks and let them affect the grieving Queen - but in

some cases Angella's own weakness would allow some men to become close to her, only for her to push them aside for the crime of literally falling for signs of mutual flirtation.

She really didn't want things to be awkward with Adora now. Adora was a double-edged sword. She wasn't just a soldier or guard who lived on the other side of the castle or in the village surrounding Brightmoon, she lived in the royal quarters of the castle and had dinner with her every night along with Glimmer.

Also, she was a close friend to Glimmer, so being cold to Glimmer's friend would garner uncomfortable questions.

Angella regretted her thoughts. Her mind discovering Adora liked her made her feel like she needed to be more distant to her.

Scorpia, on the other hand, was more delighted to know about Catra openly saying she had a crush on her.

Even though that it wasn't exactly said, and she didn't dwell on the idea that Catra's epiphany of emotional revelation was only several hours fresh.

Scorpia still listened through the communicator to hear that Adora and Catra were talking about crushes and how Adora kept teasing Catra about her – *their* – engagement. Scorpia was slightly happy hearing the obvious embarrassment in her voice, even if it was just her groaning and telling Adora to shut up, there was still the implication that Catra was thinking of Scorpia and enjoying it.

When Catra declared she was going to check on her, Scorpia turned off the communicator.

She wanted to act surprised when Catra came.

She missed the part where Catra dared Adora to drink the rest of the wine with her.

Two foolish girls drank half-bottles of wine too fast and ended up dizzy, drunk, and barely able to walk.

Catra made her way to Scorpia's door. Too drunk to knock properly she lazily kicked the door and Scorpia heard an *Ow* coming from the other side.

When she opened the door to greet Catra she hoped to see her famous smirk and hear Catra say something witty and charming. Or be assertive. *Or be hers*. Scorpia smiled and blushed at Catra once she had her face to face, wishing that Catra would bounce on her and forcefully kiss her.

That would be nice, a little kinky, but nice.

Instead of that she saw Catra look up at her. Ears dropping down and her eyes watering.

Scorpia tried to speak first but was cut off with Catra cry of "Don't leave me like she did, *please*" Before falling into her claws an passing out.

Scorpia blinked a few times in pure confusion.

What did I miss in ten minutes? Why did she pass out? I thought she was going to kiss me, not take a nap! I'm not one to curse but... What. The. Fuck.

In truth, she missed nothing, but her thoughts made her reflect in a short amount of time how cruel it was for Adora and her to get along so well after being apart due to a War.

All she wanted was her friend back, not as her lover, but as her friend.

She missed her.

Was she expected to be cool with the idea that her and Angella were here just to sway the Scorpion Kingdom and make the Rebellion stronger?

Was she supposed to just be okay with that?

No, it wasn't fair.

What if Scorpia left her after all this was said and done?

What if she did make a mistake by jumping into all this blindly?

What if she should have stayed in the Fright Zone? What if Shadow Weaver was right?

It all came crushing into Catra as she fell into the arms of the one person she desperately wished to trust more then anyone else in the world.

Scorpia placed her on the bed and sat next to her.

Watching Catra sleep she questioned to herself several things, but one floated above anything else.

What am I going to do with you, Wildcat?

Adora took the whole evening as positive.

She would be skipping to her room if she wasn't so drunk.

She was happy to think that despite the time apart Catra was still fun and they could have a good time together.

It was like before when they were kids. She was happy. She was happy to see Catra was growing into a better person, one who can accept love and be kind.

Adora felt proud in herself that she was able to be apart of this.

The Scorpion Kingdom leaving the Horde, possibly joining the Rebellion, and having Queen Angella here to see it all happen.

It was amazing! It made her feel valued, treasured, important, and… *horny?*

Her whole body felt warm from the thought of being important and the thoughts of how Angella could possibly award her.

When she got to the shared room, she stumbled in. Angella was just sitting at the table reading. She looked up and smiled

"Adora, how was Catra?" Asking as if she had no clue what was going on.

Adora purred "She's great, I'm great, we should celebrate!" she lifts up her bottle of wine with little to nothing in it "Guess who won at drinking her wine the fastest" she slurred in a sing-song voice.

Angella smiled and placed down her book "I assume you did?"

Adora giggled and hiccupped "That's right. Me! And I even got to spend time with all my other friends, and I had a good time with Catra, no fighting, no arguing, just talking, and we had fun! It was - nice"

Angella smiled and patted Adora's shoulder

"That's great, darling" maybe that was a bit too much of an invitation. Adora placed her hand on Angella's and grinned.

Her eyelids dropping slight as if she was trying to be flirty "*Darling?"* Adora questioned "I like it, I wouldn't mind being called that by you all the time your *majesty.*"

Angella then moved her hand away. She mentally gulped at what Adora would do or say next. The blonde just giggled. Her cheeks growing pink, as was Angella's.

She playfully started to fidget in her seat. Her giggled ended with her asking "Can that be my new nickname from you?"

Angella sat up "In private I will refer to you as that, if you want me to. Now, get some rest… darling."

Adora then fumbled as she stood up, falling forward and into Angella's arms. Adora giggled.

Angella flapped her wings a bit in annoyance.

"Looks like I will need to get you settled for bed then, huh?"

Adora nodded into her chest. Her hands going to the queen's hips. Angella's eyes went wide as she realized Adora was being a little more handsy than she desired.

The blonde was never this bold. Once they reached for a pen at the same time and the girl retracted her hand instantly.

Now the same girl was making her hands at home on the Queen's waist.

She pulled the girl off and ushered her into the bathroom.

"Are we taking a bath together?" Adora asked, her voice overly excited.

"No, Adora, I am taking you to freshen-up."

"Aw!" Adora whined.

Angella couldn't stop herself from smiling.

Something about Adora's actions reminded her of someone very dear to her. *Micah*.

She helped Adora into the bathroom and kept her from falling to the floor multiple times.

Adora kicked off her sandals and hummed as Angella wiped her face with a washcloth.

She took out Adora's ponytail so Adora's hair was now loosely flowing to her shoulders. Angella then stood her up and made her face the sink to the vanity.

"Brush your teeth" She ordered.

Adora nodded and giggled as she firstly decided to tug at the collar of her dress to unsnap it so it would fall off her body.

Kicking it off she was now only in underwear and turned her back to the Queen. Angella didn't realize Adora was wearing a braless dress before – this.

Her breasts were now exposed as she bent leaned over the sink to brush her teeth.

Angella did her best to not look into the mirror to Adora's chest and started to comb her hair from behind.

She noted how toned the young lady was. Strong shoulders and biceps for a girl entering her twenties. She looked at her back-muscles to see scars. Claw marks from Catra, no less.

Her eyes traveled lower to Adora's admittedly cute butt.

Behave, Angella.

Desperately trying not to be caught checking her out the Queen moved away from Adora a bit to let her know her hair was brushed, and she was ready for bed.

Adora nodded, but not before spinning around to place her hands over the Queen shoulders. She smiled and pressed her chest against her slightly. Slowly, as if testing the Queen's sanity.

Angella placed her hands on Adora's waist. Not as an act of suggestion, more to have someway to push her away if things got inappropriate and it got inappropriate real fast.

Adora giggled and slurred out "You make me feel so happy to be around you — I'd do anything for you, my Queen. *Anything, just say the word.*"

Angella went into a slight internal panic.

Sober Adora was shy and sweet, far too bashful to let her libido take over her thoughts.

A drunken Adora on the other hand was shameless and had no filter.

A sober Adora would turn beat red and scramble away if she happened to be this close to Angella.

Drunken Adora is loving every second of closeness.

Adora nuzzled herself into Angella's neck and asked, "You know I like you, like-like you, right?"

Angella then looked up at the ceiling. She was uncomfortable beyond belief as she moved Adora away from her

"I'm aware of your admiration, yet - I would like to keep our professionalism still intact, Adora."

Adora whined and tried to wrap her arms around Angella again. "But I want to be a part of your harem!"

Angella would have screamed if Scorpia hadn't informed her of this earlier.

Internally Angella still wanted to scream. Adora lived in the castle for months and still assumed Angella had some bizarre sex team this whole time.

The thought of that made her face burn with embarrassment. She pulled Adora off again and exited the bathroom.

“The Horde lies Adora, and you need to go to bed.” She said before walking away to her bedroom.

Adora snorted “I knew the falcon thing was a lie and the acid sparkles, but it’s not so bad to think you’d have some loyal subjects wishing to please you.”

Angella turned to her with her wings flared slightly.

This conversation was crossing a line she never thought anyone would dare cross.

The sex life of The Queen of Brightmoon was not for anyone to fantasy about, not even a hormonal and confused drunken young adult.

“Adora,” her tone had a hint of a warning in it. “Get to bed now. We are not having a vulgar discussion such as this when you’re inebriated.”

Her tone made it through the drunken and still very naked young lady as Adora sniffled and whimpered out. “Did – Did I – Make you mad?”

Angella crossed her arms and replied, “You’re being inappropriate with your superior, this is not something I would expect from you.”

She uncrossed her arms when she realized Adora was covering herself and softly sobbing.

Angella was taken by surprise by this and walked towards her.

Adora swatted her hand away and turned around in shame.

She began to walk back to her room mumbling to herself something about being an idiot and a fool, and how anyone would like her, and that Shadow Weaver and any other Force Captain in the Horde would have jumped on the opportunity to have her.

An unsettling realization came to Angella as she realized Adora may have issues with consent and may possibly have had some type of sexual abuse at some point in her life.

Angella watched the girl close her bedroom door and sob rather loudly.

Angella rushed in. The mother in her could not pretend this was not happening.

Adora is a very emotional drunk.

She entered the room to see a sobbing Adora under the covers.

She sat next to her on the bed "Adora, darling, please don't be upset…"

Adora peaked out from the covers and asked "How can you not be disgusted with me? I was so desperate and pathetic, what kind of She-ra asks her boss to *do* her?"

Angella tried to deflect to give Adora an excuse to not feel so much shame.

"You're under the influence of alcohol, Adora. You're not yourself right now with all that wine you drank. You need to rest, and everything will be fine in the morning."

Adora cried a bit before nodding off to sleep with Angella caressing her back.

Maybe this will be harder than I thought. Keeping the Princess of Power in line may not be as easy as originally planned.

In truth Angella's motivation for having Adora come with her instead of Glimmer or her General was due to wanting to get to know Adora better.

In her worst thoughts she wanted to see how Adora would act around former Horde friends and test her allegiance.

Now she felt remorseful.

She knew she could trust Adora, but she may have accidently placed Adora in an emotionally charged situation she could not separate herself from.

Angella couldn’t help but look at the sleeping girl with worry.

This diplomatic mission may become intense soon and Adora didn’t seem to be in top shape for it.

Her paranoia made Angella feel that way, at least.

Postponing the meetings and partying seemed so unsettling in this dire time.

Now with a drunken She-ra what else could go wrong?

The meeting to cut ties with the Horde for the Scorpion Kingdom is tomorrow.

What will happen next is a mystery that terrified Angella.

She sighed heavily as she brushed a few strands of hair away from Adora’s face.

Only time will tell, Angella.

From barracks to hangovers

Chapter Summary

The previous night opens up old wounds for Catra and Adora.

Sex was not some unspoken topic for the former Horde Cadet and short-lived force Captain of 24-hours.

Adora knew it well.

Thought about it, dreamed about it, figured out by her late teens what she would like in a partner if she ever had one.

It started off when they turned thirteen.

Training bras were mandatory for girls now. She and Kyle needed special facial soap for acne. Catra had to shave her legs and underarms more then Lonnie and Adora did.

Lonnie got unlucky and needed extended shower times due to her constant sweating and the boys were a whole other gross topic altogether. Sharing a barrack meant seeing things poke up during night hours or accidentally seeing something peek out from shorts in the morning.

The boys were smellier, and the girls needed to get shots to halt their menstrual cycles.

Catra didn't get her period but she went through heat cycles and she needed two different shots for that. Rogelio got shots for it too.

It was endlessly awkward around the barracks for three years. It wasn't until the interest in sex crossed all the teenager's minds when all the awkward hiding was over, and the new awkward pining was in.

More Horde babies equaled more Horde soldiers and Force Captains had flings and some married for better living arrangements.

All senior cadets started to pine for someone. Adora received a lot of male attention, though she didn't care for it. She could tell Lonnie and Catra were jealous, nonetheless.

With being a teenager came the need to be *brave*.

Like one particular day after training and hiding out on the roofs with Catra accidentally had them come back to the locker rooms to see the first-year soldiers playing spin the bottle.

Adora and Catra happened to get called over. First, they declined until one guy called them princesses, immediately taking offense and joining them, making two sixteen-year-old girls who knew nothing about kissing join the eighteen and twenty-year-old soldiers for a hormonally charged game.

They watched as several pairs kissed. Some just puckered their lips while others kissed with tongue. This made Adora and Catra looked at each other with unease. Kissing looked harder than they originally thought. The two were both turning red and getting slightly aroused at the thought of kissing someone. Adora made the mental note that out of all the six people sitting around there were at least two girls she wouldn't mind kissing and maybe one boy.

Only because he has girlish hair, She thought.

The bottle landed on Catra and she flushed a red brighter than her Cadet shirt. A boy laughed at this. It ended up being the boy Adora wanted to kiss who was Catra's partner in this turn.

The two leaned in, Catra's eyes shut and puckered lips out, and the guy forcefully grabbed the back of her head and forced his tongue into her mouth.

Adora could tell Catra was startled and uneasy but was keeping up the tough-girl act and tried her best to follow his lead.

The group cheered for them, even after Catra pulled away and showed everyone her beet-red face.

‘’First kiss, huh?” The guy teased.

Catra instantly lied and told him no, looking away from him.

He turned to his other friends and replied smoothly:

“You're going to need some more practice before you join the first-year squad”

Catra started down at the floor. She wanted to leave and take Adora with her, but it was now her turn.

The tingles in between her legs were gone. She was now uncomfortable and scared.

The bottle spun and she felt like she wanted to puke.

To her luck, it landed next to her on Adora.

Adora looked wide-eyed and shocked.

Her first kiss was going to be Catra.

Catra felt a shiver run up her spine. This was something she felt before and refused to admit it. She had a slight crush on Adora. Adora was her big sister in Horde-related adventures and someone she idolized.

Adora was uncertain of all this but to have Catra be her first kiss wouldn’t be so bad. She was her best friend after all.

The two looked at each other and leaned in for a kiss. Both red-faced, puckered lips, and clueless.

Their lips touched and the group cheered and whistled. Adora couldn't bring herself to part lips with Catra. She wanted to know what tongue felt and tasted like, and who better to trust than her best friend?

She grabbed her shoulders and kissed her deeply. Catra in shock obliged and opened her mouth. She let the tickle of a purr vibrate through Catra's mouth and ran her tongue across her fangs.

Catra's tongue was not as serrated as she once thought. It must be something the feline could control. The smoothness and ecstasy of kissing stopped when the lights flickered off and the booming voice of the Horde Commander bellowed.

"Soldiers and Cadets are not to mingle in this fashion! Dismissed! All of you!"

Catra and Adora moved away and attempted to escape with the other soldiers, failing miserably as the dark red and painful aura of Shadow Weaver struck Catra down and made her cry in pain as she fell.

Adora turned to face her and cried out loud, "Shadow Weaver! Please Stop!"

Shadow Weaver growled "I will not tolerate degeneracy!" she pulled Catra closer with her powers "What have you done to my Adora? You, disgusting, filthy animal!"

Adora rushed in to defend Catra "Shadow Weaver! Please! She didn't do anything wrong! We were both here with the first-years and I—"

Shadow Weaver zapped her silent causing her to faint from the hit of red static.

Her vision went dark and all Adora could remember was waking up in the black Garnet sanctum. She sat up and rubbed her head and tried to make the buzzing inside her head stop. She closed

her eyes, groaning from the lightheadedness she was experiencing.

Once she opened her eyes again, she saw Catra was still laying facedown and rushed over to shake her.

"Catra?" Adora feared for what had happened to her while she was out. She rolled her on to her back and shook her. "Catra?" she felt like crying. She cupped her face. She saw her chest moved up and down lightly and she felt some type of relief to know she was breathing. A faint chuckle came from behind her, making the hairs on the back of her head stand up.

Her commanding officer appeared in front of them. "I see you're unable to control yourself, my Adora"

Adora looked down and realized she looked like she was straddling an unconscious Catra. Adora attempted to get up but Shadow Weaver pointed at her to stop.

"You will one day be her superior," She began. Adora shivered under her masked gaze. Catra slowly had her eyes flutter open as she looked up to see Adora on top of her while Shadow Weaver circled over them.

She didn't dare move.

"I am somewhat relieved in this new revelation, Adora. Such a beautiful girl like you will garner attention from all sexes," saying that made Adora blush and look down at Catra. The girl did the same but closed her eyes shut when she saw Shadow Weaver look at her.

Adora breathed in and didn't let go of the air inside her lungs until she heard Shadow Weaver speak.

"I was worried about your future as Force Captain. I dreaded the thought of you being on maternity absence from the battlefield. I knew that in time you would be capable of producing powerful offspring, but it seems I can rest easy knowing you won't dwell on

such foolish career setbacks as you clearly have…" she glanced down "…A distasteful choice on your mates" she said looking directly down to Catra.

Catra shivered.

"I will allow this distraction as it will help you in the long-term. You will get to be your dominating and powerful self as you see fit Adora, and Catra can remain your obedient and willfully-giving submissive mate."

The feline looked at her and Shadow Weaver narrowed her vision and leaned down to Catra and ordered "Don't dissatisfy her. That's an order." she said before the shadows engulfed them and they were back in the barracks. Right outside the locker rooms and on the cold metal floor.

No one was around to see this questionable position. Adora got up and reached down to help Catra up. The feline swatted it away and rushed into the locker room.

Adora frowned at this. She never meant to upset Catra. She should have said something during the interrogation. Instead, she was quiet and obedient to Shadow Weaver and now her commanding officer thinks she has the hots for Catra and just openly gave her *consent* to have her way with her.

The kiss left a bitter aftertaste on Adora's mouth.

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Catra was mortified, to say the least.

How could Adora just sit there and let Shadow Weaver assume all that? Why was Adora on top of her like that? Would Adora touch her –

No, Adora wouldn't just do a thing to her without her being awake, and Adora isn't going to do stuff to her. Because she doesn't want to.

Right?

The two didn't talk about it after that. Both knew it was on each other's minds but didn't know how to talk about it.

How would either start that conversation up?

Hey, remember when Shadow Weaver caught us kissing and assumed we were fucking and now wants us to fuck on the daily? Yeah? Cool, because quick question, do you want to f –

The two shook it off, avoided thinking about it and never spoke about it again.

Internally they had to think long and hard about what they wanted, not just as Horde soldiers but as young ladies.

Adora tossed and turned in bed thinking about it. Being on top of Catra and having her look up to her submissively was something she couldn't shake out of her mind.

She didn't like the idea of dominating someone in that way. She did like to be a little bossy, but not in *that* way.

She thought about what she would have done if it was Catra on top of her or one of the other soldiers.

Would she like it? Maybe.

Having someone pin her down and kiss her. Tell her what to do. She was raised to follow orders well and she liked praise because of it.

Would someone praise her for laying down and letting someone pleasure her and then let her pleasure them?

Would she like that? Submissiveness?

She knew she couldn't have that. She had to be a Force Captain candidate. She had to dominate.

But she didn't want to.

Catra wanted to dominate.

She didn't want to feel weak. She didn't want her guard to be let down – her barriers to be destroyed.

But she would be lying if she never thought about having a special someone. In her most foolish thoughts, she wanted it to be Adora but knew that wouldn't happen.

Be her sidekick forever? She guessed that was all she could aspire to be, but that wasn't what she wanted.

She wanted someone to like her in a way other people could notice she was loved. She wanted someone to think she was tough and respect her for that. She wanted someone to like her and make her happy.

She wanted something more than domination in her romantic fantasies.

She wanted consent and love.

Two things in the Horde she would never get, and two things shadow Weaver made clear she was not worthy of.

She looked down from her bunk and glared at Adora why she slept.

Why didn't you say a thing to Shadow Weaver? she thought to herself.

She still loved Adora after this incident, but not enough to erase the painful reality that Adora doesn't love her or respect her enough to protect her. She feared that one day Adora would hurt her again, and vowed to herself that, if she ever did that, she would not forgive her next time.

//

Adora woke up and placed her cactus robe on her naked body before peeking out of the room door to see her Queen.

She gestured for Adora to come to sit with her, and to Adora's surprise, she received no chastising from Angella.

''Good morning, Adora, are you feeling alright, dear?" The Queen greeted her.

Adora looked down at her breakfast and replied "Not all that well" she looked up at Angella and frowned. The Queen poured her some tea and offered it to her "Drink this. The butler said it was good for hangovers."

Adora questioned "Hangovers?"

"Typically, when someone drinks large amounts of alcohol, they become sickly the next morning after sleeping." Angella took a sip from her cup of tea ''That, my dear, is a hangover." She informed her.

A silence fell between the two of them.

Adora's eyes stared down at her plate.

She didn't understand why Angella wasn't yelling at her. Adora was beyond inappropriate last night.

For one, she was drunk. She's supposed to be Angella's guard and all she did last night was run off and drink her lights out with Catra. Anything could have happened to Angella while Adora was absent.

Second, she came back and stripped off her clothes and flirted with the Queen of Brightmoon.

Her. Majesty. Queen. Angella. Of. Brightmoon.

Then when she was told to knock it off, she cried and passed out on her bed.

Why was Angella not screaming right now?

Angella saw Adora's discomfort. She placed down her fork and cupped Adora's chin. "Adora?"

Adora looked at her fearfully. *Here it comes,* She thought

Angella softened her look brushed the loose hair from Adora's face before retracting her hand. "Adora, Alcohol will make a person do and say things they wouldn't normally do. Let this be a lesson to you that drinking a bottle of wine in one sitting is not the wisest move to make. Besides that, I don't want you remembering last night affect you today. I don't want you upset, distracted or feeling like an apology is needed. We have a busy schedule today and I need you at your best, okay?"

Adora looked down and nodded "Understood your majesty"

Angella closed her eyes and smiled "Good, now enjoy breakfast. The meeting is at high noon and I feel we must be attentive to what is going on. Something tells me to worry. All these delays have me concerned a strike is coming"

Adora questioned, "You think the Horde will play dirty even if Catra is here?"

Angella looked away as she answered "The Horde had Micah and killed him. You remember from when they captured Glimmer, they tortured her. In her place, I would have been killed for her," she looked back at Adora "I don't think Catra is safe with the Horde. None of us are"

Adora nodded in agreement. Today was going to be an eventful day.

//

Back in Scorpia's room, it turns out she didn't sleep in her bed.

She slept on the couch so Catra could sleep on her bed peacefully.

The feline tossed and turned all night, occasionally whining about Adora and *How could she.*

Scorpia was used to it. She didn't like it but was used to it. She sat up on her couch to see Catra was finally waking up.

Catra shot up from the bed. She looked around. "I'm in your room?" she asked, turning to Scorpia.

The tall princess nodded "Yeah, you were tired last night so you stopped by to rest"

"I'm still in my clothes from last night"

"You were tired, and I didn't want to be rude and take off your clothes without permission, so… I figured you could sleep in those" Scorpia replied.

Catra's looked relived in away. Scorpia could have easily peaked at her goods while she was out cold. Instead, she was a lady and allowed Catra to sleep. She even gave up her bed for the night for her.

Catra had a flood of memories come back to her. She was upset last night. She said something but couldn't fully remember.

"Hey, did I say anything weird last night?"

Scorpia took a second to respond. She knew Catra would get embarrassed and shut her out if she told her anything. She lied.

"No… No, don't worry, just that you were tired"

Catra narrowed her eyes and looked down.

She knew she said something. Why was Scorpia lying to her?

Scorpia then clicked her tongue and added "Oh, wait. You said something about Adora having a huge forehead and that wearing her Princess Prom dress to the festival last night was tacky"

Catra threw her head back and laughed.

She knew that wasn't what she said, but it was still funny. Scorpia didn't like Adora in the slightest and took the first opening she could to throw a jab at her.

That was too perfect. Scorpia was perfect. Catra looked at her and smiled. Scorpia was pretty for some reason.

They just woke up and neither of them should look good, but for some reason, her bedhead and that ugly cactus robe looked good on her.

"Hey, Scorpia?"

"Hm?" She replied getting up from the couch to fold her blanket.

"I-I… I like the idea of us. Y'know, the getting married thing"

Scorpia beamed at that. It took a lot for her to not run and hug her for that. She replied in her calmest voice possible.

"Yeah, me too" She sighed with a smile on her face. She realized how loving that sounded and rubbed the back of her head. Looking away she added "You know, I think today Is going to be an easy day. With you here, the Horde won't pull any funny stuff and it's been pushed back enough to iron out all the details, so I feel we're in for an easy day"

Catra hummed to herself before laying back down on the bed "Yeah, today won't be so bad"

Scorpia saw how Catra smiled before her face could leave Scorpia's sight.

She smiled too, deciding it was best to not inquire in the matter any longer.

‘’Yeah.”

Diplomats or Killers?

Chapter Summary

Catra's plans have backfired and the Horde has deemed her disposable.

Catra’s happy mood scared the crap out of Lonnie and Kyle. The last time they saw her this happy was when she became Force Captain and made all the Cadets that were ever mean to her do extra laps during obstacle course training and she made a girl with bangs be on latrine duty for a month after calling Catra *“Whiskers kitty poo”* as a nickname when they were seven. Catra had a talent for holding grudges and Kyle kept nervously darting his eyes around. He never crossed Catra in any bad way, right? The only thing he could think of was when he accidentally saw her naked, but that was technically her fault for taking too long in the shower and cutting it too close to boys’ shower time. So, she can’t hold that against him.

“Did she hook up another one of Entrapta’s robots to chase mode?” he spun around and whimpered “Did she put another kick me sign on my back?” he panicked. Fearing something bad was going to happen to him today.

Rogelio growled and shook his head.

Lonnie swiftly kicked him in the butt lightly to get him to stop “No, but cut it out or she might start though,” Lonnie knew she had crossed Catra a few times growing up. It was bad enough Catra was a rough boss to have sometimes but to think of Catra’s new status and power that came with it made her worried. Catra would be the type of person to use Scorpia and her Kingdom to

throw some major destruction towards the Horde for crossing her and mistreating her. She considered making good and offering up some last-minute apologies and compliments to see if that would soften the blow of what was to come for her.

They were back in the empty room where they did training the night Adora played with them. As Catra walked over to them they stood at attention as Catra kept her eyes on her communicator pad. Her tail swayed slightly in a somewhat relaxed way. She cleared her throat to speak.

"The meeting is coming up soon and we don't need everyone around for it. So, you three are relieved of duty today, just go off and do other stuff that you want today"

She said before turning away from them and walking off. Lonnie kept her eyes on Catra in disbelief that her feline former friend did not take this opportunity to terrorize them. What could have gotten into her? Lonnie focused her vision to watch how her tail moved.

Last time her tail swayed like that was when she figured it out the showerhead in the shower stall four detached…..Yeah! that's right Catra! I know you masturbated in the shower stalls! We all did it, you're no better!

She saw her walk over to Scorpia and saw her smile grow enough to make her canines more visible.

I feel like I've seen that stupid toothy grin somewhere….not on her but I feel like I've seen someone else make that face before for some reason…..

Whatever the former Force captains were talking made them happy. Scorpia got her to do that high pitch squeaky laugh. Lonnie's eyes went wide as she realized.

Oh Geez! Catra got laid!

She flushed and made her way out of the room.

No wonder she's in a better mood, Shit if that's all it takes, I should have offered up myself to Catra to keep her shitty attitude under control.

Scorpia seemed to notice the better mood Catra was in. She liked it, she couldn't figure out why though, all they did was shower; not together, got dressed, and they ate breakfast together and Catra stole her biscuit during breakfast. Other than that, nothing else happened. Catra was just happier and nicer for some reason. She glowed to her almost as she spoke to her. The light purr in her throat escaping as she greeted Scorpia. The cute flush of her cheeks when she realized she was purring while talking. Scorpia just played it off like she couldn't hear so she wouldn't embarrass her.

Catra started "So, we walk in. The Princesses of the Scorpion Kingdom, and we need to look intimidating and badass Then when we sit down; you sign the treaty first, but act like your super invested and not happy and at like you are reading it over suspiciously—"

"I need to read it anyways"

Catra facepalmed "Yeah, but, don't look all happy about it. Don't do that humming thing you do when you color or anything. You need to look fierce and intimidating! Like that time, you threw that guy off that skiff when we were in the whispering woods that time!"

Scorpia tapped her pinchers together "I think I gave him a concussion," she said sorrowfully.

Catra giggled "Yeah, I think he peed his pants too, but that what he gets for not getting off when you said please"

Scorpia let out a giggled and rubbed the back of her head "Yeah, I guess now…. We don't have to worry about that anymore"

Catra smiled "Yeah… I guess not"

While they went off to meet with Scorpia's dad; Angella and Adora got gotten ready in somewhat awkward silence. Adora was dressed in another one of her outfits that Angella had bought her. She wanted to feel slightly cuter today but also felt like it wasn't worth it to even try. Getting the light praise of how cute she was from Angella didn't feel right; also, why would Angella want to tell Adora how good she looked after she threw herself at Angella like a horny teenager. Granted, Adora is, but she doesn't need to be acting on it. She never acted on crushes or urges before so why on Etheria has, she started now and with a person double her age and also her commander. She let her hair stay down for today and morphed the sword of protection into a bracelet so it would go undetected. She had been doing this all without Angella's knowledge since they arrived. She thought Angella would be impressed with her stealth but what was she thinking? Her humiliation from last night wasn't over. She knew how she acted was painfully obvious and embarrassing. Angella must be either secretly laughing at her or low-key disturbed by Adora after her little display from last night. Angella came out of her room to be escorted down the corridor with her to the meeting room.

It was a massive-sized room. It had a long rectangle table and the wall pillars were taller than the War meeting room at Brightmoon. It wasn't near as pretty as Brightmoon. It was cold with its grey concrete and red tangling banners. The Horde had graffiti it's signature symbol over whatever the original portraits that were hanging up and the King brought banners and flags in to cover the past shame of the Horde affiliation.

Scorpia and Catra were present before anyone seemingly. Octavia and Grizzlor sat adjacent from. Catra gave a slightly annoyed look at Adora as she entered in. she was mildly relieved Adora wasn't wearing her signature red jacket or had her hair up in her regularly styled poof. She looked more like some cutesy resident of Brightmoon or Theymor; which ironically is where their

friendship died. Now that she was reminded of how much she needs to hate Adora, she decided to make it a mission to make as many jabs as possible at her during this meeting.

Octavia and Grizzlor's mouth dropped when they saw Queen Angella. They had never once seen a real photo of her and from all the artist's depictions of her made her look unattractive and terrifying. Seeing the tall, gorgeously framed body, and long flowy pink and purple pretty hair made them think differently about her. The kid standing next to her looked oddly familiar too.

Angella stood near them and politely extended her hand out towards Grizzlor.

"Hello, I am Queen Angella of Brightmoon, and you?"

He seemed oldy flustered to touch Angella's hand. He didn't have to as Octavia, and her sickeningly big gay energy shove him so she could shake her hand. Angella kept a calm and composed face during this and politely took her to shake it.

Octavia nervously let out a very fast introduction "I'm Octavia, one of the first Force Captains the Horde ever had!" also a little too loud for someone standing next to her.

Angella kept her polite smile as Octavia awkwardly commented "Wow, you are so much prettier than the posters made you out to look,"

Angella moved her hand away and nervously chuckled "Oh? Is that so?"

Octavia rested her head hand as her elbow was on the table "Yeah, what a shame you aren't on our side, right Grizzlor?" she said as she turned to her partner. He just replied with a nod and Angella backed away in complete discomfort. She was no stranger to be the alluring type of woman to some, but the slightly unabashed directness was much to be desired.

Octavia's flirting was cut short as she shot a look towards Adora.

Oh crap! No one knows who Adora really is here except Catra and Scorpia and maybe the king. If Octavia outs her in front of the diplomats, they might have an issue on their hands. The Queen of Brightmoon sneaking in extra muscle for a peaceful contract deal doesn't sound so good in the face of enemies.

Octavia snarled "Is that seriously you, Adora?"

Adora flinched before replying.

Angella's wings lifted in discomfort. She prepared for conflict to wage forward; Catra stepped in with a cackle as she stood up and sigh "Oh, Octavia, one eye does you no good," she smugly turned to Adora "You think every blonde girl in her late teens with a big a forehead is Adora?"

Angella shot Catra a warning look for her insulting Adora.

Catra walked over and placed her hands on Adora's shoulders and began to tease. Catra always spoke to Octavia condescendingly and smugly. Her pride for scratching her eye out at six was a slight trophy to Catra; the older cadets and Force Captains to taunt and torment the small cry-baby that Catra once was and Octavia took the most pleasure and picking on the child. When Catra got a little bigger she realized her claws were sharp and could detract and become longer and she used that to her full advantage as a little kid to get back at Octavia once.

Catra smugly proceeded "This is some pretty Birghtmoon resident that just happens to look like Adora, but trust me, Adele, over here is no She-Ra, isn't that right *Adele*?"

Adora shot a look at Catra. *Where the heck did that name of all names come from?* Adora just nodded and went on with the lie "Yep, that's me. Adele of Brightmoon I'm a castle guard and I, uh, like horses,"

Angella felt herself mentally cringe at how bad this was going. Luckily, the blissful ignorance of Scorpia had her interrupt with an "I like horses too" and that stalled for enough time for the diplomats to arrive.

The king walked in front of them and greeted "Hello, everyone" he then shot Angella a wink. As he attempted to pull out a chair for her. Adora made the rush to Angella's side to place her hands on the chair and shoot him a look. He took the hint and just

chuckled before taking his seat. The Queen felt herself flush. *The endless lack of subtlety of everyone having an interest in me has just finally become embarrassing.*

Sitting down and looking around Adora made a mental note that she had not met any of these Horde members before and that made her uneasy. Octavia seemed unsettled with their presence as she didn't dare make any more comments or give Catra any more dirty looks, but the feline gave the two diplomats a knowing nod. Adora notices this and clutched her bracelet fearing what was to come next. Angella knew something was off too, the three darted knowing looks at each other while the Scorpions just sat unknowingly to what was to occur.

Catra had this day planned for months. When the Diplomats reveal themselves as assassins; make sure the King and Scorpia are safe and use Octavia and some guards as a diversion while she pounces and offs each one until no one is left. She'll look like the champion of the Horde and win over the King, convince him to place her into a powerful role and fuck up the Horde and the Rebellion. All easy. And now with her title as Princess through marriage; she had more power then what she originally had expected.

Angella felt the tension come from Catra. she knew she couldn't trust her. She looked over to the Diplomats and saw how they looked very attentively at her and her wings. She was not one for backing down from a staring match; she lifted her wings slightly and gave them a look.

This was easily noticed by Adora. *Did Angella just flex in front of these guys? She just made the most unladylike thing sexy and*

elegant. Woah, she's a Queen on so many levels.

The King stood up with his chalice in hand. For whatever reason he thought it was a good idea to bring wine into a meeting was beyond Angella's understanding. He smiled again at her and began, "Let us begin our peaceful solution towards the future and —" his words were cut short as he looked over in horror as one of the Diplomats stood up with a stun gun and shot him in the chest; causing him to collapse to the ground. Scorpia shot up and cried.

"Dad?!"

Catra growled and jumped on to the table. The second assist stood up and took out a stun whip and cracked it on the table to garner some fear from Catra; the feline just growled and tried to grab it with her bare hands. Adora shot up in front of Angella to protect her. She whipped off her bracelet and shouted her phrase — "For the Honor of Grayskull!"

She-Ra was now beside Catra and she took her sword to cut the whip. She pulled Catra close to keep her safe as she turned her sword into a shield to block the stun gun blasts.

In that split second of blinded vision; one assassin rushed to Angella. His voice was gruff and menacing as he lifted his hands over his head to join them together and slam down on the chair blocking his path "The Queen of Brightmoon must die!"

In her panic, she placed both hands in front of her to send a powerful blast of magic his way and send him flying to the other side of the room. She rushed to Scorpia; now holding her father in her claws shaking him to awaken.

Octavia and Grizzlor join in on attacking Catra and She-Ra.

Catra jumped up in the air to land a kick to Grizzlor's stomach and shouted "What the hell is wrong with you two!? Can't you see they want us all dead!?"

Octavia rushed to attack and was stopped by a blast of magic from Angella across the room. Angella felt her arms ache in pain. She wasn't a fighter, why in Etheria did she persist on aiding the actual soldiers. She kept close to Scorpia and the King.

Octavia groaned in pain on the floor. Catra proceeded to get on top of Octavia and punch her in the face as she laid on the floor in pain. Grizzlor cowardly tried to rush out of the room for help. A big guy like him should be a capable fighter, but he was far from it.

She-Ra was able to lasso the assassins together.

Adora bravely stood in front of them and demanded "Who are you and why did you attack us?" she was followed by Catra standing next to her with her arms crossed. Octavia still on the floor in pain from the multiple hits to the face was groaning.

One assassin spat "We know of this cue, do have the Scorpion Kingdom join the Rebellion and take down the Horde," he turned to Catra and snarled "This one was going to betray Hordak, we needed her out of the picture too!"

She-Ra turned to Catra and her face softened. *Is Catra going to join the Rebellion?*

Octavia shouted; still on the floor "Catra was going to betray Hordak and—" she was cut off by Catra's hiss. Scorpia stood up as Angella had the King's head resting on her lap. She walked over to Octavia and helped her up "What else was going to go down?"

Catra felt herself go into a panic. How did Octavia know her plan? The feline shot a worried glance over to Scorpia. The one-eyed women coughed out a laugh "Ask Catra; she's the master of manipulation over there"

The room grew quiet. The assassins nor She-Ra said anything as everyone looked at Catra with betrayal and disgust.

Disarming the assassins might have felt like an hour-long affair, but in reality, it was a matter of minutes. For Angella, It was

stressful and terrifying. Imagine being in battle and seeing this constant action; fearing every living second? Angella couldn't fathom the thrill-seeking desire Glimmer had when it came to battle. The jaded actions of Adora when it came to be running headfirst into fear. All the Princesses were babies compared to her. She knew them from birth and yet, they were fearless. Angella was a magical Angelic being. Powers of light beams, shields, and painful zaps of power; but Angella hid in her castle and stayed safe and worked from the sidelines; taking pleas from villages for aid, having diplomats and other Kingdoms crawl to her and see her on the Brightmoon throne. To everyone, she was honored for being the respected Queen of the lushest and plentiful Kingdom of Etheria. Angella felt shame as she walked down the hall with King Sabara. He limped in pain and clutched his chest. His eyes winced, and he kept his face as stoic as possible as he walked past several concerned Castle goers.

"Pardon my words M'lady Angella but, this pain is pure fucking agony"

Angella placed her wing around him and help his left claw as they walked "Your injury requires an immediate trip to the infirmary"

He held his head high as he hissed "It hurts, Damn it hurts"

Angella frowned as she saw him do his best to walk strong. The second they reached the infirmary he collapsed to the ground. Lonnie saw this and rushed over. In a panic, she asked, "What happened?"

Angella tried to help him off the ground with Lonnie and answered "The Diplomats were assassins; they wanted to take out me and Sabara"

Lonnie blinked in shock as they helped the King to a bed "Wait? All this just happened. You guys were in that meeting for like ten minutes?!"

Angella looked down at Sabara as he groaned. The Queen looked at Lonnie and confirmed "yes, in a short time we ended up not discussing plans for peace and it went straight to an attack"

Lonnie noticed the slight tremble in Angella's hands. It dawned on the young soldier that the Queen was shaken to her core. An attack on their everyday lives was normal for Lonnie; living in the Fright Zone was scarier than any battle she has ever faced. But, the queen of Brightmoon was scared over a small ten-minute conflict?

A medic came to assist Sabara. Leaving him to some privacy as the medic started to undo his shirt; the ladies left the room and walked down the hall together. Angella kept somewhat closer to Lonnie and looked around nervously back and forth. Lonnie didn't mind this but found it odd, she had heard that Angella was a menacing magic user and fighter; according to Horde propaganda; but she seemed beyond disheveled by the recent event.

Lonnie offered to escort Angella back to her room safely while Adora and Scorpia had to handle interrogation.

Adora had mistakenly taken on Grizzlor and Octavia. They may have been the two oldest force captains, but they were beyond stupid. It was a good reason why Adora and Catra referred to her as a *dumb face* when they were kids.

"So what? Did you change your name in Brightmoon?" Octavia asked Adora.

The blonde facepalmed and growled in frustration "No! my name is still Adora! Catra was just messing with you!"

Grizzlor asked, "Where did that name come from anyway?"

"I don't know!" Adora cried in frustration. Where they seriously going to start the integration talking about names?

Octavia shrugged and mumbled over Grizzlor "I think she should have changed her name, I mean really? Adora? we get Shadow Weaver adored you, but c'mon it stops being cute after she was nine"

The two Force Captains chuckled as Adora's left eye twitched.

Grizzlor retorted "Can you imagine being told that someone named *General Adora* is here to execute you?"

The two laughed openly as Adora's patience ran thin and she smacked her hands down on the table and snapped. "Okay! No more laughing at my name! tell me why those guys wanted to kill Angella and Sabara!"

Octavia leaned back and looked up at the ceiling. "Easy, Sabara wanted to join the Rebellion; at least that's what Hordak assumed. When news got out that Angella would be attending in help to give Royal consoling; it was clear to Shadow Weaver at the time that the Horde might lose the Black Garnet if the Rebellion used a full-force attack on the Fright Zone. We needed to act and offing Sabara would be necessary"

"And Angella?"

Grizzlor replied "If we kill Queen Angella we win the war. Her only successor is her teenage daughter and for Sabara it is Scorpia; she can be swayed easily. Catra was meant to stick around and help Scorpia rise to power and seize the opportunity to take control, but her communication started to…" he trailed off and Octavia finished for him. "Catra, looked like she was leaning more to betraying the Horde. She made it clear to do some clever tactics of clearing out her former cadet friends from the Fright Zone. She had taken several tanks and skiffs with her without permission and cleared all her belonging. It was obvious she wasn't coming back and her keeping Shadow Weaver locked way until her exile to Beast Island was odd, seeing as how it would have been easier to just—you know…. Kill her, but it wasn't until Entrapta—"

Adora shook her head and interrupted “Wait, Entrapta!?”

Octavia narrowed her eyes and annoyedly replied “Yes, Entrapta. Princess of Dryle… She is Hordak’s prized lab partner and—”

“What!!!???” Adora shrieked.

This was news to Adora; who originally assumed Entrapta died in the first Fright Zone invasion after Princess Prom. This was not news to Scorpia; who had become friends with Entrapta during her time in the Horde. Her focus on Catra, who knowingly, saw what was to come and did nothing to stop it. Her dad getting shot was a shock to them. But, Catra knew the risks and didn’t have a precautionary plan in place for this. She insisted that Lonnie and the others take the day off and had the halls cleared of guards. Was this some cruel plan to kill her dad and her? Why would Catra want that? Did she ever care about Scorpia?

Her emotions were getting the best of her and Scorpia was sensitive enough under no stress. She had hit Catra with a stun gun out of blind rage when Octavia implied Catra knew about the attack. Now with Catra slowly waking up, she jumped up to realize she was in hand and feet cuffs. She laid on her side in the large empty room. The only one to watch over her was Scorpia; who was more menacing at this taller and somewhat unflattering angle.

Catra growled as she sat up. "Who the heck shot me in the back!?" she ordered. Looking up to Scorpia for an explanation.

Scorpia's heart was beating and she was nervous. Fearing she might not have the fear garnering skill to integrate on her own. She wasn't good with persuasion. Her lip trembled a bit and her voice showed the sign of fighting back tears as she replied: "Who shot my dad and why?!"

Catra looked at her dead in the eyes "The Diplomats went rouge,"

Scorpia circled her in an attempt to look intimidating. "You had no idea?" she asked.

Catra kept her eyes on Scorpia. She could tell what Scorpia was trying and it wasn't working. Catra glared at her "Why would I want the Diplomats to shoot your dad? It doesn't make sense in a peaceful negotiation, does it?"

Scorpia swayed her tail around and asked, "But you knew they weren't here for peace talk; so why to keep quiet?"

"Who says I knew any of that?"

Scorpia was at a loss. She couldn't get Catra to talk and she knew she couldn't defeat Catra in a battle of words. She needed someone who could break down Catra's walls. Just then, it came

to her that the only person that could get under Catra's skin wouldn't be here or Adora, but another person.

Scorpia left the room "Wait right here" she yelled as she left.

Catra shouted back "Is that a joke or something! You tied up my freakin legs!"

Scorpia was nervous. She felt uneasy to have to ask this question to this person. How odd would it be for Scorpia to ask this? They barely know each other, but she felt a genuine connection. She felt that her wisdom and grace were strong enough to cut through the wild and powerful presence that was Catra.

She was at the door of Queen Angella's suite. Scorpia was nervous to ask this. She softly knocked on the door; hoping no one would answer.

Lonnie opened the door "Scorpia? What happened in the interrogation?"

Scorpia tapped her claws together. "Um, they are still going on, I —I need Angella's help"

Lonnie glanced over to Angella on the couch. "You want Queen Angella's help?' she asked. Loud enough for Angella to sit up from the couch and walk over.

Angella gestured for Lonnie to invite Scorpia in. the Queen was as composed as ever as she brought Scorpia over to sit down. "You look troubled" Angella offered.

Scorpia nodded and Lonnie and next to her. "I am, its Catra; she knows more then she is leading on and I need to get her to tell me what is going on"

Angella frowned in worry. She knew Catra was not the type to talk out feelings. The girl was cunning, but not too bright, clearly not smart enough to join with Adora when she had the chance, but she knew how to silence a Rebellious teen.

Angella asked, "Do you need my help in getting information?"

Scorpia practically bowed "yes please, I feel so bad for asking, but I need help"

Angella placed her hands on Scorpia's shoulders and assured her "You have nothing to apologize for Scorpia, I can help you"

The two parted ways as Scorpia went to go see her father and Lonnie walked Angella to the room Catra was being held at. The

Queen assured Lonnie that she was okay to be alone with Catra; she didn't fear a tied-up kitten.

She was prepared to handle Catra by any means necessary.

She walked into the room on high alert as she didn't see Catra in plain sight. Her wings raised above her head. Worried she may need to dodge and attack. She heard a toilet flushing as Catra hobbled out on her tied up legs and jumped forward calling out to Scorpia "If you think bladder control is teaching me a lesson then you are sadly mistaken Scorpia!," she was looking down and hadn't realized it was Angella in the room with her "I should have just left you a puddle on the floor and made you clean it up for being such an ass—" she looked and saw Angella and her face dropped her annoyance "Oh great, its Queen Glitter Bomb. What do you want? And where is Scorpia?"

Catra asked as she made herself comfortable on the floor again. looking up the Queen with delight. She was going to give her a hard time.

The Queen answered in annoyance "I will be here for the remainder of the investigation; I will have words with you instead"

Catra snorted "You think you'll get me to talk to you? The Queen who wants to monopolize Etheria for magic?"

Angella snapped “Where did you get such a Ludacris idea? The propaganda that the Horde taught you is absurd!”

Catra smirked as she realized she had made Angella upset.

The feline was satisfied; if lies and mean words can get the Queen this wild up; imagine if she says a certain “M” name.

Angella's had enough of your shit

Chapter Summary

> The Queen of Brightmoon must handle the interrogation of Catra; while also coming to the realization that the Horde's finest are not that smart, to begin with.

Catra smugly laid her body back down on the cold floor "Well, this is fun"

Angella extender her wings and stood over the difficult girl. "I fail to see the pleasure in this" Angella informed. Her stern voice clearly showed her disapproval. Catra snorted. She felt a slight hint of pride in annoying Angella. She found it funny how much Glimmer and Angella looked alike when angry. She easily got under Glimmer's skin in combat before and felt it was super easy. The former best friend of Adora; the one who knew her every move and every action. Glimmer had nothing on Catra when it came to Adora. Did Angella seriously think she could bring down Catra in a battle of words? Catra used to drive all the Horde officers insane with her constant backtalk. Was the prim and proper Glitter Queen going to make her speak? Doubt it.

Angella's eyes narrowed as she pulled up a chair and sat next to the feline; who chose to remain on the floor after her bathroom break. "I see you prefer to be tied up. If you're willing to comply, I'll see to you it that you are released"

A simple enough request. Do as your told and you will be free. Simple. But for Catra, she needed to make things difficult.

The catgirl snorted "I don't make things easy on people who don't deserve it"

This could be the opening I need to make a breakthrough. Does she have some empathy towards Scorpia? Thought Angella.

"What a terrible thing to say; are you saying the Sabara and Scorpia deserve to suffer because of your failed take over?"

Catra sat up and glared at Angella "I didn't plan a takeover anything! What the fake Diplomats did was on them; They are the ones who need interrogation, not the person who helped take them out"

Angella's wings flared up higher to spark intimidation. Catra looked up at that. Seeing them shine through the light in the room. Those wings were meant to garner fear from her when she was a child. But now they just looked stupid. She found Angella less intimidating. She made the quick jab at the Queen again "The wings get stupider and stupider the more I look at them"

Angella smirked "Funny, the more I hear your voice I find it less and less tolerable"

Catra scoffed "Your daughter and you sound equally whiny and annoying"

Angella smirked, “Didn’t my daughter punch you in the face for insulting her before?”

The feline girl was far from quitting she didn’t fear Angella; Glimmer was the one with a temper, and she may have gotten it from Angella, if Catra can make Angella lose her composure, it will be a victory. She just rolled to her side to look away from Angella “Yeah, too bad it didn’t hurt” Catra then laughed.

Angella grew tired and lifted Catra from her tied up torso on to a chair. At that moment Catra feared she would be struck down to the floor. Instead, she was gently placed down to sit. This was uncommon for Catra; she was used to being handled with cruelty. After Angella made sure she was seated, The Queen got on one knee and placed her forearms on Catra’s thighs. The feline felt her face heat up by this tender contact and mentally remarked on if this is was what Angella did to Adora while they were alone, it made sense to why the blonde was so goo-goo eyed for her majesty.

“Catra,” the older women’s soft voice called “You know the difference between right and wrong, and you know this was not what you wanted. Explaining to me what is wrong will help everything out”

Catra just snarled and broke eye contact. Did Angella think sweet words of nothingness was going to work on someone who is a hardened child of war? Who does she think she’s talking to? Adora?

The queen slowly stood up. Letting her hands trace the natural arm marks on Catra's skin. The feline felt the gentle touch as something foreign and odd. The body felt a rush of unfamiliar heat and the sensitivity was enjoyable. The cold and callous hands of the Force Captains who would violently yank her out of cadet classes for misbehaving or the knife-like nails of Shadow Weaver piercing her skin was fearful. But these hands gave her comfort. Angella's wings retracted and her eyes were soft; she gave Catra an honest sincere look. Her hands moved to Catra's face; gently gesturing the girl to face her. "We just need to know what is to come next, we need to prepare for the Horde; you know you don't approve of their actions and your far too good of a leader to waste your skills on them; you know what is to come. We just need you to explain to us what it is, let us into your master plan"

Angella was now cupping Catra's cheeks. The feline's ears twitched. She was met by Angella's soft eyes again. Catra's face was visibly red. Hot and embarrassed from the purr that was building up in her throat. This was kindness, too much kindness, and it wasn't sitting well with Catra. the gentle touches and soft words sprinkled with compliments was not doing Catra any favors. She was tied up while an older woman softly spoke to her. This wasn't something Catra was used to, this was a dominating and powerful move, the moves that Shadow Weaver wanted to use on her while Adora and she were teenagers; Their fearsome mentor wanted Adora to use her charms to keep Catra in line, and without Adora knowing, it worked.

Now Angella was using her charms on Catra like she was some foolish hormonal teenager and Catra was not going to give the Queen that humiliating satisfaction. How could Catra look at herself in the mirror if she fell for such ridiculous gestures of tender touches?

I won't let myself fall for that again…..

Catra's eyes turned to a sadder expression. Angella's right thumb was closer to the exposed fang of Catra's mouth. Angella noted the saddened look. She felt she was making a breakthrough to her.

"You can tell me" Angella assured her.

Catra was stuck in her thoughts. The last time a person lovingly stroked her face and hair was Shadow Weaver, and that was only a cruel scheme. That was another secret Catra couldn't tell. She was tricked by Shadow Weaver. She feared Hordak and knew she couldn't go back to the Fright Zone if Shadow Weaver ever resurfaced. It was fear, she feared the Horde and she wanted to end the pain that fear brought along with it. She wanted to emancipate herself from all her past suffering and rule like she always wanted to. She to rule Scorpia's Kingdom and Army to victory over everyone, she wanted to stand superior over the Rebellion and the Horde. This desire she had could only be fulfilled on her own. Letting Angella know that she ran out on the Horde because she let Shadow Weaver escape and she made a weak plan to look like the good guy in front of the King, only to have it backfire, and to know that the Horde is still on its way to destroy the Scorpion Kingdom for leaving the alliance was all terrifying failures to own up to. She would lose the respect of everyone and look foolish. She would look pathetic as Angella would need to let everyone know and Adora would have to take control of the attack on the Scorpion Kingdom and be the hero; be the one that can lead, rule, and be adored. Catra would have

to sit on the sidelines while She-Ra saved Etheria and Catra would be deemed the screw-up.

I can't let that happen!

Catra couldn't let herself stay second best to Adora anymore.

She shut her eyes tightly at the horrible image of Adora being the winner in all of this. Angella questioned if she was okay and received a powerful bite on her thumb from Catra's exposed fang; piercing Angella's glove to injure the Queen.

Angella drew her hand back and hissed in pain. She shook her hand as she backed away from Catra; she took notice of her hand as she saw the blood starting to show through her white glove.

Angella snapped "Why did you do that?"

Catra then rocked violently in her seat to get down; falling to the ground she yelled to her "Because there is no way in Etheria that I'm going to be seduced into falling for whatever the Rebellion wants to do! You might have Adora fooled, but I won't be relegated to second-best anymore!" she was starting to breathe heavily and Angella attempted to lift her from the ground only to be bitten again on the same hand. This time it was another powerful chomp and it easily drew more blood. Angella stood up from her again. She realized something was off from her.

Catra was a child who grew up and suffered from the abuse of the Horde in a way much crueler and eviler than Adora did. She is emotionally attached to her abusive upbringing due to it being the only one she knew, and she needs to prove her worth. She is broken from her loss of Adora and her new position in the Horde ranks has only triggered more PTSD for her, but what was it that Angella did that caused Catra to snap at her?

"Catra? what did I do? What caused you to lash out like that?" her voice still showing concern.

Catra started to violently squirm in her bindings and growled.

What does she mean? What did she do?! She tried to get me to get all smitten over her like Adora so I can join the Rebellion.

The next thing to come out of Catra's mouth was; "Don't think feeling up on me and trying to be nice is going to fool me into telling you stuff you want to hear! I'm not here to help you!"

Catra growled in pain. Her thrashing around was causing her rope burns.

Angella then ordered her "Stop moving so I can help you out of those!"

Catra stopped resisting; only to lay on some insults.

"Your too tall for heels" Catra quipped as Angella sat her up to undo her bindings.

"uh-huh," Angella replied. Not paying her much mind.

"Your butt is big" Catra also quipped.

"Very mature" Angella noted as she was able to release Catra from her ropes and Catra was able to undo her leg bindings.

The feline then looked up to Angella; ungrateful as ever and flat out stated "I'm not saying thank you. If this was Adora being tied up and having her face felt up by you—there would be a wet spot on the chair right now"

Angella's wing twitched at that. Granted, Catra isn't wrong, but Adora was still her guard, a bit of a horny spaz, but still her guard and she didn't like the idea of Adora being insulted.

"Vulgar" was the only word Angella said as she gave Catra warning look. The Queen looked down at her hand. Sore from Catra's bites. She kept her eyes on Catra as the feline stood up. "I'll leave you alone. I figured you could use some peace before I speak more with you" Angella informed her as she turned to the door to leave.

Catra let out one more insult before Angella left.

"Your hair is stupid!"

With that Angella had slammed the door behind her. Annoyed.

What is wrong with that child?

She wasn't even five feet away from the door when she saw Octavia and Grizzlor coming towards her with a metal pole.

Octavia offered "We're here to help with Catra's interrogation"

Angella shook her head "Wait? What? Aren't you two—"

"Adora and Scorpia cleared us the interrogation. We had nothing to do with what happened" Octavia explained.

Angella's eye seemed focused on the mental pole "I see, and what is with this here?" gesturing to what they were both carryings.

Grizzlor then stated “This usually gets Catra to talk; a nice whack with this and she’ll give you what you need”

Angella shook her hands in front of her body “Wait? You’re not implying you are going to hurt her?”

Octavia waved her free hand at Angella “Relax we did this to the cadets all the time, especially Catra, she’s used to it”

Angella’s wings hitched up slightly “did you just confess to child abuse?”

Octavia looked back at Grizzlor “It’s not child abuse, right? We were discipline right?”

Grizzlor nodded.

Angella pinched the bridge of her nose and sighed in frustration “Regardless to what you call it, you’re not—”

She was cut off again by the intrusion of Lonnie, Rogelio, and Kyle.

"There they are!" Lonnie shouted, "Give back the support beam to Kyle's bunk bed right now!"

The Brightmoon Queen kept looking back and forth and the two arguing parties. The disgusting and dastardly Horde was more or less a cavalcade or children and adult-children with no sense of right and wrong, and it drove Angella insane. She flared her wings with her patience "Enough!" she shouted.

She turned to Octavia and Grizzlor "Give that back and return to your barracks!" she then turned to younger solider and informed them "Please set Kyle's bed back up" turning back to the Force Captains again and demanding "Stop torment, Kyle! All of you! the poor boy hasn't done anything!" with that the five unwelcome guests left Angella.

After regaining her composure for a brief moment, she peaked into the room; hoping Catra hadn't heard any of what transpired.

Looking in she saw Catra standing smugly with her hands on her hips. "Having fun your majesty?" she taunted.

Angella swiftly slammed the door and heard the laugh coming from the other side.

She had never been in such a bizarre situation before. In her time dealing with the Horde and other members of dangerous organizations; she never felt her patience be so heavily tested by

such people. The Horde felt slightly less threatening after sitting down with the alleged best the Horde had to offer. And, no offense, Adora was in that category of best and she ran out on the Horde the second she realized they were more than just stupid but just plain awful.

Finally, in her suite for some much-needed peace of mind. On her stomach, she laid on her bed and groaned. She was so uncomfortable; it wasn't like her bed at the castle and she has been trying her best to not look like a diva for wanting special treatment, but the Queen missed her spa routine and being pampered. She missed fluffy soft cushions, perfumed halls, and soft lighting. The stone-cold castle, the stench of dirt and lack of comfort for starting to take its toll on the Queen. That, and the fact that the Horde soldiers are an absolute pain to deal with.

She wished Adora was here with her. She had grown attached to Adora's company. minus the few hiccups along the way, she enjoyed Adora and wished she was around. She would do well in this situation with Catra. she forced herself to sit up; she needed to be focused on what was going on. Scorpia's father is recovering from his injuries, Octavia and that other guy, Grazzlor was it? Were too dumb for Catra's plan, but they know something about Catra's misdoings and might have shared it with Adora. And, Adora is Etheria knows where right now.

She forced herself to get up to go to the medical ward to see Sabara.

To her fortune, Scorpia and Adora were with him.

Adora shot up "Angella," she cried as she rushed over to her. Her expression showed she had much to tell Angella; the Queen gave Adora a lift embrace. She was so relieved to be in Adora's presence. The Blonde pulled away from the embrace to inform "Entrapta's alive! Working for Hordak, she doesn't feel like a prisoner and Scorpia says she's knowing and willingly making weapons for Hordak! S-she betrayed the Rebellion" Adora placed herself back in the Queen's embrace.

Seems she had a worse time than me in the interrogation…….

Scorpia nervously mentioned from behind Adora "Well, you see…. Entrapta thought you guys left her to die, so, umm, it was a misunderstanding"

The two looked at the Scorpion Princess in disbelief.

She nervously waved her claws "B-but now we can all clear the whole thing up" she assured them.

Sabara sat up and coughed "Scorpia, sweetie. I would like a private audience with the Queen of Brightmoon if that is alright"

Angella looked at Scorpia and nodded. She looked to Adora and gave the gesture to leave with Scorpia. Once the girls were gone

Angella sat beside and Sabara and greeted him “Your majesty, Sabara,”

He replied “Your majesty, Angella”

His shirt was opened and revealed his bandaged torso. Angella didn’t try to stare at his chest as it caught her off guard to see him slightly disrobed.

He spoke to her “I can’t lead in this condition; I need your help”

It took her a second to grasp the terms of what he could ask her*. Be his advisor? Help mentor his daughter or even work on an attack plan?*

“Take over as ruler until my recovery?” he asked, his voice was sincere and also pleading with her. A more qualified leader in Etheria, a great Kingdom. Angella could do so much more for this broken castle and village than he could right now.

What!?

Angella could not accept this offer! To even think of it was insane. The Horde media would have a field day and the propaganda would spread like wildfire through Etheria! *What would other Kingdoms say? Angella takes over? The first time in years, Angella leaves Brightmoon and comes back with a new*

territory? Oh, what madness! I can't lead another population of several hundred! I already lead to the Kingdom of several Thousand!

"Sabara…. I—"

"Scorpia can't lead! I love my daughter, but she isn't read. You understand. You wouldn't want Glamor leading at this age"

He doesn't even know my daughter's name.

"Well, Glimmer already leads the Princess alliance in many facets. But, Sabara having me lead your Kingdom would be controversial. It would not be in the best taste for me to take command. What about your advisors?"

He lifted his claws a little as he explained "All Horde officers. Double agents. I don't trust those guys. All my senses point to you, firstly I wanted Catra, but I'm afraid she's too distracted with her Ex-girlfriend being here"

Angella patted his shoulder "Adora isn't her ex in that sense"

He hung his head back "Oh thank goodness, I was worried I might have lost my touch. I sensed she wasn't malice from the

beginning, just—Y'know, a kid putting on a show, playing the tough girl"

Angella seemed a little confused "Your?"

Sabara's explained "When the Black Garnet was taken to the Fright Zone, my wife and I lost our ability to control the desert lightning as before, but the Black Garnet has so many more properties of power. Just like the Moonstone of Brightmoon, my abilities ranged from physical and mental powers of projection"

"Meaning"

Sabara gave a proud smile as he announced "I used to read minds, I can sense the feelings and emotions and what how some people feel or think. With the Black Garnet, it was better, now it's much weaker"

Angella raised a brow in disbelief "And this is possible how?"

"You don't believe me?" he questioned.

Angella moved her chair closer to him "I just find this ability to sense thoughts to be doubtful"

He chuckled “Want a demonstration?”

Angella just rolled her eyes and nodded.

“Very well your majesty, demonstrate” Angella felt a wave of smugness, her powers could be easily shown and displayed as she was one with mastery of magic and light projection and he claims he can read minds. This should be good.

Sabara sat himself up more “Place one hand on my chest”

“Over your wound?”

“A little lower”

Angella glared and placed her hand below his bandages.

“Lower” he instructed.

Angella slowly moved her hand lover to where his belly button was.

“Lower,” he said. Now with a smile.

She growled “If I go any lower, I’ll grace your—” her face burned as she quickly recoiled her hand away from him and shrilly cried “How was this a demonstration!?”

The king laughed “High emotions of distress, joy, embarrassment, and anger help me search the mind better” he smiled and stared at her.

“Now,” he began “Your emotions are a flare and I can see your deepest emotional baggage and turmoil is easy to sense”

Angella crossed her arms “Sabara, we were having a serious conversation a moment ago and you took it as a chance to make an inappropriate advance on me!”

She was furious. She turned her chair away from him in disgust.

He cleared his throat “You find me to be charismatic drunk, incompetent to lead and you think I’m out of shape and could lose a few pounds” he stated.

Angella’s wings raised. All those thoughts were true, but she didn’t say them out loud or thought them at that very moment. He was grasping at straws.

He went further "You think the castle is ugly, everyone here has been *pervy* with you,"

Angella turned a little to him. There isn't any real way for him to know that unless he could read minds, right?

"Your insecure about your relationship with your daughter, you think people look down on you for Micah's death, you're afraid your sister-in-law hates you; you have unresolved feelings about your mother"

She turned back to him fully "You really can read minds" she exclaimed. Astonished it was true.

He nodded "A talent in rare use for me. The Horde is too cunning for me to handle. They have never been kind to know of anyone in the Royal family maintaining their connection to our runestone"

Angella asked "You've had to keep it secret for your safety"

"Indeed. My wife didn't and, well, I'm sure your aware of Venomora's demise….." he looked away, saddened.

Angella placed her hand on his claw "I know the pain of losing a loved one due to the Horde"

He looked at her and smiled "So we can agree we just want to keep everyone safe. Playing the fool made my people suffer less and kept my daughter safe. It wasn't until I realized the Horde was going to test my Kingdom out for an annihilation weapon. I had to pull out and prepare for a fight that's when I contacted you. The kingdom of Brightmoon stood toe to toe with the Horde and won. I need your help Angella"

The Queen of Brightmoon nodded "I will do everything in my power to help, I will mentor Scorpia into becoming a leader. Adora will use her powers as She-Ra to aid in the attack and Catra will serve her role too, we will win this"

He smiled at her warmly "Thank you Angella," he said placing his claw on her hand and slowly moving her hand lower "If you wish to help me further, we can always have a bit of fun together as two royals without spouses we can—"

Angella took her hand back and swatted his shoulder "Sabara I'm not going to bed with you" she turned her chair to look away from him. Crossing her arms and staring at the door, she also commented "Shouldn't you focus on recovering instead of courting?" she couldn't help but smile to herself at his playfulness, despite not being attracted to him, she did find some of his antics humorous and it reminded her of Micah.

He chuckled "I figured it would help the recovery process to a have a beautiful lady's company,"

She stood up and walked to door “I shall take my leave Sabara, rest well”

He called to her “Now I have a cracked rib and a broken heart”

A short leash

Adora kept finding new reasons to stay in awestruck by Queen Angella. In her short time of needing to assist Scorpia to keep the Kingdom under control with the knowledge of an invasion. She had made remarkable adjustments to the security and welfare of the kingdom—all while remaining completely mentoring and assisting during the whole procedure. She took no credit and was able to coax the solutions and the answer out of Scorpia with patience and cunning. Improving was what she was doing. But she was far too clever and prideful to admit she was making this up as she went along. Either way, it was brilliant to see her in action! The Queen who works from behind the scenes is what Glimmer often called her mother; despite it wasn't an endearing statement coming from Glimmer; it was still a fact Adora couldn't deny. Angella was brilliant in her element of leading, managing, and mothering.

She had such a soft and regal demeanor about her that made all Horde members give in to her request. *As per the order of Princess Scorpia, it is declared to not wear any armor or carry any weapons around the castle or village.*

With that. All Horde officials were relegated to civilian attire. This kept them away from Horde technology and the ability to get in contact with Fright Zone. This hindered enemy communication and also their intimidating grip on the locals.

Adora was slightly embarrassed by her former Horde family. The way they took everything so literal was a continuous point of humor. Watching her former friends and force captains being given the easiest of commands *do as you please*. Left them

shaking their heads in confusion. They lived lives of only being told what to do. Another example needed to be given to let them understand their liberties better*. Act as Catra would* conclude as a better analogy. Grizzlor and Octavia decided to relax and go out into town; more as a tourist than anything ominous. The three others decided to pursue some recreational activities. Rogelio made his way over to the kitchen to help the chefs cook, Lonnie just went off to take a nap somewhere, and poor sweet Kyle just wanted to be around Angella now.

Adora found that to be another annoying part. All her one on one time with Angella had the unwanted attention of a third wheel, and Angella was just too nice to tell him to leave. The worst part of it all was, Angella seemed to enjoy his company. Or maybe she just enjoyed Adora's jealousy.

The Kingdom finally felt more like a Kingdom instead of an occupied colony in a matter of days. This didn't change the looming fact that the Horde was near, and three prisoners refused to cooperate. The assassins refused to give more information. Leaving them to their cells they stubbornly refused meals and showers. Just out of spite, the refused any sort of humility.

Worried by this Scorpia tried her best to convince them she can be trusted. Her methods were endearing to her, but the. Torture. She tried her best to warm them up with her sweet guitar music. Her large claws made that harder for them to enjoy. For them, this sound she was making was more torturous, to say the least. One giving up and pleading "Just execute us!"

This statement Caused her to jump a little as another guy threw his cup of cold soup at her. "We've already accepted defeat! Don't

mock us!”

Scorpia placed her guitar down and frowned “I don’t understand why you guys are being like this?”

She felt a soft brow tail brush against her red tail as a snark response from Catra declared “Because guitars suck, Scorpia” Her feline fiancé was considered the third prisoner. Her punishment was more of a house arrest, as she was tied to Scorpia at all times —*quite literally*.

The white-haired woman glanced over in annoyance to right to see Catra standing next to her. Fidgeting with the thin rope around her waist that trailed over to Scorpia. Angella suggested *Keep Catra on a short leash to avoid her mischief.*

Scorpia managed to take this literally. Now, using a rope to keep Catra eight feet near her at all times with no exception. Angella and Adora found this extremely humorous, but Catra was fuming every step of every day. Originally being cold to Scorpia to make her leave her alone—now he was tolerating her more and more, and dare she say *enjoy* Scorpia now more than ever.

Catra threw the cup back at one of the assassins and demanded “Tell us more, or I’ll make her sing!” pointing to Scorpia as she said it.

Scorpia grinned; not catching the insult and picked up her guitar again and looked over to Catra. "Should I sing the happy little lizard that could or 99 bottles of protein rations on the wall?"

Catra smirked and crossed her arms "99 bottles,"

After driving the prisoner insane for 45 bottles of rations made him crack and he gave in and told them what was to come to the Kingdom. A dangerous planned attack. Catra was unaware of a portal machine that can break the Space-time continuum to open up dimensions and a whole other Army of Horde soldiers to come in and take control of Etheria.

With this news, they had to take fast action. Scorpia asked for a private audience with Angella and Adora on the matter. Much to Catra's humiliation, she was tied by the waist to her soon to be spouse during this meeting. Trying to keep a stoic face of displeasure as Angella and Scorpia spoke to one another on the situation. Her eyes focused on Adora. the blonde was trying not to laugh at the sight. Catra; the feared and powerful Commander of the Horde Army—was now on a leash. It would be degrading and cruel if it wasn't pure Karma and delight to see Catra being put in her place. Her lack of honesty was her undoing and now she had to deal with it. *On a leash.*

Scorpia spoke up. "I guess we can focus now for an attack. We should do a meeting for the citizens and how to hide and protect themselves"

Angella nodded in agreement "An excellent idea, An evacuation plan is necessary and assembling the citizens will be a great strategy"

Catra's ears twitched in annoyance. She caught on to how Angella was agreeing with Scorpia but repeating back the plans differently. It was a manipulative tactic to make Scorpia feeling smarter and more confident than what she was capable of. Catra remembered these methods from Shadow Weaver and her dislike for Angella intensified.

Adora suggested, "Maybe a civilian self-defense class?"

Angella smiled at Adora "I think that is an excellent idea," she looked to Scorpia with a happy look and asked, "What is your opinion, your majesty?"

Your majesty? She said.

Scorpia's eyes went wide at the title. To be called Your Majesty by the most respected royal in Etheria lead her to be speechless for a moment. Catra caught on to this and her tail hitched in

frustration. Angella's words meant nothing to Catra, she knew Scorpia was being played and didn't like it one bit. Now with the influence of Angella at Scorpia's arsenal, she felt that the young princess might make more cowardly decisions. Catra shot a glare to Angella as she heard her speak on the matters of evacuation*. Leave it to a coward like her—someone who never is seen in the battle to offer such weakling advice to a Kingdom she cared nothing about until the tides of War made them need to! What a fake, manipulative, and vile leader!*

Catra's thoughts kept stirring as Adora explained her safety training to Scorpia. Which was such a waste of time? The three of them grew up in the Horde. They knew survival and combat training. Adora doesn't need to be the one to train people she doesn't care about to handle the front lines.

The meeting ended and Catra remained silent during the whole thing. Scorpia was surprised by this, she knew Catra was quick to have a temper. She remembers chasing Catra for a good thirty-minutes this morning to get the rope around her waist, so she knew Catra was willing to fight her on anything.

While they left the room Angella and Adora looked to each other and laughed. The sight of Catra tied to her fiancé was humorous. Neither of them picked up on her built-up rage. The two left the meeting room to go have lunch.

Left alone—finally! Adora cleared her throat and smoothly attempted to flirt with Angella. The Queen smirked as Adora; in a weak attempt to smolder her informed "Your majesty, I did some

more walking through the Kingdom and I found out they several places to get lunch in town. It looked nice and I think I should do take you there. It would look good for the Queen of Birghtmoon to seem to mingle with the people of other Kingdoms" Adora Was slightly smug at her attempt at flirtation. In this instance the Queen allowed her to attempt courtship, knowing that you'd only be a matter of seconds before she became two flustered too act in any other impulses. I came to Angela's realization that, despite her denying Adora the ability to speak on her attraction towards her, didn't drive her away from still pining for her.

I really should stop this Angela thought to herself. even with her better judgment and wisdom she couldn't help but enjoy this attention and for that, she felt bad. adore extended her forearm out to Angella to grasp on to as they walked down the Hall.

Just as the two turned left down a hall they saw Kyle. Before the young man could say a word; Adora snapped "You're not going!"

Making him flinch and whimper a bit.

Angella shot her a glare in disapproval. Not liking how quickly Adora was snap at someone for simply saying "Hello"

She unclasped her arm from Adora and asked informed Kyle "Sorry for her outburst, she certainly didn't learn that trait in Birghtmoon," shooting her a look as she continued "Adora wished to take me to the *lunch date* for the afternoon, so we will not be in the castle for the afternoon and so on,"

He tapped his fingers together before awkwardly backing away "_Oh—Oh well, uh, I see… H-have your majesty," he said taking an awkward bow before turning and rushing off down the hall away from them.

Angella's smile fell when she gave Adora a look of disapproval "IF you lead with that, you would have come off nicer,"

Adora looked down in shame.

Angella's wings arched forward to cover Adora as she commented: "Jealousy brings a bit of a mean side out of you, now doesn't it?"

Adora refused to look Angella in the eye as she answered "In some cases, I mean—Everyone had been hovering over you nonstop since we got here. Now that see how nice you are and that all the evil Queen stories are false, they all want to be around you," she shrugged looking up at her and asked, "Is it so wrong to want to just be your guard and have some piece without anyone being so—clingy to you?"

Angella laughed as she started to walk forward "I suppose I should be flattered by this inner battle for my attention, when we return to Brightmoon, inform Glimmer that her mother was so cool that all the Fright Zone teenagers wanted to be me,"

Adora chuckled and followed after. "I will,"

The two walked out into the small town of vendors and were stopped almost everyone. Children wanted to see Adora do her She-Ra transformation and give her snacks. Angella was not one to partake in street food and politely directed all snacks to Adora, who gluttonously accepted all of them. Brownies, fried fruits, spicy kabobs, and whatever else they could place on a stick for consumption. Adora ate them all and with the nod of approval from Angella transformed into She-Ra. She showed off her large Bracelet as it transformed into the Sword of Protection, raising it to the sky she cried out loudly and proud "FOR THE HONOR OF GREYSKULL!"

A golden shine of light engulfed her body as her hair flowed shinier and longer. Standing before the applauding crowd for seeing the sight of the beautiful and blonde worrier. Adora took the time to show off a bit. Flexing a little with her sword in hand as she did some backflips and jump kicks in the air. A few moves of spins and flips of her sword and the crowd was mesmerized. Angella filled a small sense of pride and how happy everyone was to see Adora in her most confident form. It was the same feeling when they were in the Brightmoon marketplace while shopping for clothes. To see everyone so accepting and appreciative of her presence made her happy. After all the young girl has gone through. She deserved this.

A vendor lifted a large melon over his head and asked, "Can you cut this melon with your sword?"

The now over-excited Adora winked and yelled back "You bet It can!" holding her sword up. The man threw it and she swiftly cut it in half. Melon juice sloshing around as the two slices made its way into the hands of the two young kids near Adora.

Angella felt a heightened sense of worry. She was swinging her sword around and children were coming too close. Adora seemed to be enjoying the positive attention so much that she was absent-minded to her swinging a sword around children could be dangerous. Another vendor had an even larger melon as they shouted, "Do this one next She-Ra!" and threw it without giving her a chance to react. Adora leaped forward and cut this one again. With the same result of splattering juice everywhere and crowd goers running over to take a piece of fruit for themselves. Angella's wings twitched in anxiety. Seeing everyone rush towards Adora with a sword as she flails it around like a showoff was losing its charm. She took note of how lost in the moment Adora was becoming; indicating to Angella that Adora was very easily distracted.

The two children who were still eating the fruit slices from before huddled near Angella; admiring her wings one child commented "Your pretty" and patted her velvety wing with their sticky little hands. Angella offered a warm smile to the child, despite being grossed out by their touches. This reminded her of chasing after Glimmer to get her little hands clean after a meal during her toddler stage.

A third vendor with a much larger and lumpier yellow fruit asked, "Try this on, She-Ra!"

Taking two people to throw it high in the air. The fruit was coming towards Angella and some children next to her. Before she could snap or scold Adora—she saw the yellow fruit erupt into a slash of darker yellow gunk and seeds flying all around the crowd. Angella's motherly instinct kicked in as she extended her wings out as wide as she could to avoid the children getting sticky. Not reacting or thinking to turn with them. She received a full-frontal attack of fruit.

Adora turned to realize she, the crowd, and the Queen were covered in fruit. She regressed into her normal form. Sheepishly looking around at the mess she had made. No one seemed to mind. They all laughed and found it fun. The only person who wasn't laughing was Angella. Covering in fruit she gave Adora the same look she gives Glimmer when she messes up. With her head lowered like a child awaiting punishment, she walked over to Angella.

The Queen asked in an annoyed tone. "Enjoyed showing off, did we?"

Adora opened her mouth to apologize and was only greeted with a stained white glove hand wave "No amount of limp handed apologies with fix this right now, Adora. As you can we see are both a mess in the town market and need to clean off"

Adora frowned at stuttered "I—I'm, really s-sorry"

Angella flapped her wings to get some mess off of her. Adora timidly grabbed a tiny piece of seed out of Angella's hair and

sheepishly offered "You—uh—had this in your hair," giving the Queen an embarrassed look. The older women couldn't help but smile at this moment. Adora's nervous fumbles were so much like Micah's once was. She took her gloved hand and booped her nose to leave a little fruit residue on it. Adora smiled at this and the two laughed at it. Everyone around them was just as unfazed as they were now and helped pick up the remaining fruit off the ground so it wouldn't attract bugs. Now sticky and in need of a shower. The lunch date in town would have to wait for another day.

Meanwhile back in the castle, Catra was still stuck by Scorpia's side. Both sitting in the castle archives to find some intel on safe evacuation routes. Scorpia was worried. Catra had barely spoken to her at all since the morning. The last thing she said was "pass the toast" and "Put that rope on me and I'll scratch you". looking at the cat-girl's sad expression made her think that she had taken the leash joke too far.

"Catra?" she asked.

The feline slammed a book shut and spat "What is it?!"

Scorpia flinched at her anger. She had this coming for at least two days now. Catra had been oldy too quiet during the morning meeting and wasn't too keen yesterday when they went to talk to her father. When he saw the rope, he commented to Scorpia that she should leave that in the bedroom. But Scorpia assured him it wasn't like that. Catra has been humiliated and her plans of a cunning takeover have been ruined by Angella and Adora's

presence. Scorpia sighed, knowing she had probably taken the leash thing too far.

"I know you're mad—"

Catra snapped "Oh! I'm fucking furious!" as she grabbed the rope and shook it "You took this short leash comment too fucking far! I can get insults or attacks, but you seriously decided to pull a Shadow Weaver and humiliate me! Fuck you!" she yelled as she pulled Scorpia closer with the rope and grabbed Scorpia's claws with her hands. The taller woman looked down to see Catra had tears welling up in her eyes "You of all people should trust me! I wouldn't let anything bad happen to you! Fuck! I even made sure Lonnie and the guys came with us! And you seriously took a defector and a coward's advice over my own!"

Scorpia looked at her with concern. She didn't want to upset Catra like this, she didn't want to embarrass her. She bit her lip and looked away as Catra shoved her aside while undoing her leash around her waist. "You wanna treat me like a criminal after I saved your dad from getting killed—Fine! Have fun with retreating and never getting your homeland back!"

"Catra!" Scorpia called as the fuming feline walked off and gave her the middle finger.

"Asshole!" Catra called back before leaving the library.

Just as she walked out of the library and turned down the wrong hall she yelled "Whoever designed this castle needs to get punched! The Fright zone didn't have this many useless halls!"

Waking forward she heard the laughter of her two least liked people. A smirk tugged at her lips as she saw that Adora and Angella were covered in – *something*. If she had to see them today, she deserved to see them like this. She scoffed and made a crude remark "Well, you two look *terrible*"

Angella commented glare "We had a bit of a mishap in town today"

Catra's ears perked up as she inquired "Did someone throw food at you!?"

Angella crossed her arms "I know you would delight in that, but no, sorry, Adora was doing a demonstration on her swordsmanship"

Adora smiled at Angella's elegant choice in wording. Catra just rolled her eyes.

Adora commented "We're just going to shower up and probably eat lunch in the dining hall soon"

Catra just crossed her arms and walked away "Great, have fun"

Angella then asked “Catra, if you would like, you and Scorpia can join us for lunch”

Catra just called back “Not happening”

The second Catra was in the solace of her room she broke down into tears. She didn’t want to be the bad guy. But if everyone found out she accidentally let Shadow Weaver escape and that was the main reason she came to Scorpia’s side then she will look ever worse then ever! All she wanted to do was make it right. She hated being an angry person. She just wanted the pain and hurt to end, and with being here in Scorpia’s Kingdom, being accepted by the King with open arms, being respected by the people of this Kingdom, and having herself relax and enjoy the company of her old friends again made her feel like everything was going to be okay, but now, thanks to Adora, she felt like she was worse than ever. She sobbed openly at the thought of Scorpia leaving her and doubting her skills as a leader in favor of Adora.

Catra's Wedding

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

So much for impressing the Queen with the fancy table manners she had learned from Glimmer. In the dining hall of the Scorpion Kingdom. Angella and Adora sat next to each other as a cook brought out some kabobs for them. Veggies and meats grilled on a stick were easy for Scorpion people to eat. For Angella, this would be deemed street food and not very elegant to consume. Looking over at Adora, she saw the girl was hungry. Double fisting with kabobs in both hands as she ate quickly. An afternoon showing off as She-Ra must have gained an appetite. As much as Adora was focused on food, her eyes couldn't help but wander up and down Angella's frame. Due to their carriage being attacked on their way to the Kingdom, a good amount of luggage was damaged. Leading to them having limited clothing options now. Aside from an assortment of dresses, they didn't have a lot of clothes, and Angella refused to have the staff do her laundry.
Because of wanting to do her laundry—she was relegated to wearing standard Horde-issued apparel—Grey trousers like Adora's and a white top. Just like Adora's, except it was only up to her elbows, and due to making incisions for her wings, it made her midriff showing. It also made her look a tad bustier than her normal attire. The mature side of Adora didn't want to stare at her like a horny admirer—but she still was one to Angella. Even after the drinking incident, Angella has shown no signs of displeasure with Adora's company.

The same goes for Angella. She looked over to see the blonde still stuffing her face. Adora was a beautiful young lady. Her She-Ra transformation does give her an elegant Amazonian grace to her that Adora—herself has not fully come into on her own yet, but, in her natural form, she was just as beautiful. Her sweet soft

blue-grey eyes made her look so pure and innocent. They reminded her of the chocolate brown eyes of her late beloved Micah.

Micah…..

She was starting to see more and more of his charming features in Adora. Her shyness, clumsiness, and skillfulness in stressful situations made her so much more transparent to the late King. She did things that would remind her of him. The memories came back to her so vividly.

Remembering the time, he tripped over his cape or when he sat in one of the Glimmer's uneaten plates of food. The first time he called her his girlfriend, then panicked and called her an assortment of other nicknames to reflect from what he originally meant.

They were happy memories, and seeing Adora inhale four kabobs in one sitting made her feel so simply domestic with her. She found herself stopping to smile at her. Her chin resting in the palm of her hand. Adora noticed this. Surprised Angella was looking at her in such away. She bashfully cleared her throat and asked, "Was I eating too fast again?"

Angella smiled and shook her head. "No. You're fine." She noticed how to tone Adora's arms were. She was fair-skinned for someone who has been running around in the sun all day. She smirked as she saw the flush make a home on the blonde's face. Adora turned to look down at her plate. A little embarrassed from

the gaze of the Queen looking at her—*lovingly*—in the same awestruck way she would look at her majesty herself.

Angella realized she had made Adora uncomfortable by her staring and swatted away all the admirable thoughts of the almost twenty-year-old girl. She cleared her throat and asked Adora, "When we finish lunch, did you have any plans on what to do for the rest of the day?" the question seemed like an awkward Segway into a question for a date. She had made this error before. Many times, with her and Micah dating as teenagers, she would often embarrass herself by trying every settle, yet unsettle way to ask him to go out for a walk in the gardens or an excuse to leave meetings together. She was so bad at just simple small talk with him that he ended up being the one to take more initiative. In time, she could finally feel less shy and as normal as she possibly could. In secret, she hoped Adora would see her inability to ask such a thing and take charge of the way Micah did. She hoped the way Adora felt for her was admirable, yet not too transparent enough just be her guard at this point. The two have bathed, fought, and took care of each other as more of – *friends*—than anything.

Adora looked at her with confusion before replying. "I might see what Catra is doing since she's been in a bad mood. After I see how she is doing, I might go back into town; do you think there is another party going on tonight?"

Now leaving Angella to answer and engage in a conversation. The Queen almost stuttered as she replied, "Perhaps, I know Scorpia had to do announcements for the military members in the village, but I am unsure of what will be the nights' activity."

Activity!? Angella. What are you? her age? You can court again. Wait? Why would I court her? Why would I even think that?

Adora suggested, "We should find something to do tonight. After you are done doing Queen stuff, we can do something fun,"

Such a simple response. Easy to answer. Whatever the reason was, Angella blushed as she replied. Almost bashfully. "Sounds lovely" she looked down at her plate, feeling Adora's gaze on her. Her peripheral vision caught the smile on the blonde's face. Angella hoped Adora couldn't tell she had blushed.

Adora was mentally beaming from ear to ear. She couldn't exactly tell if it was a blush, but it did seem the Queen liked the idea of spending time with her.

After lunch, they decided to return to see Scorpia—who was now not having a good afternoon. Catra had ignored her for the day after her outburst earlier but, she has made her anger very clear. She left Scorpia alone for the rest of the day. Unknown to her act of sulking, it was customed to be apart from your spouse before a marriage ceremony, and Scorpia took her lack of attendance as a sign of her preparation. The wedding plans needed to go just so, it was a quick put together the ceremony and the plans were as followed:

1. Meet with seamstress.
2. Meet with marriage counselor.
3. Work on writing vows.
4. Go over seating arrangements.
5. Talk with chefs about dinner.
6. Pick songs to dance to.

7. Fireworks display.

Scorpia was now gone for the day leaving Adora to continue her aimless walking around the castle after breakfast, Angella went to go do her own laundry and talk to someone about dresses for the two of them tonight. The thought of her failing at her duty as a guard was running through her mind. Angella doesn't need her to hover around her. All situations of chaos are under control and today should be a happy day. Walking past the corridor to Scopria's room she heard the shriek of her former feline friend.

"Wh-what!? N-no! Stop that!" she heard Catra cry.

In the moment Adora thought Catra was being attacked by intruders to the castle and entered the room without hesitation, only to find Catra being held down by Lonnie and Octavia in a vanity chair while a woman Adora has never seen before brushes Catra's hair down. A tiny lizard lady brushed the felines hair while she sat on the floor with her legs crossed and each Horde solider holding a forearm to halt Catra's ability to retreat.

Catra squirmed and yelped "This hurt!"

Lonnie quipped "It's only hurting because you keep moving!"

Catra yelled "It hurts! this is bullshit!"

Octavia sighed "Kid! Why the heck did you agree to having your hair up if you can't handle it being brushed?"

Catra growled "It shouldn't hurt this much! AGH!"

Adora chimed in "She's always been tender headed,"

The three all looked and at Adora and greeted her. Catra asked "Where's your boss at, I almost didn't recognize you without your head up Queen fancy pants butt," She chuckled to herself before feeling the painful tug of her hair being pulled into a bun.

The three girls Laughed at Catra's expense while she had her hair continuously tugged at. Octavia took this moment to ask Adora "Is Angella in her room?"

Adora shot her a look. Knowing Octavia was planning on hitting on her.

Lonnie and Catra laughed a little. Knowing from miles away that Adora's attentiveness to Angella has nothing to do with her obligation to be a bodyguard and everything to do with Adora being infatuated with the Queen. It didn't surprise them. Adora always had a thing for older women. Usually, non-Etherian women like an older magicat or this buff purple lady they never saw again after junior cadet training.

Octavia tried to excuse herself to roam the halls to find Angella, but Adora followed her.

Lonnie made the smart remark to Catra. "Are you gonna act like a baby some more while your hair gets brushed?"

The Feline snarled "Hey! I'm fine, you can go run around with your boyfriends to kiss *Queen Fancy wings* butt,"

Lonnie chuckled "As you command your majesty!" she got up to leave.

Catra was now alone with the hair stylist and she politely let Catra know "Your hair is all brushed, now I will but it up in a bun and curly the front loose hair for you,"

Catra shrugged "Cool. That can't be so bad."

With one powerful tug from the petite lizard woman Catra yelped and clawed her own knees as she pained through the vanity of her wedding day preparations.

While Angella finished her laundry and borderline sexual harassment from the chamber maids she went back to her room. Missing Adora completely as she chased Octavia down a corridor reminding her to stay away from Angella.

It was a matter of seconds before King Sabara knocked on her door and asked for Angella to assist her with wedding preparations. Not that Angella was too good to help in anyway. It struck her as odd how unorderly the castle was, and the staff seemed so—*unqualified*—to do much of anything useful. To have a King and a Queen from a foreign nation to set up for wedding was so…..*Plumerian*. The agricultural runestone kingdom was small and operated in this style of hands-on royal inclusion, but not Brightmoon. Angella's role was more performance in some regards, most of her subjects did everything for her. Many events went on without her involvement as they were overseen by advisors. Since the Horde was most of the advisors were Horde members and after the attack on the King; they are all in the prison of the Scorpion Kingdom. One thing she could say in their favor was that they had a prison. All Brightmoon had was a few guest rooms for detaining people—it was more like a luxury resort stay then a punishment in Brightmoon. With a non-existent crime rate and the intense security in Brightmoon; there was no need to ever build an actual prison. Queen Angelica; her mother before her once had a small brick house for a prison, but Angella found it crude and had it repurposed into a blacksmith workshop.

King Sabara walked with Angella as the Queen looked lost in her thoughts. He asked her "Something troubles you?"

Angella looked to him and replied, "what will become of the prisoners?"

He calmy replied as he limped along side her "They will remain in prison until tomorrow and then we will work on a plan."

Angella raised a brow and offered "Shouldn't we discuss a plan now? We don't know what is occurring now that they have not been able to report to Hordak in several days,"

He brushed off her concerns and assured her that everything was under control. The Queen was not fond of his action plan at all. A wedding is lovely, but to have a ceremony while dangerous Horde members allied to Hordak still made no sense to her.

He nodded for Scorpia to take over the meeting. She stood up from her seat and nervously shuffled her papers together. Angella gave her a sincere look of assurance. A motherly look that said I believe in you without ever saying it. It was something Scorpia needed right now. With Catra being mad at her and her father taking his injury as an opportunity to stop working, she needed any sign of assurance from someone who genuinely cares. With that small boost of confidence, she was able to go through her reading without fail.

Not having much else to say on the matter, Angella found herself tasked with helping with table arrangements. This would be a scandalous moment if she were in Sealines or the Ice Kingdom doing—*servant work*—instead, she found it pleasant. It was a relieve to get away from the King and his nonsense. The other villagers were polite to her and were in impressed by her fancy napkin folding abilities and her impressive knowledge of foreign wines across Etheria. This homely feeling of belonging and just being like everyone else was only an experience she had a few times in her life when Micah was alive. He always made her feel at ease in a way her own castle could never do.

Her relaxing time working with the staff ending as soon as the tables were finished, returning to her room she finally ran into Adora with the sword of protection morphed into a mop. She couldn't help but smile at the sight.

Adora huffed and without introduction she informed "Catra told the King I was the best toilet scrubbing cadet in the Horde, so I got bathroom duty before the ceremony."

The two paused for a moment before chuckling.

Walking back to the ground level cleaning closest Adora apologized "I was away from you for too long today, I'm sorry they made you set up tables,"

Angella shook her head "No, I enjoyed it. I only folded tablecloths and told people were to set up chairs, I didn't do any eternize labor, Adora…." She smirked at the blonde and teased "I may not have your upper body," gently squeezing Adora's biceped; making the blonde smile "But I do have some strength in me,"

Adora chuckled "I know, but I wouldn't of wanted them to let you move tables and stuff,"

"I assure you, if I can give birth to Glimmer and her giant head, I can move a few tables,"

Adora laughed and opened the closet to put the bucket back inside and transformed her mop back into a bracelet. Turning back to Angella she asked, “Did Glimmer really have a big head as a baby?”

Angella raised a brow “Have you seen her head now? Yes, believe me giving a natural birth to a baby girl weighing in at eight pounds and seven ounces,” she shot a look at Adora and knew she would be confused. To clarify “That is considered a heavy baby, most babies are between six and seven pounds.”

Adora just blinked innocently unaware of the pain Angella endured giving a traditional pain killer free childbirth to her daughter.

The Queen chuckled and remarked “Your so cute,”

A bashful smile was now on Adora’s face while they walked back to their room. Returning to the room meant they would get ready for the wedding together in peace. They showered separately and once they were both dressed; Angella started to help Adora put her hair. Asking “would you want it down? Up? Maybe a few curls?”

Adora shrugged “Maybe down…. I think Catra is going with curls?”

Angella nodded and brushed it down and brushed her bangs to the right side to give Adora a very—mature—hair style. A young woman needs a few new styles.

Angella decided to wear her hair partially up. She changed out her earrings for sapphire stones, including her forehead jewel to sapphire, as she though it was fitting for the Kingdom of the Black Garnet.

Adora wore her red dress again from Princess Prom. Nothing too special. She worried she didn't have a good variety of clothing. Some of the cute clothes Angella bought her got ruined on the travel over, and she secretly dreaded that most of her old clothes survived.

A knock on their door came as Lonnie called to them "Your highness? Adora? Is it okay if I come in?"

Adora opened the door and saw Lonnie in a tasteful yellow dress. The former friend was surprised to see her in something so pretty and girly, as Lonnie never expressed individuality in the Horde outside from picking on Catra when they were young, and even then, it was just her following the crowed.

She walked in and asked "Can Catra come in? she needs a place to hang out because Scorpia told her she cant see her before the ceremony. Catra then walked in with a huff "I'm telling you she's making it up, she's just getting back at me for snapping at her yesterday" there was Catra; hair beautifully pulled back in a tight bun with loose hair curled in front. Her dress was plain in an elegant way. Pearl white with lace trim around the chest and bottom of the frills. It wasn't overly puffy for Catra, it looked perfect, it was quite regal on her. The three starred at the feline; causing Catra to become extremely flustered. Stammering she shouted "Wh—what!?"

Adora cooed “Oh my gosh! Catra! you look so pretty!”

Catra crossed her arms and turned bright red. “N-no! don’t be dumb, Adora!”

Angella smiled behind her hand, realizing that the aggressive feline is incredibly bashful with small compliments gave her a bit of joy that the young lady was not nearly as tough as she portrayed herself.

Lonnie and Catra sat on the couch and Catra explained “Scorpia says it’s bad luck to see your spouse before the ceremony, so I had to get ready in Lonnie’s room, and now the guys are getting ready and we’re just waiting for everything to start,”

Lonnie nodded and Adora sat next to Catra. In awe of how pretty Catra looked. Makeup, hair, and a dress! She never thought she would see the day.

Angella sat on the chair across from then and confirmed “It is presumed back luck to see your betrothed on your wedding,”

Catra huffed “The lady who did my hair also made me take a weird mineral bath and then it all got weird from there,”

Adora asked “How?”

Lonnie asked for Catra “She told her how to fu—” looking over to a disappointed glare from Angella she rephrased herself “Gave her wedding night advice,”

Adora looked confused again. “What does that mean?” looking at Angella; the Queen’s look was discomfort as she excused herself to her bedroom.

Lonnie chuckled and made a crude gesture with her fingers to create a scissoring gesture “She told Catra how to—” Catra swatted her hand away and growled “Ugh, I knew I shouldn’t have told you,”

Adora felt left out of how close Lonnie and Catra have become over her time apart. In the back of her mind she felt a guilt inside of her. She felt she was the one responsible for them not getting along in the past and as happy as she wanted to be for Catra; she also felt hurt. The horrible things Catra said to her in the crystal castle before the Brightmoon invasion felt more true, Catra was more social and was rising to the top of the Horde due to Adora’s absence, without her being around; Catra’s life is better without her. The feline woman was a military officer, soon to be married, and will have a higher rank in the Scorpion army and princess title then Adora in a matter of hours.

The sulking stopped when Kyle; dressed very dapper with her hair combed back told everyone it was time to get seated.

Catra's tail started to nervously flicker as she walked down with the opposite corridor then the other women. She was briefed prior to take a different route to the wedding grounds so she would not see Scorpia.

Catra arrived at the grounds and was instructed to wait behind a curtain. Everyone needed to be seated before the music starts to play. Then she would walk down the aisle. She peeked through the curtain and saw everyone sitting down in cheap wooden chairs outside. All of them facing the front of a decorated gazebo. A scorpion older man wearing a white rope with a green and red sash over his shoulders made her nervous. That was the person who was going to do the ceremony. Her tail fluffed up in anxiety at the fear of messing up. If she stammers or walks to fast—worse trip! She would be laughed at.

A gentle tap on the shoulder from King Sabara as he instructed her. The music will start in just moment. Walk down the aisle with this bouquet and then my daughter will go down the aisle with me,"

Handing her flowers, Catra looked at them and gulped. This special event was now starting to make her uneasy. All the thoughts of messing this up for Scorpia was all hitting her now. She jumped a little when she heard the music play. Sabara smiled at her. Two women dropping flower petals walked slowly down the aisle first. He tabbed Catra to go whispering to her "Chin up, look straight, and stay about six-feet behind them,"

She nodded and did as he instructed. Walking down the aisle made her heart race. This whole time she had been more worried about Horde assassins then this moment right now—because now—she was walking down the aisle to get married. A person who never once thought of marriage or having a person being with them and loving them was something Catra never thought would happen. Maybe for Kyle, Lonnie, and Rogelio, and Adora—*obviously*, would have people come into their lives and I want them. The idea was never for Catra. Now that it was right in front of her, she clutched the flowers tightly and slowly walked down the aisle, doing her best to look calm while looking confident and regal. No rehearsal on this walk made her extra nervous. Her lips were looked thin while passing Adora. The blonde frowned when she saw Catra's tail fluffed. *She's nervous.* Adora's sudden mood change was noticed by Angella. The Queen giving her a worried look as Adora whispered as quiet as possible to not have Catra hear.

"She's nervous. When she gets like this, she's emotional."

Angella knew the look of bridal panic all too well. Her own wedding was nerve-wracking for her. Pacing aimlessly in her room, sobbing randomly, fearing rejection or mockery made her very ill before her wedding. She felt so much better when she finally saw Micah. The same feeling she wanted Catra to have was the relief she had once seeing Micah.

The music got louder and everyone stood up as Scorpia came down the aisle. Catra felt herself sweet a little seeing Scorpia walk with her claw around her father's claw. Catra watched her as they walked slowly down they aisle. Something was blocking Scorpia's face and Catra couldn't tell what her expression was. A

nervous glance over to Adora giving her a soft smile made her heart race faster, as everyone else was watching Scorpia.

The blonde softly mouthed *It's going to be okay*.

That was enough to smoothen out the feline's fluffed tail. Giving her a soft nod, Catra made it known to Adora she was okay.

Adora was happy for her. Now with Scorpia across from Catra— the shorter bride instinctively lifted up the vail; thinking it was some sort of weird thin sheet and it shouldn't have been in her face.

Awww

The crowded at went.

Catra looked confusedly at the crowed and heard some light laugher and turned back to Scorpia. The taller bride was smiling, but……..a hint of sadness was in her eyes. Catra's felt worried. In all her selfishness she never considered how important this would be to Scorpia. The taller woman must hate Catra for stealing this day from her. Scorpia is the sensitive mushy type, she really must of wanted this day to be special.

Catra gave her a nervously smile, which made Scorpia blink in shock. *She's not acting like she normally would…..*

The music stopped, people sat down again, and the pastor started to speak. It all felt fuzzing to Catra while she heard the man talk.

"We are gathered here today for the marriage unity of—"

Catra felt her hands tremble a little as she held her flowers—she was going to get married. She was going to be married to someone who cares for her. Someone that deserves love too, Scorpia deserved the most love; she has given it the most, she deserves the most.

Lost in focus she didn't hear what the guy said. The moment he uttered her name "Catra,"

The feline sputtered "I do!"

Causing some laughter from the crowed. Her ears flattered a little as she went red and looked and Scorpia in an apologetic way.

Her bride to be just smiled softly at her.

The man cleared his throat "I was going to confirm your last name. It only has your Horde ID: C-10282002……"

With glee she heard Lonnie and Adora shout "Her last name is Applesauce meow meows!"

A little bit more giggling from the audience as the man confirmed "Do you, Catra Applesauce Meow Meows take, Scorpia Lynda De'reem as your wife, through sickness and in health, rich or poor, and no matter where the Wars turns, will you love and protect Scorpia for the rest of your life?"

A pause came over everyone was they all looked at Catra. Her tail fluffed again, and the man cleared his throat and softly whispered "That's the part when you say—"

"I do!" Catra exclaimed.

A couple *awes* can be heard from people sitting as the man now asked, "And you do, Scorpia Lynda De'reem take, Catra Applesauce Meow Meows as your wife, through sickness and in health, rich or poor, and no matter where the Wars turns, will you love and protect Scorpia for the rest of your life?"

Scorpia softly replied "I do."

"I know pronounce you wives of the Scorpion Kingdom, you two may kiss."

Both looked embarrassedly at each other when he said that. Their first kiss was going to have an audience! No pressure or anything! The two very red-faced women leaned in for a kiss. The nervous pucker made the tip of Catra's ears go hot. Her tail swayed in anxiety; too nervous to pull away first. Scorpia pulled away, leaving a dreamy faced Catra to regain her former shyness as she looked down right after. The cheering from the crowed made her feel more embarrassed and Scorpia couldn't help but find it sweet.

The reception began right after. The newlyweds walked down the aisle together and away from away for a brief amount of time while everyone got out of their seats and headed over to wear the food and dancing would be. In a haste, Adora clung to Angella's arm so no one would think to make a move on the widow. By the looks some peoples faces, some wanted to dart over to Angella and a few other attractive single women for a date. Unfazed by this protective act; Angella thought about how Catra had acted. *The girl needs love, I wish her the best.*

The first dance they shared as a couple was sweet. The size different between them reminded her of her and Micah's height impairment with one another. Being taller than her late husband; he was typically chest level to her for dances. *Not that he minded it.*

Others began to dance as well. Adora being asked to a few, only to reject them by claiming she was on guard. Angella mentally face-palmed. No one else was thinking about being on edge right now. For such an uneasy time King Sabara made everyone in the Kingdom feel at ease. Despite it being common knowledge that Sabara was almost assassinated a few days ago. Not a word about prisoners or being under the radar of the Horde to be

attacked was being mentioned. Angella mentally remarked on how clam his people were, even if it is blissful ignorance. The two royals' eyes met as he walked over jovially. His limp was still visible. He rightfully should not be out of bed due to his injuries and sickness.

Adora looked at him with slight displeasure as he made his way over to them. He might be the King of this Kingdom, but he was far from graceful. Plus, he was extra flirty with Angella. Everyone was. It must make Angella uncomfortable.

Sabara asked "No dancing for you ladies? Is that a Brightmoon feature?"

Angella shook her head and offered "Adora and I are going *stag* for this event."

Sabara chuckled "Stag? You and I both. If you change your mind save a dance for me" he said limping back to his table.

Adora questioned the term "Stag?"

"It means we have no dates for this ceremony."

Adora nodded in understatement. Angella teased and playfully nudge her with her wing "Such a pretty girl like you should be dancing, no?"

Adora stiffened as she stuttered "I'm pretty?! Your Pretty! I—I—I don't wa—want to dance."

Angella smiled and asked "Why not? Too shy to ask someone?"

Adora shook her head "I don't want to leave you alone, and also I don't want any of them asking you to the dance floor" She said referring to several muscular Scorpion men giving flirty looks to all the passing women.

Angella giggled "I appreciate the concern, but you should mingle more for your age"

Adora raised a brow "What about you?"

Angella shrugged "I've done all the mingling I need to do for one lifetime. Besides, I have no desire to dance at my age."

Adora frowned "So if I asked you to dance you wouldn't accept?" the blonde frowned.

The taller woman bit her lip as she answered in a hushed tone "Adora… I haven't danced since my wedding day. I've never been one to enjoy the dance floor much, not even at Princess Prom when I was younger."

Adora blinked as she caught on to what she was saying and nodded. Not prying any further, the two stood in silence. Closely to one another a little Scorpion boy came up to them. He had to be at least four and he asked.

"Hi! Hi! Ec'cuse me! Can you—can you—can you dance with me?" looking directly at Angella. Adora held her breath for a moment. Worried Angella was going to hurt a toddlers feelings.

Angella smiled at him and kneeled down to say "I'd love to," She gave Adora a smile before taking the small child's pincher and walking him over to the dance floor. Adora watched as Angella start to dance with the small child. People looked over and smiled at her. For a Queen, this was a good PR move. Adora knew it was more to do with genuinely wanting to make someone happy.

Standing alone she saw everyone else have a good time. Without her. Lonnie was dancing with the boys, Octavia managed to find someone to dance with; Grizzlor even managed to dance with someone too. She saw in the corner of her eye the brides looking at her. Looking away from them, she wondered what they were thinking.

Scorpia whispered "She looks sad."

Catra replied "She's not the center of attention. She's probably upset that no one needs She-Ra right now,"

"Well…. We might, to deal with those prisoners,"

Catra looked down at her plate of food and back at Scorpia "Look… don't think about that right now, today should be about you,"

Scorpia was surprised to hear that. Even more, when the feline grabbed her claw and insisted "I mean it, today is about you."

Scorpia chuckled "W-wow, I wasn't expecting any of this from you…. You've been so…. Nice to me today, what's got into you?"

Catra looked insulted "What? I'm thoughtful. I was thinking about this all day today and besides…..you looked sorta sad walking down the aisle."

Scorpia's frowned returned "I was. A little. I was afraid this was a power move for you. I know you want to pull rank on everyone, and I know this new title for you will do that."

Catra felt ashamed. Scorpia knew her so well and it was now starting to bother her. For someone like Scorpia to be drawn to Catra for no reason made her feel the affection was undeserved. The fact Scorpia knows that Catra was always in this for power from the beginning bothered her. Thinking it was one thing, but to say it was another. She took Scorpia's claw and confessed "I know how I can get…. I know this was supposed to be important to you, I really want to make you happy. I mean it," She looked

into Scorpia's eyes "I want you to like being my wife. I know I'm not easy to be around, and I know I'm a jerk, but I really, really, want you to like this."

Scorpia's mouth was agaped for a moment. Unable to say anything. The rush of emotions made her eyes water.

Catra retracted her hand and apologized "Sorry! I didn't mean to upset you. I just—" she was stopped by the quick peck on the lips her bride.

"No, it's fine…" Scorpia said pulling away. "It was sweet. I really liked it. I want to be your wife and make you happy too," smiling at the dumbfounded look on Catra's face. The feline was taken back by the kiss and was turning just as red as she did at the altar.

Scorpia hid her smile behind her claw. The feline defensively asked "Wh-what are you smiling about?" her flustered state making her right ear twitch a little.

Scorpia replied with "Your blushing, it's really cute." She chuckled.

Catra's eyes widened as her ears flattered to her head. Defending herself "I—I am not!" turning away from Scorpia. The taller bride smiled more when a camera man walked over to snap a quick photo and teased "How cute. Kitty is the blushing bride," before walking off. Catra growled and stood up "I'm gonna check on all the dorks."

Scorpia kept sitting down and smiled as Catra left. Her worries on Catra making this special day something selfish was gone. Catra really is changing, or maybe this has been the real Catra all along. She always wanted to see the sweet side of the feline Horde officer for quite some time. It made her look forward what their marriage would be like.

The feline made her way to the sulking blonde standing alone while the posh winged Queen humored a little kid by dancing with him.

She walked over and shoulder nudged Adora "Hey, Adora,"

Adora replied "Hey…."

The bride looked In Adora's direction and asked, "I take it Angella didn't want to dance with you?"

Adora sighed "she said she doesn't like to dance,"

Raising a brow "So I take it you still have a thing for her?" Catra asked.

Adora looked down ashamed. Not saying a word.

Catra awkwardly rubbed her forearm before offering "If things in Brightmoon gets too awkward…. You can just stay here in the Scorpion Kingdom when this is all over."

Adora asked "When this is over?"

Catra smugly shrugged and declared "Yeah, when I stop the Horde, save Etheria and punch Shadow Weaver and Hordak in the face, you can live here…. stay in the castle…. Find a horse that doesn't talk, even get a few different jackets, anything."

Adora snorted "I have more than one jacket."

"Could a fooled me."

The two laughed and watched the rest of the party goers having a good time. People started drinking and Angella was no longing dancing with the little boy and was now just talking to some of the party guests. Sabara and Scorpia shared a dance and after they danced, he asked for Catra to dance with him.

While the dance awkwardly danced while everyone stared, he asked Catra to keep his little girl safe. Catra promised him she would. With Adora now alone again she watched as Kyle and Rogelio started dancing. Clearly unable to handle their wine as now the two were dancing on a table shirtless with several Scorpion women throw their napkins and some money at them. Crying for them to take more off. Angella nudged Adora and

asked, “Now I figured them to be quiet boys, but is that normal of them?”

Adora turned and started laughing “No, never. I think they had their first sip of wine.”

Adora noticed Angella had a half-empty wine glass in hand. The Queen was smiling more than before and Adora’s eyes went a little when she realized Angella must not be good at holding her liquor. It made sense as to why she kept denying drinks early on to their trip.

Angella’s eyes narrowed “Hmm, I’m going to keep an eye on them. Those women are too old to be flirting with such young boys” she then took a sip of her wine when Adora asked, “Do you think everyone is too young for you?”

Angella’s eyes went wide at the slightly rude remark, she answered “No, Adora, I don’t think that, but you former Horde children are so baby faced it’s hard to believe your all almost twenty.” She said offering Adora a sip of wine from her glass. Adora took a large gulp and stated “Well you told me your age and I wouldn’t call that old, I wouldn’t say you look old either, and also Glimmer has a baby face too and she’s a commander.”

Angella chuckled “She is a baby, my baby”

They both laughed at that.

“Don’t tell her that” Adora commented.

Angella shrugged “My sweet little Glimmer, Commander and big baby” Angella looked down at Adora as she said “I wonder what she’s doing right now”

Adora answered, “Probably yelling at someone, or kissing Bow” she teased.

Angella smiled as she took another sip and commented “I don’t fault her for snogging. I still can't believe she never told me about her and Bow” she raised her hands a little “I mean I like Bow, he’s such a nice boy, the perfect son-in-law. Now I must wait until Glimma decides to tell me on her own, and that will take forever. Good thing I’m immortal.”

Adora smiled “You might just want to tell her you to know because she doesn’t tell anyone. I only know because I saw them kiss.”

Angella chuckled at that. It reminded her all too well of her sneaking around with Micah when they were young. Several stolen kisses when no one was watching was such a thrill until they were caught by guards, other sorcerers, and Castaspella. Repressing all those embarrassing memories aside she couldn’t help but smile at it. She was happy for Glimmer. Her first love, her secret pining affair. She remembered how much she enjoyed those days herself. her smile turned to a sour look when she

remembered how sexual Micah and she were behind carriage blinds and hidden rooms in Mystacor. She liked Bow, but not enough to be so approving of his hands on her daughter's body. Or worse, if Glimmer took after her father, she would use her shortness to her advantage.

Adora questioned, "You want to dance?" seeing if the Queen will say yes this time.

Angella averted her gaze from her; confessing "I'm not such a good dancer."

"You were dancing with that little boy."

"I was standing in place almost while holding his pincers," she answered.

Adora proudly declared "I am, Glimmer taught me, she said I was good at it" holding out both her hands she smiled at Angella "One slow dance? Please? I never slowed danced with anyone before."

She couldn't resist those puppy dog baby blue eyes. She took her hands into her own and was escorted by the shorter woman to the dance floor. She felt this sense of nostalgia when this happened. At her wedding, she wore heels Micah was only to breast level as they danced together. She felt her face redden at the memory of her slight cleavage dress made Micah's eyes draw to her bosom. Adora was no exception. Her eyes were focused

on breasts and Angella jokingly commented. "My eyes are further up, darling."

Adora shot a sheepish look upward towards the Queen. Their dance was short but sweet. All the while Angella was flooded with memories of her first great love, Micah. The only person she swore to ever marry. A man that would never be replaced in her heart. So many men and even women came to send her letters of their adoration of her after his death. Many men being so arrogantly bold to go to Brightmoon in-person to declare love to her. She brushed it all off. This dance somehow reminded her of all those old things.

Adora dancing with her felt something familiar; it was no secret she knew Adora's fondness of her and having a young female admirer was not new to Angella, but Adora brought something different to her adoration. Adora could protect and be brave for her. Something Micah did. Something Bow is doing for Glimmer as she is miles away from home. Adora is new and different to her, yet familiar. A different type of love. But this was love none the less, Adora was the young brave woman who left the Horde, took on the mantel of She-Ra and has been willing to sacrifice and fight for everything good in the name of Etheria. She *adored* her.

She placed a soft peck on Adora's forehead as she pulled away. The blonde going wide-eyed. Angella softly spoke "Thank you, Adora"

There was no time to process a comment back as Lonnie came over; her face covered in lipstick and she tugged on Adora's arm

"C'mon, Sabara asked us to give Catra a toast before they run off to their bedroom,"

Can we question why she looks like she's been making out all night?

Adora questioned, "Why does she want toast?"

Lonnie snorted "It means a speech, Scorpia's dad just did one for Scorpia and it was just a bunch of cute stories about her as a kid. We got plenty of stories of Catra when she was little."

Adora beamed "Like the mouse story?"

Lonnie grinned "You tell it the best."

The two giggled and rushed off to the other side of the dance floor. Angella smiled warmly at her as the blonde ran off to embarrass her friend. She was not left alone for long, both Kyle and Rogelio came to stand by her. Both boys looking down in shame as they approached the Queen in only dress pants and no shirts.

Angella questioned, "I take it you couldn't find shirts after your show?"

Kyle nodded and Angella laughed and ruffled his hair "Be a little more careful next, both you of. Handsome young men should show some restraint around a crowd of inebriated women" both boys gave her a sheepish smile. It wasn't long before all three were laughing at Adora and Lonnie's retelling of all of Catra's most infamous cadet moments. Only for Catra to continually sputter out that they were lying and tried to turn off their microphone several times. Giving everyone around a good laugh.

The party ended and everyone was ready to retire to bed. In the suite, Angella noticed Adora's comfort of stripping down in front of Angella without any hesitation. Just two weeks ago, she was too bashful to join Glimmer and her in a spa. Now she was in panties and a bra in their living room without hesitation. Adora had gotten herself a few glasses of wine on her own and eased up after a while during the reception. A blush burned over Angella's face as she got to admire her tone body. Adora was a beauty. Angella was slightly tipsy. The two jumped a little when they heard someone call the door "Your giftbag is on the doorknob,"

With no thought Adora walked over to open the door, Angella pinches the bridged of her nose "Adora, darling, your not dressed,"

The blonde blankly looked at her with gift bag in hand "Oh? Sorry. I forgot," with a shrug she handed the bag over to Angella. The Queen inspected the bag and saw nothing of major interest, some snacks, a mini bottle of wine and a card thanking them for attending.

Adora looked over her shoulder; undressed still and asked, “Is that wine?”

The Queen booped her nose playfully and remarked “Not that you need anymore.”

Adora giggled “what makes you say that?”

The Queen looked Adora up and down and remarked “Your practically naked.”

Adora then gestured to her bra “Not entirely,” she giggled with a slight slur in her speech. Her inebriation showing.

The fun banter had quickly turned sexual. Adora’s undressed state made Angella’s mind go into the gutter as shameful as that felt. Their eyes met and Angella turned away with a blush again.

Adora asked inncoenlty “What else is in the bag?”

Angella handed it to her “Just some sweats.”

Adora pulled out a package and read the title “Kissing sticks?”

Angella chuckled “Those are a bit of a naughty party gift.”

"How?"

For the love of Etheria Adora! Put on pajamas! Please?! You want to stand around and talk while your almost naked in the middle of the living room like it's no big deal!

It took Adora longer than it should of to realize she was still half-naked talking to Angella. In embarrassment she sat down on the couch and covered herself with a throw blanket. Angella—*who was still a little red in the face*—sat next to her and explained. "It's a naughty little game. You take each side of the stick; it tastes like a biscuit; you try to take small bites while still keeping it in your mouth until you reach the other persons mouth… then you can be fresh and kiss them or just pull away and eat the rest of the biscuit,"

Adora just gave her a blank expression. Either she was playing dumb or she was just dumb from the wine. The Queen sighed and opened up the package and took out the thin biscuit stick and placed the tip her mouth. She cupped Adora's face "Open,"

The blonde cautiously placed her lips to lightly touch the stick with her lips. Angella lightly bit into the stick and moved closer to Adora's face. The realization of what was occurring sobered her up quickly. Either Angella was playfully demonstrating or potentially ready to kiss her. Adora's eyes were wide with anticipation. Angella moved closer with another small bite. As did Adora. The third bit could have easily been Angella's chance to kiss her. Instead, she bit hard on the stick and pulled away smiling; covering her mouth to chew "That is how kissing sticks is played,"

Adora looked at her with wide eyes. Disappointed she didn't get the kiss she was looking forward to. Hoping it didn't show on her face. Angella sobered a little more with her partners reaction. Realizing her flirting had emotional consequences she apologized "I'm sorry, that was a little mean? wasn't it?"

Adora felt stupid. Just as stupid she did the night, she drunkenly tried to hit on Angella. She was looking down at herself. Black bra and red underwear covered in a cranberry-colored throw blanket; she knew she had made a fool of herself again. Desperate for Angella's adoration, she stupidly threw herself at her again. This time it felt crueler. Instead of being tenderly put back in her place, she was humored.

Adora frowned and replied, "It's my fault for feeling this way," she shrugged. "I dunno, I think I might take Catra up on her offer after this is all done….."

Angella pulled back a little more from her on the couch and asked, "What offer was that?"

Adora didn't look at her as she answered, "Stay here after the war….. I can do more work here in her Kingdom…. It's closer to the Fright Zone, and they could use she-Ra more than Birghtmoon."

Angella's mouth fell at this information. The idea of Adora leaving Brightmoon was something she never thought was even possible.

She has everything she could ever want in Brightmoon! After the war, why would she want to be anywhere else?

"Adora…. I….." Angella felt such deep guilt over this situation. Cursing herself for getting so close and casual with Adora. Hoping it would turn into a genuine friendship seemed so reasonable at the time. She never assumed Adora would grow a romantic interest in her.

She sighed and asked, "Is this because of me?"

Adora shrugged. Sort of…. She-Ra could be used here….. Also, it's going to be awkward going back to just referring to you as; *your majesty* and *ma'am* after this is all done. I thought we were sort of…. Becoming friends," she looked into Angella's eyes and asked, "Once the war is over…. what will you need me for? You won't need a bodyguard, so?"

Angella placed her hand on Adora's shoulder. "I would like to maintain our friendship….I mean, only if this is a friendship. If it's only an infatuation…. Then I will be forced to deny it. I don't want to be the reason Glimmer loses a friend."

Adora assured her, "I'd still see Glimmer. Talk to her. I just might not want to go back to Brightmoon…. that's all…."

Angella looked saddened by all of this. The was a conversation not to have come down from four glasses of wine. "Why don't you

see me the way the other Princesses do? They see me as a mother. You've only ever seen me as a commander. Why is that?"

Adora replied without hesitation, "I grew up in the Horde. I have no concept of mothers or fathers. Shadow Weaver made it noticeably clear she didn't love us. Most commanders married each other, and seeing a twenty-year-old and a forty-year-old together in the Horde was not a rare thing. Most Force Captains had age gaps between them. I see you the way I see everyone who has more power and authority than me. I want your approval…..at any cost."

Angella felt uncomfortable. It was never made more apparent than now how foreign Adora's thoughts on healthy relationships were.

Angella stroked the side of Adora's face. "Adora, I know this is hard for you right now. I'm so sorry. The Kissing stick thing was out of line."

"It wasn't. I liked it. I like being around you… even if you know, I have a crush on you…. You haven't been mad about it," Adora scooted closer to her for comfort. Angella placed a wing around her and hugged her from the side closely. "I'm flattered by it all. Truly, I find you beautiful and sweet, of course, and I would like to have a companionship that can be platonic in love. It's something I have lacked for a long time. I am reclusive by choice… Glimmer always resented me for it. I could use your company after the war. As partners in restoring Etheria and as friends…."

Adora let her head fall to Angella's shoulder. "I'd like that,"

A smile crept up on the blonde's face, and Angella felt it somehow. Looking down at Adora resting on her shoulder, "What are you smiling at?"

Adora snuggled up more "Just some hypothetical ideas…"

"Such as?"

"If you and I did date… how would people react."

Angella smiled and that idea too and chuckled, "I would get a lot of angry letters from suiters I rejected….. most definitely shock all the royal guards and Captain Juliet for sure…."

Adora added, "The Princesses would probably find it odd too…. They'll ask dirty questions; Glimmer would probably be weirded out."

Angella smiled. "Glimmer would hate it. She would demand we show no affection in front of her. Or just growl and groan over it,"

Adora laughed. "She would; I think Catra would mess with her about it."

Angella's eyes narrowed playfully. "Ah, yes, the newly crowned princess who wants to steal you from me. I would love to trade passive aggressiveness with her. I'd spoil you so much you'd never have time for her."

Adora grinned. "She'd hate that. She offered to give me a horse to replace Swift Wind,"

"I'll give her Swift Wind, you know…. As a peaceful gift," Angella winked.

Adora, knowing all too well Swift Wind annoys people chuckled and replied, "That might start another war,"

Angella chuckled and kissed Adora's forehead. "I'd like to see her try. Doubt Scorpia would allow for any of that."

Adora chuckled. "Oh, she wouldn't. Judging by how Catra was all night. I think she has it bad for Scorpia."

Angella agreed. "She should. Marriage should do that to her as a person…. Once you in love, the feeling is something you never want to lose…." Angella frowned for a moment and softly resting her head on Adora's. "I wish you find that love, Adora."

Adora closed her eyes and agreed, "Yeah… I hope so too….."

She was adjusting herself a little so that she could face Angella. The Queen looked at her. The soft smiles drew their faces closer together after all the talking. They were dancing around the subject. The attraction was still there. It was forbidden. But it still couldn't be denied. The constant teetering on *you can't feel this way—you shouldn't feel this way*, was tiring. Even after that whole conversation, the romantic tension was still there. Drawing in closer without a single word…. they pressed their lips together lightly. Eyes softly closed. Lips still touching and mentally daring the other to make the next move. Angella was parting her lips slightly, and Adora tilted her head. A real kiss was being had at this moment. They were parting away slowly with their eyes fluttering open.

Adora softly asked, "Please don't banish Swift Wind,"

Angella giggled and pressed her forehead to her and assured. "I promise I won't."

She said she was off to bed. When she closed her bedroom door to cover her face with her hands, she felt attracted to Adora in a taboo way. Only a few more days to plan for a battle, and then

they would back to Brightmoon. After being so close to Adora made her wonder what will be of their relationship? Will Adora still treat her like a boss? At this point, Angella wanted Adora to be a friend to her. Her loneliness made her yearn for a companion. She wanted a friendship with Adora. Or maybe she *wanted* Adora.

Chapter End Notes

I know it's late, but here is the new update!

Read Catra and Scorpia getting naughty in chapter 17 early, check my ko-fi to read under my blog post.

https://ko-fi.com/garbagefanfics

The Escape

Something euphoric came over Catra for the duration of the night. She went with the flow with everything. She played with kids. She took pictures with people and danced with Scorpia for most of the night. Even danced with other people. When it was all over, Lonnie and Adora finished all their embarrassing stories of her as a child, none of which are nearly as accurate as they think. It was finally ending. Her feet were killing her. She never wore shoes this much—she never wore heels once!

The music stopped.

The lanterns were brighter, and everyone was leaving to their bedrooms.

She watched as Lonnie and the boys left. They were conveniently walking in the direction of Lonnie's bedroom. At the same time, Octavia and Grizzlor seemed to wander off together*. If those two got together—eww—I'd feel sorry for their kid…..*

She was leaving the brides alone—a few giggling and grinning people passed by them, Including Adora. Scorpia asked, "So, uh, do you want to go back to our room?" almost biting her lip as she asked.

Catra teased and crossed her arms. "Oh, so it's our room again?"

Scorpia tapped her claws together nervously. "Y-yeah, w-we should get some rest."

Catra smiled and put her arm around Catra's claw to keep close. "Lead the way," she purred.

The blood was now rushing to Scorpia's face as they walked together. Some more grinning people passed them.

Scorpia tried to be bold at the bedroom door and lifted Catra off the ground, making the cat squeak in shock. "Wh-what are you—"

"It's a married couple thing," She sputtered. "You're supposed to carry your wife across the threshold of the bedroom on the wedding night."

Catra just moved her head back a little "Oh, okay, don't let me stop you."

Scorpia stopped at the door and then let out a nervous laugh. "I should have probably opened the door first…."

Catra let out a high-pitched laugh as she leaned out of Scorpia's claws to open the door.

She was walking past the threshold. Scorpia placed Catra on the bed. The feline kicked off her heels and sighed. While Scorpia turned around nervously and asked, "Could you zip this down for me, please?" referring to her dress. Catra did so without a second thought. She was unzipping it. The second Scorpia knew back was more exposed, she lost all her nerves. She was taking a step forward without saying anything. Catra teased, "We've seen each other in the locker rooms before. You don't need to get so shy now,"

Scorpia didn't look at her as she replied, "Yeah, well…. It's different tonight. I'm not wearing Horde-issued underclothes. I got on something prettier," she sputtered.

Catra purred, "Cool me too."

Scorpia chuckled as she slowly turned around to take off her dress. "Your pretty confident right now,"

Catra shrugged. "Well. I'm comfortable around you….. your my wife now, so…. We should be comfortable around each other and —" she stopped once the dress fell to the floor. She looked up and down Scorpia's frame; this was by far different from their locker room encounters. This is far more intimate. Her lack of words made Scorpia cover herself up with her claws and tail, and now she regretted her white lacy bra and panties being under her dress, including her garter belt on her right thigh. The silence from Catra made her lose even more confidence than before. "Your—you're not saying anything," She nervously called to her.

Catra snapped back into reality. She needed to say something smug and witty to keep Scorpia flustered. She stared up and Scorpia and saw the worry in her eyes and flattered her ears when she saw that Scorpia looked more worried than nervous and replied honestly. "You're pretty. Pretty. I've never seen you like this before; it's hard not to stare…." *Did that make things less awkward?*

Scorpia sat next to her on the bed and shrugged shyly. "Thanks, um, you—you can take off your dress now if you want."

Catra sat up and turned to remove her dress. Unzipping the back, she let it fall to reveal herself to her bride in her white underclothes.

Scorpia's mouth gaped, and she softly said, "You're stunning. Beautiful and—and pretty—"

All the blood rushed to Catra's face, and she bashfully covered herself before sitting back down next to Scorpia and sputtered, "Wha—what? Wait, that's too many compliments at once, geez," she looked down and smiled. *AHHH, I'm embarrassed! I can't act cool when I'm embarrassed.*

"Sorry"

Catra then gestured her hands in a waving motion. "No—no—it's cool, it's fine. I'm just not used to compliments like that, so…. My

bad… .that's my fault."

Scorpia assured her, "It's fine. I, um, won't go too overboard on compliments."

Catra shrugged and kept her arms crossed. "Thanks,"

"Even if they're true," the taller girl teased.

Catra gave her a grin and asked, "You're a lot more forward half-naked."

Scorpia rubbed the back of her head. "Well, I'm trying not to act *too* shy. I mean, y'know…. Some of the wedding rituals are a little embarrassing and stuff."

Catra tapped on her thigh where her garter belt was and asked, "What is that? My dress came with one too, and I didn't wear it because I didn't know where it was supposed to go."

Scorpia bit her lip, then explained, "When we were dancing during the ceremony, we were supposed to do the garter belt dance. You and I were going to take turns sitting down while the other goes up each other dresses to grab it with our teeth."

Catra's eyes went wide. "Wait? So I was supposed to sit you down. Get on my knees, lift your dress and grab that with my teeth?"

The scorpion girl nodded.

Catra looked down and her lap. "Wow, that sounds so pervy."

Scorpia nodded. "Yeah, it's a little perverted. But, it's supposed to be good fun. I didn't want to do it because I was too embarrassed to have my dad watch me, so….."

Catra crossed her arms. "I—I get, a lot of this stuff is embarrassing. But—but, we don't need to be embarrassed now because we're alone."

Scorpia tapped her pincers together and asked, "Umm, so you know what happens on a wedding night, right?"

Catra turned to her and gave her a slightly embarrassed grin. "Yeah, we are supposed to *do it*. I'm not oblivious, plus the lady that did my hair gave me the most explicit talk about lesbian sex. I know we both have to want it. If your too embarrassed, we can cuddle?" she offered with a shrug. "I know you like hugs."

Scorpia smiled at her. "I'd like cuddling…. Maybe some more kissing?"

Catra's ears perked up. "Yeah! We can do that!" she looked down at the garter belt and offered, "Do you want me to take off your garter belt? The sexy way?" attempting to sound cool. Her voice shook a little with uncertainty. Scorpia felt her heart flutter a little and gulped; the mere idea of Catra taking off her garter belt made her feel more embarrassed—and hornier—than she would have wanted.

The feline got on her knees before her bride sitting on the bed, dumbfounded at the situation. Seeing the worry in Catra's eyes when she placed her hands on the pale-skinned women's knees, Scorpia sputtered, "S—sure, go ahead."

Catra then used her hands to open up Scorpia's legs slightly and then moved to her right thigh. The taller bride feeling Catra's teeth on her leg aroused her, and the sight of Catra pulling the garter belt down without using her hands made her turn bright red with embarrassment.

Catra lifted her head with garter, still in her mouth, and let it fall to the floor. The two made eye contact, and Catra stood up to plant a kiss on Scorpia's lips. The first time she had ever kissed her directly without instruction to do so. Scorpia deepened the kiss and slowly moved her claws to embrace Catra gentling. The feline did not flinch at the embrace and wrapped her arms around his wife's neck. This kiss was their first—*proper*—passionate kiss, with no one telling them they should or have to. The feline ran her nails through Scorpia's short hair and moaned into the kiss. Her breath hitched a little in the kiss when she realized what she was doing. She pulled away to see Scorpia's reaction, scared that Scorpia might laugh at how low Catra's guard was. Instead, she

was greeted by a warm smile or assurance. Catra's gulped slightly in anticipation of what Scorpia might say or do; in return, she received a soft kiss on the lips.

Catra blinked in shock. *Is she not laughing at me? Why isn't she going to make fun of me?*

When Scorpia pulled away, she softly told Catra, "I love being around you. I like you when you're like this,"

"Vulnerable?" Catra questioned.

Scorpia touched her forehead to hers. "No, sweet. You are being relaxed and not having to act like a Commander is nice; you don't have to be that way around me,"

Catra closed her eyes and let her weight press more on Scorpia as she asked, "You want me to be like this all the time?" *Clueless and Horny?*

Scorpia replied, "I just want you to be yourself and y'know, be happy,"

Catra lifted her head to look at Scorpia. "I—I am happy, I like being around you too, I feel like I can trust you, really trust you,"

Scorpia smiled. “You should. I’m your wife, and I want you to trust me,”

Catra gave her a shy smile. “I do,” she practically whispered.

The two shared another kiss before Catra pushed her body towards Scorpia some more to get to her fall off back on the bed. Scorpia allowed her to, enjoying the kiss; Catra rolled over next to her. Sitting back up and stammered, “S-sorry, I’m getting nervous,”

Scorpia grinned. I’m so glad she is honest with me. “Don’t worry,” sitting back up, “Would you like me to…. the pleasure you?”

Catra gulped again. “Uh—umm, I’ve never done anything like this before.”

“I’m not all that experienced either, or this is going to be a first time for both of us together,”

Catra turned her head a little to the side and asked, “So…. You have had sex before?”

Scorpia looked down and didn’t say anything. Catra hid her face in her hands and groaned. “I’m going to embarrass myself all night; I have no idea what I’m doing,” she looked at Scorpia

through fingers and asked, “Aren’t we are just gonna touch boobs and kiss all over each other's bodies and stuff?”

Scorpia found her uncertainty cute. Knowing how nervous Catra was getting, she did her best to put her at ease by stroking a little of the feline’s ego.

She turned to Catra. “Yeah, it’s that with a little more stuff,” placing her claws on Catra’s shoulder, she asked, “If you want, I can show you. You are the mastermind behind saving Etheria, shouldn’t I pamper you the way you deserve? Your majesty,” her voice got a little sultrier with that last part. Catra tensed as her cheeks reddened, and she squeaked, “Y-yeah! C-cool! If—if you want, I’m not going to stop you…Princess Scorpia?” her voice not nearly as confident as she wanted to sound.

Scorpia swiftly undid the clasp to Catra’s bra making the feline question how she did that. Scorpia giggled before gesturing for her to lay down. “I’m going to kiss you all over it. Is that okay?”

Catra nodded. “Yeah—yeah, go ahead, princess.”

Scorpia softly began to kiss her neck as she replied in between kisses, “As you wish, *your majesty.”*

The two enjoyed their first time together. The peace was delightful. Most guests of the wedding were enjoying the quiet night. Most people had hookups from the wedding, and many naughty castle residents had a one-night stand. Lonnie gave in to temptations and spent the night with a woman she had only met that night. Kyle and Rogelio had privacy to themselves to be intimate after a busy week, and Octavia and Grizzlor were hooking up too—know that they were—in all cases—never returning to the Fright Zone, they might as well have fun.

After making love for the first time—Scorpia sat up on the bed—naked and looked down at Catra beside her. Bare chest exposed over the sheets as the feline panted. Catra couldn't fathom the intense pleasure she had just received. *First of all! Sex! Wow! Why did the Horde never let them do this?* The minute the girls had their periods; they were instantly given birth control shots and hormone suppressants; Catra started receiving those when she was twelve due to her feline biology. She never experienced feeling the urge for sex. Only in small spurts, but her lack of sexual desire for men meant she would never indulge in it. Scorpia's circumstance was different, as a Princess, she often got to leave to go home, and she had boyfriends and girlfriends on her visits.

Catra just mustered up only one-word "Wow…."

Scorpia inquired, "Was it good?"

Catra smirked and closed her eyes. "Amazing."

Scorpia bashfully looked away and tried to downplay her skills. "I'm—I'm not great. I'm not all that experienced,"

Catra replied with her eyes closed, "I have no experience, and all I gotta say is that was…. wow! Amazing."

Scorpia enjoyed seeing her like this; something like this was so personal and rare for her to experience, and to experience it with Catra made her feel great. Because their relationship was rushed entirely, she felt her connection to Catra was familiar enough to make all this work. All day, she had doubts about Catra's willingness to be a wife to her. She was even having a horrible daydream of Adora objecting to the wedding and stealing Catra from her. These last two days have been all about her and her Kingdom, and she was surprised by it all. It was never—ever! All about her, and right now, it seemed like it was. Catra could barely move after what she just did to her. Scorpia felt slightly embarrassed as she asked, "Was I too much for you?"

Catra opened up her eyes and chuckled at her. "I feel you prepared more for this. I guess you did pay attention in sex ed?"

Scorpia asked, "You didn't?"

She giggled. "Adora and I skipped sex-ed class because we didn't want to look at wieners,"

She and Scorpia laughed.

The feline sat up and asked, “So? Want me to try to do the same thing to you?”

Scorpia tensed up and pulled her knees closer to her body, and let out a nervous chuckle. “Oh! Um, no—no, not tonight. I’m on my period…. Uh, you know….so, it might not be all fun for you like it was for me.”

Catra blinked and gasped a little “S-sorry!” she stammered.

Scorpia relaxed again and assured, “Don’t be.”

Catra offered, “Can I still kiss you?” she leaned forward.

Scorpia then turned away and reminded Catra, “My mouth was in between your legs just five minutes ago,”

Catra counter-offered with, “Can I kiss you? On your body?”

“Don’t leave marks where anyone can see them. I bruise easily.”

Catra grinned and pounced on Scorpia. “Got it. Only make marks where I can see them,”

The two giggled as Catra playfully left kisses all around Scorpia's next and chest.

The only two guests from the wedding that were fighting temptations were in the royal quarters of the castle. Angella stirred in her bed, mentally kicking herself for allowing herself to kiss Adora. The girl just finished telling me she didn't see my title and age difference as something to remain off-limits. She might as well of said age is a number—*Oh moons! How could I have let this happen? I don't want her to wake up tomorrow and think we're dating. She's a sweet girl with a pretty face and works hard; she needs to find someone equally dear to make her happy! Oh! Why couldn't Bow have had a sister or cousin I could introduce to her!? If Glimmer ever hears about this, she'll never speak to me again! She barely talks to me anyway!*

She sat up and sighed. Her actions were awful; even if that kiss could have been taken as a spiritual display of affection, Adora might be thinking something else. She was no fool to what a kiss could mean. She was married for years—she knew what kissing did.

She heard a faint whistle from outside and mistook it for street fireworks. Placing her robe on, she walked out into the living room and saw Adora's bedroom door was open. She walked over to see Adora wasn't in there; instead, she was on the balcony. Hearing the faint whistling and pops from the balcony, she approached Adora and asked, "Unable to sleep?"

Adora turned to her and nodded. "I keep hearing these fireworks go off, and I can't sleep" she turned to Angella. Her red robe is slightly undone at the top to reveal cleavage. Angella's eye fought the urge to draw her eyes downward. Adora asked, "Can't sleep either?"

Angella shook her head. "No, the fireworks were keeping me awake, and you?"

"Same." The blonde replied. The two looking out at the dimly lit down below them. The ceremony tables and alter still up from the last event. No one around outside. The two looked on in silence, both wanting to say something but couldn't think of the right words.

Adora focused her gaze on Angella and asked, "I didn't do anything to make this awkward, right?"

Angella asked the same question back to her "Have I done anything to make this awkward?"

Adora shook her head. "N—no, I just don't want things to be weird for us, and I don't want us going back to Brightmoon to be different in a bad way."

The Queen assured her, “It won’t, but you are coming back to Brightmoon with me? Right?”

“Yes”

Angella nodded. “Good, I would hate to be the reason you leave all your friends. I enjoy your company; I would never want to ruin this.”

Adora reached her hand out to touch Angella’s. “I don’t want to ruin anything either, or I know the way we here won’t be in Birghtmoon.”

Angella accepted her hand into her own and agreed, “I don’t want anything here to ruin our relationship in Brightmoon; our friend here has to remain only here. I know how casual we are with each other here, and I would like that to carry back to Brightmoon… I’m just aware of how awkward it will be for other people for us to act like this back home.”

Adora nodded and sadly said, “It’s not fair for you to have to keep people so distant.”

Angella greed “It’s not, but I have been like this my whole life. As an immortal Angelic being, I will be Queen of Brightmoon for—essentiality—forever, and my relationships will follow me throughout my reign. It will be a lonely rule, but I am the immortal that must do it.”

“It sounds so sad.”

“It is,”

Angella thought about what she could say to Adora. At this moment, she could tell her all about how much she hated being immortal and that it wasn’t her choice to be this way, and that it was all her mother’s cruel doings to make her like this, but she knew Adora was far too sensitive to let that information go. At this moment, she needed comfort.

She looked down at the hamlet together, the curious sounds of rambling coming from the castle grounds. It’s such a tiny Kingdom on a large amount of land. Would it be considered a hamlet or a village? They weren’t sure. More whistling sounds came from the outside and then a few muffled sounds in the castle. The sound was faint until the rumbling felt like it was coming from inside the castle. A bit more of loud whistling and then.

The loud sound of an explosion shook the walls—Adora dove on top of Angella to protect her. Angella’s wings instantly closed around them to protect the two. The thudding around outside the room from people running around to see what is going on. Their door to their suite swung open as Lonnie asked, “Are you two, okay?!” her hair messed up from—apparently—not sleeping, and her dress was disheveled, and her feet were bare. She saw Adora

on top of Angella in only their robes and softly apologized. “Sorry to interrupt,”

Adora jumped up. “Don’t worry, what is going on?”

Lonnie sputtered, “The prisoners have escaped! They took King Sabara!” Adora rushed to her room and cried out, “FOR THE HONOR OF GREYSKULL!” emerging from the room as She-Ra turned to Angella, “Stay here, I’m going to help!”

Angella nodded and looked out her balcony. Scared people are running around outside, retreating from the castle. In a panic, she rushed back to her bedroom to put on clothes. Dressed in the Horde slacks and top that revealed her midriff, she stayed in her bedroom where it was safe.

While Adora rushed down the halls with Lonnie, they met Scorpia and Catra; both were underdressed and disheveled as they all met up to speak.

Catra instructed, “We need to find the prisoners!”

Adora asked, “What about all these people?”

Lonnie offered, "I'll get the boys to check on everyone and anyone who hurt; we'll treat anyone who is injured,"

All three nodded, and Scorpia added, "I'll go with Adora to see where they took my father!"

Catra offered, "We'll all go! We need to find out how they got out!"

Lonnie ran down the opposite hall as the other three women did. The halls were vacant with the slightly rumbling and shaking of concrete walls.

Looking around, Catra sniffed the air and stated, "They're using Horde tech! these aren't firing works; they're lasers from Horde bots."

Scorpia nodded, and the two of them rushed to the dungeon as She-Ra followed after to check and make sure nothing else was going on and no one was following them. They saw the prisoners were gone in the Dungeons and were greeted by several large Horde bots instead. The three battled them off and searched the dungeon. They had no clue where they could have entered and how the prisoners got ahold of or signaled for the Fright Zone to bail them out!

Rushing around, they left to see the damage that has been done to the hamlet outside.

Fires were started; people were frantically rushing for safety as more Bots came to destroy anything in their way. She was ruthlessly blasting vendor tents, carts and bursting holes into people's houses. In fear, she took a step back, thinking of her next move. *Fleeing the castle is dangerous! Hiding here is also dangerous! People are scared, and I'm not close to Adora or anyone who can help me!* She looked down at her trembling hands, her wings shaking in fear as she realized how cowardly she was acting. She knew she was a coward, too afraid to fight; *this was wrong*. She tried to shake herself out of it. She had no connection to the Moonstone, and if she used all her magic, she would be even more defenseless. She ran back to the balcony and saw innocent civilians being corralled by the bots and armored horde soldiers. She stepped back, frightened. What could she do?

She clutched her first and closed her eyes tightly. Innocent people were below here, and if these were the people of Brightmoon, she would fight for them. These people deserve that too; she had the upper hand to fly; she can attack from the sky with light beams and take out the bots and soldiers. That will give the citizens time to flee. Angella exhaled and pulled her hair back. She ascended from the balcony and took flight.

With a loud cry, she blasted two blue beams of light from her fists to hit two bots. Missing both bots with her attacks and almost harming the citizens, she flew down closer to the ground to try a

second attack. The second her fists lit up again; she felt an unbearable pain on her back.

"AHHHHH" she had been shot directly in the wings with a laser beam. The pure agonizing energy disintegrated her wings from her back and fell to the concrete ground. They were knocking her out cold. The crowd of people looked on in horror as the Queen of Birghtmoon—died? Before them.

Catra and Adora looked around the collapsed dungeon. The stones hot from explosives, and they searched through the rumble to find clues. Teary-eyed, Scorpia looked through the destruction while her wife looked on in concern for her. Catra walking over to place a hand on her shoulder, "We'll find him," she assured her. She-Ra smiled warmly at the affectionate sign of concern Catra was having, a true breakthrough for her former friend. The three heard another rumble and looked up to see the ceiling was collapsing in on them. She-Ra quickly drew the Sword of protection into a shield and yelled as she manifested a mighty power to clear an explosion around them, remove the debris of anything rumble collapsing on them. Once the ceiling entire collapsed, the three tried to make their way out of the mess. She was moving in haste as they needed to locate the prisoners. The moment they finally left from the chaos inside the castle, they were greeted by the wreckage of the Horde's invasion. Octavia and Grizzlor were tied up in front of several Horde soldiers while bots attempted to surround them. In a rage, Scorpia angrily charged at the bots and swiftly destroyed them. Catra and She-

Ra made a charge over to Grizzlor and Octavia, easily defeating the guards and untying them.

Octavia rubbed her head and informed them, “They took Sabara to a tank. They are heading to the Crimson waste.”

She-Ra and Catra glimpsed at each other in confusion.

Scorpia asked, “Why?”

Grizzlor replied, “They want him to use the Black Garnet.”

Scorpia shook her head in disbelief. “He—he can’t! None of us can use the Black Garnet! Only—”

A growling dark voice interrupted, “Only I can” a familiar voice ran a chill down Catra and She-Ra’s spine as they turned to see Shadow Weaver behind them.

The five gasped in disbelief to see the sorceress behind. A cracked mask and her hair were no longer flowing with power. She looked shorter in stature without the Black Garnet’s power. Catra extended out her claws and lunged at her former guardian. Angrily shouting, “What are you doing here!?”

Shadow Weaver did not flinch as Catra came closer to her; anything Catra might have down was throated by She-Ra. In a moment of weakness, she transformed back into Adora and asked in the same fearful tone: “Why are you here?”

Catra growled and pushed off Adora angrily. We were walking back to Scorpia.

The sorceress placed her hands together and calmly explained, “Hordak has a plan to cross-dimensional lines. He needs all the Runestone of each Kingdom to do so. With the alliance disbanded throughout Etheria, he has launched a full invasion on Birghtmoon and here. He plans to go the Crimson waste to us some First One's tech to create the portal he needs to succeed.”

The three looked on in horror at what she had just explained.

Catra scolded, “Your lying! I was the second in command! I would have known about a plan to go into other dimensions!”

She curtly replied, “Well. Hordak did not trust you enough with that detailed information.”

Scorpia held Catra back from lunging forward again.

Adora spoke up, “This can’t be the rest of the army. We took out only a few bots and soldiers?”

Shadow Weaver confirmed, “This was only the closest regime. You still have to brace for six others, as do most other Kingdoms.”

Scorpia asked, “Why are you telling us all this?”

The former commander walked closer to her and Catra and replied, “Hordak will destroy us all. He needs to be stopped.”

Catra growled, “Oh? What now he needs to be stopped? You were his second in command for years! You're telling me now that you're out of power, he needs to go?”

She turned to Catra and, behind her mask, smirked and answered. “If it were a simple war, Catra, he would not need much help in being defeated with you in command, but he has always had bigger plans.”

Catra’s face looked deeply hurt by her words. Adora frowned at this exchange; even with all this time apart, Shadow Weaver is still just as unnecessarily rotten to Catra and every chance she can take.

Adora’s eyes went wide as she saw Kyle rush to her in her line of vision. “Adora!” he cried. “The Queen! She’s hurt!”

Adora's eyes teared up, and she ran with him to see Angella. She thought she was injured inside the castle, but he brought her outside to where the royal quarters could see the rest of the Kingdom. There she saw Angella on her side. Unconscious and without her wings, Adora tried to shake her awake, only to be stopped by a Scorpion medic from the castle.

"Her injuries are severe, and she can't be moved right away."

Adora looked on the verge of sobbing at what she was looking at. The sight of someone she swore to protect laying on the ground in pain. Everyone else came to see Angella in this state.

Shadow Weaver—even with her mask on—seemed taken back on seeing Angella here.

"What is she doing here?" Shadow Weaver asked.

Catra snapped at her, so Adora didn't have to. "You're the last person to ask that!"

Dismissing Catra's outburst, Shadow Weaver came to Adora's distress and informed her, "The Sword of protection. It can heal,"

"I don't know how!" tears ran down her cheeks—taking Catra back at the sight of Adora's tears. The blonde was never one for crying. The only time was when she was deeply disappointed in

herself and was terribly upset at Shadow Weaver; seeing Adora cry over a woman she has known for only a year hurt Catra in a way she didn't want to be reminded of.

Shadow Weaver moved forward and gestured towards Sword. Instructing her, "Transform, and I will show you……."

Later into the evening

Catra paced around their room. The castle: still irreparably damaged from explosions, talked to her wife.

"She just showed up out of nowhere—literally! —right behind us, just to help!? Help Adora with Angella! Now she's just giving out Horde information like it's no big deal and acting like she isn't the worst person ever to exist!"

Scorpia sat on the bed and saw Catra was deeply distressed. She knew the feline had a lot of emotional baggage when it came to Shadow Weaver, and the treatment she always gave Adora was unfairly out of balance. The cruelty of Shadow Weaver favored Adora for her talents and never acknowledge how hard of a worker or cadet Catra was upsetting.

Even the fearful knowledge that her father was out in the Crimson waste alone and injured made her upset. She pushed aside her feeling for her wife to comfort her.

She sat up to attempt to hug Catra. Telling her, "We're going to figure this out,"

Too emotionally drained to protest the affection, Catra hugged back and looked up into her wife's eyes. *Scorpia cares.* Catra thought. Her eyes closed as she tilted her head; Scorpia was shocked when she realized Catra was initiating a kiss. Accepting it, the two had their lips touch and shared in a kiss for several seconds until the door to their bedroom swung open. The unpleasant sight of Shadow Weaver, Adora as She-Ra, and Octavia, looking in on them from the doorway. A private moment that was uncomfortably interrupted. Shadow Weaver held no regard to Catra's feelings, just spoke up, "Oh? You two are together?" She turned to Adora and thoughtlessly commented, "I always assumed you would have taken her,"

Adora's face burned at the insinuation. The Octavia looked away in awkward silence. It was something she didn't want to hear. As much as Catra was a pain as a child, she didn't deserve *that*.

Catra pulled away and asked, "when you lost your powers, did you lose the ability to knock?"

Only a smug grunt came from Shadow Weaver as she entered the room to explain, "I know you want to lash out at me, but Adora can assure that my intentions are good. Hordak is deploying all

his resources out of the Fright Zone to launch invasions throughout Etheria to get to the Runestones. We need to protect them to prevent his plan."

Catra asked, "Why have good intentions when all you've ever done is think about yourself? What good does it do you know to help anyone?"

Shadow Weaver placed her hands together. "I AM. Still thinking of myself, do not doubt that! there will be no place for me in the world under the Horde, so assisting my wards in saving Etheria is something greatly beneficial for me."

Catra soft "So only when people are useful to you is when you care about them?"

Shadow Weaver curtly replied, "Who said anything about care?.."

Adora stepped in. "Shadow Weaver, please? We need to explain the plan," She turned to Catra and Scorpia to explain, "We are going to call the alliance and tell them what is going on. Glimmer is going back to Brightmoon along with all the princesses returning to their Kingdoms. I'm going to the Crimson waste to stop Hordak from getting ahold of whatever he is looking for; I need you to help stay here with Scorpia and watch over this Kingdom. It's the first that is going to be attacked, and we need people here safe."

Catra glared at Adora. Even as She-Ra, standing taller than her and Scorpia, she couldn't shake the feeling of being talked down to. The person who always was the best of the best was now hero-explaining a mission to her—telling her to stand her ground and let Adora fix everything, all. At the same time, shadow Weaver gets the accolade of being the guardian to the hero of Etheria.

Scorpia could tell Catra was upset by all this. She knew how much Catra hated to be talked down to. Before Scorpia could say anything, Catra just sighed and said, "Fine, go off and be the hero, us little people will stay here,"

Adora's expression turned to hurt as she tried to explain to Catra is had nothing to do about her playing the hero; shadow Weaver grabbed her arm and scolded, "Don't fuss over her," she directed her attention to Catra as she condescendingly offered, "Thank you for not being as difficult as you normally are,"

The two left the room and Octavia, and Scorpia's eyes met, both saddened by the cruel way Shadow Weaver spoke to Catra.

Once the two were alone, Catra angrily threw her helmet off. Distressed, Scorpia tried to comfort her. Only to be shoved away as Catra dashed to the bathroom to cry in privacy.

Adora was shocked by all of this; her worries were split into so many different directions: the war, the Horde, Hordak, Catra, and Angella…….

She made her way back to her private quarters she shared with Angella. The Queen is resting on her stomach. Still fast asleep from the healing. Although she healed any significant injury the Queen had suffered from her fall, she could not restore her powers. Her wings were still gone, bandages all around her chest and back, the side of her face was still severely scratched up from the fall. A giant bandage was over her right cheek and under her chin. Her left wrist was wrapped up as she lightly sprained it.

Adora sat down sadly next to Angella to watch her sleep. The Queen's expression was pained in her slumber. Adora felt horrible for leaving her alone; whatever happened or whatever compelled Angella to attempt to fight troubled her.

She opened her communicator pad and left to the living room to talk to Glimmer.

Instantly greeting her was Glimmer on the other line; it looked like she was in the tent and looked upset. Adora shakingly asked, "Glimmer?"

Glimmer tried to push through a fake smile as she replied, "Hi, Adora."

Adora gulped as she asked, “I want to let you know what’s going on. We received some upsetting news today about the Horde,”

Glimmer’s forced a smile changed to a frown as she replied, “So did we.”

Adora asked, “Do—do you want me to tell you—”

Glimmer cut her off and asked, “Why weren’t you with me, mom!?”

Adora blinked. “Huh? How did you—what did you find out,”

Bow came into the frame behind Glimmer and handed her an extra communicator pad. Glimmer then turned the screen to show Adora a five-second clip-on loop of Angella being shot with a laser beam from a Horde Tank. Adora’s eyes went wide. She had not been aware of a video from the Horde on Angella’s injury. Adora was speechless as Glimmer angrily shouted at her, “The Horde sent it to us! Not just us, but all the royals in Etheria were sent this video from a messenger bot! they say the Scorpion Kingdom is under Horde control again, and they are coming for the rest of Etheria!”

“Glimmer, I—”

“How could you let this happen!? Letting my mom fight?! She isn’t a fighter! She has been paralyzed with fear during this entire war, and you just left her alone to attempt an airstrike on her own!?”

Adora’s hands trembled as she tried to explain, “Glimmer! Please, that isn’t what—”

Glimmer started to go off on Adora again. This time being hurtful, she yelled at her friend, “Do you have any idea how much my mother means to Birghtmoon!? She is a symbol of grace and longevity! People in Brightmoon lose their fucking minds when they see my mom in person! And now all those people saw a video of their Queen—My mother! Fall to her—what they all assume—Death! I trusted you to keep her safe! I told her you would help her and—”

Adora felt a hand snatch her communicator from behind her. The exhausted and pained look on her face as she took the communicator away to have it face her instead of Adora. The blonde felt her blood run cold. *How long was Angella listening?*

She didn’t bother to primp herself up for the video call. Bandages and all, she wanted her to see Angella was not some frail little dove that couldn’t handle a scuffle. Facing her daughter, she saw the look of absolute shock on her face. The Bow was behind her as well. Angella didn’t intend for anyone else to be in the frame and quickly covered her bandaged chest. Lump instantly jumped out of frame, flushed to Angella—almost—shirtless.

Glimmer gasped. “Mom?”

Angella scolded her, “Do not speak to Adora in that way. This was not her fault.”

“Then who? Why were you in the air flying?”

“I was trying to assist in helping civilians during the invasion.”

A pause came over the two as Glimmer drank in the sight of her severely injured mother. Bandages on her face, chin, neck, and shoulders, wrapping all around her torso. Her wings were gone, and seeing her mother without them made her look like a different person.

Glimmer fought back the tears as she insisted, “You need to be back here! I’m going back to Brightmoon with Spinnerella and Netossa. We’re going to fight off the invasion like we did last time; you need to come home and recharge your powers.”

Angella didn’t protest to that critical detail. Her powers were all used up, and she did need the Moonstone to regenerate her wings. The Queen did sternly reply, “I shall return when we have taken care of the crisis here; an attack for this Kingdom is on it is way, and we are needed here.”

Glimmer growled, “Adora might be, but not you. Mom, you need to come home! You can’t fight! You're not a fighter.”

Angella stood her ground on the matter. “I can’t leave just yet, and I need you to be strong and care for Brightmoon in my absence. Is that clear? Commander Glimmah?”

Glimmer sucked in a breath and nodded. “Understood, your majesty” her tone was cold.

Angella replied, “Good. Would you like to speak with Adora now?”

She sharply replied, “No. We don’t need to speak. If everyone knows the plan, then they don’t have to prolong a conversation. Intel came from the Fright Zone about the oncoming invasion, and we all need to prepare.”

“That is correct, we all do,”

Glimmer didn’t say anything on the matter as she flatly “Goodbye, mom, I’ll see you in Brightmoon when this is all over.”

“Yes, darling, you will.”

With that, the communicator disconnected the call.

Placing it down on the table, Angella turned to see tears falling from Adora's eyes. The blonde hero had failed her best friend. Angella could have died, and it would of all been Adora's fault.

Angella moved closer to her. Too sore from wrapping an arm around her, she offered a sincere "I'm so sorry for this, Adora. I never wanted to cause discord between you and Glimmah."

Adora didn't look up as she spoke, "You could have died. I was so scared."

Angella felt all the shame of her predicament flood her mind. She had upset Adora, her daughter, and Kingdom. Not to mention she had humiliated herself throughout Etheria. If a video was sent to all the Kingdoms, it meant it was a public communication. Meaning every single person with access to the communicator saw Angella almost fall to her death. As miserable as that was, she worried for Adora and Sabara in all of this. They had no idea of what Sabara's condition was. A war was directly at their doorsteps, and she was in enemy territory, far from home. She was scared beyond scared. She wanted to keep a brave face but couldn't manage it. Tears fell from her eyes, too, as she looked down at her lip. Her shoulders bounced a little as she sobbed, and she pleaded with Adora, "Please forgive me for this. I only wanted to help."

She didn't hold back her emotions as the two women, without looking at each other, were both tearfully look down at their laps.

Their door slammed open as Catra dashed in. Tears running down her face as she explained, “We need to make a different game plan! We just got the news that the tank harboring King Sabara was taken captive by pirates in the Crimson waste! We need to get to deploy a recovery squad!”

The two looked to Catra and Scorpia. All four women were deeply emotional about all that was occurring. Shadow Weaver did not take long to follow in without asking, and seeing all four women in tears made her sigh. *I raised them better than to cry.*

Catra wiped her eyes and explained, “I’m going to send out Lonnie, the boys, and Octavia to the Crimson waste for intel. I want Adora to go with me to figure out what’s in the Crimson waste,”

Shadow Weaver let out another sigh of disproval. “I already told you that would be a waste. Sabara is as good as dead. Take Lonnie and the others to be intel and let Adora go back to Brightmoon with Angella. It is the only way to guard all Runestones,”

Catra snapped back, “We need to find out what is going on in the Crimson waste!”

“They took my father!” Scorpia cried.

Shadow Weaver threw her hands up and explained, “They did it to retain a member of the monarchy; they would have taken you or Catra if they knew you two had a shame marriage.”

Scorpia defended, “Our marriage is valid!”

Shadow Weaver narrowed her eyes. “Oh yes, you two had a perfectly healthy and normal romantic relationship before had; yes, you two were the best of friends,” she said, looking over to Adora slowly. Before upsetting anyone further, she started to back away to explain, “I’ll be in the remnants of what I assume was a meeting room. Please make finish up crying so we can come up with a plan to stop Hordak,”

Leaving them, Octavia stepped in only to say, “I’ll do whatever I can,” looking at Scorpia and then glancing over nervously at Catra. The tension that had filled the room made her uneasy, and she left right after.

Angella stood up and proclaimed, “Adora should be able to accompany you in the Crimson waste. While I remain here.”

Adora turned to Angella and took her hands into her own “I don’t want to leave you again,”

Angella assured her, “I promise I won’t act irrationally,”

Scorpia offered, “I’m coming too; I need to make sure my father is okay,”

Catra informed, “Then I’ll go too,”

Scorpia asked, “I want you to stay here to run the Kingdom, you know more about the Horde army, and you have a way with my people that makes them respect you, I want you to lead the Kingdom through the invasion because I know you can protect them.”

Catra was surprised Scorpia had that much faith in her.

Adora and Angella were unaware they had been holding hands this whole time and looked at each other and blushed before Adora cleared her throat and asked, “Would you be okay staying here with Catra?”

Angella nodded and turned to the feline royal. “Does that work for you?”

Catra shrugged and crossed her arms. “It’s fine, just don’t expect any special treatment from me.”

Adora stood up. “Then it’s decided; Scorpia and I will get ready for the Crimson waste,” the two looked at each, and Scorpia nodded. “I’ll get my land cruiser, and we’ll head out soon,”

Catra and Scorpia exited the room. Leaving Angella and Adora alone again, the princess of power looked at her Queen. Battled scared from the earlier events, Angella stood up and reached out for Adora. "I will be okay here, on my own," she embraced her, Adora assured her, "Catra is here too; everyone here loves you—you'll be safe until I get back, I promise,"

Angella moved to place her hands on Adora's face and kissed her forehead. "Please don't let Glimmer's words upset you. This is my fault, and I will deal with her. Just please be safe on your journey,"

Adora nodded and smiled at her—her eyes now fixed on Angella's head jewelry. The Queen asked, "Are you looking at my forehead or my gemstone?"

Adora bit her lip at the question; Angella knew the answer "Did you want to kiss my forehead too?"

Adora then focused on Angella's lips, and they shared a brief kiss on the lips. Same as earlier in the night. For the second time, they displayed affection without the boundaries of what it was, to be precise. The emotions they both had been confusing. In this significant time of distress, they needed comfort, even if it was unclear where the two stood in their relationship. A kiss from the Queen was exclusive. For grounds as to why Adora was getting them were vague. For them, it did not matter at this moment. Right now, A mission was set.

Twenty minutes passed, and Catra and the rest of the Horde soldiers that pledged to serve the Scorpion Kingdom watched as Adora and Scorpia made their way to Scorpia's ship. A black Scorpion-shaped flying cruiser. She gave an uncomfortable look at it as she remembered it from the Princess prom incident.

Before leaving, she turned to wave goodbye to everyone. Lonnie, Kyle, Rogelio, Octavia, Grizzlor, Angella, and Catra. Her gaze is ignoring Shadow Weaver in the process. Catra approached her; her former friend wanted to say something sweet and endearing; knowing all too well that Catra wasn't entirely they're on that level of emotional openness, she acted the felines arm punch and her saying "Don't screw up,"

Adora smiled and promised her. Catra walked up to her wife, looking behind her shoulder for a second at the crowd behind. He was embarrassed that she was going to have to kiss her wife with an audience again. Scorpia gave her a warm smile. Knowing Catra's shyness towards affection, she didn't advance. Catra knowing Scorpia would appreciate a kiss before going off on a mission. The shorter wife got into her wife's embrace and stood up on her tiptoes to kiss Scorpia. A small *aww* came from Kyle before Lonnie nudged him. The two partings as Catra turned and attempted to clear her throat. She was covering her mouth in an attempt to hide her blush. The taller royal smiled at her and cleared her throat to make an announcement.

"Can I have everyone's attention, please?"

Everyone watched her as she spoke, “As the heir to the Kingdom, I appointment my wife, Catra, to Queen and highest authority in the Kingdom. You may address her as her majesty in my absence and continue after I return.”

Catra looked shocked at this statement. A spouse to a royal would only be given that title under an equal or higher authority. Scorpia smiled at her before turning and leaving with Adora as much as Scorpia. It threw Catra into anxiety with shadow Weaver being close to her to chastise her every move.

With a brave face, she turned back to the onlookers and explained, “We have to prepare for the invasion.”

Double Crossed

In everyone's brave actions came the consequence of fear.

Catra feared her new role, the role of being the highest-ranked leader in a foreign land meant she was responsible for the safety of all its citizens. To protect and nurture people was not her most vital feature. Her aggression and rage were able to get her to bully her way to where she was now; as a mission leader. She was mean and cold to her fellow Horde soldiers; now, she was expected to be compassionate and prepare civilians for battle. She needed to be softer to them to make her stance as a leader clear with them. Instead of this putting her at ease, she now felt weak. She needed compassion, and due to being robbed of it her whole life, she couldn't give it to people who deserved it. She wished Scorpia didn't leave. She wanted her around. Not just support, Catra is just now realizing how much she misses her and wants to be around her. The feeling of love wasn't ever there before. Even if Catra really couldn't say she loved Scorpia, she can at least now say she does have feelings for her.

Her feelings were also conflicted by Shadow Weaver's unwanted presence. The wicked woman was now involved in the Scorpion Kingdoms' future, and many locals were not happy. It didn't make things better on how ex-horde members were the central core of the Kingdom's population, and the thought of neighbors turning against neighbors was a very realistic fear.

Catra mentally prepared herself for this morning's briefing. First, a meeting with commanders, then town folks, and an action plan to defend against the invasion would be put into effect. But, in her room, she felt exhausted. Sitting on the bed in her pajamas of a

Horde issues sports bra and shorts with the Horde logo cut out, she contemplated what to do.

Same as Angella. In several rooms away, Angella let the grave reality of her situation sink in. She was playing the Horde propaganda message on loop. The humiliating slow-motion video of her being hit with a laser blast and falling. The words in giant, bold red print saying "Brightmoon has fallen and so will the other Kingdoms" the message was clear; people thought she was lost a battle in Birghtmoon. Support and relief for her subjects are not limited due to people believing the Horde had already successfully invaded Brightmoon. She worried for her people and felt the shame and regret of her irrational thinking. All these years, she had been responsible, and yesterday was the one day she wasn't, and she made a fool of herself. She almost got herself killed, and everyone on Etheria knew it.

She wished to get her mind off of the incident. It was embarrassing for her to know that she made such a blunder on camera. Everyone has been concerned for her and does not hold her in ill regard due to her mistake.

A knock on her door came, and she had somehow hoped it would be Catra; knowing the newly crowned Queen had such a young sass to her that it would take her mind off of things, opening the door, she instantly soured her face at the sight of the former Horde Commander. Shadow weaver's mask most likely hid a gleeful smile. Seeing Angella in bandages must be a sight she had longed for since her time in the Horde. With no desire for formalities, she coldly greeted her "Shadow Weaver."

The Sorceress with a larger than average-sized communicator pad made her way into the room without permission, smugly replying with "Angella of Brightmoon.

An insult to not address Angella by her title, enough to make Angella reply with "That is Queen Angella to you,"

Shadow Weaver sat on the couch and coyly replied, "According to your Kingdom, you aren't even alive yet alone their Queen,"

She offered Angella her communicator pad and remarked, "This is what the Horde used to see what the alliance Kingdoms were doing. According to your Kingdom, the people are devastated. For someone who is rarely ever seen, the castle is flooded with subjects looking to your daughter for answers,"

Angella saw the front gate of the Brightmoon castle on the screen and what appeared to be a line of her subjects. The sight of this hurt Angella; her foolishness now caused her people to despair. To put this on them and her precious Glimmer made her hate herself for it all.

Shadow Weaver spared no feelings as she reminded Angella of Micah "When it was announced that Micha has perished, all Etheria mourned. It was a poor calculation on the Horde's part to exile him to Beast Island. I told Hordak he should have remained a prisoner, but he feared the magic Micah had sent him to die. I recall Mystacor and Brightmoon grieved for weeks. It was such a sad sight," she watched Angella's hurt expression border on tears

as she cruelly finished. “His line of mourners were much larger than yours seem to be,”

Angella handed the communicator pad back to her and demanded she leaves. Devastated by all this news, she locked herself in her room to weep. She felt so ashamed of how she let so many people down. Her subjects were dear to her and to know she had hurt them made her feel awful. She always wanted to be a better Queen than her mother; Archella was posh and arrogant and didn’t pay any mind to most of the infrastructure in Birghtmoon outside of the Castle. Plus, she overtaxed the people to where Brightmoon became less populated by difficulty. When Angella was crowned ruler, she changed all that, and in her short reign, she was beloved by her people. She became even more cherished when announcing that she and Micah were to be married. After having Glimmer, Brightmoon became one of the largest and wealthiest Kingdoms in Etheria.

In despair, she knew she had messed up and needed to make things right. But, first, she had to straighten herself up and address her people. She wanted to announce her wellness and promise her people that things were going to be okay.

She left her room to find Catra and the others. She had to use whatever was left of the war room to make a video announcement. She hoped she would not run into Shadow Weaver again after her taunting from moments ago. Instead, the former Mystacor Sorceress was turning her cruelty towards Catra again.

Angella was seconds from walking into the war room when she heard Shadow Weaver speak to Catra in such a strange manner.

It was far from praise, but it must have been something like praise for Catra.

Angella stood silent as she listened in from the other side of the door.

"Catra… Look at you—a Queen through marriage through a defeated Kingdom. I don't think you ever saw yourself doing this at eighteen. But…. Here you are….."

The way Shadow Weaver spoke to people made Angella sick. Her fists clenched as she heard the words of Shadow Weaver's constant beratement.

"You now have a Kingdom. While Adora goes off and plays hero, you finally have an opportunity to show your worth. While the Alliance is disbanded, you can fight off the Horde and turn your attention to Birghtmoon."

Angella felt her heart race as she heard Shadow Weaver suggest to Catra to launch an invasion. The Queen didn't know what to do. She never handled conflict well. In-person, she could be sharp and witty; in this case, she felt fearful. She wished Adora was here with her right now.

She only hoped Adora's mission was going okay.

It was not going poorly; Scorpia and Adora arrived in a record time to the Crimson Waste. No issues were to be had, except that Scorpia and Adora were never alone until this point. They were making for some painfully awful conversations.

One is going as far as.

"I don't know what it is about you, but I never liked you. At all. I mean, I like everyone, but ever since I met you when I was eleven, I never, ever, liked you." Scorpia said. I was poorly timed as the two were finally in the Crimson Waste. Adora wishes she didn't have to hear Scorpia tell her how much she didn't like her while searching for old First One's tech.

Adora could only cross her arms. "I never even talked to you."

"I know you were always kissing up to the Force Captains since Shadow Weaver gave you keys to the skiffs and the Captains lounge, but you were shallow since you were a kid."

Adora let out an offended gasp. "Shallow!? Seriously! Name one time I was ever shallow!"

Scorpia paused and rephrased, “I guess shallow wouldn’t be the best way to describe you…. I guess you are more of a bully than anything,”

Adora was at a loss for words at the idea that Scorpia would consider her a bully. She has never done anything ever to be considered a bully.

Adora demanded, “Name one time I ever acted like a bully!”

Scorpia seemingly had a list prepared for her. Without missing a beat, she recalled all the times Adora’s overachieving nature came off as bullying. “You never let any other squad win a match, not even a practice match, you constantly kissed up to Shadow Weaver and the other officer to more chores to do, which made everyone else suffer, you never stuck up for Catra when she got bullied, and you pretended to be her best friend—”

Adora cut her off and practically shouted, “I never let Catra get bullied! She was bullied around me!”

Scorpia didn’t even look at Adora as she coldly replied, “Remember the who would die first in the battle survey? Or the time Shadow Weaver said Catra was in heat in front of everyone? She’s been bullied by other members of the Horde her whole life. Yet, for some best friend, you never did anything about it.”

Adora was speechless as she remembered Lonnie and other cadets wrote that Catra and Kyle would most likely die or get injured in battle first. She had no idea Catra took it to heart. The heat comment was made by Shadow Weaver passingly when Catra wasn't paying attention during a drill. The Sorceress remarked in front of only a few people who snickered at it. Adora didn't think anything of it, Catra stormed off, but she didn't know the feline was upset by it.

Adora frowned and looked away Scorpia. She sure knew how to devastate Adora in only a few examples for someone she never talked to. Was Adora all that bad of a friend? Has she ever been a bad friend to the other princesses? Is she a bad friend to Glimmer for liking Angella?

The ship came to a halt as Scorpia rolled down the window to talk to someone. A local was passing by the boat, looking at it with curiosity as Scorpia innocently asked, "Excuse me, have you seen any old ships around here? namely, anything that looks like it's from another planet?"

Adora facepalmed at Scorpia's antics. The Scorpion queen gasps in the offense as she rolls back up the window to the cruiser. "He flipped me off! Seriously! He gave me the middle finger for asking a question. Who does that – AHHH!!!"

Both her and Adora scream while a man with a knife in hand jumped on the front windshield of the Scorpion cruiser and yelled at them. Panicked by the assault, Scorpia put on the windshield wipers to see if that would get him off.

Adora shouted, “The windshield wipers!? Really!?”

Scorpia then backed the cruiser up, only to hit the sand cruiser behind them. They were causing the bandits who were following them without their knowledge to get out. With the cruiser surrounded by bandits, Scorpia and Adora had no other option but to fight them off.

Both nodded to each other in mutual understanding that they needed to act fast. Adora transformed into She-Ra, and Scorpia jumped out of the cruiser to sting several bandits.

She-Ra used her sword to destroy any weapon the other bandits wheeled in their hands. Once the bandits realized they were no match, they fled.

The Princess of Power smiled at the Scorpion Queen. They had only entered the Crimson Waste when this all happened; they got back in the cruiser to look around some more. When they reached a spot where there was a canteen ahead, and parked the cruiser outside and went in. Scorpia gulped at the rough crowd inside while Adora didn’t seem to mind and just stood up on a table and asked, “Hey, hello, umm, I’m Adora, and we’re wondering if anyone has seen a first one ship? The Horde is on its way, and we need to stop them.”

Scorpia cringed at Adora’s forwardness; she knew if Catra were here, she would have been stealthier. Scorpia missed Catra, it might have only been less than a day, but she did wish she could be with her wild cat.

Catra wished she had someone to turn to the right about now. With Shadow Weaver's words burning into her mind, she worried about what to do. She needed to confide in someone, and she didn't trust anyone here. It didn't matter how close she had started to get with Lonnie, Kyle, and Rogelio; the fact still stood that they were her subordinates, and she didn't want to show weakness in front of them. Octavia and Grizzlor were considered her superiors and her equal, but she didn't have faith in their input. Although shadow Weaver had a plan, she also came with the baggage of being hurtful and messing with Catra. She couldn't trust Shadow Weaver after what happened in the Fright Zone. No one knows that Shadow Weaver escaped as her prisoner. Seeing here now to come for Adora was like a painful wound being torn open, and even with Shadow Weaver being invested in Catra's title and authority, she knew it meant nothing. The desire for approval was not coming true. She knew Shadow Weaver only wanted to use her, and it hurt.

She had no older mentor figure to look to, no mother figure, or wiser and mature person to seek out when she needed it. In her loneliness and rage, she threw her red tiara down and sobbed out of anger. The bitter loneliness she suffered was nothing unfamiliar. She hated herself wanting companionship. She needed Scorpia with her right now, and she couldn't have her; she needed to be strong and brave for a Kingdom. A whole population of people needed her, and she didn't know how to handle it all. Two days ago, she felt powerful and fearless and, in only forty minutes alone with Shadow Weaver, made her feel just as worthless as she did as a cadet. In the shadow of Adora's greatness, she was nothing more than second best, and Shadow Weaver reminder her of that.

Adora will be the hero she was destined to be, the Horde soldiers assigned to you will follow her or Scorpia to the needed route of survival. You will be left alone if you do not take the charge you have always craved. Seize this Kingdom and Brightmoon during the conflict. With two Runestones of Power, you will never know powerlessness again. With me by your side, you will be a force that Hordak with regret, ever letting go. Think of it, you and I—a duo genuinely deserving of our time to lead—haven't we both given are all? Haven't we suffered enough being the shadows of those who were always destined to do better than us?

Catra felt gutted by all her emotions and doubted all her relationships. She and the defected Horde soldiers seemed to have gotten along better, now that they weren't in the Fright Zone anymore, but they could quickly turn on her if it were a matter of survival. If she fails at keeping the Kingdom safe, then she will lose the respect of everyone. Even the love of Scorpia, if she isn't careful, wouldn't be able to be forgiven by Scorpia if the Kingdom fell due to Catra.

Her thoughts were cut short by a knock on the door came. She jumped, feeling it could be Lonnie or Shadow Weaver. She sniffed the air to see if the familiar scent could be recognized. To her surprise, it was the elegant lavender smell of Angella from behind the door. Why the hell would she want to talk to her? Angella has diplomat statues; all she needs to do is hide in her room. Especially after her little hero stunt, no one asks her to do anything except not make an ass out of herself again.

Catra put her tiara back on to answer the door. Hoping her eyes didn't betray her and show the visible remnants of tears.

Opening the door, Catra had her arms crossed to show she had no interest in opening to Angella in any other way than to hear what she wanted to say. But, before the door opened, Catra thought of something mean to say to Angella to clarify that she was not a person to mess with. If she didn't dare to do it, Shadow Weaver, she would at least punch down and do it, Angella.

The Queen of Brightmoon was in front of Catra with a tray in hand her arms. On the tray were a tea set and some treats. Something completely unexpected. Catra blinked in confusion as to why Angella was even here. Looking at the Queen, she opened her mouth to speak, but the words couldn't come out. She was just so taken back by this random nice gesture, and it was something Catra never really experienced.

Angella softly as "As one Queen to another, may I come in? Speak with you for a moment? So much is going on, and I would appreciate the time with another royal."

Catra just let her in. Only offering a soft "Sure."

The older Queen knew how to break down walls. She was a master in conflict resolution in her Kingdom; being the peacekeeper in her Kingdom, she knew where Catra's weaknesses were. She wanted to feel important and valued, Catra has worked to give herself a title and the respect of others; addressing Catra by her title and making her feel equal to her was a way to break down Catra's walls. She intended to see the real Catra without

the gruff and grit. It would be manipulative if it weren't because she had no intention to use or abuse Catra. She knew this child was in pain, suffering from the trauma of the life she had due to Shadow Weaver and the Horde, and all Angella wanted to do was be supportive of someone who needed it. Even if it might seem like Angella only wanted to be helpful to someone, she felt sorry for, and it wasn't true. Angella genuinely cared for these people and cared for Catra.

The young Queen didn't know how to respond to this gesture of kindness from the older Queen.

Angella placed the tea down on a small table. Catra question, "How are you feeling?"

The Queen sat down and looked at Catra. "I'm still sore. My wings will regenerate once I return to the Moonstone Chamber. But, for now, I will be fine. I regret not being formidable against the attack on the castle; aside from that, my Kingdom thinks I'm dead, and everyone is treating me like I'm made of porcelain. I'm not sure if you have ever had a blunder televised throughout Etheria; I can assure you it is not a great feeling."

Now the direction of the conversation was in Catra's control. After opening up to the feline Queen, Catra could easily be dismissive and snarky to Angella for her vulnerability, or she could engage and find common ground to relate to her. She didn't want to take Catra's emotions for a ride; she only wanted to see if Catra would have a normal conversation with her.

Which she did; Catra sat down next to her and replied, "I know the feeling. Captain Cobalt made a video tutorial of Adora and me doing a drill routine. I was the example of how *no to* fight a princess bot, while Adora successfully fought a princess bot. It wasn't very comfortable, and I just had to pretend I didn't care. Even if I said anything different, I still would have been the butt of the joke."

Angella frowned. "The Horde isn't kind to any of their talent, are they?"

Talent. She used the word to assure Catra she had value and worth.

Catra nodded. "Yeah, they pretty much mistreated everyone. Even the top Force Captains get shitted on when something goes wrong. Why do you think Octavia and Grizzlor are here? They failed their last missions and got stuck on this mission with me because of that. They didn't even go rouge; they're just considered defective by affiliation. I don't even think they care, I know Lonnie and the boys don't. After being mistreated for so long, who would even think to remain loyal?"

Angella nodded and sipped her tea. "It's good to recognize abusive work culture. However, nothing or no one from the Fight Zone can hurt them here, and when this invasion is settled, closure can happen."

Catra shrugged and looked away. "Yeah. No one can hurt them anymore."

"No one can hurt you now, either," Angella replied.

The feline's ears twitched as she clarified, "I can still get hurt and die in the fight."

Angella set her teacup down. "That could happen, I doubt your combat skills would make that likely, but it could. Are you doubtful over the success of these defenses of this Kingdom?"

Catra took a sip of her tea and replied, "This Kingdom doesn't have its army or defense team against the Horde; their Alliance to the Horde took that all away from them years ago. These people are farmers and mechanics, not fighters. I don't even think half of them are trained for combat of any sort. The Horde always—just—took control of things. Most of these people only knew the world in which the Horde ruled, so it's tough for people to adjust to big changes."

Angella nodded. "I agree with you on that. When I was coronated, It took time for people to adjust to a new type of leadership."

Catra sipped her tea, unsure of what to say. She could ask for Angella to become a successful monarch. That would imply interest, or it could mean insecurity. Catra was still cautious on how much she could trust Angella. The foreign Queen had nothing to lose or gain by being kind or helpful to Catra. This made the feline worry that she was set up for criticism.

Against her worries, she pushed forward and asked a question she framed as an inquiry to Angella. She didn't want to look like she was seeking advice from the other Queen, so she asked her about Angella's successes as the ruler of her kingdom.

"How did you get all the people of Brightmoon to like you? You were a teenager when you took over, right?"

A smile tugged at the older women's face as she replied, "I was. I was seventeen and organizing my Princess Prom during my coordinating session."

Catra replied, "In the Horde, we had to study all the kingdoms, and we got a bunch of different backstories about each Kingdom. For example, Brightmoon lore was always depicted as a wealthy and productive society, and the Queen before you, Archella. No one liked her; why do they like you?"

Angella gulped down tea, uncertain how to answer this question. Not that it hasn't been asked before, the last time someone asked her how she would lead compared to her mother said it in a more dignified way. Brightmoon under Archella's rule was considered a dark age for Brightmoon. During her reign, she overtaxed the poor and made it so even the rich wouldn't want to live in the Kingdom. In addition, Archella was rude and not easy to work with. After she died, Angella made every change possible to fix all of Archella's destructive actions. It took her first ten years in power to regain loyalty and trust, but even with that, Brightmoon still is vastly underpopulated.

Angella knows this question was more than just an inquiry on Brightmoon history; Catra needed to know what to do next for the sake of a kingdom. With Shadow Weaver in Catra's head, her following words will carry weight on Catra, which could quickly impact her decisions to invade Brightmoon or fail the Scorpion Kingdom.

Angella answered truthfully in a way that would make her and Catra relate to one another. "I knew how I was treated as a child was something I never found to enjoy; I felt alone and isolated from the people I wanted to value me the most,"

she saw Catra's face soften almost at the thought of Angella having any relatability to her. She continued, "I knew I wanted to be better than anyone who came before; I wanted to be a leader that was adored, beyond someone who was just special by right of birth. It wasn't easy for me, but just because life was demanding, I never felt like others had to feel my pain."

Catra looked down at her tea. Internalizing what she meant, Catra was one to take her anger out on people. Something she learned from Shadow Weaver, a trait Adora never followed it. Did that make her a wrong person? A bad leader?

Angella offered, "I chose to be the exact opposite of my mother, I wanted to make people's lives better, and I knew she wouldn't have approved, but my Kingdom was more important than her insecurities. So I made choices that I knew were right for the people I would lead."

Catra nodded.

She felt she understood what Angella was trying to convey to her. Angella changed tradition and broke the cycle of what Brightmoon was once known for. Adora had done the same; instead of being a Force Captain—*like she was always told she wanted*—she became a super-powered eight-foot-tall worrier lady. Hell, Scorpia even broke the chains of her expectation of just being a trophy princess for the Horde and stepped up for her family. Catra felt her ears flatten when she realized the pattern. Angella, Adora, and Scorpia were born for greatness. Not her; Shadow Weaver never missed a moment to remind her of that.

Angella saw the sadness in Catra's body language and shared with her something very private. A crucial part of her princess hood she only shared with Micah beofre.

"I was never meant to become Queen." Angella softly said.

Catra’s ears perked up. Not due to joy but for intrigue.

Angella furthered her statement by telling her, "Immortality is not a power all Angelic beings have. It was reserved for royals only. When one Queen or King wishes to retire, the surrounding their power at the Moonstone and live the rest of their lives with mortality. My mother lived for thousands of years, outliving my father—an elderly Angelic being a man and our other family. She intended to be the last of all Angelic beings. But I grew to out

favor my mother, and when I married an Etherian man from Mystacor, she knew her time was up. So instead of keeping her Immortality and stepping down from the throne, she forced me to take her Immortality so she could perish."

Catra looked at with shock. It sounded like such a Shadow Weaver thing to do.

Catra looked down again and asked, "What would you have been if you never had to Queen?"

Angella was taken back from the question. Of all the questions she had ever been asked. She never had anyone question life without her crown.

The Queen sputtered, "I—I've never really thought about—at least—not in adulthood. As a teen, I used to enjoy teaching younger children reading. It was one of my very few times away from the castle; I supposed I would have loved to be a teacher. My husband was a teacher before marrying me. We would have loved matching careers." She felt herself smile warmly at the idea of her and Micah working in a school together or grading papers together. What a delight that life would have been.

Catra saw how happy Angella seemed to get at the thought of not being Queen. Of course, it must be a challenging job for some who is allegedly good at her job to want something different. But then again. Angella was good at her job. So, even if it isn't what she wanted, she must still have value in it.

Catra only made a flat statement, "It sucks not being able to know what you want, doesn't it?" This had more sadness than sass to her words. So clear to Angella, Catra didn't know what she wanted. How could she? An eighteen-year-old in her position shouldn't exist.

Angella nodded and sipped her tea before replying. "It does; in time, it doesn't; once you seek out what makes you happy and what you want, you won't have to feel like that anymore."

Ears still faltered down to her skull; Catra just gave Angella a scared look before Angella assured her, "You don't have to feel what others want you to. You are your person, and you worked hard for everything you have accomplished; you deserve happiness."

Catra shrugged.

Angella assured her again, "Catra, you deserve your accomplishments. You do deserve love too."

Before she could say anything further, Shadow Weaver entered the bedroom without knocking. "Catra?" the terrible mother figure called. A smug sound came from Shadow Weaver as she saw, "Oh? The Queen of Brightmoon, what a treat for you to be here with Catra. I have news for both of you."

The tension in the Scorpion Kingdom was running high.

Equally as high as the tension that came between Adora and Scorpia.

The two had dealt with bandits attacking Scorpia's vessel in the sandy streets of the slums in the Crimson Waste. Now the two were unable to drive the cruiser through the streets and had to go on foot.

Walking next to each other, Scopria gritted her teeth. "Why didn't you turn into She-Ra?"

Adora spat back, "Why didn't you sting those guys?"

Scorpia "My stinger isn't some endless supply, you know?"

Adora crossed her arms. "Well, neither is She-Ra; besides, we need to keep a low profile."

"We can in on Scorpion-shaped cruiser! How low do you think we could have been?"

Adora stomped her foot as she stopped. "Well, I wasn't the one to pick out the ship! So why are you like this?"

"My dad is gone!"

"We're here to get him back!"

"He might be dead!"

Adora remained silent as she looked down in shame, knowing she couldn't relate to Scorpia's feelings. She apologized. "Sorry, I know this is hard for you."

Scorpia's anger softened from Adora. The former child soldier would never know what having a parent was like. Even if Scorpia's time with her family was limited, at least she knew them. Adora never knew her parents. She sighed and told Adora, "I know you can't relate, I'm apprehensive about him, and I don't even know where to go to find him."

Adora placed a hand on her shoulder and assured her, "We won't stop until we find King Sabara."

A brief moment of assurance between them did not last as a goat woman, and lizard person came from behind their busted cruiser and asked, "Did you two say, King Sabara?" The goat woman asked.

Adora instinct went to touch her arm guard that disguised her sword.

Scorpia pushed Adora out of the way as she demanded from the goat woman to tell her what she knew. The two ushered them away from the cruiser and tried to rob them, only to receive a harsh beatdown from Adora and Scorpia.

When the scuffle was over, the cruiser had been lifted and taken somewhere without their knowledge.

Without a cruiser and their belongings, they were stranded in the Crimson Waste.

Great.

Meanwhile, Catra and Angella were up against Shadow Weaver's deceptive tactics.

The Sorceress coldly explained to them, "The Hordes army has been confirmed to be moving this way. Only a ghost platoon is coming for this Kingdom. The real battle is going to the Kingdoms with Runestones. With such a small invading force, we can easily take them all on with a single platoon of our own."

Catra looked at Angella cautiously.

Angella asked, "This Kingdom has no army. So are you asking civilians to fight?"

Shadow Weaver put her hands together. "Why shouldn't they? It is their home."

Angella stood up in defense of the people she did not know. "Civilians are not military trained. So your asking farmers and children to bear weapons at trained soldiers in tanks?"

Shadow weaver walked over to Angella; inches away from her face, she asked, "Does the coward Queen have a better plan?"

Angella felt her voice become lost at the statement. Her ears burned at the cruel taunt, and Catra stepped in command, "Can we not do this? We need to prepare for an invasion. We can't risk people getting hurt. Can you give Angella and me a minute to talk so more?"

Shadow Weaver's mask couldn't show her disgust in Catra at this moment, but she still answered respectfully in her condescending way, "As you wish, your majesty." And left the room.

Catra looked at Angella and saw the fear and discomfort in her eyes. As much as this angelic being wanted to put on a brave face—she was scared.

The old Catra would have loved to be awful and cruel to her, but now she only wanted to help. So she asked Angella her honest opinion "What should we do?"

Angella cleared her throat and answered, "We need to address the invasion to the public; they need to see their Queen make a public statement and with a plan. To keep people protected, I'll like to propose a bunker of some sort. But, unfortunately, the houses are not strong enough to handle missile blasts, and we need a better solution for those who are not combating skilled."

Catra rubbed the back of her head and looked away as she pondered, "We can set a safety drill in place, and all the soldiers we have can help with a stealth attack on the ghost platoon."

Angella smiled warmly at her and offered, "We will do this together. First, summon the castle staff to inform them, then we will address your subjects."

Catra nodded and left the room.

I am leaving Angella alone to her thoughts.

Fearful of what could come her way, she remained brave as she walked out of the bedroom.

Shadow Weaver followed behind to confront them in her hall. "You know, getting Catra to side with you is no victory." Her cold voice is echoed in the hall. Angella refused to engage with her and paid no mind to her words. Shadow Weaver continued, "Adora would be the only person to have been perfect for this mission. She has the sword and the power, not Catra. So, you're putting your need to have teenagers' approval over the real matter."

Angella turned to her and spat, "I will not be instructed to do anything by you! You've lost your control over those girls! Haven't you done enough to harm Etheria!?"

Shadow Weaver's eyes glowed through her mask. "I went where I was valued! Where will you go after this?"

Angella stopped and turned to her. Then, submitting and giving her full attention as she declared, "I will return to Brightmoon and reign as Queen again. Why does that matter to you?"

"Do you think after this war is over, you will be remembered fondly?"

She began to walk past Angella. "It will go down in the history books that the Queen of Brightmoon sent her husband to die in a battle she wouldn't fight herself, and her daughter has perished on multiple occasions. Even when the Horde captured Glimmer, you hesitated to meet the demands the Horde laid to you before shows your cowardice," Her voice grew softer as she asked Angella, "When the War is over. I will be known as the traitor of Mystacor and the former horde Commander. Catra and Scorpia will have to make up for past crimes too, but you? Who would want a Queen that failed to protect their beloved King and Princess?"

Angella felt her throat go dry.

Could Shadow Weaver be right? Did people secretly resent her?

Shadow Weaver walked past her and turned back to tell her, "When the time comes, I will sacrifice myself for the good of Etheria. Can you say the same?" she left down the halls to disappear into the shadows.

She is leaving Angella to think long and hard about what she should do.

Suppose the moment called for it. Would she sacrifice herself?

Back in the Crimson Waste.

Now that it was dark, the two didn't know where to go and where else to look. Scorpia and Adora had gone into every tavern they could find to see if anyone could help them; it led to more fights. Finally, the last saloon was out farther into the desert, and the two went into it. To their surprise—there he was.

King Sabara swung around her the bar stool and raised his claws out. "My baby girl!" he cried.

Scorpia rushed to him to embrace her father. Relieved, he was okay. Adora couldn't believe he was hanging out in the middle of nowhere without any Horde guards around.

Adora cautiously asked while looking around the tavern to see if anyone was listening in on their conversation. "Where is the—"

"Horde?" He asked, "They got ambushed by the locals and retreated. Right now, I'm here. With my new pals."

"New pals?" Scorpia questioned.

The moment she questioned that, the goat and lizard woman from earlier came in, only to be angered by the sight of Adora and Scorpia. Adora took her sword out to prepare for a fight, only to hear a booming voice come from her "Drop the sword, blondie." A muscular woman with purple skin and white hair emerged from behind the tavern's back doors. Standing behind the bar, she leaned an arm over the table and asked, "Not even one whole day, and you've gotten yourself into trouble, you three."

The goat and lizard woman looked confused and stepped back a little so as not anger the bartender.

Sabara replied, "I’m a victim of circumstance, gorgeous.”

She snorted and mumbled, “Now like dumbass of circumstance,” looking over to Scorpia, she pointed, “This your kid?”

Scorpia jumped a little as he replied, “Oh yes! My little girl! Queen Scorpia!”

The purple woman smirked. “Cute.” Then, looking towards Adora, she asked, “What’s your story, sword girl?”

Adora gulped as she looked at the purple woman’s strong arms and stammered, “I—I’m Adora!”

As if that meant anything here.

Scorpia stepped in front of Adora to show dominance. “We are from the defected Horde Kingdom. We’re here for Sabara and the Black Garnet Runestone.”

The woman and Sabara looked at each other. Finally, the woman turned to them and explained, “The Horde doesn’t know what it’s messing with when coming here to the Crimson Waste. A group of scoundrels tipped over the tanks and started skiff jacking them at the boarding, right at the edge of the Crimson Waste on the east side by the crater. When they left, they left this guy—” rolling her eyes and pointing to Sabara.

The retired king just beamed at her and teased, “You know you’ve loved to have me here, Huntara.”

Huntara deadpanned “No.”

Adora asked, “What about the Hordes' plans to use the Runestones?”

Huntara shot Sabara a confused look.

He answered, “Ho, yeah, the Black Garnet is ruined. Thanks to Shadow Weaver, it can’t be used, ever. They left it by the crater.

They’re heading back the Fright Zone to launch a full-scale attack on the Scorpion Kingdom.”

Both girl's eyes went wide with horror. This was terrible news, and they were now far away from the Kingdom to be of any help. Without a Skiff or any transportation back, they were useless to everyone that needed them. Scorpia felt so disappointed and ashamed of her father for his lack of concern over his people. Adora could see the hurt in Scorpia’s eyes as Sabara seemed so flippant to the demise of innocent people. As She-Ra, Adora knew that expectations were high, and Scorpia had a lot of pressure on her for being the newly crowned ruler of that Kingdom. Scorpia asked, “What crater is it at, dad?”

He looked to Huntara; the tall purple woman sighed and pinched the bridge of her nose and explained, “Kid, that giant rock almost six tons, and the crater is by this old tech junkyard on the other side of the Crimson Waste, there is no point in going there.”

Adora interrupted, “We need to try. But, first, we need to know why the horde left the Black Garnet and why they retreated so fast?”

Huntara shrugged. “Forget it, kid. You two aren’t going to stop the Horde. Those people are the worst.”

Scorpia chimed in “Adora, and I were once in the Horde.”

Huntara smugly crossed her arms and let out a short laugh. "Ha! Two kids, well, that proves it. The Horde is worst, and there isn't anything two defects can do about it." She turned to Sabara and spoke to him, "Your daughter and her girlfriend can crash here. I know the tavern owner, and I know she can get some use out of them in exchange for a bed."

Sabara looked at Scorpia and shrugged. "This is our only option, sweetie."

Scorpia frowned and turned to Adora. Hoping she had some answers to this situation. Sadly, Adora looked away from her, unsure of what to do. With no way to communicate or get back to the Kingdom. It was almost as if this whole mission was a bust from the beginning.

But who could make it so Adora and Scorpia—the two only people who could realistically save the Kingdom leave so they would be defenseless.

The Crimson Waste group where non the wiser than what Shadow Weaver was planning.

Back in the Scorpion Kingdom, the remained of the Horde defects had gone on a scouting mission with Catra. Without anyone knowing not to draw suspicion, the feline Queen felt uneasy about the current situation and wanted to see if she could spot any signs of the Horde coming. To their dismay, they did see campsites being built less than a hundred miles away from the Kingdom. Getting Octavia and Grizzlor to investigate further, she started to worry about the camp sizes. It would make no sense for them to build compounds this close to the Kingdom for a small invasion. Remembering her first real battlefront mission with Lonnie, she remembered setting up a campsite that would house fifty Horde soldiers for Seaslines invasion to ransack their supply ships. It was a scary first mission due to Catra's hatred of water and her poor swimming skills. All she could remember was the minor private part being the campsite.

When Octavia returned with her scouts, she worriedly confirmed, "Those bases are huge. They haven't even begun to finish them."

Grizzlor nodded, and Lonnie removed her helmet and stated, "This is one of the large compound models. Each tent can houses a hundred soldiers."

"How many are they setting up?" Catra asked. The fear is showing in her voice as everyone shot her a look. Seeing Catra lose her computer and show fear was something they rarely saw. Lonnie and Kyle had caught glimpses of it as children, as Catra was once the crybaby of the group that turned into a bully when Adora. So seeing her worried didn't make them want to taunt her. Instead, they shared in her fears, and Lonnie explained, "I think I saw six of the tarp boxes on a loading freight."

Catra's eyes went wide. "That means it's the whole army."

Lonnie gave her a sad nod.

Catra ran her nails through her hair and sighed, "We need to get back."

The boat rides back into the village leading to the castle was a quiet one. No one dared to ask Catra what she was thinking, except stupidly, Kyle asked, "Catra, are you okay?"

The feline tensed up but didn't have the strength to snap at Kyle. So instead, she softly replied, "No. I don't feel right."

Everyone remained silent.

Catra felt the tears gloss over her eyes and didn't dare to blink. With her helmet on, she felt some comfort in not shedding tears in front of everyone, but the simple matter that no one cared to comfort her hurt in ways she couldn't imagine. She might have spent her whole life around these people, but they weren't her people. They didn't care for her enough to feel like she mattered. She had the entire weight of the Kingdom on her, and none of these former teammates could offer her any support.

The drive back to the Kingdom felt longer than it needed to be, successfully avoiding everyone; Catra turned, went to her room, and cried. She felt week. Her emotions were getting the better of her. She has never been this sensitive beofre, except for Adora leaving her, and this situation was far more dangerous. She was actively going to be at fault for people's lives being in danger, and she didn't have any resources on how to resolve them at all.

It was unknown to everyone how Catra felt.

Unsure how to feel themselves, they chose not to pursue asking her anything and were stuck in their thoughts. Uncertain of what to do. All being Horde trained, they knew what tactics of assault were ahead. The Horde fought with no honor; they rampaged through towns and cities and causes needless destruction to make the Etherian citizens unable to recover or return to their former homes. They knew if the entire army was on the way, they had no chance of winning.

Lonnie, Kyle, and Rogelio gave Angella the courtesy to tell her what was happening and what they discovered. Then, saddened and worried why Catra didn't come and speak with her, she made her way to her bedroom.

Passing by the war room with one of the only properly working communication hubs, she spotted Shadow Weaver. Angella knew it was her from the sound of her voice. Although behind the large double doors, she could have easily walked in to see what Shadow Weaver was doing. Instead, she listened outside to hear what was going on.

She heard her gruff voice speak, "Lord Hordak. They are still defenseless, and She-Ra and the real Queen have been dealt with. I can assure Catra's surrender and arrest in a matter of hours…."

Angella covered her mouth in shock. Shadow Weaver was double-crossing them.

She heard Hordak reply, "You have shown your worth to me, and now the Horde has no need to rush our efforts to get the Kingdom. Instead, I have chosen to pull out all ghost platoons from bases near the other Kingdoms, and when the Scorpion Kingdoms people are eliminated, the Second Fright Zone will be placed there to succeed my rule."

Angella balwed her firsts.

How could Shadow Weaver be this cruel? To harm innocent people more than she had already done in her lifetime. Angella didn't know how to process this. Without Magic and no wings, she couldn't fly off and tell a guard, and with no one around, she had to take matters into her own hands. She examined her soft dainty hands. Perfectly manicured nails that have never seen combat a day in her life. Uncertain of what to do. If she allows Shadow Weaver to slip away, she will lose her evidence that Shadow Weaver is betraying them. Finally, in another irrational decision, she barged into the room and lunged and Shadow Weaver.

She was giving the vile old hag no time to prepare. Magicless herself; Shadow Weaver tried to push Angella off her to little avail as the two toppled to the floor. Angella straddled over Shadow Weaver and repetitively punching Shadow Weaver in the mask. Finally, cracking it, Shadow Weaver was able to take a forceful swing at Angella in the face, Punchng her, and make Angella halt to cover her face; Shadow Weaver could push her off. Trying to reach for the screen of the communicator hub, she saw Hordak was still watching her intently. Surprised at what he was witnessing, he had no desire not to watch this fight take place.

The two unskilled women combatting it out with no grace as they grappled on the floor and slapped and pulled on each other's hair. Shadow Weaver's mask finally fell off to reveal her disfigured face. In a split second, Angella lost focus due to seeing the unsavvy sight of Shadow Weaver's true face. She gave Shadow Weaver a free hand she needed to reach into her dress pocket to retrieve a small knife to which she tried to impale Angella in the stomach with it. Getting out of the way in time to not get stabbed was the only thing Angella could do. Trying to slide away from Shadow Weaver proved to be a wrong move as Shadow Weaver was able to stand over her. They were forcefully stepping on Angella's stomach to keep her in place as she allowed her body to fall over her and slash Angella's neck. The cut was not deep, but painful and it drew blood. Knowing her slice was uncoordinated, shadow Weaver took her knife to stab Angella directly in the throat. Angella grabbed Shadow Weaver's wrist with both hands, leaving her open Shadow Weaver's free hand to pull at her hair. Angella tried to break free but to no avail. Moving her hands would have available to be stabbed, and she wasn't strong enough to maneuver Shadow Weaver off of her. She didn't have the skills, and this brought tears to stream down her face. Angella failed herself by not being combat trained, and now in she was close to death. To die at the hands of the person who damned Etheria to Hordak.

Shadow Weaver's deranged eyes looked at Angella with satisfaction. Knowing she was going to win. Shadow Weaver gloated. "This is for Micah!" she said, taking both hands to press the knife down on Angella's bloody neck. The Queen felt the blood in her arms go cold as she tugs her nails into Shadow Weaver's wrists and cries out. Her body is jolting as it touched the pressing of the knife on her open wound.

Angella only tried with all her might.

The end was drawing near to her.

A sudden shout came from the doorway with Octavia, Grizzlor, Kyle, and Lonnie rushing in to get Shadow Weaver off Angella and forcefully removing the older woman off Angella. The Queen was covering her throat with her own hands and feeling the stinging pain and the blood rush through her fingers. Angella's heart raced uncontrollably as she felt faint. Her vision became dark, and she didn't remember closing her eyes as her body stopped tensing.

"Angella!? Queen Angella!" Kyle cried as he rushed over. "She fainted! Get help! Get Catra!"

Blacked out and, Angella just laid there in pain. Unable to protect herself again.

When she finally came to waking up, she found herself in Catra's room—lying on her bed. Unable to move her neck as she jumped a bit, seeing the feline watch over her. The girl's tail is swaying on her right side while the faint words of Octavia could be heard.

"We heard some commotion going on, and then Lonnie and Kyle rushed with us when we realized there was a scuffle."

Catra looked up and asked Octavia, "What did Shadow Weaver say?"

Octavia replied, "She said Angella walked in and attacked her."

"Doubt it," Catra replied. Then, seeing Angella's eyes were open, she instructed the Queen, "Don't talk yet. I know you will tell me the truth later."

Octavia offered, "I can stay with her if you need to do anything?"

Catra shook her head. "You've done enough for us. Get some rest." The feline offered the other woman a sincere smile but was only met with an eye roll from Octavia as she left the room. Catra sighed and sat next to Angella and asked her, "Just blink if I'm right. Shadow Weaver played us."

Angella closed her eyes tightly and nodded to her best ability.

Catra sighed and crossed her arms, wanting to cry all over again.

All this work was for nothing. They couldn't win, and it didn't matter how hard they tried. Catra was going to send an entire Kingdom to their demise.

Angella slowly sat up and felt the pain of the various bruises and scratches she didn't know were there before now strung with her sudden movement. She was unable to speak louder than a whisper. "We can make this work, Catra. We have access to the Princess Alliance."

Catra snorted. "*You* have the Alliance. They will come for you. Not to save us, they never cared about the Scorpion Kingdom; what will change now?"

Angella defended, "We were always told it was an allyship. We never knew they were invaded and conquered."

Catra shrugged. "It doesn't matter. They won't come. Even if their Kingdoms aren't in danger, they have no reason to save us."

Angella reached out to Catra's forearm and stated, "You are the Queen of these people; you must attempt a diplomatic movement to better the lives of these people."

Catra didn't respond.

Angella raised her voice a little “I know you feel defeated, but you cannot give in to your despair.”

Catra sat up and coldly offered, “Didn’t you? When your husband died. Didn’t you give up and hide in your stupid castle while your people went into combat?”

Angella felt her throat string and didn’t say anything.

Catra continued to criticize her, “You would never know what suffering is! You had the privilege and loved your whole life! Call your Alliance! Have them take you out of here! Adora is gone, and we have no idea when she will come back to go! Leave! Your useless here anyways. You can’t be trusted to be alone for two seconds without finding some way to get your ass kicked!” the feline stood over Angella in a threatening way.

Fearful, but not moved. Angella did not flinch or back down from her. Instead, she sat up more and repeated herself, “You are a Queen now.” Then, and as sharply as she could, she demanded, “Act like it!”

Catra sat on the bed close to Angella’s feet and replied, “I don’t know how.”

Angella assured her, "I will guide you through everything you need to know. I will help you through this, Catra."

Catra just looked down at her lap and didn't answer.

Angella offered, "You know how livid Shadow Weaver will be to know her terrible treatment of you didn't stop you from saving Etheria and undoing all her wrongs."

Catra looked at her and smirked. "Fine. Show me all your Queeny knowledge to save my people and piss off shadow Weaver."

Angella smiled. "Well, you might upset a few of the other alliance members; Queen diplomacy training only happens when a princess succeeds their parents. So Glimmer may never receive this intel."

Catra sat up and grinned. "Pissing off sparkles on sweetens the deal. I'm in."

Angella smiled and laid back down. "Good. Good. We should rest a bit."

Catra nodded and made her way over to the couch, and Angella called to her, "I'll move to the couch; you don't need to give up your bed for me."

Catra shook her head. "No thanks. I have to be kind if I'm going to be good at this Queen stuff, so you stay there. I'm good over here." Catra said as she stretched before laying down.

Angella smiled at the girl. *Behind all her anger, she is a sweet young lady; she will be a great Queen in a healthy environment.*

Halfmoon

Adora tossed in her sleep, unable to rest in the little room she shared with Scorpia above the Tavern. She looked over to see Scorpia was not moving much, indicating she had fallen asleep. On the other hand, Adora was kicking herself for letting them get stranded in the Crimson Waste. With no way to communicate with anyone, they would need to manage the long trip back into the semi-occupied Horde territory and hope that Angella and the others were okay.

Her mind stopped processing other plans when Angella came to mind.

Her Queen.

Why did she ever think it would be okay to leave Angella? Catra and Scorpia should have done this mission. But, instead, she volunteered herself without thinking, and the cause of this was going to end up possibly hurting Angella. If the Horde invades and captures Angella during the siege of the Kingdom, then Hordak will essentially have won the war if he gets control of Birghtmoon.

She sat up and left to go down to the Tavern.

It was dark downstairs, with only Huntara sitting at a table polishing a shotgun in a dim light flickering from a candle while sipping something from a jug with an "X" label on it.

"Can't sleep, blondie?" she asked. She was not looking up at her to see the worried expression on Adora's face. The blonde shrugged, feeling that Huntara would know how Adora responded.

The older woman looked up and saw the blonde at the edge of the door frame. She gestured for her to sit down. Adora did and asked, "Aren't you worried about what is going on in Etheria?"

Huntara shrugged. "Etheria ain't worried about me. Even if Hordak throws his desert missiles our way, we won't have loose much here in the Crimson Waste."

Adora blinked and looked surprised as to how Huntara knew about the desert sand missiles that Hordak used. Of course, they used more for demolition work than an actual attack. But, of course, only a member of the Horde would know that was.

Adora questioned her. "How could you have known about the Horde demolition missiles?" slowly getting up from her chair Huntara glared at the younger woman. Adora sat up from her seat and bawled her fists.

The older woman chuckled. "Relax, kid. I'm not a spy. I went rogue. Turncoat. I left on my terms just like you did."

Adora's shoulders stopped being tense, and she questioned, "What made you leave?"

Huntara ran her hands through her ponytail and sat back down. "Everything. We were stealing orphans, destroying villages, ruining supplies and natural resources. It went from rebelling against the world that failed me to do eviler than I could have ever thought of on my own. One battle got messy….. King what's his name from Brightmoon coming, and our defenses were down." A saddened look came over Huntara as she retold the event that made her leave the Horde. "We were skeleton platoon. We weren't made to win. We didn't have enough supplies to withstand an attack from one of the biggest armies in Etheria. So I left and said I would get intel, and I headed south of the shoreline to come here….."

Adora saw regret in Huntara's eyes.

The blonde asked, "Why did you stay here of all places?"

Huntara shrugged. "Nowhere else to go. I never had a home before the Horde, and this was the only place that didn't check refugees for what their background could be. As a result, the Crimson Waste is filled with former scum. The wasteland of criminals is the only place for military traitors."

Adora looked down and her hands. Her golden armband was secretly the sword of protection. Her Runestone glistened, and Huntara asked her, "What made you leave?"

Adora didn't answer at first. Her mind raced at the idea of the army coming to the Scorpion Kingdom and how she couldn't get back to anyone in time. Hordak was going to show them all no mercy, and she feared what would happen to Angella and Catra if they got caught.

"Blondie?" Huntara questioned.

Adora cocked her head up and looked confused. "Hmm?"

"What made you leave?" Huntara asked again.

Adora looked back down at her Runestone "Everything." She answered.

Huntara frowned. The guilty feeling of knowing someone so young was a traumatized child soldier made someone like Huntara, a woman in her thirties, feel remorse. Judging by her kid's arms, she was no stranger to combat, but at what cost? For a kid not even twenty. What was the cost of her childhood?

The sun was slowly rising, and Huntara felt compelled to help. Now that Sabara was the last thing on his Kingdom's mind, she couldn't use him for extortion. Instead, her mind now went into the thought of getting help for Adora and Scorpia. She knew

where the Runestone was dumped If Sabara couldn't use the Runestone. Maybe Scorpia could?

She heard the footsteps come from the stairway and saw Sabara and Scorpia head down the stairs. She sat up and asked the three of them, "You kids up for a field trip?"

In the Scorpion Kingdom

Catra failed to get any decent rest, as did Angella. The fear of what was ahead of them made trying to relax difficultly. Lonnie had come to them early in the morning with ration bars for breakfast. She was entering the room without knocking. Shaken by what was pending their way, she had ration bars in her hands. Her original plan was to wake the two of them up and ask them if they wanted to eat breakfast. Seeing the two still asleep, she awkwardly placed them on the end table closest to Angella. Seeing the woman with the blankets covering her face made her feel a little comfort. Lonnie always found when everyone else was sleeping to be peaceful. Then, she heard the faint purrs come from Catra, and she moved closer to her. Sitting on the floor at the foot of the couch, she listened to the purring get louder. In all the years she spent fighting with Catra, she couldn't deny she liked the sound of her purring. Catra wasn't aware she did in her sleep and was a quick indicator to everyone else in the bunk room that she was asleep. The only time the purring stopped and Catra slept without sound was the week Adora left. She remembered Adora's old blanket making its way to Catra's top bunk and feeling bad for Catra.

The feline was a terrible friend to the other Horde cadets. She was becoming meaner instead of comforting each other over the

lost friend. Lonnie took to siding with other cadets against Catra. The regret now showed. If she had left with Adora then, nothing would have changed, but the two would have been better teammates. Some things Lonnie couldn't go to the guys with and wished her and Catra had a relationship to where they could be close and be good friends. She watched the feline stir awake. The feline jumped a little when she saw Lonnie. Then, sitting up quickly and softly asked her, "Are you okay?"

Lonnie nodded. "Yeah, I just brought you guys some rations, so….."

Catra sat up fully and asked, "did you sleep?"

"Sorta," Lonnie replied with a shrug.

The two heard Angella sit up, and she looked over to the girls. Both wore concerned looks on their face as Catra asked, "How are you feeling?"

"Sore, but other than that, I'm okay," Angella replied. Then, slowly getting up, she saw the ration bars on the end table and didn't bother to ask about them. Instead, she walked over to the younger woman and asked Catra, "What would you like the plan to be today for majesty?"

Catra kept her eyes focused on her lap and answered, "We should do that thing you were talking about last night. About

broadcasting a speech to the other Kingdoms."

Lonnie was surprised at this suggestion. Catra wasn't for public speaking, and when she spoke to crowds, it was never elegant.

Addressing the public during a crisis was a royal standard, just as dressing the masses when it came to holidays, important news events, and any political situation that would be considered favorable or damage control. The rules of the royals differ from every Kingdom. For Catra to approach her new subjects, she needed to have her people love her. This crisis of an invasion was beyond the control of one person and a low-functioning population. Angella was to how Catra the much-needed addiction to bring her people to ease. This enraged Shadow Weaver's plans. She was bringing them to a foil while she remained in prison. In a cell away from everyone, Shadow Weaver was away from Catra, and Angella knew that the feline royal needed. Angella knew from what Adora had told her that Catra was never given the same structure and support as Adora. She never offered kindness or humility when others were in the Horde, and that said a lot as the Horde was unfair to all their cadets; for Catra to suffer more than others was awful and explained her trauma and behavior. The mother in Angella only wanted to comfort her and assure her things were going to be okay. Being in the dangerous predicament made her want Glimmer near her at this time. She knew she couldn't have that but liked it so severely.

She had told Catra to prepare herself for a public announcement. For Catra, she understood why this was important to make a statement. Her whole life has been a statement. The only magicat in the Horde, being treated like an animal by the senior cadets and Force Captains. The abuse and torture Shadow Weaver put her through. The only salvation is her love for Adora

was ripped from her all the time. Catra can lie to herself and say it didn't hurt to be around Adora and that she felt proud and accomplished for what she had done. But unfortunately, she was on the wrong side of history for her time in the Horde. She was nothing like Adora, the prized turncoat with a magical, unique destiny and Catra was just another cadet. She could be a faceless suit of Horde armor at this point. But it wouldn't make a difference.

Catra looked at herself in the mirror and thought of how she could make herself look presentable for a broadcasted appearance. Angella was behind her, combing her hair gently and telling her, "You look beautiful."

The tiny bit of assurance was something Catra never received. She felt her throat go dry when Angella placed her hands on her shoulders. This comforting gesture, none of it was something Catra was used to. Then, looking down at Angella's pre-written speech, she asked the feline Queen if she wanted to rehearse again. Catra shook her head.

Angella offered for her to change whatever she felt didn't work in the speech. Looking at Angella, she saw something in the Queen she had never seen before and tired eyes and bruises. Angella's arms were cut and bruised from her scuffle with Shadow Weaver, and her eyes showed the exhaustion and stress going through. Looking around the war room, she saw it in everyone's eyes and felt guilt over it all. If she wasn't with the Horde, she might have been able to stop all of this. Now she had to find a way to end it all.

She stood up in front of the camera. Kyle was pointing it directly at her as she stood behind the podium to speak. The script was in front of her for what she needed to say. Angella was behind Kyle and informed Catra. "This is not a live feed. We will rehearse as long as needed until you are satisfied with the final cut."

Everyone was behind Angella, looking intently at Catra. The feline Queen gulped and looked at her notes. She was preparing herself for an impactful presentation of her class as a leader. This was her making a plea for the Princess Alliance to come to her aid in saving the Scorpion Kingdom, and she was going to be the face of the person saying please. Catra has done some damage to all these Kingdoms under Hordak's command. Getting people to understand her and want to help her will not be easy. With Angella's notes in hand, she began.

"People of Etheria, I am……"

Adora had followed Huntara into the desert alone. Sanding rushed past them, and only a thin brown clock covered them from the elements as the taller woman led Adora to a cavern in the middle of the Crimson Waste. Inside was the remains of something unseen by Adora.

A large vessel of some sort.

"What is this?" Adora asked, walking closer to it.

Huntara grabbed her and warned her, "This is something from the First Ones. If you know anything about old myths, you should know that a worrier named She-Ra arrived on Etheria from space and trapped us in Dispondos.

Adora blinked in confusion and asked, "Did Sabara tell you who I am?"

Huntara shrugged and looked at Adora. "Are you supposed to be something special, Blondie?"

Adora turned to look at the massive metal ship in front of them and placed her hand on what seemed to be the graffiti-covered and dented entrance door, and replied softly, "I am the new She-Ra."

Huntara's eyes went wide with what the younger woman had just said. The new She-Ra? What does a new She-Ra mean for Etheria? The shock turned to anger silently underneath her skin. She-Ra is a legend of power and strength, as well as someone who is at fault for much discord in Etheria. It was said that if She-Ra were around and doing her job right, half the issues of Etheria would be resolved. Hordak would have never gone into power. Now a *new* She-Ra was here. One who worked for the Horde. Indoctrinated by the Horde now is rouge with power? Huntara had her fists balled up as she saw Adora use her sword. The light blue Runestone is glowing as it opens the doors to the vessel. A ship that was never able to be opened now was thanks

to her. For years people of the Waste tried to open it, only leaving weak dents and some graffiti on it, but never capable of opening it. Once Adora stepped in, she looked at Huntara and asked, "Coming?"

Huntara sighed and kept her calm as she replied, "Right behind you, kid."

Back with Catra.

Her rehearsals were much-needed work. Angella instructed everyone to leave the room so that Catra had fewer eyes focusing on her. Catra sat down in her chair, defeated. Taking a sip of water, she looked at Angella and asked, "Are you sure you cant do it? If people see you, they'll help. If people see me, they'll turn their communicators off."

Angella stood close to her and softly touched Catra's face. Making the feline flinch as she was still not used to tenderness. Then, Angella offered her, "If the script does not work, then you can change it?"

"To what?" Catra questioned.

Angella pondered before answering, "You have lived your whole life being someone strong and never letting anyone see the sweetness and goodness inside of you because you were surrounded by people who hurt you. In your position of power, you no longer answer to them. You can be sweet, sincere, and venerable to people. Let Etheria know what you have gone through. Get the support you need. Adora opened up about her life and only received nothing but love from everyone. You can too."

Catra's ears turned downward, and they replied, "Adora is She-Ra."

"And you are Queen Catra of the Scorpion Kingdom, and you are here to help end the war and save your people and countless others."

Catra sat back up and asked, "Can we do anything few takes. I think I have a good speech in mind."

Angella smiled and watched as Catra stood back up and walked close to the camera again. The Cameraman nodded and focused back on Catra.

The feline took a deep breath and began to speak. This time with confidence, she needed to get her message across right.

Her message was clear, and she insisted on it being live when she recorded it. By this time of night, everyone with a communicator pad was getting ready to call it a day. All members of the princess alliance received a live stream notification from the coordinates of the Scorpion Kingdom.

In curiosity, everyone in their designated camps turned on the feed. Assuming it might be an update about the Hordes takeover.

To everyone's surprise, it was Catra. She dressed up and wore a gold tiara with sapphires on it as she began to speak.

"People of Etheria. My name is Catra……." Catra's tail nervously swished as she continued, "Some may recognize me as a member of the Horde army. After leaving the army, I have worked in helping the Scorpion Kingdom regain independence and leave their history with the Horde behind them…. Many members of the Horde are doing the same. Knowing what we all know now. The many Horde soldiers renounced their ways to live a better life of peace."

She paused and felt her chest go tight. Then, knowing she couldn't keep silent for long, she continued, "We know that the crimes of the past must be accounted for. Therefore, in my works to repay my debts to Etherian society, I asked for forgiveness and the extension of assistance in saving the Scorpion Kingdom from being eliminated by Hordak."

Angella stood by the Cameraman proudly, seeing that Catra had gained her rhythm in how she speaks. She is clear and direct—the perfect sign of a leader.

Catra continued, "As an orphan, I was taken by the Horde and only knew one way of life. Many of the Horde's youngest members were child soldiers taken from unknown circumstances and made to fight. I only knew one of thinking for my entire life, and removing myself from a toxic and dangerous environment made me want to be a better person. I have defeated Shadow Weaver and taken down many of the most high-ranked Horde army members. As the full forces of the Horde come and take control of the Scorpion Kingdom, I ask for the assistance of the Princess Alliance and their forces to come to fight with us in defeating the Horde once and for all. All of Etheria needs to join forces to save our world. Please, we must be brave, and we must be strong to keep on fighting for what we love. As Queen Catra of the Scorpion kingdom, I love my friends, subjects, and wife Princess Scorpia and will fight for them and the rest of Etheria."

Angella's eyes softened as she realized how hard that must have been for her to say. Her honest feelings. As beautiful as it was, she knew it was something Catra had never done before, and it could not have been easy. The Cameraman let the transmission fade out as Catra asked for anyone who wished to speak with her can reach her on the Scorpion kingdom channels.

The camera moved away from Catra, and she looked at Angella with pleading eyes, desperate for Angella to offer some feedback. Instead, the Queen of Brightmoon walked over to her and pulled her into an embrace. Softly telling her, "You spoke beautify."

Catra tightly embraced Angella back. This feeling of support was something she had never felt before, and she wanted to savory the moment where the first motherly person in her life told her she was doing something good.

Angella rubbed Catra's back and asked her, "How are you feeling?"

Catra pulled away and looked up, replying, "Scared. I don't know if that was any good. Was bringing up the orphan thing too desperate? Mentioning Scorpia wasn't bad, was it?"

Angella shook her head. "You're okay. You spoke from the heart, and that's what's needed right now."

Lonnie then rushed into the room and explained, "Brightmoon, Plumeria, and the sea kingdom are all on the line. They want to have a four-way call."

Catra gulped, and Angella placed her hands on her shoulder and offered, "I'll be in the call with you."

Catra still looked nervous but followed Angella into the communications room to speak with the other princesses. The setup the Kingdom had with alliance communication was poor and dated. The large monitor on the wall and a keyboard laying on an old table. Kyle and Rogelio got it to work and turned on the screen for them, and in only a few seconds, four boxes, each with

a princess in the frame was on the screen. Perfuma, Mermista, Glimmer, and Frosta were in attendance to speak with them.

Catra's ears flattened at their scowls towards her.

Glimmer's eyes went from anger to Catra to worry and concern to Angella.

"Queen Angella? Are you alright?" Glimmer asked.

Angella nodded and replied, "I am, but this is not about me; please speak with Queen Catra."

Mermista sighed and started first. "So, how do you go from ramming into the sea gate to being some domesticated saint in the desert?"

Harsh words.

Catra looked ashamed and replied, "I'm sorry for what I've done. I've made a lot of bad mistakes, and I want to make up for all that I've done."

Perfuma narrowed her eyes and asked, "If you want to make up for all the things you've done, then why would you invade the

Scorpion Kingdom under Hordak's orders?"

Catra felt a lump in her chest form. How would anyone know information like that? It was true. Her original mission was to sabotage Scorpia and her father and seize the Kingdom to start building the base for Horde to conquer more of Etheria. However, none of that information should be public knowledge. Unless…….

Frosta spoke up, "The Horde sent every kingdom all your crimes and willingness to do all the horrible things you've done."

The three other princesses nodded their heads in confirmation.

Glimmer spoke up sternly, "We all have come together and agreed we will help in making sure Queen Angella is okay, but this is not an invitation to the Alliance."

Angella felt her back tense hearing this. Like a phantom limb, she wanted to spread her wings to show how angry she was, something she knew Glimmer hated, but due to her injury and loss of them, she couldn't. So instead, she saw Catra's defeat in her eyes as the feline-only agreed with them.

"If that is all the help your willing to give, then so be it. Please know that the people here are innocent, and they don't deserve this. So if you can spare anyone else in this war, please let it be them."

Perfuma was taken back by Catra's plea; she saw the sincerity in Catra's eyes and knew this was not a trick. She softly replied, "I will do what I can." Shocking the rest of the Alliance with her words. The transmission went offline as the Alliance logged off to scold Perfuma.

Angella placed her arms on Catra's shoulders and spoke, "You did well."

Catra sulked. "Not good enough." She rolled her shoulders, and Angella moved her hands as Catra huffed. "What's the point of trying to be good if everyone only sees you for only being bad?"

Angella didn't have the words Catra needed right now. A second transmission call came in, and Catra looked confusedly at the screen and asked, "Where the hell is Halfmoon?"

Angella felt her chest go tight at seeing the name. Halfmoon was a land of people that just up and disappeared one day after a Horde Invasion. Her eyes focused on Catra's face. If they are still around, they must have seen Catra and recognized her as their kin. Angella felt a feeling of relief at this idea. If Halfmoon offers to help, that could be a real game-changer.

The Screen went clear, and two older feline men were on the screen. Their eyes were focused on Catra as one softly said, "Look at her; she's beautiful."

Catra's ears slightly dropped in discomfort at the comment, and she glanced over to Angella for help. Unfortunately, the older Queen stepped out of frame, so Catra was the main focus. She nodded in assurance for Catra to say something, and all the young Queen could do stammer. "I—I am Catra. I am the new Queen of the Scorpion Kingdom."

One man asked, "And you were a Horde soldier?"

"I was a commander." Catra corrected but instantly faltered back on, "I was born into being a child soldier. I knew no other life as an orphan."

Both men looked at each other before asking, "Do you know of your heritage?"

Catra shook her head. "No. I was the only feline hybrid in the Horde."

One feline man spoke and told her, "You are a Magicat. A proud feline face of people who have powerful magical abilities."

Catra's ears twitched at the idea of magic.

The man then said, "You are one of our lost kin, Cy'ra, and we are here to help you. The two looked at her through the screen and said, "You have the full army support of the Halfmoon Kingdom. So, we can assure the safety of your people."

Catra couldn't believe this.

People who barely knew her were her kin!? She had never seen another cat person before, and it amazed her. Now they were going to help her. For the first time in her life, she felt seen by someone other than Adora and Scorpia.

The conversation continued to go well.

Angella exited the room so Catra could speak privately with the Magicat Generals while she returned to her room to speak with Glimmer on her communicator pad. Turning it on and sending out her call signal, she answers still in the middle of her blowout with Perfuma. Going on about how Catra can't be trusted and Scorpia is still just as bad, just not in the physical sense.

When Glimmer finally meets her mother's gaze on the screen, she is welcomed to the sight of Angella's disappointed face. Glimmer sighs and asks, "What is it, mom?"

Angella retorts, "For starters, your tone. Additionally, a young alliance was be expected to be a little more understanding, but your biased only showed."

Glimmer growled and insisted, "Mom, you've never fought with Catra. She's cruel and menacing. I've seen her literally punch Adora in the stomach, and she's even threatened to throw Bow off a cliff before. She isn't some sad victim of the Horde."

Angella angrily replied, "She was a child soldier. Adora was treated far better than Catra was, and this poor child never came from a loving or safe home."

Glimmer crossed her arms and replied, "And look how Adora turned out compared to her."

Angella wished she had her wings to flare up in anger. "They are not the same. Adora was never subjected to the treatment Catra had."

Glimmer asked, "Where is Adora?"

"On a mission," Angella replied.

Glimmer growled at her mother and angrily asked, "So she left you alone again?"

Angella hated her daughter's undermining tone and asked her, "Who do you think you are to speak to me like this?"

"Your daughter! We're the only family we have left, mom, and I don't want to lose you."

Angella's voice became soft as she answered, "I don't want to lose you either, Glimmer. It's not easy for me to know you are fighting in this war, but we are needed in different places right now. So, please, understand while I'm here, I will do my best to support the people here, and I hope, since you cannot support us here, that you are doing the best for the people of Brightmoon and the rest. Of Etheria." She didn't want to fight with Glimmer anymore. Hoping her words sank into the young adult, she saw Glimmer exhale a little, and she asked her mother, "Are you alright?"

"I'm fine," Angella said calmly.

"You look like you were in another fight." Glimmer motioned to her cheek. Angella still had a small bandage on her left cheek from her altercation with Shadow Weaver and did not want to scare Glimmer. Instead, she calmly stated, "I'm training in self-defense. It's a small injury, nothing to fear."

The conversation became stilted and awkward as Glimmer was pulled away by Bow due to another transmission coming in from another Kingdom.

When the communicator went offline, she returned to Catra's side to see Catra was sitting down, more relaxed and now speaking to several Magicats on the communications screen. But, unfortunately, all Angella heard was the end of the conversation before they all logged off.

"Help will be on its way through Halfmoon. They are going to help keep us safe from the Horde Invasion." Catra explained to Angella. The older Queen held her arms out for Catra to be accepted in an embrace. The feline gladly accepted and softly remarked, "Finally, some people trust me. They want to help me." It hurt to know Catra didn't see her as an ally or anyone else around her as much or as one, but if Catra could find kinship with her people, then she couldn't stop her.

With this burden off their shoulders, it only begged the question of how Adora was doing with Scorpia.

That question left uncertain as Scorpia woke up to find Adora and Huntara had left in the morning or sometime at night. She was unsure as she came down to the unopened Tavern to see her father drinking at the bar.

"Hey, Princess!" he hiccupped.

In disappointment, she shook her head and asked her father, "Dad, have you seen Adora?"

He shrugged and answered, "She and Huntara left sometime last night. Something about looking for some old First One's ship that Adora might know something about."

He took another swig of alcohol as Scorpia sat next to him.

"Something the matter, princess?" he asked.

Scorpia just looked at him and replied, "I wish Catra were with me. Not Adora. Adora isn't awful…. She's not my type of person….."

"You don't like her." He replied. A small smile curly at the edge of his lips as he recognized Scorpia's jealous look. True, this Adora gal was someone special but seemingly overhyped by her friends and close allies. Sabara has not yet seen anything remarkable with Adora, but everyone else has.

Scorpia sighed and extended her claw out to sip whatever he was having. "She was close to Catra when they were younger, but she left Catra, and now she's run off on me, so it's hard to believe she's all that great." Then, taking a swig of whiskey to move the bottle away and make a sour face, "Dad, this stuff is awful."

"Cheap whiskey. Not much can be done about it." He seemed so calm. Never doubting himself and still drinking early in the morning like nothing was wrong.

She hated how unresponsive and helpful her dad was being. For a recently kidnapped and presumed dead man, he sure had a weird way of showing worry and fear of their Kingdom, which was now a sitting duck for the Horde to attack. Her thoughts lost momentum as a loud humming of a boat was outside the doors of the Tavern. She heard the muffled talking of gruff women inquiring, "Where's Huntara? No way she'd be closed on looters day."

Scorpia peaked outside to see her Scorpion ship dented and covered in graffiti as a goat and lizard woman walked around outside of it. Scorpia flew into a fit of anger. Rushing out of the Tavern and shouting, "You two are the ones who stole my ship!?"

The goat woman tried to puff out her chest and intimate Scorpia with the brutal "Yeah; I don't see your name on it."

Scorpia had no patience and shoved her aside and shouted, "The door says Scorpia on it!"

The lizard woman hissed and tried to throw a swing at her, and Scorpia blocked it with her claw and turned around and stung her in the shoulder. The goat woman lunged at her, and Scorpia stung her too. A little tired from stinging two people seconds apart. She walked into her ship to see it had been trashed on the inside. She used her claws to cover her mouth as she felt sick

smelling the rotting root the two had left in the ship overnight, plus they had blown the Air conditioning out by overusing it. She was disgusted by how they left the ship condition. Angrily she got off the ship and saw several locals circle it with hammers and screws in an attempt to claim it for themselves. In a rage, Scorpia used her claws to slam into the ground to make a statement of her power "All of you! Leave my ship alone!"

Sabara ran out of the Tavern to see why Scorpia was yelling, only to find her making a scene in front of the locals. "Sweetie?" he called to her.

Scorpia shot him a look and yelled, "They wrecked my ship! All of them! They're a bunch of assholes! Nothing but shit jerk assholes!"

Sabara covered his mouth after hearing her curse.

Scorpia scared off the looters and went back into her ship to access the rest of the damage. To her rage, she discovered they had cracked the screen to her communicator and unscrewed a bunch of panels to see what was in them. She was surprised it could still fly. Her day started miserably. She needed to work with her communicator and clean up her ship to fly it back to her Kingdom. She knew this was a solo mission since Adora decided to run off and go somewhere with Huntara. In anger, she cursed Adora for being so stupid and selfish and leaving her alone to deal with this.

Meanwhile, Adora and Huntara had spent the whole night searching through the old ship and found no clues on starting it or how anything works. Adora was starting to get distressed, while Huntara seemed to have lost interest in what Adora was trying to do.

"I think we can assume that the ship is a dud blondie," Huntara said, walking out of the ship. Adora didn't follow and called back to her, "There has to be something here!"

Huntara rolled her eyes. "Forget it, kid, nothing worth money is in that ship!"

Adora poked out of the ship's entranced doorway and asked, "Did you only help me because you thought there would be money involved in this!?"

Huntara shrugged. "Yeah, and it turns out—" she walked towards Adora and took a swing to try and snatch her sword out of her hand. Adora pulled away and got into a defense position. "This was a waste of time!" Huntara then got back on her skiff and called to Adora, "I'm heading back to my place. I thought I'd get that Runestone and chop it up to make some money, but all I did was waste hours playing around in a dead hunk of metal."

Adora rushed out to yell at her, "I'm the new She-Ra! I can figure out a way to use this ship somehow!"

Huntara rolled her eyes. "If you are She-Ra, prove it! Do something magical and tough then!"

Adora puffed out her cheeks and yelled, "For the Honor of Grayskull!"

Huntara watched as Adora turned into She-Ra and was impressed by the sudden increase of height the young blonde gained on her and got off her skiff and smugly replied, "Nice trick, now do something useful with that and help me get something and get on this skiff so we can track down that Runestone so I can make some damn money today."

Adora huffed and turned back to go inside the ship again. Huntara shrugged and mumbled on her breath how unimpressed she was by Adora and drove off—feeling no sense of guilt over leaving Adora out on her own. She felt like her time was wasted enough and didn't want to miss out on looting day. A weekly event in the Crimson Waste was all about robbing each other blind: for Huntara, being the biggest bully in the Waste, she knew she could get the most out of people trying to pull a fast one on her. To her concern, she had left the Tavern she had seized by some desert locals years ago in the hands of two Scorpion people. She wasn't going to waste another minute trying to humor Adora on her lackluster attempt to impress her as She-Ra.

Adora was now on her own and determined to find out some answers about the ship still. Was this Mara's? or a First Ones?

Finally entering through what she assumed to be the cockpit of the ship. The door never opened while she had searched the ship all last night, but now that Huntara was gone, she was able to get light from the ship to work finally. All seemed to be powered from her sword, which was glowing blue right now, and she saw the main chair start to glow, and to her surprise, a voice sounding like Light Hope instructed her, "Insert the sword in the slot, She-Ra. The ship will set it the course to your desired location."

In a shocking turn of events, Adora could get the ship to work, but to navigate the ship, she had to luck. As it finally took to the sky, it levitated upwards to see the whole Crimson Waste from above. Adora was scared as she felt the ship slowly go downwards. Fearing a crash landing, she begged for the ship to "STOP! Don't crash down!"

Somehow the worked, and she was levitating in midair. Looking at the screens, she saw all around her. She was seeing Huntara's skiff driving off into the distance. Another crater was close to her, surrounded by rocks and rugged terrain, but inside the crater appeared to be the Black Garnet.

Adora ordered, "Take me to that crater!"

The ship, with little hesitation, flew down, causing Adora to fall back and almost transform back to normal.

The ship hurdled downwards and almost crash-landed. The second Adora lost control of her transformation; the ship turned itself off again. Now stuff in a new crater with the Black Garnet,

Adora did her best trying to lug the giant Runestone into the ship. Taking a minute to transform back into She-Ra made it more accessible, the ship turned back on, and Adora was on her way to the Tavern again. She was passing Huntara on her way. The desert criminal stopped in shock to see the old beaten-down ship flying. She smirked to herself when she saw the ship flying overhead. "Not bad, Blondie."

Adora's new ship landed hazardously by the Tavern. Since Adora didn't know the coordinates, it didn't land easily. Making the mental note that she needed to learn to drive the ship better, she emerged to see Scorpia's ship was outside the Tavern. Sabara was going in and out of the Tavern, helping Scorpia with whatever she was doing.

Adora left the ship happy to see them.

Scorpia just scowled her and pointed to the ship and exclaimed, "What the hell is that!?"

Adora tried to explain in her She-Ra form. "This was a First One's ship! Huntara helped me find it; now we can go back."

Scorpia spat at her, "You can go back in that death trap by yourself! I'm still fixing my ship! Remember! You didn't help much when it got stolen! So why should you help now!"

Adora seemed a little deflated by Scorpia's remark and tried to sweeten the offer with "I found the Black Garnet."

Scorpia lifted her claws in the arm and sarcastically "Great, something no one can use and something I don't care about! Glad you found it!" She turned back to get into her ship.

Adora looked and Sabara, and he informed her, "They clogged the toilet on the ship. She's a little peeved about the graffiti on the tail end of the ship, too."

Adora walked around and saw what he was referring to. Someone had written in purple spray paint *I like boobies,* and someone drew a piece of poop on the right-hand side of the ship.

Adora frowned and went inside and asked Scorpia for help. Only to be shouted at.

Leaving her alone, she went back into her ship with Sabara. He whistled and remarked, "Boy, this is one heck of a setup. Who knew the First Ones were all about luxury travel years before us."

Adora didn't smile at his attempt to brighten the mood. He then commented, "Scorpia get stressed out sometimes. Usually, she's great, but I think it's the pressure she's under. Plus, she misses Catra."

Adora turned to him and replied, "I'll make sure we get back soon. My ship can take us now, but I don't think Scorpia will leave her ship behind."

Sabara replied, "It was a gift from her mother before Venema passed, so I doubt Scorpia would willingly leave it."

Adora frowned at that. Feeling guilty, she never considered why Scorpia was so upset over the ship being lost for a short time.

She heard Scorpia let out a yell in frustration as she came into Adora's ship and shouted, "The communicator won't work!"

Adora offered, "Why don't we tow it? We can leave and be back at the castle in only a few hours." Trying to help her out. Scorpia turned to her dad as he nodded about it being a good idea.

She sighed and allowed Adora to hitch up the Scorpia shaped ship just as Huntara's skiff pulled up. In shock, she replied, "Wow, surprised to see the Tavern still in one piece. By the way, thanks for leaving me behind, Blondie," she said, flicking Adora in the forehead with her index finger. Scorpia commented, "Yeah, she's good at that."

Adora rubbed her forehead and explained she didn't leave Huntara behind.

The older woman ignored her and asked Scorpia, "So? Leaving now?"

Scopria nodded and asked Huntara, "How can I thank you for keeping my dad safe?"

Scorpia asked, "You can pay me cash. If I hitch a ride with you guys, can I get a better place to stay?"

Adora's eyes narrowed to Huntara, annoyed at how flippant she was, and Sabara replied for Scorpia and told her, "We got better liquor, and you can stay in the castle."

Huntara smirked. "Well, you sold me on that. So, let's get moving, Blondie." She said, turning to Adora.

All the blondes could do was glare at her. She wanted to be more grateful to Huntara, but the second Huntara couldn't loot anything off the old ship; she left Adora out in the desert.

The four were off on the ship; Scorpia was clearly out of all patients as she kept yelling at Adora for not knowing how to use the ship properly, and Adora only replied by yelling voice commands. Eventually figuring out she could set coordinates into the pilot control panel, and they made it back to the Kingdom safely.

Returning in a massive ship caused the people in the village to panic as seeing a large ship towing the royal Scorpion ship looked worrisome.

Catra and Angella were alerted to the sight, and Catra exited the castle on her own to see what the matter was. Upon roughly landing and almost destroying Scorpia's ship in the process, the four emerged from the ship. As soon as the doors to the hangar opened, Catra was surrounded by villagers and other unseen before feline soldiers with batons at hand.

When Adora and Catra's eyes met, the feline Queen ordered everyone to stand down. "Easy, everyone, they're with us."

Angella came out to see Adora and felt an intense relief was over her. Just seeing the girl's face again made her feel so much better.

Scorpia and her father emerged from the ship. Catra felt her heart flutter a little after seeing Scorpia. The taller woman felt the same way. She was walking past Adora to see Catra up close.

The two tried to contain their excitement with an awkward formal exchange. "Hey, how did everything go here?" Scorpia asked.

Catra tried to flex a little as she explained, "These guys behind me are from Halfmoon. They are going to help us with the Horde invasion."

Scorpia then awkwardly waved them as they did the same back. Angella couldn't help but smile at this exchange. Catra took this moment to inform everyone to come inside to discuss what was going on.

Huntara followed them in.

Getting inside the war room, surprised to see so many people that looked like Catra around the castle.

Scorpia's eyes were darting all around as she had only known Catra to look the way she did, now seeing all various sizes and colors, she was a little distracted. Finally, Catra sat down next to Angella and began to explain when everyone took their seat.

Huntara's eyes were focused on Angella as she tried to sit near her; Adora swooped in to sit next to Angella, to Huntara's annoyance. A smile tugged at Angella's face to see Adora act so blatantly jealous in a way akin to Micah's past actions.

Catra explained, "I sent a message out to all the Kingdoms, unfortunately, the rest of the Alliance can't help us. But the Kingdom of Halfmoon that has been hidden for over seventeen years has come to our assistance," Catra said, gesturing to the

female and male Magicat cats sitting near her. Scorpia's eyes still darted between the felines as Catra explained, "We have made an escape plan for the civilians to Halfmoon; the next step for us to ambush the remaining Horde Soldiers in the Fright Zone. Then, with only a skeleton crew stationed there, we can take over their base and defuse any major weapons. We can even arrest Princess Entrapta and Hordak if everything goes according to plan."

Adora's face fell a little at the idea of arresting Entrapta. She knew that Entrapta had done wrong but couldn't shake the guilt of knowing it was all the Princess Alliance's fault that she ever went to the Fright Zone in the first place.

The Magicat general close to Catra spoke, "As kin to our people, we support all of Queen Catra's plans and look forward dot welcoming in the Scorpion people into our Kingdom."

Catra then turned to them and asked, "How was your mission?"

Scorpia could have taken this time to praise Adora for her efforts. Part of her knew it would have been the nice thing to do but didn't bother and explained, "After some setbacks, we were able to get Sabara, the Black Garnet and uncovered a First One's ship that can fully operate off of She-Ra's powers."

Angella smiled at Adora.

Huntara did comment, "I helped with all of that."

Catra narrowed. "And you are?"

Huntara smugly remarked, "I'm the woman who saved your wife and……servant?" She said, gesturing to Adora, making the blonde scrunches her face.

Angella frowned at that remark.

Catra seemed uninterested. "Great, well, I thank you for your help. Now, what do you want from us?"

Huntara remarked, "Food, bed, and maybe some cash for all my hard work." She shot a wink to Angella.

Catra replied, "Deal. You'll stay here in the castle in the West Quarters."

"Where is everyone else staying?" Scorpia asked.

Catra replied, "We have already started evacuating. Kyle, Lonnie, and Rogelio already left with a quarter of the villagers who were

on the outskirts, and Octavia will be leaving tonight with the elderly."

Adora asked, "How are they leaving without being detected?"

Catra looked to the feline general for that answer. But, instead, he spoke to her, "Rest assured we Magicats have a magical ability to go to our homeland without detection. So, all her royal highness Catra's people are safe."

The meeting ended shortly after that. The Magicats seemed to hover around Catra for the rest of the evening, and Scorpia was a bit of a third wheel. Same for Adora, as Huntara was obnoxiously trying to talk to Angella. Completely unaware of who Angella was, Huntara proceeded to court her only to have Angella dismiss her. Not rudely, though, Adora wished Angella would be rude. But, instead, Angella seemed to play along with Huntara's fake charm.

To Adora's sadness, she felt left out and out of place. She couldn't call Glimmer and tell her anything because Glimmer was still mad at her, and Catra was too busy to talk to.

For the first time in a long time, the Princess of Power felt useless.

Angella wasn't fond of the additional set of eyes on her. The Magicats were respectful and polite to everyone. However, Huntara's presence was something that was not expected nor

ideal. The female desert woman was firmly insistent on trying to get to know Angella better.

Sitting in the dining hall, she was given the unwanted company of Huntara. The former Crimson Waste bully had loaded her plate full of food and had asked the kitchen staff for a bottle of booze. But, unfortunately, the only thing they had was peach schnapps, and she gladly accepted them.

Sitting near Angella, she tried to talk to her again. "So, you still won't tell me your name. You know what mine is by now, right?" Huntara grinned at Angella.

The Queen rolled her eyes. "My name is Angella, and you have something in your teeth."

The white-haired woman's charming confidence went down the drain instantly as she covered her mouth and mumbled, "Not one for company, I see."

Angella let out a small laugh and handed her a napkin. "I do enjoy company, not so much the directness."

Huntara checked her teeth in the reflection of her spoon. "Well, you can't blame me. I'm from a place where the pretty gals don't come often. You married?" Huntara asked.

Angella replied, "Widow. I lost my husband ten years ago."

Huntara frowned. "Oh. Sorry. Was he a soldier?"

Angella looked down sadly. "A general."

Huntara then sat up and softly apologized, "Sorry for your loss…..and sorry for all the things the Horde has done. They took my wife when I was a soldier" She began to walk away.

Knowing she had depressed the mood, Angella turned to her and replied, "You haven't told me anything about yourself yet."

Huntara turned back to her. "Would you like to know? I don't want to bother you if you don't want the company."

Angella pulled the chair out next to her. "As widows, I feel we could both use the company."

The two talked for almost two hours. First, Huntara told Angella all about being a teenage orphan, joining the Horde, meeting her wife, and getting married in the Horde. Then, having their room in the Horde and how she lost her wife to a factory explosion, Shadow Weaver told her to get over it, which prompted Huntara to leave during a mission and go to the Crimson Waste.

Angella kept her life story vague and didn't mention that she was Queen of Brightmoon. Without her wings, she could pretend to be someone else—a noble widowed wife of a General with a daughter in the rebellion. The two enjoyed each other's company as two older women and knowing what life was like before the Horde, all while Adora sulked in a bedroom alone.

Catra and Scorpia had finally had some alone time together.

The Magicats all went back to their base for the night, leaving Catra and Scorpia back to their room to relax for the evening. Catra had finally had the chance to explain to Scorpia everything. "Long story short. Shadow Weaver was double-crossing us; The Horde would invade the Princess Alliance Kingdoms, only ours. The Princess Alliances told us they weren't going to help, and…. My transmission somehow got to the Magicat Kingdom, and they offered to help. They have teleportation powers, and they're able to cloak their Kingdom. They live somewhere in Etheria the Horde has never detected and have been shuttling people all day."

Scorpia asked, "So in the two days we were gone, you got a lot done."

Catra shrugged and replied, "I got lucky. You two were busy. Finding a ship, your dad, and the Black Garnet."

Scorpia shrugged. "That was all Adora's doing….." she paused for a moment beofre confessing, "I was kinda mean to her during the

mission."

Catra chcukcled “Adora can handle it.”

Scorpia looked at her with a concerned face. "So much has happened in such a short time. It's so overwhelming."

Catra nodded in agreement and placed her head on Scorpia's shoulder "Yeah. I am…… but I think we're going to be okay."

Scorpia let her head rest on top of Catra's. The brief moment of cuddling was interrupted by Catra's nervousness. Pulling away, she looked at Scorpia with the hope that she would kiss her without feeling any sense of doubt. But, instead, she averted her eyes and gestured, "We should get some rest."

Scorpia frowned a little at her but agreed.

She did kiss Catra on the forehead before walking into the bathroom to change into some pajamas.

Catra mentally kicked herself for being so sheepish; The Queen of a Kingdom, a Queen who successfully made contact with another Kingdom for Alliance….. too nervous to ask her wife for a kiss goodnight so, she had that not going for her.

The Queens

Adora felt worse about herself when she woke up in the morning. However, seeing Angella in the next room made her feel a little better, and she was looking forward to her time with her today. Today was a full-on evacuation for the Kingdom. A small population such as this was going to move fast since all last night; they made sure to get the elderly and children out first for safety. When she left her bedroom, she opened the door just as Angella walked out of the bathroom with a towel. Adora's eyes instantly darted to her legs, and Angella didn't say anything but smile and greeted her, "Good morning, Adora."

Adora sheepishly smiled back and greeted, "Good morning."

Angella went into her room to get dressed.

Just as she did, a knock on their door came, and Adora answered it, hoping it would be Catra. But, instead, to her annoyance, it was Huntara holding up a bouquet in her right hand.

"Hey, Blondie, is Angella around?"

Before Adora could answer, the bedroom to the right of her opened, and Angella called, "I'm still in a towel. Would you be a dear to wait for me?"

Huntara moved past Adora and purred, "Towel?"

"Don't get so insatiable this early," Angella giggled. Her tone was flirty and joyful in a way. Adora's never heard her act like this before, and it angered her to see it be given to someone like—*her*. Huntara wasn't worthy of Angella's affections. Seeing her lounge on their couch in the shared space she shared with Angella made her mad. The older purple-skinned woman smirked at Adora and teased, "Cute robe." Referring to the ugly moon cactus robes that were left for them in the rooms upon arrival.

Adora looked down and clutched the collar and growled, "Angella and I will be busy today—"

Angella dressed in a dark purple frilly wrapped around her neck and revealed her back with tight pink leggings and white heels. Huntara whistled and rushed to give her the flowers. "You got dressed so quickly." She commented. Noticing Angella's hair was still wet, and commented, "You smell good."

Angella smiled and accepted the flowers with a very slight flush coming over her cheeks. "Thank you, these are lovely,"

She looked up to see Huntara smiling warmly at her and sputtered, "I—I still need to dry my hair, pardon me for a moment." She said, returning to her room with the flowers in her hand.

Huntara couldn't help but keep smiling at her as she sat on the couch next to Adora and asked, "You got She-Ra stuff to do, right? So I can keep her company today for you."

Adora glared and reminded Huntara, "I'm staying with her today; Angella wants that."

Hearing the hairdryer go off, she wished Huntara would leave.

Not taking no for an answer, Huntara kept waiting for Angella to see what she wanted to do.

When the Queen emerged from her room to see her two pining ladies look at her. Angella smiled at the two and asked, "We should see what Catra is planning."

Huntara and Adora both sat up, and Adora spoke first and said, "You and I should do that."

Huntara snarked, "Yeah, you in pajamas should do that."

Adora buffed out her cheeks and was ready to say something when Angella offered, "Adora, get freshened up, and I'll be with Huntara in the war room with the others." She said, coming closer to Adora to kiss her forehead as her lips made contact with Adora's forehead. Her eyes somewhat managed to stay on Huntara as she did to see her reaction. Adora nodded and went

off to the bathroom, feeling victory for her little forehead kiss, but she was unaware that Huntara was not impressed by that.

Leaving the room, Huntara tried to over her arm for Angella to hold on to, and the Queen playfully remarked, "So determined to make this a date?"

Huntara replied, "It's going to take a lot more than flowers for that, then is it?"

"Much more." She teased.

Huntara was willing to play this game with her; a woman who is hard to get isn't something Huntara feared. She secretly enjoyed the idea of being flirty with Angella non-stop. Trying to get her to giggle and blush was the mission for her today, maybe get her *romp* on. Angella was no fool to these games. After Micah died, she received countless letters from men wanting to meet with her in private; some of the old princess alliance members tried to get her to go on dates four years after Micah died, and Angella shot all of them down. Politely responding to all invites that she was still in mourning. Tragically, many people found her excuses exhausting and stopped reaching out, including former alliance members she would once call friends. It saddened her, but she was unable to resolve those old matters. Her husband met everything to her, and without him, she never wanted to be with any other man after that. No one was as handsome and perfect as Micah.

The company of women didn't bother her. Women flirting with her seemed more innocent and playful; despite Huntara being a handsome woman, she was not crossing any boundaries. In the war room, she saw Catra with more Magicats surrounding her. Angella liked their respectful nature to Catra. Ever since they have been present, they have treated Cara with such a powerful authority and were kind to her. They showed to have high regard for her, and it made Angella start to question their reasoning. As trusting and open they were to this Kingdom's needs, they have asked for nothing in return.

Catra started to feel her doubts sink in when they specifically asked for Catra to be the last to arrive. Part of her hoped it was for a party, but the other part feared it was because of something more sinister. No one would speak to her about any necessary details, and that started to bother her. Worrying that she might have sent innocent Scorpion Kingdom people to their doom made her fearful now. Without any other details and no one telling her anything except that everyone was adjusting well didn't make Catra feel as good as she wanted to. When the Magicats left the war room, she wanted to speak with Angella in private but saw Huntara was following her; she was not interested in making new accuracies. So she asked if Angella could help check the outskirts of town make sure everyone evacuated. Angella was happy to get an assessment and feel useful, and it makes up for her embarrassing herself by losing the fight with Shadow Weaver. Something no one has even dared to bring up since it happened.

Angella and Huntara walked out to the castle's front, where a castle server had driven a boat over to use for their mission. Huntara paused for a moment. "We gotta get you a cloak for you." She spoke. Angella huffed. "Oh, please, I'll be fine." Huntara playfully ran her fingers down Angella's back and teased, "Your dainty soft skin won't handle this heat."

Angella jumped a bit and let a slight squeak almost at the contact. Huntara chuckled. "See, you can't even handle that."

Angella huffed retrieved a cloak from inside the castle, all while trying to keep her smile off her face. The flutter in her stomach from such direct flirting was something only Micah dared ever to do. Placing it over herself, she got on the skiff and offered for Huntara to join her.

Gladly accepting, she made sure to stand close to Angella and admire how poorly Angella drove a skiff into town. She found it cute how an obvious diplomat like Angella would eagerly accept hard labor. Eventually, the sand and wind became too much for her, and Huntara offered and took over for her.

"Let me do it." Huntara offered, taking control.

Angella smirked. "You seem so cautious of me; I'm not flower or anything."

Huntara grinned and didn't take the chance to tease her. Instead, she just offered, "Let a big strong gal like me take care of you."

That statement sent heat to her face and the lower region as Micah used to flex his muscles and tell her to let his big strong

arms handle things. Such as opening jars and doors to get a few laughs out of her.

Taken back a bit by the memory, she regained her composure and instructed Huntara where to go.

Angella navigated Huntara through town as they checked the remaining houses to make sure everyone was out. Angella knocked on doors while Huntara walked around the cabins to make sure no one was in sight. As Angella knocked on one door, it creaked open, and she saw an empty house. A soft gasp came out of Angella as she saw a whole family's life in just one tiny room. A living room with pictures on every inch of the walls and a mantel of gemstones on the front couch. Huntara noticed the valuables lying around the house, and all Angella could pay attention to was the pictures. "Look, this family were gemstone harvesters," Angella said with a hint of sadness in her voice. Huntara nodded and saw Angella being distracted and quickly shoved the gemstones into her pocket that could fit since they could sell quickly in the Crimson Waste. She made sure to keep Angella's back towards her so she could steal more from every house they went to. Every time they returned to the skiff, she made sure to put her loot in a small sack as her pockets kept filling up the more they went along the homes.

Getting farther and farther out into town, Huntara stopped and what appeared to be a hot spring house.

"Looks like a business outside here," Huntara commented.

Angella mentioned, "It's the last place in town."

"Good," Huntara said. Then, she drove over a bump of sand, and Angella felt pain in her bladder. Hours of waiting to go back to the castle made her need for a washroom difficult. Waiting in long meetings and dealing with Alliance while pregnant trained her bladder well, but she needed to stop in this situation.

She sputtered, "Perhaps we hurry there?" Angella asked.

Huntara questioned, "You want me to go faster? We'll start flying all over the place if I do that." And also possibly expose her loot bag to Angella if that happens.

Angella readjusted her crossed legs and let out an audible whimper as she turned her head away from Huntara.

Huntara smirked and asked, "What's wrong gorgeous?"

Angella, flustered, replied, "N-nothing."

The muscular woman teased, "Gotta pee?"

Angella looked at her with her hair frizzing out from the ends of the hooded cloak. "I—I need to freshen up, yes."

Huntara chuckled and opened the front door with force. "To elegant to say pee?"

Angella huffed. "Just get us there faster, please."

Huntara stopped the skiff and told her, "Alright, go pee."

Angella panicked. "What?"

Huntara tilted her head and pointed to the sand. "Go pee. Just squat behind the skiff; I won't watch."

Angella frantically shook her head. "No, no, thank I cannot do that."

Huntara chuckled. "Too prudent!"

"If I say yes will you start driving again," Angella asked as her voice became slightly shrill?

Huntara grinned and started the skiff back up to drive, and they made to the front doors of the hot spring.

Huntara smiled. "Oh, a hot spring, that's pretty cool." She helped Angella out of the skiff and watched humorously as the elegant woman walked with a bit more speed than usual to the front door. Letting out an audible whine when she realized it was locked. Huntara cracked her knuckles and quickly opened the doors with force. Angella thanked her and dashed inside to luckily see the female changing room was to the right and went into the curtained room.

Huntara peered over the counter to the tip jar was full of change, and she looked back to make sure Angella was not around to see her jump over the counter and start to steal any loose valuables. She found a lost items box that had small pieces of jewelry and stuffed them into her pockets. Walking around the lobby, she found a small vase with an emerald crystal in it and decided to rip it out. She was leaving a small crack in it. She heard Angella come into the lobby and quickly acted like she was doing nothing.

Angella offered, "Ready to go?"

Huntara smiled. "How was your bathroom break?"

Angella blushed and didn't answer that. Instead, only telling her, "They have a very nice hot spring back there if you want to see it?"

Huntara jested, "I would rather see you pee."

Angella covered her mouth. "Don't be dirty."

Huntara chuckled. "C'mon, you're telling me you never saw your husband pee before?"

Angella rolled her eyes. Biting her lip, she made the bold decision to share a dirty secret from her past "I've seen him relieve himself before. I one time *held* it for him as he did." She replied with a slight blush.

Huntara whistled softly, "Oh wow. Naughty girl."

Angella put her cloak back on and replied, "I have a child. I'm not so much of a prude."

Huntara gave Angella a sultry look and offered, "Want to show me how imprudent you can be?"

Angella flustered and gently ran her hands through her hair. "And how would I do such a thing like that?"

Huntara looked over the female changing room and grinned. "I can take you up on that offer of seeing the hot spring. Maybe we can take a quick dip together?"

Angella gulped practically and sputtered out, "W-we would have to be quick about it. This is an evacuation mission. And a certainly wouldn't want to keep Catra and Scorpia waiting."

Huntara winked and replied, "Well, my tongue better work fast."

Angella blushed and let out a louder than needed to be laugh. "Oh! Ha! I um, I—let's not get ahead of ourselves."

"Says the blushing girl." Huntara teased.

Both entering the hot spring, Huntara instantly gained more interest as soon as she saw plenty of jewel-encrusted wall art around the spring, and she would rather be off stealing every emerald and sapphire she could find. However, she was still slightly horny, and her new attractive posh friend seemed willing to entertain her. The more muscular woman pondered on how to handle Angella with all her strength. Indeed, we weren't the type for anything rough, and that for Huntara was a letdown, but she could make it work. She felt Angella might make it fun with her bashful demeanor. The idea of making this prissy diplomat fluster and moan in pleasure for enough for Huntara to forget about her petty thought plan. As gently as she could, she pinned Angella to a wall with gemstones above her promised her, "You are going to love what I'm about to do for you."

Angella smiled nervously and allowed herself to be taken by her.

Back at the Scorpion Kingdom

Adora internally struggled with her replacement in Angella's heart. The Queen of Brightmoon was off with a criminal on a mission, and Adora was left with Catra. Angry that the feline would even consider for Angella to do a mission. Catra knew that was Adora's problem; even in her She-Ra form helping staff in the castle leave and talking to other Magicat soldiers still showed the upset look in Adora's eyes.

With a free moment, Catra pulled her aside. "Hey, Angella is fine."

Adora huffed. "I didn't want her to be left alone with that woman."

Catra shrugged. "Well, we kinda don't have many options; I paid her off, and she should behave; they're only in town making sure every house is empty. There isn't anything else they can do."

Adora didn't want to hear that.

Catra didn't understand her feelings on this and wouldn't. "Easy for you to say, You have Scorpia, you married with a Kingdom and everything."

Catra's ears twitched in surprise at what she had just heard; Adora was jealous and bitter. For someone who can turn into a giant sword lady, she found what Catra had to be better. After all this time, she always wanted to have a one-up on Adora, and now she finally did, and it didn't even feel satisfying.

"Hearing you lament like this should be more fun, but it's not." Catra sighed, grabbing Adora's forearm and taking her into the empty war room to talk. Adora sulked. "I know, I'm such a terrible friend for even saying that."

"Oh, big time!" Catra assured her. Not sugar coating Adora's ridiculousness.

"You're great to talk to in times like this," Adora replied sarcastically.

Catra snorted. "Well, the Horde taught so much on emotional support."

The two shared a small laugh and began to try to talk usually. Adora was happy for Catra and wanted to express that but didn't know-how. Catra could tell Adora was upset about Angella being

with someone else today and didn't have the words to make Adora feel any better about it.

Catra offered a compliment to her to get the conversation flowing. "Thanks for helping with all the heavy lifting. The Magicat general with the eyepatch is impressed."

Adora smiled and looked down at her feet. "I'm glad I can help." She looked at Catra. "I'm thrilled you connected with them. The Magicats are all very nice."

"They are; they've been all great to me. It's just weird to have people so nice to me."

Adora frowned at knowing Catra was hardly ever on the receiving end of kindness beofre.

Catra nudged Adora and offered, "Hey, you know being Adora and She-Ra is still important. So if you want to call it quits on being in stuffy sparkly Brightmoon, you can always be here with me. You and I know we do some serious damage to the Horde, and you will be treated a million times better with me wherever I go."

Adora nodded and extended her hand to hold Catra's. "Maybe I should do that."

Catra smiled. "Good! This is great. I just have to tell Scorpia! Think about the powerhouse we can build now with you being with us."

The two heard a knock on the doors, and Catra called for them to enter. Shocked to see Lonnie and Kyle standing in the doorway, both rushed over to them.

Catra was happy to see them. As much as she didn't want to admit it, she stood up and asked them, "What is your report on the Magicat Kingdom?"

Lonnie informed her with high enthusiasm, "Catra, the place is great! Everyone is happy, gets along, has this cool cave castle and city with glowing crystal lights and everything, and the Scorpion generals and the Magicat generals were playing volleyball last. So everyone is looking forward to meeting you."

Kyle chimed in, "Yeah, you're the—OW!" he was sharply nudged by Lonnie to shut up.

"I'm the what?" Catra asked.

Lonnie corrected, "You're the guest of honor as the Queen of this Kingdom. The King of the Magicats is looking forward to meeting you."

Adora raised a brow as she knew Lonnie was hiding something. Catra didn't care to pressure her for the truth as she saw Scorpia in the doorway and excused herself. "That's great, thank you for telling me." With that, she left the three alone in the war as she walked over to Scorpia to go down the hall.

Lonnie whispered in Adora's ear, "The King is Catra's father; Catra is a princess."

Adora backed away in shock. "Wait, Catra? our Catra?"

Kyle nodded and explained, "She was stolen from the Horde when she was a baby, and the Magicats used their magic to hide themselves away from the war."

Lonnie extended their arms out. "Adora, this Kingdom is huge, and Catra is important to them."

Adora averted her eyes from the two and thought about what she had just heard. Catra is being reunited with her family. She has a family that missed her and wanted her. Does Adora have anyone that is missing her after all these years? It made her sad for herself but happy for Catra.

Kyle innocently asked, "Oh hey, where's Queen Angella?"

Adora turned cold as she replied, "She's busy." \

Both flinched a little at her sudden mood change and awkwardly told Adora they would see if they needed help with anything in the castle.

Adora stormed off to see if she could get her mind of Angella.

Scorpia and Catra snuck off to their room to talk. Scorpia asked, "So, what were you and Adora talking about?"

Catra replied, "She's a little down right now. She's not in the spotlight, so you know how she is."

Scorpia sat on the bed and replied, "Oh yeah, I know."

Catra sat next to "So I offered her to join of Kingdom."

Scorpia sputtered, "Like live with us?"

Catra nodded. "Yeah, what's wrong with that?"

"What if tries to steal you away from me? You two are so bonded she might seduce you and convince you to divorce me." Scorpia

confessed. Her dislike for Adora was more routed in the fear that Adora might steal Catra from her.

Catra laughed. "Trust me, that won't happen. Besides, Adora is hung up on Angella so that she won't try anything like that."

Scorpia didn't look convinced.

Catra gulped and told her, "I love you so that I wouldn't do that."

Scorpia looked surprised for Catra to say that.

Catra then followed it up with, "After the war stuff, we should go on dates and stuff." She said, averting her eyes away as if she was embarrassed to suggest it.

Scorpia saw the look of shyness come over her and confirmed, "We should."

The two shared a warm smile, and Scorpia leaned in to kiss Catra. The feline's tail fluffed up, and she leaned in for a kiss too. The contact between lips was brief as the two pulled away and gave each other an awkward smile. Scorpia flustered and sputtered, "S—so when how long before we get to go on dates?"

Catra stammered, "We could see if we can have dinner alone tonight or maybe brunch. I like brunch."

They let out a shared laugh before returning down to the war room to see what else they could do before they all left.

Back in the hot spring with Angella and Huntara.

Huntara was lying on her back on the rocks of the spring as Angella was lying on a towel panting with her legs open. Both naked and breathing heavy, the muscular woman stood up and admired her handy work of making the elegant woman climax and scream. Angella nervously covered herself with her hands and smiled at her sheepishly.

"You are loud for a fancy lady." Huntara teased while she extended a hand to her.

Angella took it and stood up and teased back, "I made be a bit vocal for someone who hasn't done this in twelve years; at least I'm not so naughty like some are."

Huntara chuckled. "It's cute how you say naughty. I was having a lot of with you."

Angella walked over to her clothes and started to put them on. Huntara did the same, and Angella asked, "I don't feel as if I satisfied you; I hope you don't think I'm selfish."

Huntara shook her head. "Oh, don't worry about it; I was getting off when I was eating you out. I've always been a service top, but you by far are the biggest pillow princess I've been within a long while."

Angella shivered at that and corrected "*Pillow Queen*."

Huntara playfully curtsied, "Oh my pleasure, you pillow majesty."

The two laughed at that as they drove back to the castle. Angella felt more connected with Huntara after this moment. She was sitting closer to her on the skiff as they made their way back. She admired how strong her arms were and how she had a particular type of beauty and handsomeness she never found in another woman. Her staring went noticed as Huntara turned to her and puckered her lips to give her an air kiss. Stunned at Huntara's bold gesture, Angella's eyes went wide as she stared at her.

"You remind me a little of my wife, y'know," Huntara remarked.

Angella questioned, "What about me reminds me of her?"

Huntara kept her eyes facing forward and explained, "She had an accent. Not like yours, but she had one, and she was tall, thin, and soft-spoken. I never could understand why she was in the Horde since she wasn't much of a fighter. Instead, she took care of orphans in the nursery and infirmary. You seem like you'd be someone to do that. You give off that motherly vibe."

"I do have a daughter at home," Angella mentioned.

Huntara asked her, "Do I remind you of your husband at all?"

Angella pondered, "Well, you're strong like him, an exceptional lover….. but I can't think of anything else you and Micah would have in common."

Huntara blinked and narrowed her eyes for a moment. "Wait a minute….. Micah was the King of Brightmoon…." She looked down at Angella. "Are you Angella as in Queen Angella?"

Angella nodded and looked down for a moment.

Huntara seemed a bit tongue-tied as she sputtered, "Wh—what happened to your wings. I thought you were some Angelic Goddess?"

The Queen rolled her eyes. "I'm no goddess, and my wings were injured, and until I return to Brightmoon, I won't be able to

regenerate them."

Huntara shook her head in disbelief and sighed. "Wow, I didn't expect this. How the hell is *The Queen, who is never seen* out running around in the desert? Did you get dethroned?"

Angella shot a glare at her and explained, "Diplomacy is limited. The Alliance is scarce. So, I went on this mission with Adora to resolve a conflict and have the Scorpion Kingdom join the Alliance."

Huntara stayed silent as it all sunk into her. The woman she had flirted with was an actual Queen and not just any Queen but a Queen of Etheria that was rumored to be reclusive and mysterious. She glanced over at Angella and smiled at her. Then she looked back at the sand road in front of her and whistled, "Wow, I was just in between the legs of the Queen of Brightmoon. Of course, no one will ever believe me in the Crimson Waste, but then again, I've never been one to kiss and tell."

Angella grabbed ahold of her forearm. Her eyes are pleading for her not to tell people about them. Huntara didn't need to explain herself

When they returned to the castle, she helped Angella off the skiff; Huntara kept her burlap sack of goods over her shoulder and wondered if Angella would question it. But, instead, Angella just clung to her arm as she ascended down from the skiff and offered her, "Would you like to join the generals and me for dinner?"

Huntara shifted her eyes. "To be honest, I'd rather not. I only came here to get some money to help blondie. But I do intend on going back home tomorrow. I'm not sticking around for the Horde."

Angella then offered her, "If you stay and help, the payment will be better than what you were originally given."

Huntara sighed and still declined.

Angella felt foolish.

Once she realized she was still clinging to her arm, she moved away and apologized. Huntara took her hand and kissed it. Angella smiled at this and turned to the castle's front gate to see a Magicat and Scorpion guard come towards them. They asked how the outskirts of the Kingdom were, and they confirmed no one was left behind. They let them know that Scorpia and Catra wanted to announce tonight, and the remainder of the Kingdom will be executed tonight.

Angella asked, "What about Shadow Weaver?"

The Scorpion guard replied, "She will be transported with us."

The Magicat guard nodded at that remark.

Huntara and Angella gave each other a concerned look while they went inside with them. Walking in, they saw Adora in her She-Ra by Lonnie and Kyle. They had just finished telling her all about how fantastic the Magicat Kingdom was. When Adora turned to Angella, her face showed hurt in her eyes.

Angella instantly knew why Adora was upset. She had spent the entire day with Huntara and not her. Before Angella or Adora could say a word to each other, Huntara greeted her, "Hey, Blondie, how was everything here?"

Adora kept her composure and explained, "Everyone has safely left, and the rest of the castle guards are packing, and we'll be off soon." She shifted her gaze to Angella and explained, "We're going back to Brightmoon tonight. The head General of Magicats is the most powerful teleportation sorcerer in Etheria. He can get us to Brightmoon in a matter of minutes." She shot Huntara a glare and told her, "He can bring you back to the Crimson Waste later, too."

Angella motioned closer to Adora, and the blonde just walked away from them. Lonnie explained, "She's been angry all day."

Angella frowned and followed after Adora. Huntara glanced over awkwardly at Lonnie and Kyle and tried to conversate with them. "So….. you two Horde child soldiers?"

She was making the two shifts uncomfortably before Huntara decided to go back to her room in the castle to pack up. But, in the meantime, she decided to do some snooping around to see any valuables. To her luck, she found some gold-plated frames and jewel-crusted items around the castle halls, not including ransacking the armory room for small knives and daggers. With everyone worrying about taking supplies, Huntara made off like a bandit with anything that wasn't bolted down. Now without any worry, she started to fill up multiple sacks of goods and went back to her tiny room she stayed in last night. She wanted to get herself ready to leave without anyone detecting her so she wouldn't have to explain her thieving.

While she was doing that, Angella had finally got Adora alone in their room as she tried to talk to her about what she was feeling.

Adora de-transformed back into her usual self and sat down on the couch to sulk. Angella sat beside her and asked, "Did you have a mission today?"

Adora replied, "Catra and I talked for a bit, but all I did was manual labor, making sure the castle staff left. The Magicats are very nice; Lonnie and Kyle told me all about them." She didn't elaborate any further. "How was your mission?"

Angella moved closer and explained, "My mission was successful. We made sure no one was still in their houses and made it back just fine."

Adora gave her a half-smile, "That's good."

The older woman questioned, "Are you upset with me?"

Adora shook her head. "N—no, I can't be upset. How could I? you were doing a mission. I can't be selfish and be upset about that."

Angella bit her lip and inquired, "Are you a little cross that Huntara was with me?"

Adora didn't look at her and answered, "I can't be. Who am I to question your friendships?"

Angella paused before asking, "Please tell me why you were upset."

Adora sat up and turned to her. "I'm not upset, your majesty. Now, if you would please excuse me, I must pack up. Glimmer has called for us to return to Brightmoon, so we should get ready to return to your castle."

Angella reached out, held Adora's hand, and corrected, "Adora, is that your home too."

Adora shook her head. "Not anymore." Her voice cracked. "I've taken Catra up on her offer to stay with her. So I'll be between the

Magicat Kingdom and here. It's the best thing to do with She-Ra's powers since the war is coming to an end."

Angella pulled Adora closer. Spinning her around to face her, "Adora, why did you make such a decision without asking anyone first?"

Adora pulled away. "I don't need to ask anyone for permission to leave! You are not my mother, Angella! You've made that clear to me!"

"But I am your Queen!" she shouted.

Adora looked at her coldly and replied, "Yes, and as *A Queen,* you can have everyone you want. The war is ending, and I'll be of no use to you. So, I should leave Birghtmoon."

Angella felt hurt by her words and sat back down to look away from Adora knows she can't convince Adora to stay if the blonde finds there is no reason to do so. She sighed and accepted. "Very well, Adora. I will not stop you."

More hurt came over Adora's face as she realized her bluff was not, followed by Angella pleading for her to stay with her. After the whole experience, Angella had only seen Adora for her duty and nothing more. The foolish romantic desire had lasted as short as the tiny kisses they shared. Angella was a Queen of Birghtmoon and heartbreak.

After that conversation, Angella couldn't stay in the same suite as Adora and went down the hall to see Huntara. She was catching a castle guard on her way that directed her to the west wing of the castle to see her. She knocked lightly and heard a shuffle come her way from behind the door, and Huntara opened it. Smiling, "I figured such a fancy knock came from you."

Angella bashfully tucked some hair behind her right ear. "My knock isn't fancy."

Huntara shrugged. "Well, it's defiantly dainty and soft." So, she said as she took Angella's hand into her own and raised it to her lips. "Like her hands," she said before kissing it.

An awkwardly bashful laugh escaped Angella's mouth, and she instantly covered her face. Huntara chuckled. "Don't get shy on me, and you weren't so shy in that hot spring."

Angella averted her eyes and sputtered, "Well, it was certainly an experience to leave someone to blush."

Huntara smirked and replied, "And blush, you sure know how to do."

Angella covered her cheeks with her hands. "I didn't come to your door to get teased, you know."

Huntara pulled her in closer. "Did you come for round two?"

Angella felt her face get even hotter as she explained, "I was coming to offer an invitation to Brightmoon?"

Huntara raised a brow. "To Brightmoon? As for what?"

Angella shifted a little "Well, as a new citizen of Birghtmoon. Live and enjoy my Kingdom with your place of residents, be close to me and all Brightmoon has to offer. It's a much more quiet and relaxing life than the Crimson Waste."

Huntara smiled and nodded. "Yeah, it would, but Angella, I'm not for that life."

Angella frowned. "What's wrong with a life of luxury?"

Huntara let out a scoff. "Luxury? Being a pet. Forget it. There is no luxury in living under someone else's rules. I live my way, and I love it. Besides, I tried living in a few Kingdoms while I was drifting from the Horde. It never worked out; no, Angella, sorry I won't come with you back to Brightmoon."

Angella looked down nervously, clasped her hands together in front of her, and softly "Well. I must respect your wishes and be on my way—" she stopped in mid-sentence and noticed several brown sacks under Huntara's bed. "What are all those?"

Huntara looked down and realized she was caught. Her soft demeanor turned severe as she scowled, "Look, I earned what I got in those, alright? So you don't need to know what's in them."

Angella crossed her arms and demanded, "What in Etheria did you do? Steal? When did you have the time to do that? I've been with you all day."

Huntara stepped closer. "I was with you while I was collecting souvenirs all day."

Angella shrank back a little bit. Huntara threatened, "It wouldn't be smart to tell anyone what you saw just now. No one wants to find out the Queen of Brightmoon romped with a criminal during her contribution to the Allie Kingdom. So don't put yourself through that embarrassment, Angella." She then turned to grab her bags. "Forget what you saw." She warned.

She walked past Angella to the door and softly thanked her. "I had a good time with you, and what I have here in my hands will take care of me for months" she looked behind at her to see Angella had her back to her. Shaken and upset, Angella did not turn around to face her.

Huntara softly said again, "I'm sorry." And left down the hall without saying anything else.

Angella was such a fool today; everything on this mission has shown her what a terrible Queen she was; she was weak, couldn't fight, was too powerless to defend people, and was too cowardly to handle this situation before her. She left the room and saw no one in the hallways. The vacant sound of wind moving through the cold stone walls made her know her place. Brightmoon was the only place she belonged, and staying in her castle was the best thing for her.

Angella felt the tears fall down her face. She didn't feel like a Queen right now.

Another Queen in the castle was facing another struggle right now as Catra and a Magicat guard went down to the dungeon that Shadow Weaver was being locked in. Catra has been more at peace with the idea of Shadow Weaver being locked up. However, as much as she should be happy with Shadow Weaver's fall from power, she was unhappy with Shadow Weaver's lack of care for her title. Shadow Weaver has never respectfully regarded Catra as a Queen yet, and that made the feline furious.

At the door to her cell Shadow Weaver sarcastically greeted them, "Ah, two beasts have come to take me away, I see."

The guard gave Catra a look and remarked, "If you wish your majesty, I will destroy her right now for you."

"Your majesty." Shadow Weaver almost laughed. Finding humor in how he addressed Catra. "It must be satisfying for you, Catra, to finally get to play the part as the important child now."

Catra stepped forward and reminded Shadow Weaver, "I can just kill you now, and you know that."

Shadow Weaver then replied with "I could have done that to you when you were abandoned by the same people who are trying to help you now."

Catra's eyes went wide, and the Magicat guard spoke up, "She speaks lies to you, my Queen."

Shadow Weaver stood up and extended her hand out to Catra. "I may never have been the maternal figure you craved, but I did save you from death as an infant. You can never deny me that now, can you?"

The guard swatted Shadow Weaver's hand away from Catra and warned, "You shall not touch her!"

Shadow Weaver stood back and watched Catra's reaction. Knowing she had made Catra doubt her position of power. Shadow Weaver remarked, "Just like Adora, you know nothing about your true past."

Catra then asked, "What does that mean?"

Shadow Weaver remained silent, and Catra raised her voice, "What does that mean!?"

Back to Brightmoon

"What do you mean!?" Catra yelled to Shadow Weaver.

The sorcerous remained calm while the Magicat guard tried to calm Catra down. "Your majesty, we need to leave. We must take this prisoner and go."

Shadow Weaver then spoke, "He is right. The reveal will be more satisfying when you hear it from the people who left you as a child."

Catra felt her stomach lurch at the thought of meeting direct family or kin to her that knew her or knew of her. As a child, she accepted she wasn't wanted, which is why she ended up in the Horde. The idea of facing the people who led her to live that horrible life. The pain of that was too much to bear, and she ordered her "Silence!"

The Magicat guard blocked Catra from striking Shadow Weaver as he pleaded, "Your majesty, we must take her and leave before the Horde comes." Catra didn't say anything to him as she stormed out of the room. The guard grabbed Shadow Weaver and met with the rest of everyone who was still left in the Kingdom. Several Magicats were teleporting people out. Scorpia waited for Catra and looked over to see Angella and Adora. Both looked uneasy, but Catra would miss seeing Adora and walked over to her. "Hey, good luck with everything," Catra said.

Adora knew something was wrong and reached out to hug her. "You too." The hug was comforting to Catra and just what she needed as she returned the embrace. When the two broke apart, a Magicat summoned Adora and Angella over to return to Brightmoon. He instructed them. "Keep ahold of me; we will be there in just a few moments."

With that, in seconds, Angella and Adora were gone in a blue poof of smoke. She was leaving Catra without her childhood best friend. She looked to her wife and walked over to her. Her hand reached for her claw in comfort. Scorpia saw that something was the matter and fearfully thought Adora's departure made her sad. In only a few more seconds, the remainder of the Kingdom was gone. All with the Magicats doing their teleportation work, the entire Kingdom was empty, and the Horde was only an hour away from invading.

In the same blue smoke and light that made Adora and Angella disappear, it made them reappear with the Magicat who escorted them had landed the three outside the Castel of Brightmoon. He asked, "Would you like me to take you to the gates, your majesty?"

Angella shook her head. "No, I'd prefer to be at the Moonstone. The pillar up there." She pointed to. He looked at it and nodded. In another poof, a blue smoke, they were at the Moonstone. A nearby bed was there for Angella. Adora knew this little bed from where Glimmer laid when she needed to recharge her powers. She had never seen Angella use the Moonstone the way Glimmer did. She had never seen Angella in the Moonstone chamber at all beofre, due to them not being close before this mission. Angella made her way over to the bed and lifted her shirt in front of Adora without warning. Bareback revealed to the blonde's eyes while

her laying covered her bare chest on her stomach while the Runestones glow hit her back. Adora gulped and walked over to her, seeing for the first time that Angella had the same back marking Glimmer had, except her markings were white wings. She sat on the floor next to Angella, and the Queen held out her hand for Adora to grab hold of it while she remained lying down. To see Angella in a vulnerable position was something Adora would never get used to. She loved that Angella was comfortable around her enough to disrobe and lay down, but not at the idea that most of all, Angella's injuries were partly due to Adora's lack of presence during conflicts. Angella tightly squeezed her hand and softly spoke, "Your planning to join Catra in the Scorpion Kingdom when they return?"

Adora looked sad. Knowing she said that in a moment of jealous anger does not mean it. Nor did she want to move all the way out to the desert. Then, looking into Angella's eyes, she softly asked her, "Would it upset you if I left?" Adora felt childish for asking her that. Knowing it was an unfair question to ask her with all that was going on.

Angella replied, "I would, as would Glimmer and the rest of the Princess Alliance. There will be so much to do after this War, and I know you'll be helpful no matter where you are. But, I don't want to share you with all of Etheria now."

That was not the reply she was expecting from Angella. She was half expecting to be scolded for trying to get sympathy from Angella or be told that it wouldn't matter to her if Adora left. But, instead, the blonde felt genuine love at that moment from Angella. She was resting her chin on the bed to be faced with Angella. The Queen smiled at her and told her, "I will support your decision. But, please do keep me in mind when you travel."

Adora asked her, "Would you ever consider going on a royal tour throughout Etheria?"

Angella smiled. "I haven't been on one since Glimmer was born. Before returning, we took her to Plumeria, Thaymore, and a few other cities. It may be ideal for me to do so."

Adora offered, "We can make it another personal mission?"

Angella closed her eyes and let out a soft giggle. "Is that your way of asking someone on a date?"

Adora felt her cheeks flush and replied, "Would it of worked?"

Angella hummed and then replied, "It would, at least on me."

Adora smiled and closed her eyes. Then opened them and asked, "would this be bad timing to ask how was your day trip with Huntara?"

Angella opened her eyes. "Only a little, but if you must know, it went well in the beginning and not so well in the end. She…. Isn't it someone I think will come around again? I don't think I'll ever see her."

It was vague enough not to upset Adora any further than she had already been.

Adora sat in silence while still holding Angella's hand. Then, softly telling Adora, "I may take longer due to being so drained of my magic. But, you can go and tell Glimmah we're here. Just tell her I'm regenerating my wings, and I would only want her to come up here alone."

Adora protested, "I want to stay with you right now."

Angella told her, "Please get Glimmah; I miss her. I know she is cross with us, but I do want her."

Adora frowned but did as Angella requested.

She leaves the Moonstone champer to return inside the castle only to be aggressively stopped by the guards she has known all year. They still escorted her to the war room as if she was still new to the castle. Entering the war room, she saw Glimmer in with Bow wearing a different Brightmoon uniform. Her typical purple outfit was replaced with an outfit similar to Angella's, and her hair was brushed differently. She looked more like Angella, which brought a smile to Adora's face. "Glimmer! Bow! It's so good to see you both!"

Bow ran to hug her, and Adora returned the embrace happily. Unfortunately, Glimmer seemed less impressed and wasn't as

happy to see Adora as would be expected. She was happy she was back in Brightmoon safely, but she wanted to see her mom.

Glimmer kept her composure as the two friends hugged.

When Adora turned to embrace Glimmer, the sparkle princess reluctantly hugged her. Adora commented, "You look different; I like it; you look like Angella."

Glimmer found it odd that Adora referred to her mother without the royal title. Glimmer pulled back and cleared her throat. "Thanks, but where is she?"

Adora replied, "She wanted to go to the Moonstone chamber first. She asked for you to come up there and see her alone."

Glimmer instantly teleported out of the room to her mother without another word. She was worried for her; Angella was the only parent she had left. If she lost Angella, it would destroy her; she never imagined a world without her mother around. The immortal Queen could never die of old age, and Glimmer knew that Angella would be at her funeral one day. The idea of losing Angella was now a fear Glimmer had after seeing her mother be struck with a laser beam and plummet to the ground surrounded by horrified onlookers watching her wings fizzle away.

The glittery poof of light she was in the Moonstone chamber viewing her topless mother laying on her back. Her exposed back shining from the Moonstone's light. Glimmer rushed to her "Mom?!" Glimmer cried.

Glimmer gently placed an arm around Angella's back, unsure if she was still in pain. Angella raised a hand to cradle Glimmer's face weakly. Then, she gently responded, "My Princess, I've missed you."

Glimmer did her best to hide her tears and replied, "I've missed you too, mom. I'm happy your back."

Angella's body began to glow as she sat up. Her front chest was exposed to Glimmer as the princess politely took the shirt Angella was wearing to help her cover her breasts.

Angella took It and pressed it close to her chest, and remarked, "I will be fine love. Please inform me about everything that has gone on thus far?"

Glimmer shook her head. "We have plenty of time to talk about that, and I just want to make sure your okay."

Angella let out a small laugh. "It's almost like I go off to some dangerous place with little contact would make a loved one so worried?"

Glimmer bit her lip and embraced her mother. "Mom, I'm so sorry; I never meant ever to make you feel like this. I was so scared I was going to lose you."

Angella frowned at this. At this time, making such a remark was just as poor as the many rude remarks Glimmer had made to her during their many arguments in the past. She hugged her daughter closely and apologized, "I'm sorry to have worried you, Glimmah, please don't be cross with Adora or me now—"

Just mentioning the blonde's name but Glimmer on the defense of stating, "Adora really should have been there for you when that happened." She remarked flatly. Cleary has done with rationalizing her anger.

Angella offered, "The Kingdom was under attack, and she needed to where she was. I was the one who chose to jump into battle. So you can't be upset with her."

Glimmer sighed. "Fine, I won't be as upset with Adora." She looked at her mother as Angella sat up. Wincing, the Queen then levitated a few inches off the ground as her wings restored behind her. The blast of white light was powerful, and any onlooking to the castle could have seen. Looking down, she frowned. "I will need a different top."

Glimmer nodded and stepped back. "I'll get you something to wear."

Poofing to the front door of her mother's living quarters, she saw Adora standing outside of it. The blonde jolted slightly to see Glimmer, and the princess scowled at her. Then, without saying anything to Adora, Glimmer teleported into her mother's room and straight to the large walk-in closet to seek out a top that would match Angella's pants.

Rudely Adora barged in and asked, "Is there anything Angella needs me to help her with?"

Glimmer shot her a look. "No, Adora, she's fine. I'm getting her a different shirt to wear since the other won't fit over her wings."

Adora reached out for a white top that Glimmer swatted in her hand. "My mom doesn't like to wear white like that."

Adora replied, "She wore stuff like this in the other Kingdom."

Glimmer took a dark purple top and explained, "Mom likes purples and pinks for her regular colors to wear."

Adora, without thinking, replied, "She'll look nice in this."

Glimmer was confused as to why Adora would even say that. It came off as so weird for her to say.

Adora took Glimmer's shoulder. "Let's go," Adora asked Glimmer while the white top was still in her hand. Glimmer just rolled her eyes at Adora's weirdness and teleported them back to Angella.

The Queen sat with her old shirt covering her chest and didn't jump when Glimmer reappeared. However, Adora's presence was unexpected as the blonde rushed over to her with the shirt.

Angella took it and thanked Adora with a smile. The blonde stared at her as her breast became exposed while she got the new top on. She needed clothes that exposed her back, and this top wrapped around her neck. Glimmer looked down at the top she picked out for her mother and narrowed her eyes at it, and gave a more narrowed look at Adora and Angella. The two have certainly gotten friendlier. Not too long ago, Adora was too shy to be near Angella. Now she was ogling her while she dressed.

Glimmer cleared her throat and told them. "It's best you rest, mom, while Adora and I go with the rest of the princesses to plan our invasion."

Angella quickly stood up. "I should be there too."

"She's right." Adora chimed in.

Glimmer assured her mother, "Mom, you need to rest."

Glimmer saw Angella's hand raise in protest. "Glimmah, thank you for your worry and concern, but as the Queen and your mother, I insist on being present."

Glimmer frowned and accepted this. They had no time to argue over this as they needed to move fast to win this War.

Glimmer teleported herself away while Angella and Adora were left alone for a brief moment. The Queen looked at Adora and thought how things would work with Adora now. In the very few seconds of being around her daughter, she knew she was showing odd behavior to Glimmer. Adora had to subtly to this and would not know how to act now that their mission is esstnaily over. she knows Glimmer is insanely protective of her. But, just as Angella is to her daughter, she's a fool to think Glimmer would be the same with her.

Angella placed her hands on Adora's shoulders and explained to her, "Glimmer needs us to focus on this new plan. I don't want her to feel like something has changed without her."

Adora asked, "How do you and I act now that we're home?"

Angella was relieved that Adora referred to Brightmoon as her home. It made her hope that Adora's plan to leave Brightmoon was just a moment of anger and not the inability to be near Angella. But that did bring into the importance of Adora's question. How are they to act now? They truly bonded and

became close, definitely more friendly than anyone else anticipated them to be. Angella and Adora have bathed, slept in the same bed, and kissed. A bit more than anyone would expect them to do. The two times they shared a kiss is a more significant issue. Knowing Adora is smitten and not in love made things slightly more manageable. Angella going off to romp in the desert with a criminal are details she'll happily never tell a soul about. Her fear was acting out of sorts with Adora and for Adora to do the same.

Angella could only reply with, "We should still be as polite and casual as we, minus the snogging."

Adora looked confused, and Angella deadpanned, "We shouldn't kiss in front of anyone."

Adora blushed but held back the smile as she agreed, "Okay! Um, okay. We won't do that in front of anyone."

Angella smiled. "I hope the friendship we made in that Kingdom will only prosper here."

Adora nodded, and the two made their way down the Moonstone Chamber to attend the meeting.

Their presence was very much missed as they arrived; all the princesses ran to Adora to hug her. They were having a blonde fall over while Perfuma, Frosta, Bow, and Mermista laughed. They

were so loving towards her, and Angella smiled at them. Glimmer frowned at this and felt unwanted by Adora's presence in the castle now. Angella saw this and made sure to embrace Glimmer tightly before walking to her guards and General Juliet. She bowed to them and took her seat, as did everyone else.

The meeting began without a hitch. Adora remembered how she used to feel when Angella spoke before; the elegant accent was so strong and beautiful as she laid out orders and commands and told everyone about what had occurred in the Scorpion Kingdom. All Adora could do was let her chin rest in her palm as she listened to Angella. The dream-like state did not go unseen by the older princesses. Netossa and Spinerrella gave each other an awkward glance as they caught the eyes of Perfuma, who was doing the same thing—darting her eyes between Adora and Angella. The Queen composed as ever while Adora looked like she had a crush.

Mermista smiled to herself at seeing this. The humor in how hilariously awkward this was too good. Granted, she would never be the one to speak up about it. But, this was nothing to tease or mock Adora for. Adults always surrounded every girl in the princess alliance. From handsome advisors to pretty guards, good-looking men and women have gone through the dreaded crush on someone older than them. No one could escape the inevitable crush on someone older. But, a crush does fade in time —some with heartbreak and some with disinterest. Adora's story will be no different, and she'll lose interest in becoming heartbroken.

Glimmer kept her eyes on her mother the whole meeting. Although I was missing her, the thought of not having Angella around really made Glimmer think about what would happen if

she lost Angella? She didn't want to live in a world where she didn't have her mommy.

After a long meeting that led to Angella organizing another meeting with her private generals, the Princesses and Bow moved into Glimmer's room to finalize their plan on their invasion.

Glimmer led using the figures Bow made and a map. "We'll infiltrate the Fright Zone at their armory. Then, taking control of their weapons, we will disarm the power and take over that way. After that, She-Ra will go and search for Entrapta and Hordak and arrest them. Once we have them, we can retreat to Brightmoon."

Bow asked, "Will Queen Catra and Queen Scorpia join this?"

Glimmer snorted. "It sounds weird calling Catra that." She glanced over at Adora, who was smiling at that remark. Then, Glimmer asked, "Was she as unbearable as ever now with the new title?"

Adora chuckled. "She wasn't so bad. Her wedding was nice to go to, and with Scorpia around her, she's happier."

Bow and Perfuma smiled at that, and Bow asked, "Do you think they'll join us?"

Adora frowned. "They went into hiding, so they might not reach out until they feel safe."

Mermista interrupted, "If we can't guarantee them being around, then we need to go on with our plan."

Glimmer agreed with her and explained, "We will need a strong force following after us just in case they retreated outside the Fright Zone to launch an attack on another Kingdom."

Frosta suggested, "Does that mean we pull back our home fronts for this?"

Glimmer paused as she was unsure how to answer that. Finally, Adora offered, "The Horde is making a grand statement against the Scorpion Kingdom, and the Fright Zone will be operated only by a skeleton crew. The original information given was a lie to throw Catra and Scorpia off. We shouldn't be in any major danger. Hordak usually takes his best Captains and tanks to these sorts of missions."

Glimmer glanced over to Bow for support, and she told Adora, "We'll be moving out soon. First, however, we need the Horde to be in the desert kingdom territory so we can invade without worrying about them returning too soon for a fight."

Adora proclaimed, "I can get us in and out quickly. Then we'll be back home to Angella."

The Ernest sound in Adora's voice came off odder than anything. Frosta is looking to the older Princess Mermista for some reaction. But, instead, Mermista looked uncomfortable as Adora called Angella by her first name. Something no one had ever done before as all the Princesses grew up knowing Angella by her title and never thought to say her name without it.

Glimmer gave Adora an odd look as Adora had never dropped her manners when it came to Queen Angella before. "You mean Queen Angella, right?" Glimmer asked.

Adora blinked in confusion. "Yeah, isn't that what I said?"

Perfuma sucked in her bottom lip at the awkwardness in the air and how Glimmer wasn't helping the situation. But, instead, her passive demand for clarification made it clear that Adora and Angella had a friendlier relationship than what they left. Of course, they all knew Adora was awkward beofre with Queen Angella due to desperately wanting her approval. But, it appeared that their time working together gave her that, and Adora must be an official confident to Angella or at least another daughter to her. But, even Glimmer didn't refer to Angella by the first name. Not even mom if she could prevent it.

Glimmer didn't press that issue and decided the plan was set, and they needed to get ready to move out. A plan for the attack was underway.

In the Magicat Kingdom.

It had all happened so fast and left her sick to her stomach. Teleporting only took a minute, but to Catra, she felt like falling over and passing out. Keeping up on her feet, she remained stoic as possible. Taking her fluffed tail in hand and smoothing it out as she walked with Scorpia over to where the rest of the Magicat guards were. She recognized and knew by name, while others were from the Magicat Kingdom and had never gone to the Scorpion Kingdom. Catra felt her heart race at the thought of what could go on. The fear of sending people off to their doom terrified her. What if this was all a trap, and she was going to be captured? She'll go down in Etherian history as Queen who went from turncoat to the most hated army imaginable to a slain ruler. Her rule only lasted a few days. Now she was going to die? She looked to Scorpia, and now her eyes watered. She was supposed to help Scorpia, and now she most likely ruined everything.

Scorpia saw Catra was clearly on the verge of a panic attack. Finally, she stopped and asked, "Wait. I'm sorry, but I'm taken aback by all this. May I have a moment with my wife?"

The guards paused and looked to Catra before suggesting, "We will inform our King that you need a moment. Excuse for a moment while we give you time."

Catra felt instant relief seeing them leaving behind the large door.

Scorpia turned to her and asked, "Are you okay?"

Catra rushed into her embrace and tried her best not to cry as she explained, "No! I'm not okay! Scorpia, I think I messed up. We shouldn't of let the whole freakin kingdom come here without us knowing anything about these people!"

Scorpia corrected, "These are your people. They came through for us."

Catra started shaking as she pulled away. "B—but why now? Shadow Weaver was going to tell me something before one of the guards stopped her. I—I don't know what is going on, and I—I can't figure out why all this is happening."

Scorpia tried to reassure her, "Things are getting better now. The War is coming to an end. We can be happy now. You can finally be happy."

Catra clutched her stomach. "No!" she winced in pain. "I didn't—I don't—I don't understand what's going on. Shadow Weaver was going to tell me something! Something big. It was going to explain all of this, and now I don't know, and I don't know what's going to happen when I walk through that door."

Scorpia saw Catra's eyes flutter before falling over into Scorpia's claws. Startled, Scorpia raised her voice loud enough to catch the guards from outside the attention of the door. The four large Magicat males came over to see the passed-out feline Queen in Scorpia's arms and helped her get Catra somewhere safe for her

to rest and regain her composure. The King was alerted to all of this and rushed out of his court to see Catra in Scorpia's arms.

Scorpia's eyes went wide in disbelief to see the King standing before her while she leaned over Catra. He had brown hair like Catra's but had yellow eyes instead of Catra's blue and yellow. A tall thin man he was, as he leaned over to see her. Wanting to cup her face, he framed from touching her as he looked to Scorpia and asked, "She fainted?"

Scorpia gulped, not wanting Catra to come off as weak while now multiple strangers were crowding them. She quickly lied on Catra's behalf and replied, "She's been unwell lately, all the stress of the planning and preparations. She hasn't rested well lately." Hoping that would give more empathy for Catra. However, telling people, she was so nervous over Shadow Weaver and seeing more Magicats might be a bad look for the feline Queen.

King stood up and replied, "Of course," he said and turned to his guards, "Please bring Queen Scorpia and my daughter to her chambers at once."

The King glanced over to Scorpia and saw her mouth drop in surprise. *Daughter?*

Back In Brightmoon

After an outfit change back to her traditional clothes, Angella had a private meeting with her guards and Captain Juliet about the Birghtmoon plan of operations. Juliet stood up to explain the plan on how guards will make sure no Horde soldiers enter Brightmoon from the outskirts of the whispering woods while the remaining will infiltrate the woods to get through and join the Princesses in their mission to overtake the Fright Zone.

Once the meeting was dismissed, Juliet remained with Angella, and the Queen knew it was due to Juliet wanting to speak with her in private. Juliet was professional and stoic, and Angella appreciated that about her but knew Juliet was very adoring towards Angella and has been ever since she was a made part of the Brightmoon army. So Angella gave the captain the platform to speak without caution.

"Speak freely, Captain Juliet; you have my gratitude and trust. I thank you for all you've done."

Juliet rubbed the back of her head and asked, "Your majesty, the Kingdom was in quite a bit of mourning, fearing you had…passed from your injuries. Should consider it all to be Horde propaganda and remove all—"

Angella interrupted and explained, "Until the War is finally over, we will not strum up more fear for the citizens. Besides, I have a

plan that I would like to get your support on."

Juliet looked worried as Angella softly asked, "How would you feel about me being on the front lines with you?"

Juliet stammered. As her head shook, she tried to keep calm and replied with "Your majesty, your wishes are to be fulfilled, but I don't recommend you being on the front lines."

Angella questioned, "Would my presence be a distraction?"

Juliet cleared her throat. "Permission to speak freely?"

Angella nodded.

Juliet replied, "Yes, it would be a distraction."

Angella frowned at that but respected the honesty and sighed, "Very well. I can't afford to be a burden, so I will not be present." Feeling foolish for even suggesting it.

Juliet then offered, "Shall I prepare your bunker for you?"

Angella also felt a mix of shame in that and replied, "I shall prepare it myself, thank you."

While Juliet and her left the war room, Angella returned to her living quarters to see Adora was standing at the door. More like pacing, but she didn't want to look too desperate for Angella's attention.

The Queen smiled and saw Adora looking at the door.

Startling Adora, she chuckled and asked, "Please don't tell me you've been waiting for me this whole time without knocking?"

Adora jumped a little and bashfully rubbed the back of her head and replied, "Well, I didn't want to be a bother."

Angella smiled. "I don't find your cute antics a bother."

Adora blushed. "I'm cute?"

Angella giggled. "Like you didn't know that?"

Adora looked away, down at her shoes. I was feeling embarrassed for being so embarrassed. It's not like Angella hasn't called her that before. After their short tiff of not talking while Huntara was

around and being absent while working with Scorpia, the two returned to their meager flirting. Angella opened the door to her room and explained, "I will remain in Brightmoon while your mission continues. I hope I'm not keeping you too long.'

Adora answered, "Glimmer says we will leave in an hour."

Angella ushered Adora into her room and closed the door.

Adora felt heat rush through her face again while she walked into Angella's fancy perfumed room with elegant furniture. This was not her first time in Angella's room, but it was still an exciting feeling that made Adora feel a tingle between her legs. Angella sat on her couch and patted the seat where she wanted Adora to sit. The blonde complied and asked Angella, "What do we do in the meanwhile?"

Angella hesitated at what to say or do. Finally, she wrapped a wing around Adora and replied, "I would like your company while we wait and see what is to happen next."

Adora allowed herself to rest her head on Angella's shoulder and said, "I like spending time with you like this."

"As do I," Angella replied.

Adora looked up and asked her, "Will we still be able to do this? Spend time with one another?"

Angella kissed her forehead. "I don't see why not; we've become friends. No one should find our relationship odd. You're a hero to Etheria with close connections to royals. Our friendship is no different than your friendship with the princess alliance."

Adora looked up at her and smiled. "Right. We're just good friends."

Angella turned her body closer to her and agreed, "Good friends."

Who were they kidding? They were more than friends. Far more. They had a deep attraction and wanted each other romantically. Adora wrapped her arms around Angella and lied again, "Just good friends that can hang out and hug and be close."

Angella smiled. "Yes, and your such a friend you'd enjoy affection. Such affections as a simple kiss wouldn't sway you."

Adora beamed a little as her cheeks flushed. "Of course, we've kissed before, and that didn't make things unfriendly." The constant use of friends was getting hard for them to keep up.

Angella then asked, "So a kiss wouldn't be so hard to ask for, right?"

Adora blinked "of course not," but not without keeping the blush on her cheeks.

A slight flush came over Angella's as she asked again, "So, kiss me."

Adora's face went deeper in color as she leaned in to kiss Angella. A friendly peck of affection is familiar on Brightmoon. She had been kissed on the cheek by Glimmer, Perfuma, and begrudgingly Mermista before. A kiss on the lips was no different. She craved this affection and wanted it sincerely. She was deepening the kiss, and Angella allowed her to. Both flushed in the face as they tightly held on to each other. Angella's wings covered them as their lips refused to part. Angella masterfully executed the deepening of the kiss and made the blonde moan in desire. The Queen lost her composure as she laid on top of Adora to kiss her further. The younger woman had no control over herself anymore as she bucked her hips to Angella's for the needed sensation and deepened the kiss with her. Adora has not been such a good kisser of yet. But Angella had plenty of time and patience to show her. The two continued to kiss. The warmth between them became more unbearable as Adora kept bucking. Finally, knowing their time restriction, Angella lowered a hand to meet Adora's aching lions for some much-needed attention. Slipping her hands into her trousers, but not her underwear, she began to rub Adora's pleasure, and the blonde gasped into the kiss. She had never been touched like this before, and she had no idea how much she needed to. Angella's felt how hot Adora was in her lions and continued to tease and massage her gently.

Knowing it wouldn't take long for such an inexperienced woman to feel the bliss of release. In a daring move, she wanted to feel Adora's sex on her hand truly and slipped her gloved fingers into Adora's underwear and, without fumbling, found Adora's most sensitive nub and ran her finger across it gently. That small gesture threw Adora over the edge as she broke the kiss and laid her head back to moan. Angella conducted to lightly stroke Adora's clit with this newfound power on her side. Knowing she was bringing the girl to her edge. In satisfaction, she felt the warmth pulsing as she granted Adora the much-needed orgasm the blonde had been craving for since the desert kingdom. Having her ride out, the pleasure made Angella satisfied in her talents as a lover while she watched Adora go limp afterward. The blonde was easily satisfied, and with fluttering eyes and flushed face, she looked into Angella's eyes. The Queen smiled at her and remarked, "That was friendlier than expected."

Adora needed assistant sitting back up and replied with a slight laugh, "Very friendly, I liked it a lot." She rubbed the back of her head and asked, "Maybe we can be friends again later? After we win the War?"

Angella happily replied, "Of course."

Adora sat up. Legs a little wobbly and softly mentioned the need to change her clothes beofre leaving.

With that, Adora was out the door and left Angella with the now flooded feeling of guilt over what had just happened. She feared she had forced herself on Adora and made the blonde comply with a sexual situation that Adora wouldn't possibly understand. But, yet again, Adora was an adult. She is younger than her but an adult with urges and needs like her own and definite feelings of

adoration to Angella. She left her room and waited by the Moonstone chamber to see them all off. Hugging each one as they left for this mission. Adora now transformed into She-Ra, with some outfit modifications. Her tiara was similar to Catra's headwear, long white pants than her shorts and shirt, and her hair was signature to her usual pompadour. Adora bowed to Angella in a knight-like fashion before standing next to Glimmer. Everyone witnessed the odd interaction and didn't say much about it. They all assumed Adora was acting weird because everything had gone on, and no one had even had time to talk about anything other than War. Then, the Princess alliance and Bow were gone in a sparkling flash. She was leaving Angella alone at her castle. Even though she was the safest of them, she felt miserable for being a coward for not fighting. Missing her daughter terribly, and now she very much cared for Adora.

Back in the Magicat Kingdom

Catra lay in a large bedroom with Scorpia watching over her and another female nurse Magicat. The nurse was very kind to them and spoke with Scorpia and showed her all the old photos of the royal family. Several portraits were hanging up in the bedroom. One is a large family portrait of the royal family. King, Queen, and baby in their arms. That baby was Catra. Or as her proper name was technically *Cy'ra*.

When Catra finally woke up. Jumping up almost as Scorpia placed her claws on her shoulders and tried to keep her down, "Catra, don't strain yourself; you're okay."

The feline asked, "W—what happened?"

Scorpia softly replied, "You fainted."

Catra shrieked, "I fainted? In front of everyone!?"

Scorpia shook her head. "No—no, just in front of me. It's okay, the King understands. We all know this has been a lot on you, and Shadow Weaver upset you."

Catra's ears flopped down a little as she asked, "How is everyone?"

Scorpia smiled proudly. "Everyone is fine. This Kingdom is massive, and the people are very nice. Our people have adjusted just fine, and Kyle, Lonnie, and Rogelio are next door if you want to see them?"

Catra replied, "Maybe later; I don't want to be seen like this." Her eyes caught the nurses.

Catra didn't know what to say to her, and the nurse only bowed before leaving the room.

Scorpia waited for her to leave before telling her, "Catra, I'm so happy for you. You're going to get such good news soon."

Catra questioned, "how do you know that?"

Scorpia replied, "I've already talked with the King; he wants to be the one to tell you. But, hey, things are going to be so great now."

Catra started to get out of bed. "How can you be so sure?"

Scorpia just looked at her warmly and replied, "I just know, and when you're ready to see the King, you will understand."

Catra didn't know what to expect. If everyone was acting like it was all okay, why didn't she feel like it was? After getting dressed in something, the chambermaid brought her. Catra and Scorpia made their way back to the King royal court. Heart pounding in her chest, she strolled as the doors opened. Music played in the background as she nervously darted her eyes back and forth and saw so many other Magicats and people from the Scorpion Kingdom looking at her while she made her way to the King's stairs leading to his throne. She kneeled before him, fearing what he would say to her.

He stood up and walked down the stairs to meet Catra.

"Queen Cy'ra, please rise." He commanded.

His voice was booming and demanding.

When Catra stood up and locked eyes with him, she felt an insane level of familiarity to her. His gold eyes, tall, slender stature were something to marvel at. Yet, his expression was soft, and in the corner of her eyes, she saw that there were Magicats on the verge of tears.

He reached out his arms and said, "It is so good to have my long-lost daughter home to me finally." He embraced Catra tightly before pulling away and declaring, "All hail my daughter Cy'ra's return!"

Catra was shocked at what she was hearing. So this man didn't even know her name and was now declaring her a long-lost daughter? It was impossible.

Several Magicats came from behind Catra, and she instantly jumped, instinctively her claws were out, and the Magicats didn't even notice. So instead, they ushered her into a smaller room by the throne as the rest of the crowd dispersed out of the royal court.

Catra felt her body go tense and almost numb at what was all going on. The King and others all crowded her as he explained to

her, "We are so happy to have you back. You must have so many questions?"

Catra gulped and nodded. He knew she was distressed and offered, "Would you like us to summon your wife to be with you?"

Without a second thought, Catra shook her head. She did need Scorpia for all of this.

They summoned her to come in, and she came to Catra's side. The King offered them both to sit down as Catra clung to Scorpia's claw. Unknowing how happy she made Scorpia but just her acceptance to touch and how she would often reach out to touch her now.

Catra felt her heart continue to race as the King explained Catra's position to them.

The origin Catra never dared to think about was finally explained. The Magicat Kingdom was once settled close to Plumeria before the Horde invaded it. Taking the pregnant Queen hostage for negotiations fell through as the Queen escaped. Fearful of a second attack, the Magicats called upon the Princess Alliance for backup, but they could not help. Two years later, the Horde waged War on the Magicat Kingdom. They stormed the original castle and kidnapped the princess. The princess of Catra and took her as a negotiation hostage. But, due to receiving intel that the toddler had died, the Kingdom retreated with the use of magic to be unseen throughout Etheria for years.

The explanation was simple in Catra's mind. She was abandoned, it hurt when Adora did it, hurt just as much when Shadow Weaver did, and now she realized a whole Kingdom did it to her.

He asked her, "I know this a lot to take in at once. Do you have any questions for me?"

Catra let go of Scorpia and stood up from her seat. "Yes, I do," Catra replied coldly. The King and the people behind him saw her visibly upset. Scorpia saw her anger and wanted to do something to stop her from blowing up. Catra asked, "Did you ever—did you even—did even wonder what my life was like in the Horde?"

The King frowned. "Of course I did. Your mother and I were beyond devastated by your assumed demise."

Catra growled, "Then why didn't you come to get me. Why did you run and hide? Why have you been hidden this whole time?"

The King and his crew looked surprisingly hurt by Catra's inclination that they were being cowardly.

He made his point clear as he stood closer to her "Our Kingdom was cornered inland with no borders and no other support. Therefore, we needed to retreat to survive. We had already thought we lost you."

Catra cocked a brow and suggested, "So the Magicat Kingdom doesn't know what revenge is, or better yet, fact-checking?"

"We never had an army before the Horde invasion." The King added.

Catra stepped back and shook her head. "Yeah, everyone in Etheria says that." Her voice grew cold as she looked him in the eyes and finished, "But they all pulled through, right? I guess one dead princess wasn't so bad for you guys, so why do I matter now? Because I'm alive? Married into another Kingdom? Even if I believed you gave up on me, why should I think you won't do it again?"

King protested to her, "You are home now! And your Kingdom and ours will remain safe!"

Catra extended her claws out. "I was never safe! You said you tried to protect a whole kingdom when you couldn't even protect your baby!? How can you offer that to me or anyone else!?"

The King took a step back. "How could you say that!?" he exclaimed.

Catra snorted and retracted her claws, and turned to leave the room. "Sure, whatever makes you feel better. Thanks for keeping

everyone but me safe."

Scorpia's face fell when she saw the tears in Catra's eyes as the feline Queen left the room.

The Scorpion Queen jumped up and tried to quell the hurtful words Catra spoke to the King. While Catra rushed through the halls to head back to the room, she was just in before the court made her anxious. All paintings and crests covered the walls. All of Magicats and family. How can these people be all about family if their princess was left to be a child soldier with the Horde?

Back in her room, she paced around and contemplated what she needed to do next. The plan seemingly was to stay here and hide away from the rest of Etheria while the War still went on. Even if it looked like the War was ending. She was just supposed to hang out here, and everything was going to be great? In her rage, she didn't consider the fact she left Scorpia alone with her new in-laws without much care.

Scorpia was still there and nervously remained in the private room with the King and the other Magicats.

Scorpia apologized profusely to Catra. "I'm so sorry! She's been through a lot, and Catra needs some time to adjust to all of this!" she bowed.

The King looked saddened by this and asked, "Did she ever ask or wonder where she came from?"

Scorpia didn't know how to respond to that. Most children in the Horde knew they were abandoned or orphaned. She explained to the King of the Kingdom that had saved her entire race of people that his daughter didn't even think to ask about him. As hard as Scorpia defended Catra's behavior, the King did not take any offense to this to her relief. He understood Catra needed time for all of this, and nothing that happened in this room would affect how the rest of the Kingdom interacted with the Scorpion people.

The King explained, "When my wife was pregnant and ill, the Horde invaded our homeland and captured her. She thankfully escaped and gave birth to Cy'ra back home, but after another invasion, they seized the castle and took the baby. They killed the Queen and several of the family's older children in the process. With that, they fled to their Kingdom farther out in Etheria. With caverns, tunnels, and a beautiful forest and river magically cloaked from the rest of Etheria.

This saddened Scorpia. They dispersed and asked Scorpia to talk to Catra and respect her needing space. This wasn't how Scorpia thought the reunion would go and didn't know how Catra would act now. When she went back to the room, she found a note left by Catra saying she needed to find closure.

In the castle halls, she found a guard and pleaded with him to speak with Shadow Weaver. Finally, he agreed to let her see where she was being held.

Doors opened at the dungeon, and Shadow Weaver was sitting on a cot looking down at the ground and lifting her head only enough to see the feet of her former ward standing in front of her. "I see you not pleased to know of your origin. It would be like never to be satisfied. I know Adora would have been thrilled to know where she came from."

Catra growled as her tail fluffed up.

She wanted to scream and cry for what had all just happened. But, instead, Catra teared up and tried to ask, "Why did you never tell me calmly?"

Shadow looked at her and explained, "There was never any reason to. You were a sickly toddler. You missed many of the junior cadet milestones that were expected of you," she reached her hand out to Catra's hair. The feline flinched but didn't stop her from touching the loose strands. "I see you cut them, but the grey tufts of fur you grew out were from your kitten fever coat. Indicating you were sickly. After your capture and the seizure of the Magicat Kingdom, we tried to use you as bait to get a surrender to assign with us." Shadow Weaver let her hand slowly come back down to her side. "But you were too frail for travel. We anticipated a strike and informed them of your expiration in our care, and they surprised us by fleeing. In the end, we chose to keep you in the hopes your magical capabilities would come with age, but they never did. Instead, you never really met any expectation greater than Adora did. I sensed power from her when I was in the same room as that infant. You never did,"

Catra felt her heartbreak entirely at that moment. Shadow Weaver rejected the idea of caring for Catra's potential since she

was a baby. Adora outshined her in everything, and there could have easily been a time when Catra could have been the favorite if she was magically gifted.

Catra took a step back and kept her teary-eyed focus on Shadow Weaver. Finally, the criminal woman looked up to her and stated flatly. "Life in prison or execution will not bring you closure. As the only mother you ever knew and someone you still reluctantly love—you need me to obtain your true potential."

Catra spat, "I don't need you."

Shadow Weaver corrected, "You do; I'm the only one who can train you and motivate you."

Catra extended her arms out. "You had my whole life to do that!"

Shadow Weaver slowly removed her mask and revealed her face to catra. She was causing the feline to gasp at the mutilated face.

"Catra, you and Adora were experiments to Horde. Hardship and struggle were your roles, while Adora was given the roles and praise to motivate. Now the roles you both plays are over, and now as Etheria faces one more battle, it will be you and Adora in these new roles you create moving forward that will change everything."

Catra demanded, "Then why do I still need you?"

Shadow Weaver didn't hesitate as she stated, "I am the reason you can't connect to your Runestone; The cat's eye Cymophane stone is your birthright. While Scorpia has the Black Garnet, the Cymophane must be used too if you want magical balance. I will need to restore your connection so that you can do it. Just be warned that it could make you sick and frail. It was the reason I took it out of you in the first place, and you were on the verge of death when you were two."

The boom came from the cell doors, and Scorpia and the King were present.

Relieved to see Scorpia, but not wanting to show it in front of Shadow Weaver, he looked to the King and saw his angered face looking at the evil sorceress who broke up his family and destroyed his kingdom. Then, with balled fists, he demanded, "What have you done, my daughter?"

Fright Zone

The Princess Alliance was now in enemy territory in a flash of glittering light. Exhausted the powerful display of teleportation magic, Glimmer fell to her knees, and Bow caught her from falling forward. "With mom back, I have less power when we share the Moonstone."

Adora frowned at this realization.

They all huddled and confirmed the plan "We head to Hordak's layer and find Entrapta and take out whatever remote attack they are plotting and then Hordak."

Everyone nodded in agreement.

Netossa, Spinnerella, and Frosta went down one corridor leading to the main Fright Zone meeting hall. In contrast, Mermista went into the sewer to get into the prison fortress to see if she could release any War prisoners.

Bow, Glimmer, and Perfuma followed Adora to Hordak's lab. Despite the invasion of the Scorpion Kingdom taking up a majority of the army, they still ran into major shuttles of soldiers still patrolling all parts of the Fright Zone. Hordak did anticipate some retaliation, and forces were still strong.

In her She-Ra transformation, Adora took on a massive brunt of attacks to the point of exhaustion. The fight was intense, but Adora made it to the lab and struck down the door with her sword. The rest hung back in case of soldiers came and interrupted her.

With Adora searching the lab, she wondered where Hordak and Entrapta were, and her question was answered when she felt the warmth of a powerful laser beam blast near her. Dodging it, she

saw Hordak was in a new suit of armor that made him look more aggressive than before. A laser beam was attached to his right arm, and he shot at her again. Adora dodged and saw the laser hit a beam collapsing towards her. In a quick move to get out of the way, she stepped on a wire that instructed her. In pain, she wailed but still rushed to Hordak with her sword, ready to strike.

He continued to blast at her, and she bellowed, "Where is Entrapta!?"

She got closer to him and was now close enough to strike down his laser weapon.

She stopped when Entrapta cried out from behind him, "Adora, please stop!"

Adora hesitated while Hordak did not. Another laser hit She-Ra directly in the sword and was deflected to another side of the lab, causing massive damage to the structure in the process.

Entrapta begged, "You need to listen; the work we've done can make Etheria better; a world of science and machine can do so much good!"

Adora protested, "Entrapta, you've both hurt people! Ruined lives and Kingdoms! You let them destroy your Kingdom! You can't allow yourself to be on the side anymore!"

Hordak spoke up, "Entrapta can make her own choices and now fall to the will of the outdated alliance!"

He raised his laser to Adora again. "Now, surrender or fall like the many magical peasants before you!"

Adora readied her sword and charged to him.

Swinging and cutting at his laser, he rushed to her and demanded, "Stand down, former Force Captain, or you will be the cause of great torment!"

Adora got ahold of Hordak's shoulders and flung him across the room. Entrapta tried to take care of him but was stopped by Adora. The tech princess begged and tried to get away from her. "Please, Adora, you don't understand!"

Adora pinned her to the ground "Entrapta, you two are under arrest! You both are criminals!"

Entrapta stopped resisting the urge to fight, and tears fell from her eyes as she softly muttered, "He's the only one who understands me and my work….."

Adora felt sadden for Entrapta in this circumstance. She loved someone who wasn't good for her.

Several sirens went off, and Entrapta gasped, "You should have listened! He didn't want to have to do this!"

Adora replied, "What!?"

Looking over to see Hordak was nowhere to be seen.

Entrapta had her forehead to the floor and replied, "He's setting off the missiles."

"What does that mean?"

The sirens blared throughout the Fright Zone as the princess looked around, confused. The Horde soldiers attacking them retreated and left Perfuma, Bow, and Glimmer confused. While Mermista was in the pipes, she overheard the commotion and heard the soldier say Hordak was fighting She-Ra and the missiles would hit all the Kingdoms.

She rushed back to the meeting point they established when they got into the Fright Zone in a hurry. Frosta and older princesses

were waiting for the rest to show up. Netossa asked, "Did you find out what the sirens are for?"

Mermista answered, "They're launching missells at the Kingdoms."

A soft gasp from Glimmer came from behind them, and she panicked. "W—where is Adora?"

"With Hordak," Mermista said.

The group looked at each other in worry and declared, "We all need to get there to help her." Glimmer said.

All agreed, and they rushed out of the labs.

Arriving, they saw soldiers fighting Adora on her own. Exhausted, She-Ra's form didn't give out, and Adora kept fighting despite the fact she had to let Entrapta go as she became swarmed with soldiers. Finally, the princesses joined in to help her, and they could fight them all off. However, she was weakened by the battle Adora retransformed and panted heavily.

Glimmer and Bow rushed to her and helped Adora back up. The blonde weekly answered, "This isn't going to be easy. They're going to hurt lots of people. The missiles are aimed for every Kingdom in Etheria."

Spinerrella took out her communicator pad to let out an emergency signal to every war room in Etheria. It was only a matter of time before all the Kingdoms knew another dangerous attack was coming, and this one was not going to be preventable.

In The Brightmoon War Room

Captain Juliet and the rest of the Brightmoon army sat and watched as the signal from Spinerrella informed that missiles were on their way to every Kingdom and evacuation was in order. As Juliet rushed to inform Angella in her living quarters, she stopped to see that she was not found. Dashing through the halls, she found the armory room was open, and inside was Angella in her silver-plated armor. Juliet questioned as she kneeled. "Your majesty?"

Angella looked at herself in the mirror with her hair up. "This was a wedding gift from our silversmith. Should I be flattered to know I still fit in it?"

Juliet rose and questioned, "Your majesty, we need to get you somewhere safe."

Angella sighed. "I have a communicator pad with me, Juliet. I know of the impending doom that is coming for Brightmoon. If the Horde's past attacks are anything to go by, they aim for all the Runestones. Evacuate the Southern border of Brightmoon and the harbor and marina. I'm going to the Moonstone."

Angella turned away from Juliet and walked past her into the hall.

Juliet looked saddened by this, and only professional replied with "As you wish, my Queen."

Angella made her way to the Moonstone to where to she made a video on her communicator pad for all royal War rooms to see.

"Members of the Rebellion and Princess Alliance, I am Queen Angella of Brightmoon. I am here to call upon all Runestone users to come forward in efforts to save our homelands." The video was graining and shaking as she held the camera far from her face while flying.

The Kings and Queens of the other Kingdoms did see it and prepared for the executions and to stand guard of their Runestones.

Looking up at the sky Angella stood in flight, hovering over her Kingdom and keeping herself looking as brave as possible. As a woman who has always stayed away from the battle, it was now her time to try and be more than just a delegator. In her last two efforts and the Scorpion Kingdom against the invasion and Shadow Weaver, she was defeated, but this time she chose to be brave and wanted to make her stand against the Horde like she never did before.

If Adora was out fighting, she had to fight as well. Her loved ones were out there, and she needed to be brave with them.

Wars End

The air was cold, and the wind smelled of metal and oil, indicting to Angella that the Horde was near. The horrible odor that would sometimes waft in the wind due to the Fright Zone always stuck with her for all these years; only someone who could fly as high as her could ever feel the chill and breathe in the scent of what was going on. Flying close to the Moonstone to recharge her powers again made her worried. She knew so much was about to occur, and she didn't know how to handle herself. But, while other soldiers remained on foot, she had the skies, and she would be the first person to come face to face with whatever the Horde had planned for them.

The airstrikes were coming to all the Kingdoms no matter what Adora could think of doing. Next, it was going to happen without her control.

She-Ra had successfully taken Hordak captured in the Fright Zone, sitting him down on the ground tied up; she and the other princesses interrogated him with Entrapta—the purple-haired princess did not comply either. Both were then separated as Adora and Bow made their way to the central tower of the Fright Zone to see if they could relocate the missiles that were heading to every Kingdom.

Bow asked Adora, "Does any of this look familiar to you?"

Adora shook her head. “No, I never made it this far in the Horde to know anything about this.”

Both looked at the target screens and saw the sad sight of Sealines getting struck first with the missiles. They were destroying the Ocean Gate.

Both frowned as they saw the debris fall everywhere.

The following missiles looked to attack Brightmoon next.

To Adora’s horror, she saw Angella flying over to where the Moonstone was, and it looked like Angella was ready to fight it in some fashion. Adora looked horrified at Angella on the monitor screen and looked back to Bow. He did his best to make sense of all the numbers and screens before him but could not. So finally, he asked Adora, “Is there any way to get ahold of Catra or Scorpia?”

Adora’s eyes went wide, and she rushed to another room to see if she could find a communication screen. She found it and tried to get ahold of any Kingdom that would know how to get ahold of Catra. But, unfortunately, Bow informed her another missile was landing in Plumeria at that moment, and she panicked and let out an Etherian comprehensive communication, begging for Catra to contact her right away.

Catra was still in her Kingdom handling Shadow Weaver and her father simultaneously. Shadow Weaver had just dropped another bomb of information on Catra, explaining that Catra has a Runestone connection due to her family and could use that to use her untapped powers. The King encouraged Catra to try, and Scorpia supported this too, knowing that her Runestone was with them. Scorpia asked Catra if she tried to use her Runestone to make her feel better?

Catra didn't like to place in this situation; all of this was a lot to handle. Finally, another royal court member entered the dungeon where Shadow Weaver was being held to inform him that the Horde was launching missiles through all of Etheria.

Scorpia and Catra knew this plan, as it was revealed to them by Entrapta that it would have been Hordak's suicide plan if he knew he had lost the war. So Catra got in contact with Adora to see what was the matter.

"What the hell did you do, Adora?" Catra questioned.

Adora was still in her She-Ra form, and she sputtered, "We captured Hordak and Entrapta, but he still launched these missiles everywhere!"

Catra growled, "then that means you did a crappy job taking over the Fright Zone! Unfortunately, there isn't a way to deactivate the missiles, but you can make the missiles hit each other mid-air if

you change coordinates, get arrow boy on the line; I'll walk him through it."

Scorpia sat near Catra and explained, "Even if you get the missiles to relocate, you still cannot set off the bombs in the Fright Zone core. So once those missiles leave the countdown for the Fright Zone, the detonators will still go off and the level the whole area."

Catra growled and looked to Scorpia. "We need to be there!"

The King and one of his guards looked to Catra with worry. The King spoke first, "Cy'ra, and we would prefer you stay here safe with us."

Catra jumped up. "You can't make that call! If the Fright Zone blows up and takes—basically—all of Etheria with it!"

Scorpia explained to the King, "Hordak had a failsafe for the Fright Zone in case he lost the war, it would blow up."

Shadow Weaver coldly replied, "It can be taken down with Adora—she has the Runestone of Power. If Adora can use her powers to deactivate the bomb, she can save Etheria."

Catra glared at snapped at her. "What about me! What I can I do?"

Shadow Weaver shook her head in disappointment. "Thinking of yourself in this time of need, Catra? you can't even connect to your Runestone; it is very little you can do."

Catra's tail fluffed up in anger, and Shadow Weaver saw this and remarked, "If you can use the Cats-Eye Runestone, you might be able to help Adora."

Bow was now on the communicator pad, and Catra walked him through reconfiguring the missiles. Then, finally, he made them launch into vacant areas to cause minimal harm.

As the princesses all worked to get Hordak and Entrapta out of the Fright Zone, they came across more Horde soldiers and took them down quickly.

While they all worked, Catra and Scorpia went to their respective Runestones and saw if they had a connection to them.

Scorpia easily connected to the Black Garnet, while Catra could not connect to hers right away. Shadow Weaver helped her, and begrudgingly Catra listened and connected with it.

With both now powered up with their Runestones, Catra demanded, "Take us to Fright Zone." She ordered one of the guards she knew could teleport. He declined when he received a

glare from the King, who continuously insisted that Catra remains in the castle. Seeing the frustration going through Catra's mind, Shadow Weaver offered, "Free me, and I'll get you to the Fright Zone."

Meanwhile, Horde Soldiers returned to the Fright Zone, and the princesses took them on.

Angella used her powers to blast the missile mid-air when it aimed for the castle, and it exploded in the sky, harming no one. The people of Brightmoon cheered as they saw their Queen in action, and Angella flew to the ground to make sure everyone was okay. As she landed, she was approached by Juliet, who informed her that She-Ra was ordering the princesses to retreat from the Fright Zone.

In confusion, she made her way back to the War room in the castle only to hear Glimmer that they were under significant attack by returning Horde soldiers. In a worry and panic, Angella pleaded for Glimmer and the princesses to get back to base in Brightmoon, but Glimmer couldn't due to not having enough power to teleport all of them. Angella felt highly guilty; sharing the Moonstone's powers meant Angella and Glimmer called on the same power.

All the princesses retreated with Hordak and Entrapta back to the central control bridge where Adora was to see she wasn't having any additional luck with everything.

Perfuma and Mermista tried to get Hordak and Entrapta to help them, but they didn't offer anything. Entrapta only said how perfect the destination was that nothing would survive it.

Bow kept communicating with the Magicat Kingdom to inform what was going on, and Catra decided to speak with her father privately.

Once behind closed doors, Catra asked him, "You know what all this means, right?"

He crossed his arms and turned to her. "Yes, I do. You are to go nowhere near that horrible place."

"Thant horrible place is going to take out all of Etheria if we don't stop it." Catra protested.

"I stand by my convictions!" The King claimed

Catra then scoffed, "Yes, your convictions were the reason the Horde raised me."

He snapped, "That is unfair, and you know it. But, Cy'Ra, I cannot risk losing you again; you must understand what I'm going through."

Catra pleaded with him, "Please, I know this isn't what you want to hear, but I need Shadow Weaver to get into the Fright Zone. All those other Princesses are stuck there too, and we could use some of your armies to get everyone out."

The King remained stoic as Catra tried to appease his leadership side "We'll be the Kingdom that saves Etheria."

The King sighed and offered, "I will be with you through all of this."

Catra was relieved to hear this.

He ushered her to the Cats-Eye Runestone and offered her help activating its powers. So now Catra had the power of fire by Runestone, and Scorpia used this small amount of time they had to activate her connection to the Black Garnet and now had the power lighting.

Teleporting with them was the King, four guards, and Shadow Weaver.

Arriving in the Fright Zone was a challenge as they took out a massive part of the Army attacking them; the guards were able to teleport Glimmer, Bow, Perfuma, Mermista, and Frosta back to Brightmoon while Scorpia stayed with the King of the Magicats to

keep guard of Entrapta and Hordak. Leaving Adora, Catra, and Shadow Weaver alone on the primary control system for the Horde. Shadow Weaver instructed Adora to concentrate her powers to use her Runestone to shield off the Fright Zone. This would make the explosion less detrimental, but the only issue is that Adora would be absorbed in the Blast.

The guards returned to take Scorpia, the King, and the prisoners away.

Catra insisted on staying with Shadow Weaver and Adora through this.

It was one of the very few times Catra stayed with Adora during all this conflict, and this was the one time Adora didn't want anyone to stay. She was fully prepared at this moment to die.

Shadow Weaver saw this, and just as the destination was going off, she used the last of her powers to teleport Catra and Adora out of the blast site. Throwing Adora full force away from the sword and singling, uttering the words, "I'm proud of you both. *Your welcome*." Sacrificing herself to save the girls and all of Etheria.

Catra shielded the weakened Adora with her body as the Blast went off. The Runestone held its power despite Adora not touching it, and the two were saved. Many Horde soldiers were unharmed and retreated out into the whispering woods. With the Fright Zone destroyed, the war was finally over; healing could begin.

A week later.

Hordak and Entrapta are still on trial.

All of Etheria is in restoration.

Adora is off to every part of Etheria to offer support. But, at the same time, Catra co-mingles a lot with other Etherians in helping integrate her father's Kingdom to the rest of society, and helping Scorpia's Kingdom rebuild and regroup was a difficult task. It was stress-filled and lonely. Watching Shadow Weaver die and Etheria ready to have Hordak publicly hang was something to think about. Entrapta had lost a lot of people's respect and empathy, and it bothered Catra as she felt she was far more damaging during her time in the war. As a leader, she did cause pain and chaos, but no one has confronted her about it. Even Scorpia's people have been given a more difficult time than Catra has received, and to make matters even worse, she felt guilt over all the pressure that was falling on Adora. Her childhood best friend was going through a lot, and she didn't know how to help her.

While Adora was out in the remains of the Fright Zone looking for anything that could be deemed hazardous with Swift Wind, the Queen of Brightmoon had summoned for her return. In relief, she

returned to the castle to see her and met the Princess Alliance—the entire alliance. Including Catra and Scorpia. Adora's face brightened when she saw this, and Glimmer and Bow rushed over to hug them. However, her eyes remained on Angella while she hugged the two.

Angella smiles at her warmly while Castaspella and Juliet lock their eyes on the display of affection between the friends. Now that everyone was there, the meeting could begin.

Mermista was the first to begin. Standing up from her seat, she cleared her throat and declared, "The Sea has the lowest rate of invading Horde criminals, but we have the most pollution from them. When Hordak launched his attack on all the Kingdoms—he destroyed the sea gate. The Sea Kingdom wants to restation in the form of labor from the remaining Horde soldiers that are in custody."

Her eyes darted over to Catra and declared, "We also would appreciate the volunteer work from the Scorpion Kingdom and the Magicat Kingdom, too, since your highest-ranking officials are former Horde officers."

Catra slammed her hands on the table. "Your Kingdom can't expect everyone to stop and do all this work for free. The Scorpion Kingdom and the Magicat Kingdom have worked better to save their Kingdom. It shouldn't be the fault of other Kingdoms for your lack of safety protocol."

Everyone gasped at Catra's words.

Mermista bawled her fists and demanded, "You should help since —YOU—once tried to attack sealines when you were a Horde commander!"

Catra then retorted, "When I became Queen of the desert Kingdom, I did everything for the Kingdom and saved all the people living there. Just because you can do the same for your Kingdom shouldn't be the responsibility of the other Kingdoms. Why should I provide free labor when the snow kingdom and Plumeria are profiting by selling services to other Kingdoms."

Frosta and Perfuma stood up and began to argue with Catra.

In a panic, Adora looked over to Angella.

The Brightmoon Queen Stood up and extended her wings. "Enough! Please, this is not settling any matters."

Glimmer then rose her hand to speak.

Angella shut her down. "Not now, Glimmah."

Catra snickered at this, and Angella shot her a look to shut her up.

Angella scolded the group about their behavior, demanded them all apologize and insisted that all Kingdoms work together to help. Still, no one can make anyone work in other Kingdoms for free, and no one should condemn anyone for needing compensation for the work. Furthermore, all Kingdoms struggle with making financial ways after the war, and no one should shame or guilt others into relief work.

The remaining Horde soldiers in custody were offered to Mermista's Kingdom.

After that, the meeting went smoothly, and Angella could get some of the other princesses smiling and laughing towards the end. Once it was all over, Adora had tried to approach Angella but was stopped by Glimmer.

The sparkle princess had teleported Adora into her bedroom along with Bow.

Adora blinked in confusion. "Glimmer, why did you—" beofre she could question anything, Glimmer excitedly declared. "Perfuma, Mermista, and Frosta are staying in the castle Tonight. So we're going to have a slumber party!"

Adora half-smiled, "Oh, great, well, I might turn in early, and besides, Spinerrella and Netossa aren't here, so it wouldn't be much of a party without them."

Glimmer waved her hand and assured Adora, “Trust me, they’re in Mystacor, and they won't take offense to all of us hanging out together without them. Besides, I’m going to Mystacor after tomorrow, so I’ll get to see them soon. But we’re all going to be so busy, and you haven’t been home since the battle. So I figured you’d want to spend time with all of us, finally.”

Adora gave a fake smile. “Sure, I’d love that, but what about Catra and Scorpia? They should be invited to."

Bow looked nervously at Glimmer as the princess informed her, "Catra and Scorpia probably don't want to come, so we aren't going to invite them.”

Adora narrowed her eyes. “Catra helped me. She saved me, and without her, we wouldn’t have won the war. So she deserves an invitation.”

Glimmer sighed and reminded Adora that Catra was a lot of problems back in her Horde days, and it wasn’t fair to make everyone else uneasy due to her.

Upset, Adora agreed to go but told Glimmer she would be stepping away to see Catra later in the night. Glimmer didn’t argue with that. In truth, Glimmer didn’t want to keep Adora from seeing Catra despite all that had happened. She assumed Adora really missed her old friend and just wanted to be close to her.

In the guest room where Scorpia and Catra were staying, the Scorpion Queen watched as Catra nervously went through her luggage for something to wear. Finally, the feline glanced over to see her wife looking at her and asked, “Something wrong?”

Scorpia crossed her claws. “I don’t think it’s polite to leave early. However, Angella did invite us to evening tea with her. I don’t want to cancel on her, especially after earlier at the meeting.”

Catra replied, “Well, I don’t want to either, but Mermista brought up an unfair point. Even Angella agreed it wasn’t fair. Just because Sealines got screwed over during the missile attack doesn’t mean everyone needs to run to her. The Scorpion Kingdom was screwed too, and no one is helping us besides King Felix’s Kingdom, and they haven’t been integrated into Etherian society for almost twenty years.

Scorpia frowned and asked, “Why don’t you call him dad?”

Catra’s ears flattened as she looked at her wife. “It feels weird; I don’t know him, and part of me doesn’t want to.”

Scorpia sat up from the bed. “Why?”

Catra shifted her gaze. “He was there for me. He is now, but it doesn’t feel right. I appreciate him for all he did to help, but it’s

so weird to have him near me. I just found out I have—like—nine other siblings, I look just like my mom, and he shows me nothing but my baby pictures. It's a lot to take in…." She turned back to her luggage but heard someone coming down the hall and opened the door beofre Glimmer could even knock.

Glimmer jumped a bit but greeted Catra, "Your majesty." She gritted her teeth.

Catra smirked and replied, "Young Princess Glimmer, what a pleasant surprise."

Glimmer internally screamed but responded with a polite and calm invitation. "I was wondering if you two would like to join the rest of the alliance for a sleepover party in my room this evening?"

Catra let out a chuckle and replied, "A sleepover party? That's super cute for kids, but no thanks; we Queens have already been invited to Angella's chambers this evening."

Glimmer tried to grit out a smile as she fakely replied, "Oh? What a shame. Perhaps another time."

Catra faked a smile and waved Glimmer goodbye. She turned to see Scorpia looking disappointed at her.

Catra shrugged. "What?"

“We still should have gone. We could have split up our time and got to know the other princesses more.” Scorpia replied.

Catra groaned. “I don’t want to do that.”

Scorpia offered, “Is it because you don’t want to make friends with anyone new?”

Catra replied, “To be honest, I’m overwhelmed, okay? All the stuff with our Kingdom, my dad’s Kingdom, and everyone on our ass all the time for everything is a lot. I haven’t even really grieved over everything yet. The only time I got to cry over Shadow Weaver was the second it happened, and right after that, Adora was rushing us back to Brightmoon just for everyone else to cry about other stuff.”

Scorpia frowned and asked, “Should we talk about this stuff more. I know you're under a lot of stress; wanna cuddle?”

Catra snorted. “Cuddle? Seriously? Right now?”

Scorpia gave her a half-smile and looked away. “Well, you’ve been so busy lately, and all I want is some affection from you too. I’ve been stressed lately too….” Scorpia felt guilty for making Catra stress about herself, but Catra instantly perked her ears up and

walked over to Scorpia. Then, again, feeling guilty for not taking into her wife's feelings agreed to cuddle.

Scorpia gladly took off her shoes and laid on the bed.

Catra followed after, reluctant to admit she enjoyed the affection. Scorpia made her feel calm and relaxed in a way no one else could. Scorpia respected Catra's boundaries outside and was respectful; even behind closed doors, Scorpia never pushed anything with Catra. Knowing how emotionally stunted she was, Scorpia chose to wait patiently for Catra to make moves and sometimes offered small tidbits of interest in romance, but never forcefully. Even kissing after marriage was a small gesture Scorpia didn't always push for. Instead, she waited for Catra to do it. After the war, Catra kissed her on the lips in front of people, then grew embarrassed and walked away. Then, in their private room, cuddling into her wife's arms, Catra gave Scorpia a small peck on the cheek to show her appreciation to her.

It wasn't long after until they were kissing on the lips again, and Catra's purr began to vibrate through her whole body, tickling Scorpia's lips.

The kiss was interrupted by a knock on the door, and Catra growled and sat up to answer it.

Adora was at the door and inquired with her, "You turned down Glimmer's party invite?" Adora questioned.

Catra shrugged and replied, "Well, I already made plans with Angella, and we *Queens* have to stick together—so?"

Adora glared. "Well, you still could have come to a stop by; none of the other princesses know you two and would like to get to know you."

Catra glanced over to Scorpia, who was still on the bed and didn't want to talk to Adora.

Adora then shifted her question to another main reason why she was there. "When are you and Angella meeting up?"

Without any thought as to why Adora asked that Catra replied, "After eight at night, why?"

Adora poked her two index fingers together and sheepishly asked, "Could you ask if it's okay for me to go?"

Catra laughed. "What? No! either crash it or get lost. I'm not your wingman on this one."

Adora whined, "Catra, I haven't been able to see her in days; every time I try to spend time with her—Glimmer pulls me away from her."

Catra chuckled. “I knew Glimmer sucked.”

Adora snapped, “Catra!”

The feline waved her hands and offered, “Just come around 9ish. Hang out with the kids for a bit, and then come spend time with the Queens.”

Adora rolled her eyes and remarked, “You do know you, Glimmer, and Frosta are the youngest, right?”

Catra beamed. “But at least I’m not the youngest.”

The two laughed before Adora down the hall, and Catra turned back to her wife. However, Scorpia’s jealousy was not suttle, and she instantly remarked, “You and she are always super close, it seems.”

Catra sat back down on the bed next to her and replied, “Why do you get so annoyed when Adora comes around?”

Scorpia replied flatly, “Because I know one of these days she’s going to turn into She-Ra, propose to you, and then fly off into the sunset on that loud talking horse thing.”

Catra laughed and nudged Scorpia. “Not going to happen. I wouldn’t leave you for her—I wouldn’t leave you for anyone.” She earnestly replied.

Scorpia gave her a small smile, and Catra gave her a quick kiss on the lips before asking. “Want to check out the town and eat dinner out tonight?”

Scorpia perked up when she realized, “Is this a date? Are we finally going on a date?”

Catra felt her face get warm and brushed off the remark by embarrassingly replying, “Yeah, what else would it be.”

In the late evening, all the princesses sat down to enjoy dinner together in the dining hall for the first time in over two months. Despite Adora loving to catch up with Bow and Glimmer and everyone else, she wanted to see Angella. Unfortunately, the Queen was absent for this meal, and Adora asked Glimmer, “Where is Angella?”

Glimmer responded, “Mom usually eats alone. Usually, she is an hour early than everyone else because she doesn’t like to keep the kitchen staff up late on the weekends.”

Adora frowned and looked down at her plate.

Glimmer finally decided to ask the tricky question she has had on her mind all week "Why are you so interested in Angella all of a sudden? You've been asking about her all week."

Adora gulped and looked around the dining room table, noticing Mermista and Perfuma were looking right at her. The blonde's face heated up when she felt everyone's attention on her now. Clearing her throat, she innocently replied, "Angella is the Queen and my boss; I only ask about her because I worked so well with her during the diplomacy mission." It was a complete lie, and Perfuma and Mermista gave each other an uncomfortable look. Frosta decided to enter the conversation and offered, "Queen Angella is nice. She makes everyone feel special."

Mermista nodded. "Yeah, she's chill."

Perfuma chimed in, "She has been helpful during the supply shortage in my Kingdom."

Adora glared at them. "What does that have to do with anything?" her remark has ruder than it should have been, and Glimmer caught it and snapped back, "They're just saying that my mom is nice to all the princesses. You don't see any of them having private meetings with them?"

Perfuma shifted in her seat. "Well, since my parents are retired, I've had private meetings with Angella."

“Same” Mermista repleid.

Glimmer asked Adora, “Why are you trying to get so close to her now?”

Adora remarked, “We are close.”

Glimmer rolled her eyes. “If you are so close to her, then why aren't you in her council? Juliet, Aunt Casta, and the rest of the Commanders are in her council. We’re all just kids to her.”

Adora sat up and excused herself. “It’s different with me; I know I’m important to Angella.”

Perfuma and Mermista shot each other a look again. She was fearing what Adora was going to say next. Bow sat up and tried to calm Adora. “Hey, everyone thinks your important. Queen Angella has just been very busy after the war. I’m sure you’ll see her soon.”

Glimmer remarked, “If you want to see her, she’s just down the hall in the throne room.”

Adora stormed off and made her way down the hall.

Frosta innocently asked, “Is she mad that she isn't in the council?”

Perfuma softly answered, “I think it's more than that.”

Mermista whistled, “Way more than that.”

Glimmer just sighed and pulled her chair in more and remarked, “It’s the council thing. Must she think my mom would make her a General or something? I know how she feels, I always thought I’d be my mom’s right-hand woman, but instead, she gave me a title and shipped me off to a vacant training ground for five months when I thought I was going to see combat for the first time.” She had never gotten over Angella’s overprotective nature to her and thought after she turned sixteen, her mother would let her join the Rebellion. So she did, but she limited Glimmer’s ability to see battle in Angella's control. For her, she assumed Adora mistook Angella’s gesture of kindness as a way of challenging and promoting Adora in some way. The private conversation Glimmer had with Angella before the diplomacy mission was that Adora wanted to be more in Angella’s favor. Angella, at the time, worried that Adora was too uneasy around her and wanted to make it right. Poor Adora probably thought this was her only way to feel important in Brightmoon despite how much she was already loved and adored by people.

The other princesses felt different; Frosta just assumed the same thing Glimmer did, but Mermista and Perfuma assumed Adora might have grown fonder of Angella over time. It might not have been akin to Adora feeling like Angella was another mother to her but more like a companion. To them, it was an awkward thing to

think about. Angella has been a figure in their lives ever since they could remember. The Kingdom of Brightmoon was friends with every Kingdom, and Sealines and Plumeria had been family friends for years. Angella was another parent figure to them; to think of her being romanticized by someone their age was unsettling. Adora was not even twenty yet; how could she be smitten with the immortal Queen of the largest nation in Etheria?

For Adora, this meant a lot to her. Angella had kissed and held her, and she wanted that to mean something. Angella must care for her somehow; even though Angella rejected her feelings more than once, she had to be loved by her. Adora's footsteps slowed down as she realized what she was doing. She took small moments of kindness and mistook them for romance. Did she? Angella wouldn't have kissed her if it wasn't romantic. She was straddling her right before she went off to the Fright Zone; she couldn't be imagining the passion.

She was in front of the royal courtroom and wanted to speak with Angella but doubted why she would even be welcomed. If what Glimmer said was true, Angella would have already invited Adora to be around more. She sighed and felt like a fool for storming out of dinner and hoped she could face all her friends later Tonight.

Just as she was about to leave, she saw the door to the courtroom open, and the red bull-horned woman looked down and saw Adora and greeted, "Oh? Hello She-Ra girl." She turned to the court and stated, "Adora is here."

The blonde tensed as she heard Angella's voice and heard Juliet say, "Is she coming in?"

Adora froze at this, and the bull woman asked, "Are you?"

The blonde sputtered, "I—If I'm allowed, I wasn't invited—so—"

"Send her in." Angella beckoned.

The bull woman opened the doors wider and offered Adora a polite head nod before exiting the room. Adora was now inside to see the other army captains and commanders, Castaspella and other royal court members.

Adora waved some award waves and smiled before seeing Angella on her throne; the Queen sat up and walked over. A glass of wine in hand as Adora noticed a large food table to the left of the room. Adora just crashed some celebration.

Angella spoke, "Adora, glad to see you here. We are celebrating the accomplishments of Juliet. Now Head General of the Brightmoon and Army."

Everyone raised their glasses and cheered again.

Juliet smiled and glanced over to Castaspella, the Sorceress winked at her, and Adora looked back to Angella.

The Queen informed her, "Catra and Scorpia will be joining me tonight for tea tonight; you should stop in my chambers this evening after the princess slumber party."

Adora fidgeted with her hands and looked down. "Or maybe I'll just stay with you for the rest of the night?"

No one else was watching them as Angella's face fell in concern. "Everything alright?" the older woman asked.

Adora nodded but replied, "I miss being around you, and Glimmer thinks I'm just sulking because I'm not in your council."

The Queen darted her eyes around the throne room to make sure no one was watching. To her relief, everyone was focused on Juliet, as they should be. The Queen placed her hands on Adora's shoulders and drew her closer. "Don't worry about that now; Glimmah and I haven't spent much time together this week, and I've been meaning to see her, but our schedules cannot work right now. Besides, I assumed you longed for them, so I didn't choose to bother you much."

Adora assured Angella, "You could never bother me; I wanted to be with you afterward, but all this stuff kept happening, and I needed to be in some many other places."

“And you will still be needed throughout all of Etheria,” Angella stated.

Adora frowned again.

Angella softly smiled at her and reminded, “Tonight is a time to unwind and celebrate successes, so let's enjoy Juliet’s promotion party and then unwind later.”

Adora beamed a smile at her and went over to the snack table with her. Giddy to be near her Queen again, Adora innocently remarked, “Everyone is so laid back here.”

Angella chuckled. “This is my royal council, darling. This is my equivalent to the princess alliance, if I could be blunt. I’ve been close friends with everyone in this room since before Micah, and I were married.”

“So…. You're close with everyone here?” Adora asked as she plated herself some food. A rather large plate, and Angella poured herself more wine. “I’ve known some of these people all my life. I don’t typically change my group of friends or colleagues.”

Angella handed the glass of wine to Adora and winked at her as she made her way back to her throne. Adora stared at her as she

walked away. Completely smitten by the Queen again, she wished she could jump in her lap and kiss her. She would have loved to do that but knew she couldn't, despite no eyes staring her down, nor did they stare at Angella—it wouldn't be proper. Juliet gave a speech and flusteredly thanked everyone, especially Angella, for her promotion. Adora had never spoken to Juliet much before this moment and was surprised to see her smile, laugh, and happily flirt with Castaspella in front of the entire royal court. It was also a treat to see Casta drunk. She was happy to see Adora and hugged and asked how she was doing and if she needed to plan a special visit to go back to Mystacor. Fun aside, Adora finally got to eat and enjoyed sipping sangria with the rest of the *adults*.

Once it was over, she ran back to her room to freshen up, putting on pajamas; she was ready to go straight to Angella's room. But, unfortunately, the second she exited her bedroom, Glimmer had teleported in front of her and exclaimed, "Adora! Can we talk?"

Adora jumped but nodded. "Sure, Glimmer, what's up?"

The princess sighed and apologized. "Hey, I'm sorry if it came off like I was hard on you earlier about the council thing. It's just that I know my mom can be hard to read sometimes, and I hope you're okay. We barely got to talk while you were out on that mission with her, and you must have been under a lot of stress."

Adora relaxed her shoulders, and she assumed Glimmer would yell at her. But, instead, Glimmer was way off in her thoughts about Angella and Adora. So Adora nervously replied, "Oh, yeah, it was stressful, but I'm okay."

Glimmer then asked, "Was she difficult? You've been off since your time with her." Concerned that maybe Angella might have traumatized Adora back into her Horde cadet mindset. She remembered how awkward Adora was with Angella initially and how doubtful and questioning Angella was of her at first. Glimmer knew Adora was a people pleaser, and being with Angella must have been hard.

Adora waved her hands. "No—no, she was fine. We—we got along well, I mean she is my boss, and we have a transactional….relationship."

It sounded so strange. Adora wouldn't dare tell Glimmer that Angella and Adora had bathed together multiple times; Adora has pleasured herself to the thought of Angella and even kissed her on three different occasions. For Glimmer hearing this, it went over her head. For whatever reason, she just assumed Adora felt left out; most media coverage of the war didn't talk about She-Ra the way they used to. She assumed Adora was also off due to seeing Shadow Weaver die and being around Catra for so long. *Transactional?* Angella must have been bossing Adora around a lot. It was the only way she could understand the term transaction used to describe Angella and Adora.

Adora then started to back away. "Uh, Glimmer, I kinda was going see Catra now, so I might not be able to be at the sleepover tonight."

Glimmer blinked in surprise. Assuming Adora would have been exhausted by being around Catra for all that time in the Scorpion Kingdom. She didn't think much of it and didn't pry. "Okay, well, hang out with us before your next mission alone, okay?"

"Okay," Adora replied before rushing down the hall; she was happy to be with Catra and Scorpia—maybe not so much of Scropia seeming as how the tall buff Queen made it clear she wasn't a fan of Adora, but after they leave she will have all her time with Angella.

She spotted a castle guard coming close to the Queen's quarters who just pointed for Adora to go down the hall near Angella's room. The blonde was giddy and rushed to knock on the door. The Queen opened the door and was in a fancy evening nightgown that was long and had a silky robe on. But, unfortunately, Adora was not in anything fancy or elegant. Instead, she was in a blue pajama set that was blue with fluffy clouds. The signature pajama set that all Brightmoon guests are given. It was better than running around in grey shorts and a tank top. But now, Adora felt childishly dressed in front of her Queen. Instead, Angella let out a giggle and remarked, "Oh, this is adorable; all three of you match."

Adora blinked and looked surprised as Angella opened the door to see Scorpia and Catra sitting at a table with Castaspella. The two younger Queens were wearing matching pajamas while Casta was wearing something just as elegant as Angella. Casta let out a giggle and replied, "Oh, this is too cute, all three of you. Would you two mind if I got a photo of all three of you two sitting together?" Casta asked, pointing directly to Catra to see if she would approve. The feline girl nodded, and Adora sat next to her and beamed a smile.

Angella went to sit back down with Castaspella, and the Sorceress proceeded back to the conversation they had before Adora

entered the room and asked Scorpia, “Go back to telling us about your night in town.”

Scorpia proceeded, “We went to this place by the harbor called *Frella Bonjour,* and we had fancy tuna, and we shared a chocolate mousse cake, it was nice, and Catra got to see how the chef prepared the tuna.”

Catra added, “It was pretty neat to see an open kitchen. We never had that back in the Horde.”

Angella smiled at the two young newlyweds. They were experiencing all the joys of finding new things together, which made her happy. Then, the two went on to tell them about their other adventures in town.

Scorpia held up a tiny stuffed turtle. “Catra won this for me at a prize cart; she had to shoot down the little cups and won this. She was so good at it she won three other turtles for some kids.”

Adora smiled warmly at that, knowing how sweet Catra could be to people. The feline once beat up a senior cadet in their junior days when she heard they were bullying the kids in the orphan wing. Catra just shrugged it off modestly. “It was easy, and the parents looked happy about it.”

Angella looked over to Adora and smiled at her. She saw her happy to be with her friend. Casta talked about her plans while in

town and offered Angella and Glimmer to spend time with her. Angella agreed that it would be nice to do so, and Casta yawned and replied, "I should get some rest; Juliet invited me for a stroll around Brightmoon in the morning on her horse."

Angella raised a brow. "You're going to be bed early?"

Casta grinned. "Well, I will be in bed; I might not sleep right away."

"Did you want us to move to another part of the room for you to rest?" Assuming Casta was staying with Angella for the night.

The Sorceress waved her hand. "Oh no, I'm going to Juliet's room." A brief pause came over the group as Castaspella grinned widely. Angella's eyes widened in shock, and Scorpia innocently asked, "Is Juliet your wife?"

The Queen looked at Scorpia as Castaspella chuckled. "Oh, my, I like the way you think, dear." Before leaving the room.

Angella rolled her eyes and took a sip of tea.

Catra snorted and teased, "I think she likes your General lady."

Adora shifted uncomfortably at this realization. However, Casta was bold in not saying what she was implying, and Angella didn't

seem to mind. The Queen remarked, "I assumed they were fond of each other."

Scorpia asked, "Is there a policy on dating in Brightmoon? Back in the Horde, you could only date or get married if they were Force Captain."

Catra shot Scorpia a look, not liking that Scorpia kept bringing up the Horde.

Angella answered her "Only rules we have are professional ones; people can date whoever in the Army as long as it doesn't affect their work. Castaspella is my sister-in-law, and for all, I know she'll be my neighbor soon if she and Juliet hit it off."

Adora finally spoke, "How do you feel about that?"

Angella laughed. "I'm fine; I worry for Juliet. If Casta is anything like Micah—she'll be fighting Casta off with a stick."

Catra laughed. "Why was your husband overly affectionate?"

Adora frowned at the mention of Micah, but Angella smiled and replied, "He was, he was sweet with his constant charming acts of chivalry—but being introduced constantly as his gorgeous, beautiful, elegant, radiant wife every time I walked into a room started getting embarrassing quick."

Scorpia nudged Catra. “I should start doing that when I introduce you, Catra?”

Adora and Angella giggled at that, and Catra replied, “Sure, just make sure to say badass and fierce, and you say gorgeous and stuff.”

The four laughed.

It was odd being around each other like this, but Angella’s motherly and dominating personality made it relaxing and calm. Scorpia was getting tired not too much later, and they were off to bed. Adora felt happy to be able to have some time alone with her. Finally, the door closed, Scorpia and Catra were gone, and Angella and Adora were finally alone.

The Queen sat up and went over to her bed. “Tired?” she asked Adora.

The blonde nodded made her way over to Adora. “Not really; I wanted to see you, though. We have barely been in the same room since the war ended.”

Angella agreed, “Yes, and it will only continue to get busier; the Trial of Hordak and Entrapta will be a long one; many of the Kingdoms want restitution in some form, so it will be a lot of

diplomatic missions to come. So I've decided to be on a diplomacy tour to all the Kingdoms. I will be announcing that tomorrow at the morning meeting."

Adora perked up and asked, "Will I be going with you?"

Angella smiled. "I would like for you too, but I'm not forcing you. I know you haven't enjoyed these solo missions, and Glimmer had complained about not spending any time with you, so I've been keeping myself away so that you don't become smothered by me."

Adora almost purred as she leaned in. "I wouldn't mind to smothered by you."

Angella grinned and leaned in closer to fluster the blonde, teasing, "You're still pining for me?"

Adora blinked and blushed. "Can you blame me?" she averted her eyes away from Angella, and the older Queen laughed and replied, "Adora, I don't want to hurt you."

Adora nodded. "I know that; I'm not going to make it weird; I know this isn't going to turn into a real relationship."

Angella's smile fell a little as she lectured her, "You should try and pursue a relationship with someone your age. Pining and loving someone you can't be with is emotionally damaging."

Adora assured her, "I'm fine, I like this—I want you—but I know I can't have you in that way."

Angella felt heat come to her cheeks by the phrase *that way* meant a little more than what it would have meant a week ago. She and Adora shared a passionate kiss before the final battle in the Fright Zone. Adora was longing for her back in the Scorpion Kingdom, and now she was desperate for the Queen's touch. Angella couldn't deny she cared for Adora, and the thought of a romantic evening would be nice. Being romantic in general would be nice to have someone to love again would bring Angella happiness she had not felt in a long time. Looking into the blue eyes of a loving person made her feel like she could be a romantic person again. But all the other factors in what made this a situation she couldn't indulge in were also there. The age, class, and Adora were She-Ra and a Queen. Although they could be a power couple—the fact that Angella was a widow double Adora's age and Adora was a friend to all royals wouldn't be an easy pill for their friends to swallow.

Angella sighed and decided there was no use playing coy anymore. She has had the same conversation beofre with Adora, and it still ended up with them kissing and Adora being open about her feelings. Angella was tired of the runaround of emotions. Letting herself become Huntara's romp for a day made her feel weak and ashamed. She knew Micah never made her feel that way, and neither would Adora. She needed to give in to her needs. Even if it was for one night, it could be enjoyable enough for Adora to move on with her pining.

“Adora, I truly am amazed by your bravery, and I am deeply fond of you.” The Queen began.

Adora felt her heart race.

The Queen proceeded, “I am aware of your feelings, and I would like to reciprocate them in a small way. Of course, I cannot honor a committed relationship—but I would like to show you how you should be appreciated as a partner.” Her most formal way of telling Adora she would be romantic with her in private.

Adora smiled widely, her cheeks blushing bright red, and she replied, “I—I like that.” The blonde then sheepishly averted her eyes and asked, “W—what does that mean for right now?”

Angella placed a hand on Adora’s right shoulder and gave her a peck on the cheek. “It means tomorrow after the meeting, and I will be taking you Plumeria with me and hopefully on a nice small date.”

Adora somewhat frowned and replied, “But tonight…..what about tonight?”

Angella giggled. “Did you want to snog?”

Adora perked up a little and patted the bed. “We can do more than that.” Eagerly patting the bed.

Angella covered her mouth. “So naughty, Adora, darling, you haven’t even snogged before—perhaps just some small intimacy before making such a big step.”

Adora frowned. “I think I earned to have a little fun.”

Angella grinned and gestured for Adora to lay down. “Lay on the bed, Adora; I’ll show you fun—doubt you can handle it, but I will give you what your hormones demand of you.”

Too horny to protest Angella calling her out for her inexperience and insatiable nature. A merger kiss was not going to sustain Adora Tonight. The Queen crawled on top of the blonde, who watched her with joyful anticipation.

Angella kissed Adora’s lips sweetly.

Adora moaned into the kiss as Angella continued to kiss the blonde with sensual passion. She heard the shuffling of Adora’s legs squirming under her on the duvet. Smiling into the kiss, Angella remembered Adora was a lousy kisser. The blonde was more an open-mouthed fish when she kissed. Especially when she wasn’t nervously darting her tongue in and out of her mouth.

Adora made the bold move to touch Angella’s breast, and the older woman could feel the bedrock as the blonde's hips bucked

up—desperate for friction.

Angella let her waist lay on Adora's, and the blonde proceeded to grind up on her.

Knowing that wasn't enough to pleasure Adora, she moved her hand lower to the young woman's needy groin area and began to slip her hand into her pajama bottoms and began to rub her slit through her underwear lightly.

Adora whimpered into the kiss that she was severely participating in, and Angella moved her lips to Adora's neck. The blonde felt ecstasy and pleasure like she never felt beofre as Angella repeated the moves Huntara did on her to make her raptured in enjoyment. It wasn't too long before the blonde pressed her thighs together and whined over her orgasm.

Angella moved her hand out from Adora's pajamas, and she kissed Adora's lips lightly before teasing her. "I see you've become satisfied during our little snog?"

Adora closed her eyes and hummed as she nodded.

Angella gave Adora a moment to sit up before the blonde moved on her own. Wobbly legs aside, Adora felt terrific. To have her feelings returned and to have some release in intimacy was terrific to her.

Angella walked her to the door and reminded her, “Be professional at the meeting tomorrow; I’ll see you at breakfast."

winding down

Glimmer had missed her mother far more than what she had led on with everyone. As brave and strong as she was in the fight for Etheria, she still missed her mom and wanted to be close to her. When the Scorpia's Kingdom incident happened, she feared the idea she had never thought possible—losing Angella in a way like losing her dad. With the war over, she wanted a better relationship with her mother. No more secrets, lies or arguing. She wanted to prove to Angella how mature she was now, and her time to do so was limited. Like when the war was going on, Glimmer had to wait for her time with Angella. She could not just spend time with her mother like she wanted to. After Adora stormed off from the princesses last night, Glimmer thought about seeing her mom late. After thinking about Angella's tiredness, she stopped herself, and it didn't bother her. This morning she caved into weakness and made her way over to her mother's part of the castle. Teleporting to the front door, she listened to hear some movement take place and knocked. "Mom?" she called out.

She heard movement coming to the other side of the door, and Angella immediately greeted her. The Queen's mouth opened to say hello, but quickly became agape when she saw how Glimmer looked. Her hair was styled differently, more mature and regal than its fluffier unmanaged style and her outfit was more in the traditional bodysuit that Angella; herself would wear. Angella did for functionality and style; seeing Glimmer wear made it clear she took after Micah's family in their curvier stature. Undoubtedly she was Castaspella's niece as the young sorceress was shaped just like Glimmer at her age. Angella's pause and gaped mouth quickly turned to a smile when she saw the immediate fluster of her daughter sputtering an excuse for her wardrobe change. "Th—this is a more mature look for me. I'm getting older, and this is good, right?"

Angella couldn't resist the beam of joy coming over her and embraced Glimmer tightly and cooed to her, "You look so beautiful."

Glimmer didn't teleport out of the embrace despite feeling a little embarrassed by the compliment. Instead, she returned the hug, and when they broke off, she looked at her mom and asked, "Can you and I have tea together before the meeting?"

Angella was beyond surprised. Tea? Glimmer never asked her to have tea anymore. She stopped around the time she turned fourteen. She knew Glimmer would have tea with Bow, Adora, and other alliance members. Angella tried not to take it personally—even when she knew it was. Glimmer grew tired of her mother's demanding nature and control and took the one fun thing they had together away from Angella out of spite. After all the drama and chaos they had faced this month, Glimmer wanted to finally sit down with her mother and enjoy her. Have tea with her. If she hadn't just finished putting on makeup, Angella would be crying.

Angella replied with an equally flustered sputter, "T—that would be lovely. We—we haven't had tea together in quite some time." Angella turned on her heels, and her wings fluttered a little as she turned to her living room quarters of her chambers.

Glimmer had a slight smile on her face as she saw how happy she had just made her mother. Angella almost fell over herself to call down to the kitchen to bring her tea.

Glimmer smiled and watched Angella set up her couch with Glimmer's favorite cushions. Finally, the Princess assured her mother, "Mom, you don't need to go out of your way for me."

Angella sat down and exclaimed, "Of course I do! We never get to spend any time together—I'm not going to miss out on any chance to make this perfect."

Glimmer then frowned when she saw how desperate Angella was for this and sat next to her—sighing and resting her head on her shoulder. Angella instantly worried. "Glimmah—are you alright?"

Glimmer nodded. "Yes, mom." She closed her eyes and softly replied, "I'm sorry we haven't done this in so long. I want to make up for that."

Angella let her wing wrap Glimmer into a hug.

The mother was so relieved to have her daughter with her again, and all she wanted to do was ask Glimmer about everything; how was her time leading the Rebellion? How was she feeling? How was Bow? Were she and Bow? Officially dating now? Can she even ask that yet?

Glimmer spoke up and asked, "I want to know about your time in the other Kingdom."

Angella turned to her, and as she did, the knock from one of the maids came in with tea for them. The maid poured them two cups, and Angella asked Glimmer, "I'd like to hear about your time here first. But, of course, you already know about some situations that occurred in the Scorpion Kingdom."

Glimmer corrected, "I only saw one bad part and one good part. But I also know from aunt Casta that—going there was your first time out of Brightmoon since dad died, so I just wanted to check up on you—"

Angella cut her off to ask, "Your aunt told you that? How did I come up in the conversation?"

Glimmer frowned and answered, "When everyone saw the video of you getting hit by that blast and falling…." Glimmer bit her lip before finishing her sentence, "I was terrified. So was auntie and everyone else."

Angella looked down at her tea and replied, "I'm sorry to have made you worry."

Glimmer sipped her tea and softly remarked, "It must have been how you always felt when I went off all the time?"

Angella sipped her tea and replied, "Yes, I never wanted you to leave the castle, but I had to. I never liked a single moment of it. But I knew I had to get over it, so I gave you a commander's

role and had you go through basic training as the other leaders in the army."

Glimmer deadpanned to her mother and corrected, "I didn't get the same basic training. I barely did a Bootcamp. Bow did more physical training than me, and we both got our separate suite tents out in the training grounds."

Glimmer's commander training was as watered down as Angella possibly made it. Almost all princesses went through combat training with the Runestones that powered them. Angella and Glimmer shared one, and the other members of the Rebellion did not share or had no one else to share with, which made Glimmer's training more delicate. Castaspella had offered for Glimmer to live in Mystacor and train there, and Angella angrily put a stop to that in her only letter to Castaspella after Micah's death. Angella had always been overprotective of Glimmer in the most invasive way. Glimmer had guards follow her around when she was a child, even when she was out playing on the castle grounds of her play area. They surrounded her. Angella knew Glimmer hated it and would often act up for the guards, who had no choice but to inform Angella about Glimmer's behavior.

Dreading this from turning into an argument, Angella wanted to drop the subject. But, instead, Glimmer sighed and asked, "Hey, I don't want to start our morning off on a sour note, so later, can we talk about some stuff. I want to sit down and talk with you about some family stuff."

Angella worried. "Family stuff?" for a brief moment, she pondered. Then, her eyes went wide, panicked internally, and she exclaimed, "Glimmah! Are you not pregnant?"

Glimmer spat out her tea and jumped up. "Mom! Seriously?!" her face was red as she sputtered, "I—I just wanted to hang out with you—I'm not dropping some crazy news on you—jeez!" Glimmer huffed, and Angella could help but chuckle.

"So, no surprises for me tonight?" Angella teased.

Glimmer promised, "Nothing crazy like that."

Angella replied, "Very well, then how about another spa night. You and I can take a nice hot bath and talk about anything you want."

Glimmer hugged Angella and replied, "Thanks, mom."

As the two parted from each other, Glimmer teleported out of the room, Leaving Angella to herself. Preparing for the days-long list of meetings was not one she was looking forward to leading all of them. However, a princess alliance meeting about new recovery plans and restoration went as expected. No bad news, and everyone was happy to help. She has grown more pleasantly surprised with Catra's involvement—the young Queen was cordial with the other alliance members and made her request to assist the Dryl restoration project much more manageable. Mermista had offered her resources to the whispering woods with Netossa and Spinnerella. Frosta had volunteered to go to Mystacor with Casta and Juliet for how they could offer their services for restoration. That left Angella to her original plan of going on

another diplomatic tour with Adora at her side. Glimmer had counter-offered with herself going in Angella's place to her downfall, and Perfuma accepted. It made sense for her to. Perfuma would much rather show Glimmer around over the Queen of Brightmoon; not only that—but—Angella has barely spoken to Perfuma's parents in years. Aside from Brightmoon being a significant supply chain to them, the Kingdoms didn't see much of each other.

This left Adora to Glimmer and Bow while Angella sat on the sidelines alone again.

It bothered Adora, too; she wanted to be alone with Angella again.

Leading into the night, Adora sulked in her room to herself, which annoyed Catra. Being in Brightmoon as a royal guest should be more fun for her. Of course, to get on the other princesses' nerves would have been nice—but Scorpia's sweet and calm nature made them all adore Scorpia, and Catra didn't want to be the odd one out, so she decided to be as polite as possible with everyone else. Deep down, she liked being nice to people. All the alliance members were friendly; they were invited out to double date Spinnerella and Netossa tonight and took the offer to see more of Brightmoon together as a couple. Scorpia was beyond excited about this; a chance to be around other princesses and the fact that they all wanted to be around her made her even happier.

Adora was happy for Catra in how relaxed she was now outside the Horde's grasp. Despite that date not being till later in the evening, Glimmer had plans to spend with her mother. She was

leaving Adora alone. She had been offered several options for having a good time with other people for the night but chose to be on her own.

A forceful entrance followed a knock on her door, and she shot up from her bed to see Catra standing in the doorway and walking towards her with a bit of speed. "I need to borrow a dress. I need your red princess prom dress." Catra demanded.

Adora let out a small laugh and questioned, "You need the dress for what?"

Catra rubbed the back of her head and walked over to Adora's closet. "Scorpia's a social butterfly, she made friends with some of the other princesses, and we have a date with them tonight. I guess it's a themed party place, and we have to wear red. I need a red dress." She said, looking through Adora's closest without permission.

Adora explained, "It's in the white dress bag."

Catra grabbed it and replied, "Thanks. Want to do me a favor and help me with my hair in a bit?"

Adora smiled. "Sure. Hope you have a good time tonight."

Catra turned to her and replied, "You can come along with us."

Adora shook her head. “No thanks, it sounds like a date place, and I’m not married, so… it wouldn’t be for me.”

Catra assured her, “Adora, your She-Ra, the princess of power, you can find a date.”

Adora rolled her eyes before her lips fell into a frown.

Catra knew what this was all about her crush on Queen Angella, took the dress, laid it down on Adora’s table, sat on the bed with her, and reminded her, “You gotta think about what’s best for Adora. I doubt the woman twice your age will mind if your crush fades.”

Adora sighed and looked at Catra. “I know this all seems silly to you, but I don’t know—I feel like I have a real connection with her.” She said, extending out her arms and explaining, “We click, I think she and I have something—something special, and I don’t know what or how it can work, but I feel like it could if I try hard enough, it could—”

Catra cut her off, placed a hand on the blonde’s shoulder, and chastised her. “Adora! You shouldn’t have to prove yourself to someone for love. I know I’m not the best person to give emotional advice, but I’m sane enough to know that your thing for Angella isn’t going to work. But, age aside, Sparkles won't be cool with it, and neither will everyone another person in Brightmoon.”

Adora continued to pout, “What is wrong with her and I being together?”

Catra shot her a look and explained, “It’s not going to look right for her to date her daughter's friend. Plus, I don’t think Angella is all that into you.”

“She’s kissed me before, and she kissed me last night. She does love me. I’m sure of it.”

Catra felt her stomach drop in anger from what Adora had just said. Although the blonde proudly proclaimed it, the knowledge that Angella would kiss a person half her age and a friend of her child no less was disappointing. Angella might think she knows Adora, but she doesn’t. Adora doesn’t understand love—she barely loves herself enough to do what's right for her. Shadow Weaver destroyed the self-worth Adora should have always given herself by always wanting to be the best—the person hero—fighter—anything as long as it made Adora feel what she assumed to be love by Shadow Weaver or anyone else. It was another reason why Catra never forgave that Adora left the Horde to join the Rebellion. The idea of Adora being manipulated by a bunch of hugging and cheerful people to make Adora into a weapon angered her to no end. It was a lie to think Angella would fail to pick up on this and kiss Adora and think that the poof-haired moron would just let it go. Adora was going to love her and love her hard. Angella would have no choice but to be a heartbreaker.

In The Queen's Quarters

Glimmer was sitting down in the hot with her mother, relaxing and enjoying time with her mother. Angella decided to make this extra bath memorable by letting Glimmer have wine with her. Glimmer took the glass and took a gulp of the red wine, and much to Angella's assumptions and dismay, Glimmer handled her liquor firmly, just as Micah used to.

Angella let out a soft hum and remarked, "You drank that like you've had wine many times before tonight."

Glimmer gulped and lied, "Oh, I've smelt wine before. I never drank it….."

She saw her mother's disapproving eyes gaze at her, and Glimmer confessed, "More than a few times before."

Angella glanced at her glass, swirled the wine around a bit, and remarked, "Well, you do hold the glass correctly. Plus, royals are expected to hold their liquor, so I have no place to scold you." She said as she took a sip.

Glimmer asked, "How come you never drink. You only ever have wine around diplomats and a few times at dinner."

Angella replied with some humor in her voice. "I enjoy wine with my dinner, and if you hadn't stopped eating with me when you were fourteen, you would notice that."

Glimmer frowned and softly replied, "Sorry, mom."

Angella shrugged and fully submerged her wings in the water. "I don't blame you, darling. I'd rather spend time elsewhere at your age. With other company." She smirked at glanced over to her daughter to see her reaction. The Princess appeared flustered as she looked down at her wine glass. Then, setting it on the marble siding of the large tub, she swam to the opposite side of the tub and mumbled, "I know what you're getting at."

Angella smiled and swam with her wine glass in hand and offered her daughter, "I'm just speculating; I don't know anything going on with you unless you tell, and you've always been spearing on details."

Shoulder to shoulder with her daughter again, Glimmer rolled her eyes and admitted, "Bow and I started—" she stopped herself from saying the word as she saw Angella's face beam, causing Glimmer to blush furiously as she confessed, "We're dating now!" dunking her head underwater to avoid Angella's smile.

The Queen joyfully clapped her hands together and watched as Glimmer reemerged from the water to avoid Angella's gaze some more. Then, the Queen giggled, "This is precious; how long have you two been officially courting?"

Glimmer rolled her eyes. "We haven't told anyone yet. Bow wanted to make it official after he asked you."

Angella smiled. "Ah, I see he had read up on traditional Brightmoon royal courting rules."

Glimmer glared at her. "I wonder how he knew about those?"

Angella sipped her wine and playfully replied, "Not sure; it couldn't have been when I asked one of the scribes to send him several books on Brightmoon when he began staying in the castle two years ago."

Glimmer scoffed, "I knew you knew you weren't just being welcoming when you offered him all those books."

Angella placed her glass down and smiled. "I just wanted to be helpful. I am pleased about this news. Should I pretend to be surprised when he asks for permission to date you?"

"No, I'll let him know that you figured it out. But, please don't embarrass me in front of everyone. Don't make some huge announcement or anything." Glimmer whined and sunk a little in the water.

Angella corrected her by reminding her, "Your aunt will be one to worry about. You know how much she loves to plan for parties."

Glimmer groaned, "Great."

Angella smiled and offered, "I'll let her know not to be so theatrical. Can you promise me we'll make more time for each other now?"

Glimmer turned to her mother. "Of course, I'd love that."

Angella smiled warmly. Looking at Glimmer, she saw what a beautiful young woman she had grown into. So much like her handsome father—yet some feminine and gorgeous. She looked so much like her Etherian side and could easily pass for Castaspella's child more than her own, but looking at the sparkles in her hair, Angella proudly had a role in making this beautiful girl.

After the bath, Glimmer went off to see Bow for their date tonight, and Angella got herself ready for an early night in. she longed for Adora to sneak over to her quarters to tell her all about how happy she was to spend time with Glimmer. A thing she had missed dearly was the companionship Adora had graced her with. Angella paced in her room alone and realized she hated not having anyone near.

With a small gulp, she reached for her room's telephone and communicated with the front of the castle guards staff on a status report on who was in the castle this evening.

Her guard informed her.

"Juliet and Castaspella were out for the evening, heading East to a restaurant far from the main village of Brightmoon. Perfuma and Frosta returned to their Kingdoms. Members of the Princess Alliance were heading to a dinner party; members included are as follows. Netossa and Spinerella, Mermista and Seahawk, Bow and Glimmer, Catra and Scorpia"

Angella questioned, "If Adora is available, please message her to come to my quarters."

The guard paused and replied, *"Queen Catra has summoned Adora to accompany her this evening with the rest of the Princess Alliance."*

Angella frowned at this but thanked the guard on the phone and hung up.

Saddened by this news, she wondered why Adora would go out on her own. But then, an ugly thought came to mind as she worried that Adora might be off looking for companionship after she denied the blonde's advances last night. Angella should be happy for Adora to get out and explore more of Brightmoon on

her own. She never had much of a chance during her time living here, as she was always sent off on missions.

Angella's loneliness right now was no different from when Micah died, and she was left alone with Glimmer. Grieving and miserable, she pushed away many friends who never returned to her. Most of them stopped calling or writing letters to her. Others took much offense and spoke ill of Angella in later years. Alone in the castle's largest bedroom, she chose to be as brave and bold as she was in the Scorpion Kingdom. Away from Brightmoon made her more confident; she wanted to be brave for others. Back in her bubble she created for herself in Brightmoon made her more invisible to the people of her Kingdom as they looked at her through rose-tinted glasses. She was a stoic and perfect Queen and not a person like them. As a blatantly non-Etherian, she was far from average. Being over six feet tall with massive wings made it clear. With Micah, given his shortness, it still made her feel special—but just like anyone else. Someone who needed to laugh, love, and relax. No one had ever given her that feeling besides Adora, and knowing she would be off at a formal festive party without her made her betrayed. Like when Micah would go off to Sorcoror events in Mystacor and Angella was not invited. It was business, and Angella didn’t want to go, but it still hurt not to be included.

Entering her large walk-in clothing closet, she looked at all her evening attire for cocktail dresses. The many knee-length dresses she owned would ride up on her and show more leg than she wanted. Micah never cared since he loved her legs. Most dresses she stopped wearing after Glimmer was born because she felt they didn’t make her look motherly. She was staring at her old favorite cranberry sparkling dress with lace sleeves. She wondered if she could still pull it off. To her delight, she could. It still was just as form-fitting and elegant as it was on her twenty years ago, and it still was stylish enough to wear out tonight if she

wanted to. The thought kept creeping into her mind. Should I leave the castle and go out to that party?

It would be one of her very few appearances out into Brightmoon, and she should present. But, she might not be welcomed. She didn’t want to take away from Glimmer’s night out with her friends. However, Glimmer did agree that they needed to spend more time together. So tonight isn't such a wrong time to start.

She stopped worrying about what others would say, threw caution to the wind, and decided to leave the castle. But, again, causing much confusion and whispers as she requested her royal carriage be readied.

The Queen of Brightmoon was off to crash a party.

Meanwhile, Adora felt an immense sense of awkwardness at the party when she shared with Bow and Glimmer, stepping out of her carriage. Besides watching them kiss for half the ride, her dress felt too short for her. Catra was wearing her other dress while Glimmer picked out another dress for her. Catra and Glimmer had a good bonding moment while Glimmer had done Catra’s hair for her and had a few good laughs at Adora’s expense over being fashionable. Glimmer and Catra are very much into looking stylish, and Adora could even hear Bow convince them to go out on a shopping date together.

Adora's anxiety peaked as she saw people crowding around with cameras, pulling up to the restaurant. The carriage stopped, and Glimmer and Bow left first, and people rushed to take photos of them and ask questions. Adora nervously gulped, and Glimmer turned back to her and offered her a warm smile, and it assured Adora to step out and she'll be okay. However, the sudden rush of people shouting "She's She-Ra!" made Adora uncomfortable as one man with a camera flashing in her face instantly asked her, "Princess of Power! Who are you wearing tonight? What are your plans for after the war?"

Another person yelled to her before Adora answered, "What Kingdom will be the first for your recovery mission?"

Adora only could look around and nervously sputter a few nonsense sentences before the familiar claws of her feline friend came across her forearms, and her voice parted the cameramen with her simple demand of "Hey! The Princess Alliance and the Queens of the Scorpion Kingdom would all like to go inside now!"

Some gasps came over them, and one boldly asked, "Queen Catra is it true you were once a Horde Commander?"

Catra walked past them and brushed it off with a snarky remark, "Is it true you once had a decent career?"

Scorpia nervously waved at the camera people and apologized for how harsh Catra came off to them and indirectly made the cameraman feel worse when she innocently commented, "Good luck with your next job, buddy."

I am leaving them all stunned.

Once inside, Glimmer rushed over to Adora and apologized, "I'm so sorry! I should have briefed the paparazzi! I didn't know they would rush you with all those questions!"

Adora rubbed the back of her head. "It's cool; I'm fine. Really."

Catra rolled her eyes and clasped onto Scorpia's claw to leave the three alone. She had done her part and didn't want to hover over Adora tonight, especially since Scorpia was slightly still jealous of Adora and Catra's friendship.

The best friend squad made their way to a table to eat. Multiple waiters came around with food, and Adora happily ate. Unfortunately, she had her picture taken every time opened her mouth to eat, and Adora lacked dining etiquette. Nevertheless, Adora kept looking over to see how happy everyone was with their partners. No single princess in sight except for her. Glimmer saw Adora looking sad and reached a hand out to her. "Hey, you okay?"

Adora faked a smile and lied, "I'm fine."

Both Bow and Glimmer knew that she was lying, and knowing she couldn't fake it anymore, she just sat up and excused herself.

"I'm going to get some air."

Adora left the banquet room, and everyone looked to see how visibly upset Adora seemed. Despite everyone being at their separate tables, they all knew something was wrong. It pained Catra to see Adora look so upset. She was more annoyed to see how no other princess was helping. Finally, she turned to her wife angrily and said, "Can you believe all these princesses are just sitting around like dumbass statues? For some super special club of magical friends, they sure as hell don't act like it."

Scorpia rolled her eyes and muttered, "Our first date out with the princess alliance, and we somehow still end up talking about Adora, right?"

Catra leaned back in her seat and apologized. "Sorry, I know she comes up a lot, but I'm mad that no one is helping her. Not even sparkle mc'dumbass."

Scorpia gave her a quick confused look beofre realizing Catra was referring to Glimmer.

Speaking of which, they both saw Glimmer walk towards the balcony alone to talk to Adora. Scorpia was relieved to see this, as it meant Catra wouldn't be the one talking to Adora.

On the balcony, Glimmer came to Adora's side. "Hey, what's wrong?"

Adora sighed and looked down over the balcony ledge to see people around the building.

Glimmer commented, "Tonight was supposed to be a quiet night out, but I guess some people caught wind of all these princesses being here and decided to crash it."

Adora shook her head. "I don't care about that—I don't mind the people and all the questions. I feel like my head is somewhere else right now."

Glimmer asked, "Where is it at."

Adora stupidly replied, "With my heart."

Glimmer gasped. What did Adora mean by that? With her heart? Was she in love with someone? Who could that be?

Before Glimmer could press further for any other questions, she heard gasps and people rushing around behind. Then they heard people mutter and cry.

"Queen Angella!"

"Oh my! What a treat to see her royal highness!"

"Your majesty Angella!"

Both Adora and Glimmer turned to see her, Queen Angella, stunning as always, in a dress that showed off her body, and her hair was up and styled to show off her shoulders and the sheer sleeves around her arms.

All Adora could do was gasp as Angella came over to the two of them.

Glimmer watched as Adora looked at Angella with complete speechlessness. It occurred to Glimmer at this moment that something wasn't right. Adora's typical nervous and shy demeanor around Angella was replaced with something different, but with what?

A night with the Queen

Brightmoon has a party scene, namely in the dance community. Brightmoon has been one of the best Kingdoms to hold galas and events in all of Etheria. In her youth, Angella was one for dance halls and parties with Micah. The man knew how to bring the hermit Queen out of her shell when she was just a princess. Fully dressed and feeling confident in how she looked she had made the trip out to the banquet hall to crash a party she knew Adora was in attendance too. Part of her didn't want to go. To deal with cameras and people staring at her was an annoyance she had kept herself away from for years. Even before Glimmer's birth, she had kept herself out of the public eye in that way. A Queen going off to *a party* made her feel uncouth. In her most glamorous horse-drawn carriage, she made her presence known at the front doors of the hall. Paparazzi ran to see who was coming out. The carriage driver opened Angella's door and helped her step out. At that moment Angella struck a bit of a pose and extended her wings out to show her glimmering beauty. As several cameras began to flash, she saw the shocked look of Catra and Scorpia from the doorway with Perfuma. With a glow of her hand, she made all the cameras turn off and softly, yet powerfully remarked "Ladies and gentlemen, it is a pleasure, but please allow me to enter the facilities. Shall we?"

Triumphantly walking past the surprised faces of everyone she shot a smile to Catra; the young feline queen smirked after seeing Angella's elegant authority in action. Entering the building she saw Mermista, Seahawk, and Bow rush over to her. Relieved to see their familiar faces she smiled at all of them, and they all stared in shock to see her. Seahawk bowed to her politely in front of her and Angella returned to curtsey him as well. Something she never does, and it caught everyone off guard.

Catra looked to her wife and grinned as she saw everyone looking at Angella in shock and decided to have fun with this and approached Angella and asked, "Your highness, what brings you here?" her polite nature still raised tension as the other Alliance members gulped a little. This was the Queen of Brightmoon and friend to all their parents. Angella's motherly and commander titles could not be unseen by them. They grew up knowing her as a Queen. Catra grew up knowing her as an enemy and the time spent in the other Kingdom made her see that Angella wasn't so bad—far from tough or cool as Adora made her out to be.

After greeting everyone she asked to know where Glimmer was.

Bow answered, "Glimmer is with Adora on the balcony."

Angella smiled warmly and turned to bid farewell to everyone as she made her way to walk towards the stairs leading to the balcony. "I hope to see more of you all tonight,"

Ascending the staircase Catra heard an audible sigh of relief from Mermista and Perfuma. The feline queen shot a look at the two of them and smirked. It was funny to see them act the way they all were. To them Angella was terrified; no surprise being Glimmer's friends they would be intimidated by her mom. From the small pieces, she knew of Glimmer she assumed Glimmer was a spoiled child. Someone to whine over not getting her way. Just like what Catra assumed all these princesses were like. Despite her bias, Scorpia was making efforts to get to know everyone, which made Catra feel like an extra wheel in the group. Without Adora to tease she had to grin and bear with being around more people than she would have initially liked.

When Angella approached Glimmer and Adora she was how shocked they were to see her. Glimmer's face fell as soon as she saw how overjoyed Adora had become once she saw her, and Glimmer's face contorted into discomfort. With little time to recover from this moment; Glimmer insisted on going back downstairs.

Music is muffling all around them and the halls of this place keep getting more and more crowded. A dance hall on the other end of Brightmoon that's owner let the news media know that all members of the Princess Alliance would be in attendance stirred up on strong crowd in such little time. The Alliance members were not celebrities by any means, but they were known for their work and admired by their respected Kingdoms. Now more than ever the war is over and everyone in every kingdom buzzed-about knowing that recovery was coming fast.

The grand entrance of Queen Angella made the meager attendance of the other Queens; Catra and Scorpia fail in comparison. The Queen of conclusion was in the dance hall? The newsworthy story was now being watched by wondering cameras. Snaps and whispers can be heard as a photographer was trying to make his way to the balcony room to only be stopped by Catra and Scorpia. The other princesses looked on in confusion and after seeing the cameraman come down the staircase with a defeated look on his face, they figured he was thwarted.

Catra smugly ascended the staircase with her arm wrapped around her wife's claw and with a satisfied tone commented to Bow "That is how you get a man to reconsider his career."

Scorpia rolled her eyes and smiled down at Catra "That is how you spare your friends some privacy."

Catra shrugged "A bonus along with hurting a creep's feelings."

Bow looked back to Perfuma and Mermista, who smiled back at him. Perfuma asked, "Is Queen Angella talking to Glimmer and Adora?"

An uneasy look from Mermista caught Catra and Scorpia's eyes and the feline Queen responded "Yeah, they're just talking still."

Catra could sense an awkward vibe in the crowd and inquired Perfuma "Why? Do you want to all go up to them?"

Perfuma awkwardly waved her hands and replied "No, no we shouldn't bother them."

Scorpia and Perfuma made eye contact and gave a brief smile before Catra took her wife's claw again and directed her to the snack table. With those two gone, Bow excused himself and left the two remaining princesses. Meeting up with Glimmer again, Catra heard the faint whispers of Adora acting weird with Angella

and Bow assuring her everything is fine. With that Mermista and Perfuma followed Glimmer into the next room and left Seahawk with Scorpia and Catra.

The pirate then awkwardly offered them shots and the two accepted. Scorpia was happy to not have to hover around Adora for a night. Happy that Catra was beside her and not around the blonde with the odd infatuation with a Queen double her age.

In privacy alone on the balcony, A jovial Adora complimented “You look so stunning.” Adora was almost breathless saying it.

Angella averted her eyes for a second shyly before replying “You’ve seen me in dresses before, Adora.” Her flushed cheeks proved Adora had managed to fluster her in just one small compliment.

“N—not this one.” Adora corrected “You look so beautiful in it.”

Angella made it a point to stand beside Adora, avoiding the princess's gaze to reply, “Always the flatterer.”

Adora shrugged and moved closer to Angella to have their hands almost touch. “You don’t seem to mind it too much.” Adora tried to coyly reply. Only to regret as Queen Angella playfully whispered in her ear “You’re just as stunning too in that dress, It wouldn't be very hard to make your cheeks turn that color, right?”

Adora instantly jumped up with a bright red face. "N—no! it shouldn't be so easy! Oh Geez!" Adora covered her face with her hands.

Angella giggled and Adora slowly sat back down and whined "I need to control my blushing around you."

Angella nudged her "I know I'm teasing still, but you are very cute and flustered. I'll stop for the rest of the night."

Adora still had her cheeks covered as she looked at Angella and asked, "What is your plan for the rest of the night?"

Angella smiled "Hopefully, spend time with you. Seeming how no one else near my age is here and I don't want to make the Princess Alliance feel awkward having a parent around. I hope I'm not taking you away from anything?"

Adora sputtered "No—no I want to spend time with you! We've barely been able to since we got back from the Scorpion Kingdom." Angella nodded and agreed "You're correct on that, I had so many long-awaited projects to do, including promoting Captain Juliet and making sure out the Kingdom's outposts were so that my time with you alone has been limited. I do wish we can spend more time together, I just fear making the others uncomfortable. They are your friends and Glimmah would be so cross to know that anything was more than just work-related."

Adora frowned and crossed her arms “Is this all work-related?” feeling betrayed by Angella’s dismissive nature towards what was Adora’s real concerns. Sure, they had to act like no kissing and sexual tension occurred now that they were back home, but could Angella right it all off as the in-the-moment type of actions? If that were true, then why was Angella even here?”

Angella sputtered “Of course, it isn't Adora. I value our friendship.”

Adora let her arms fall to her side as she began to nervously swing them “So what was your plan to come here tonight?”

Angella sighed before smiling “For you firstly, and I was bored secondly. I’m the only monarch in Etheria not celebrating. The rest of the Alliance parents are having their celebrations right now.”

Adora blinked “Oh? How come you didn’t go to any of those?”

Angella frowned a little as she tried to reply with a small laugh “I wasn’t invited.”

Adora frowned at this and tried to lighten the mood with “Well, it’s their loss. You’re going to have a better time with me tonight.”

Angella grinned “Oh, this that a fact?”

Adora walked over to her and wrapped an arm over one of Angella’s arms and replied “It’s a promise. “

The two gazed into each other eyes and the urge to kiss each other was strong but they knew their surrounding would forbid it. With that, they returned to the main hall where everyone was dancing and drinking. Angella worried her presence might make people uncomfortable, seeing as how the second Mermista and Perfuma saw her; the two immediately put their drinks down. Dreading being seen drunk. Angella went to the bar and asked them what the princesses were drinking and if she could have the same. Even the bartender fumbled when Angella asked for a drink. Adora smiled seeing Angella interact with people the relived look on people's faces when they realize how nice Angella was.

This was out of the ordinary for the Princess Alliance members. No doubt, them seeing her scold Glimmer time and time again and the several times she had universally grounded all of them for botched missions on the Horde. Seeing the Queen of Brightmoon getting a drink at the open bar made them feel a little less tense. The Queen walked over to the same table as Perfuma, Seahawk, and Mermista and asked them if she could join them. They said yes and it wasn’t too long until The Queen of Brightmoon was taking a shot of tequila with a forsaken pirate, and two trouble princesses. Adora was keeping her cool, acting like she didn’t want to hover over Angella as she stood with Glimmer and Bow. Both of whom were uneasy with Angella being near. Glimmer asks Bow “Should we go over there?”

Adora answered for Bow "We should, no point of being separate from everyone else, right?"

Bow looked around and asked, "Where's Scorpia and Catra."

Glimmer snorted "Making out on the balcony."

Adora giggle and looked over to the stairs "I guess that's why she wanted all those camera people gone?"

Bow offered "Maybe she's camera shy?"

Glimmer looked over to see her mom at the bar with Perfuma and Seahawk, all of them were smiling and Angella caught Glimmer's glance and smiled at her. The princess turned away and asked Adora "Did my mom say anything about how long she was going to stay?"

Adora shrugged and asked "Does it matter? She looks like she's having a good time."

Glimmer nodded and replied, "Yeah, she does." She paused for a moment "She's been different since she's been back. More relaxed, easier to talk to. Whatever happened in the Desert Kingdom made her different, I don't know if it was the fighting or being closer to you; it just made her different. I like seeing her like this."

Adora smiled at her and then looked down at her drink for a brief second. Unsure of what to say to that. Before she even had to say much Angella, Perfuma, Mermista, and Seahawk came to their cocktail table with shots in hand. All of them were smiling.

"Glimmah, would you like to take a shot with mum?" Angella was grinning as she handed Glimmer the shot. Glimmer offered her mom a half-smile and asked, "If I take this, am I grounded?"

Everyone laughed and Angella promised she wouldn't. Everyone was handed a shot, including Adora and they all took it at the same time. Adora was surprised to taste it and realize the shot was nothing more than an iced tea?

Glimmer growled, "This wasn't alcohol."

Angella smirked "Why else wouldn't I ground you, my little Glimmah?"

Glimmer rolled her eyes and retorted "Military Commanders under 21 can drink in Brightmoon."

Angella responded with a quip "So can daughter's that sneak into wine cellars." Angella took a sip of her wine and playfully remarked "You may get grounded for that, though."

Everyone chuckled and Glimmer took Bow's hand into her own and moved him to the dance floor. The music started to play louder and looked like things were going to get lively again. Everyone started dancing except for Adora and Angella. The Queen sighed and made her way back to the bar for another drink. Adora frowned and followed her. The blonde asked her "Would you get stared at too much if you danced with me?"

Angella frowned and shifted her gaze behind Adora to remind her "I'm still the Queen, it wouldn't be fair to upstage Glimmer's fun tonight."

Adora looked back and saw Glimmer and Bow dancing together.

She asked Angella "You think Glimmer doesn't want you here, because I'm sure she does."

Angella smiled and handed Adora a glass of wine "I know you want me here. I shouldn't stay to dance, I haven't danced since I was a teenager."

Adora remarked, "You make it sound like that was a century ago."

The Queen smirked and pointed to Mermista and Seahawks dancing. The two were far from being modest as the princess of the sea was grinding her bottom against the pirate while his hands were in the air and Perfuma was playfully dancing behind him being just as vulgar—if not—more than he was. Angella lifted

her hand to shield her eyes and replied to Adora with a slight shift in pitch similar to when Glimmer gets flustered "They may be adults now but I remember going to their baby showers and their first birthdays."

Adora chuckled and suggested "If the music was more nostalgic would you dance? What kind of music dance music played back you went out?"

Angella laughed lightly and replied "Oh, it was swing dancing. Less vulgar but still attractive," She gestured to her feet and lighted her dress a little so Adora could see her heels as she began to move them "Dancing had a little more art to it back then I suppose."

Adora nodded and continued to lounge back with her and enjoy the scene of everyone else having a good time. Only once teasing Glimmer as the princess had her hands drift lower on Bow's backside than needed and an audible "Ahem" was heard from across the dance floor which left everyone laughing. Including the now, red-faced princess. It wasn't long until Scorpia and Catra returned from the balcony to see everyone dancing and the Scorpion Queen convinced Catra to join her on the dancefloor.

Adora snuck off to speak to the DJ and after one song ended an unusual familiar jazz song came to play and Angella fell back into an old nostalgic memory. All the other royals on the dance floor look confused. Seahawk said, "This is swing dance music."

Perfuma commented, "I think my parents used to listen to this?"

“Mine too,” Mermista replied.

Seahawk began to move his legs and everyone started to laugh “I think this is how it’s done.” He responded.

Queen Angella stepped forward and remarked, “Mind if I show you how it’s done?”

Everyone watched as Seahawk took Angella’s hand and the Queen used her free one to lift her dress a little and coach “It’s in in the ankles. Watch me.” She started to move, and everyone stared and started to “oooo” at her. Watching how good she was. Seahawk tried to keep up and tapped out as Bow offered to be her dance party and caught on much easier to the dancing. Seeing the dance floor get livelier with the old swing music the DJ put on another song and soon Angella had everyone dancing as they would thirty years ago. She was able to sneak a dance in with Bow at Glimmer’s approval and got the other princesses in on the fun. Catra even took a try at it and was having a good time. Adora smiled from the sidelines and her heart dropped when the music turned to a closing night slow dance. Worried, the blonde darted her eyes around the room to see everyone had a dance partner except for her and Angella. The Queen saw everyone’s distraction and warmly smiled at Adora and offered her hand to her. The blonde smiled and accepted as the two finally shared a tender moment of dancing together. Adora was so happy she forgets where she was. Her hands closely wrapped around Angella’s as the Queen made it, so they were in the corner out of eyesight as they danced. Catra and Scorpia seeing them only, as the two Queens of the Desert Kingdom made sure to be in the way from other eyes as they did.

When the night was over everyone decided to make their way back to their carriages and leave for the night. Adora took this moment to go with Angella to give Bow and Glimmer time to be alone. Knowing everyone is making out on their way back to the castle—Angella nudged Adora as they drove back to the castle. Knowing a castle guard was the carriage driver, Adora kept her hands to herself. Seeing all the other carriages leave before them made her feel more at ease as coming back to the staples meant no one else would be around.

Swiftwind wasn't ever again, much to Angella's delight. She had seemingly avoided the talking horse this entire endeavor. Walking past Glimmer's room, she heard silence. Angella debated on wishing her goodnight but decided against it on the off-chance Glimmer and Bow weren't decent. Adora walked her to Queen's quarters and wished her a goodnight. Longing for more than just a simple goodnight her royal majesty pulled Adora into the large double doors leading to her bedroom. Both gloved hands covered Adora's cheeks as she pressed a kiss to Adora's lips. Surprised the blonde didn't move or make a sound. She was in complete shock by Angella's forwardness.

As the Queen pulled away, she looked at Adora lovingly and suggested "Shall we enjoy a bath together, and perhaps another cocktail before bed?"

Adora nodded vigorously almost as if she was in disbelief that Angella was welcoming her into this private space again. This wasn't like the first time. She wasn't accompanying Glimmer to get more used to Angella, this time Angella was welcoming her to enjoy Adora without the looming need to become formal for the

sake of a mission. Angella wanted her in this private space. Adora wanted nothing more than to be with Angella in this private way. The Queen held Adora by the hand and escorted her to the spa tub. Fill up the tub with hot water. Adora felt the butterflies in her stomach flutter seeing Angella like this. It was so natural and comfortable—the Queen wasn't over-explaining this simple time together. She was just filling up a bathtub and walking to her vanity to disrobe and remove her jewelry and makeup at the vanity. The Queen offered "Adora, extra robes are behind that closet to the right, you can hang your dress up and let your hair down."

Adora did as she was instructed and removed her dress and covered herself in a fluffy white robe. Sitting beside Angella on a much small vanity stool. The Queen chuckled "That was Glimmah's vanity stool when she was little. She had long hair like mine in her adolescence and decided to cut it short when she was sixteen."

Adora shuffled onto the stool and asked, "Is there another chair?"

Angella smiled at her reflection and offered "Micah's old vanity chair is in the closet to the left. After you see it—you may settle for Glimmah's instead."

Adora nodded and walked over to the closet and opened it. Her reaction was visibly surprised, and Angella laughed at it while the blonde wheeled out the odd-shaped chair. "Is this a toilet chair?" Adora exclaimed as she pulled the chair out of the closet. Revealing the red satin-lined themed chair. Angella chuckled and replied "Micah found it in a novelty catalog and had to have it.

Same with all his tweed jackets and this hat-thing he bought that had holders for canned drinks and straws."

Adora slowly rolled the chair back in the closet and replied, "I suppose the baby stool won't be so bad."

The two shared a laugh before getting into the tub. Soaking and relaxing the two didn't speak as they sat close to one another and enjoyed the sweet lavender oil smell and the sound of the running water. Adora broke the silence with a soft "I'm really happy you came out tonight."

Angella hummed "I am too. The princesses are a fun crowd of young ladies. Bow and Seahawk are true gentlemen and I liked interacting with them…." She paused and looked at Adora to ask her "Did Glimmer mind me being there?"

Adora smiled and assured her "Glimmer was happy to see you. She said you seem more relaxed."

Angella averted her eyes, unsure of what to ask next.

Adora shifted her body to face Angella and asked, "What are you thinking about right now?"

Angella bit her lip and debated on what to say next. She wanted Adora with her tonight and wanted the blonde in her bed to be

specific. She knew this was wrong and a romp would be emotionally unfair for Adora. The Queen's needs made it hard for Angella to think straight. Wanting so bad for companionship and now thinking Adora could be that companion made things harder. She didn't want Adora to feel used or less of a person for what was essentially a *hookup*. Pondering she thought a piece of jewelry as a gift would be an ideal exchange. It was customary to give personal gifts to partners. From platonic to romantic. Her relationship with Adora was now undeniably romantic. All their encounters have been linked with sexual tension and longing. This wasn't a one-sided crush from Adora that was just flattering. Although Angella was deeply honored by Adora's feelings she never entertained the idea of making it work. Now with the war over and after tasting the thrill of adventure—she wanted to go on more with Adora—*alone*.

Angella spoke "I'm thinking I want to give you something. A Brightmoon custom. A token of my adoration to you and our friendship."

Adora smiled and sunk herself a little in the bath shyly "Oh? You don't need to get me anything special. I don't have anything to get you."

Angella stood up from the bathtub and put a robe on to head to her jewelry vanity. Adora sat in the tub nervously hearing Angella shuffle and fumble. A small smile made its way to Adora's face as she realized Angella was acting nervous and for the blonde, this was surprisingly cute. She couldn't think of a time when Angella seemed flustered to her. Now it was clear this was something on Angella's mind since their return. After a few more seconds Angella returned with a small red bracelet in her hand. Adora questioned "A bracelet?"

Angella kneeled on the marble floor and asked “Sit up out of the bath for a moment I want to give you this.”

Adora did as she was instructed but also lifted her arm out as if Angella was going to put the bracelet on her. Angella shook her head “This is an anklet, darling.”

She took Adora’s right ankle and began to place the red jeweled anklet. “There. It looks nice. I know red is your favorite color and this is something that can be safe while you go on adventures and won't bother you when you’re wearing boots.” Angella smiled at her. Adora was in shock by all this. Firstly, Angella had just kneeled in a spa robe to give a very naked Adora an ankle bracelet. With that Angella still had Adora’s ankle in her hand and softly rubbed and explained more about her choice for gifting it to her “This is my gift to you as someone who has become very dear to me and very important to me. I also gift this to you in hopes that we may….. enjoy the night together.”

Adora’s eyes went wide as she couldn’t believe what she was hearing. Angella wanted to sleep with her. Adora simply sputtered “T—thank you, and yes and I would love to spend the night with you.”

Angella smiled at her and raised Adora’s ankle closer to her so she could kiss it. Then she began to lead kisses up Adora’s right leg, and the blonde instinctively fell back and without thinking softly said “Wow, wow, this is happening, wow.” The Queen’s gaze met Adora’s when the blonde realized she said that out loud and the sheepish younger woman just smiled at her Queen. Angella

smiled back at how simply—Adora—was being right now, and she loved every second of it. She began to trail kisses up her stomach and then to the middle of her chest to lead kisses to her neck. The blonde smiled and her toes curled as Angella was on top of her over the marble lining of the tub. The left side of Adora's body. Arm and legs fell back into the warm water as the Queen peppered Adora's neck with kisses. To her lips to kiss her softly and Adora attempted to deepen the kiss by opening her mouth. Angella lifted Adora's chin slightly and instructed her "Allow me first." She said closing her eyes again and parting her lips slightly to kiss Adora passionately. This way Adora could follow the rhythm Angella was setting for a kiss—as memory served correct. Adora was not the best or most experienced kisser. Leading her into it made Adora more confident as she felt that Angella was enjoying the kiss too. Instinctively with all these hormones rushing through her, the blonde's hips bucked up repeatedly and Angella smiled through the kiss and parted it to ask her "Would you like to go to the bed now?" Angella asked.

Adora with no control of her body at this moment exclaimed "Yes!" and jolted upwards, almost headbutting Angella in the process. The Queen giggled at Adora's eagerness and the two made their way to the Queen's large bed. Angella turned to Adora, and the blonde innocently asked "Can I…. take your robe off?"

Angella smiled and nodded. A blush now made its way to the Queen's face as Adora fumbled to undo the knot in Angella's robe. Opening it slowly to reveal the taller woman's nudity, the blonde looked up at Angella's eyes as she moved her hands to remove, she removed the robe from Angella's shoulders. The robe fell and Angella bit her lip and looked down at herself as Adora locked eyes on the Queen's breasts. In a bashful reflex, the Queen covered her chest and offered Adora to get on the bed. Adora saw the flush on Angella's face and smiled. Moved over to

the left side of the bed and began to dim the lights as Adora made her way over to the right side of the bed. Adora questioned, “Why are turning off the lights?”

Angella stammered a little “You should never make love with the lights on, it’s uncouth.”

Adora questioned, “Then how will I know what I’m doing if I can't see?”

Angella teased “Adora, I don’t think lights would help you, dear. Besides the lights off is an intimate sigh that it’s only feelings, not just looking.”

Adora then teased back “And it has nothing to do with you blushing, right?”

Angella playfully swatted Adora’s forearm and heard the blonde giggle. “As if you aren’t bashful, Adora?” the Queen questioned as she began to move close to Adora and placed her right arm around her. Adora replied, “At least I don’t cheat and turn the lights off.” The two giggled before sharing another kiss.

Making love for the first time was an experience for them. Angella was never one for being the lead in her romantic relationships. Micah was a very unselfish lover and satisfied

Angella endlessly. The Queen was not a greedy lover. She pleasured Adora greatly and Adora did so in return. A definite blush-worthy evening as it was one of the rarest occasions where Angella had to be lead and talk Adora through intimacy. Not the young lady was a complete fool to romance—just inexperienced. Adora was a good lover and judging by the vocal moans and sighs exhaling from Adora all night—Angella was a good lover for her.

Exhausted from the passion they slept in each other's arms all night. Failing to set any alarms, with all the drinking going on they also failed to remember that a brunch meeting was supposed to take place in the morning with all the other Alliance members and the Generals. As the cooks prepared brunch Castaspella and Juliet worked on assembling everyone for the morning. The easiest and earliest members were Spinerella and Netossa. Casta knocked on Mermista's room to awkwardly be great by Perfuma and Seahawk sharing the room with Mermista. Thoughts ran through Casta's mind, but she didn't care to pry. The Princess Alliance were all adults and hooking up after parties is expected. Not thrilled to see the young adults she once knew as kids scrambling to get dressed and head back to their rooms before being caught. Relieved to see Glimmer and Bow were up and dressed made her hope that Bow was in his room last night. People started to sit down for brunch. As Angella preferred, she'd rather people start to eat without her. Since Queen had a small appetite she never wanted to make people stop eating on her accord and didn't want her kitchen staff to be made to wait after cooking so much food.

The conversations began to start while everyone ate.

Glimmer questioned Catra if she had seen Adora this morning. Catra shook her head "No, but she likes to train early in the morning, so she might be out jogging."

Glimmer replied, "I went to her room earlier and she wasn't there."

Perfuma suggested "Maybe she's in Queen Angella's office? Have you seen your mom?"

Glimmer shook her head "No, but she usually doesn't eat with everyone, so I'll probably see her later."

Catra and Scorpia gave each other a look and that didn't go unnoticed by Perfuma or Mermista, who gave each other the same look in return. Adora's odd behavior and obsession to be close to Angella have been obvious since her return to Brightmoon. The gossiping teenager inside all of them wanted to speculate a scandal but knew Angella was far too reserved to ever consider Adora as a fling.

Glimmer sighed and remarked, "I'm going to teleport over to see mom quick."

With a glittering poof, she was gone.

In her mother's chambers, she was right at the entrance of the room. Off to the side was the entrance was her sleeping quarters and her wardrobes. Walking over she called in a hushed tone. "Mom?"

Turning to see her mother in bed still. Sound asleep and her bare chest exposed. Glimmer instantly backed away in discomfort as this is not the way, she usually would see her mother in the morning. A lump on the right side of the bed a pale foot stuck out with a red ankle bracelet on it and Glimmer gasped audibly enough to cause Angella to awaken. The sight of her daughter looking at her in shock made Angella grab her bedsheets and jolt up out of bed. Causing Glimmer to jump back a little and teleport out of the room. Adora tried to jolt up when she saw Angella was sitting up but had the blankets thrown over her. Angella yelled for her daughter "Glimmah! Please wait outside for a moment."

She panicked and through on her robe. Struggling to get her wings through the slits of her rope and fumbled to her front door. Opening it she saw her daughter's face painted with pure discomfort at what she had just teleported into.

Glimmer sputtered out an apology "M—mom I'm so sorry! I just wanted to see if you were coming to brunch. I didn't mean to disturb you and your friend."

Angella stammered out an apology as well "This is my fault Glimmah! I'm so sorry you had to see me like this and find out about—"

“Your friend?” Glimmer asked. Still unable to look her mother in the eyes she waved her hands in the air and protested “I swear I didn’t see anything! Just afoot. I shouldn’t have just teleported in —I’m sorry! I don’t want to make this awkward I promise!”

Angella realized Glimmer didn’t see who was in bed, only that someone was in bed. Angella flustered replied, “I don’t want it to be awkward either, This wasn’t how I wanted you to ever see me.”

Glimmer shook her head “No—no, mom it’s okay, We’re both adults, I can handle this—um, we can talk later. But right now I’m going to try and find Adora so we can eat, okay.”

Angella clutched her rope and nodded. Still visibly embarrassed while Glimmer teleported away.

Rushing back into her bedroom she saw Adora grab her robe and dress. Adora gave her a mutual nod of understanding as Adora rushed down the corridor. Angella rubbed the back of her head in worry. Hoping Adora wouldn’t be seen by anyone as she rushed to the other wing of the castle.

Glimmer had already teleported into Adora’s hallway. Trying to compose herself before trying to find Adora. Being tactical, Adora had gone through her bedroom window leading to the bathroom. Turning the showerhead on she heard Glimmer teleport into her room and call for her “Adora?”

Adora opened the door and greeted "Hey, Glimmer."

Glimmer signed in relief to see her "I haven't seen you all morning, where have you been?"

Adora nervously stepped out of the bathroom and lied "Oh I went out for a jog and lost track of time." She said with a shrug. Nervously pointing back behind "I'm just going to shower now."

Glimmer's eyes somehow made their way to Adora's bare feet and saw the red anklet around her right foot. With eyes widening she looked back at Adora who was stepping back into the bathroom. "See you later Glimmer," Adora called to her before shutting the door.

Glimmer quietly replied "Yeah, see you later….." teleporting out of her room she pondered about what she had just seen. Adora didn't look like she went out running. Not only that, but the robe she had on was a robe from Angella's room. She could tell since it had the fancy *A* crest on it. She looked back at the door and thought. There was no way Adora was in her mother's room just a minute ago. How could she run to the bedroom so fast?

She knew Adora had some odd relationship with her mom but couldn't tell if just Adora was trying to be an overachiever in Angella's eyes or if it was something else. After seeing the way Adora looked at her last night at the party she wondered what was going on with them. It dawned on her it could be romantic.

And she had no clue how she could handle this. All she knew is she had to play it cool. Even in her mind she was screaming and demanding answers she knew Angella and Adora were not the ones to confront with uncomfortable questions.

The Queen's Reveal

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Brightmoon had little going on for it right now. As far as scandals and gossip went the news cycle for a Kingdom of quiet opulence didn't have a busy news grind. With the War overall, they had to report on mundane updates and occasional gossip-related forums. Typically, the royals were off-limits to criticize, such as Glimmer's many faux pax from her early Commander years and Angella's reclusion was not reported on due to citizens not wanting to see their royals painted in a bad light. At the alliance brunch, a few newspapers floated around the table. Gossip columns had made full articles on almost everyone. Catra was pleased to see she was given the captain "Royal Rudeness" over her title as Queen as the small article went into detail about how aggressively passive, she was with paparazzi. All Catra could comment on is "Yeah but look at how good this picture is of me?" and showed her wife, causing everyone at the table to laugh. Even Juliet and Castaspella couldn't help but find Catra's personality infectiously enjoyable. Looking through the paper they saw a small section about them. Juliet scoffed "One date in town and already I'm *moving up in elite status*." Castaspella hummed and replied, "At least the photo they took was good?"

Juliet shot her a looked and playfully tossed the paper at her "My mouth is open."

Casta chuckled "It's still cute."

Spinerella and Netossa joked with them about how they're old news as Juliet and Casta—and—Catra and Scorpia were now prominent lesbian figures in Etheria.

Glimmer had returned to the dining hall to eat with everyone. Her face looked flushed, and she seemed visibly uncomfortable with whatever she had just needed to do. Bow noticed this and asked, "You okay?" Glimmer nodded to save face and Perfuma had looked to Bow knowing that she was not. Bow handed her the newspaper and she saw all the photos taken from the party last night and with all the captions. No one said anything bad, but Glimmer didn't like seeing her mother being on the front cover of the newspaper with the headline "Hermit Queen out for a night on the town with Princess of Power" the photo had Angella positioned in a way that flattered her in the dress but also showed Adora beside smiling brightly. This scene would have been sweeter if Glimmer hadn't just teleported in on her mom in bed with someone. Her eyes narrowed as the article read that Angella came to visit the dance hall and appeared to be having a great time with her Adora.

Glimmer tossed the paper aside and turned to her aunt and asked "Doesn't Brightmoon Gazette know my mom hates to be photographed?" her tone came off angrier than she wanted and now she had the full attention of the room.

Casta gulped a little at seeing her niece angry over a picture of her mom. Juliet answered for Castaspella "The Gazette is usually reserved all mention of the Queen, but her majesty has never silenced freedom of speech from the press. So, they are at right to document her when she's out in public."

Casta nodded and Glimmer glared and reminded them "My mom did get them to pull images from my dad's funeral."

Everyone mutually frowned. The princesses were too young to remember Micah, but all their parents remembered him and were openly saddened by his death years ago. Casta confirmed "They did and issued an apology to Angella after, but sweetie your mom is just being photographed having a good time. You just said earlier that you all had a good time, right?"

Everyone nodded. A smirk made its way to Catra's face as she realized that Glimmer must be one for tantrums often. Seeing how everyone was trying to calm her down and this *auntie* lady was set on keeping Glimmer from freaking out. Glimmer growled "I just don't like that they took pictures and paired her up with Adora—it makes it look like they're implying something!" she said pointing picture again.

Mermista questioned "Like what? Everyone knows Adora is Angella's bodyguard now—so wouldn't they all just assume it was diplomacy thing again?"

Casta nodded and turned to Juliet "Captain Juliet was your father's bodyguard from Brightmoon to Mystacor during the war, sweetie."

Glimmer rolled her eyes and moved the paper away from her "I don't think picture. This whole article is about relationships and __"

Her words were cut off as Adora rushed in with fresh clothes and slightly damp hair "Sorry I'm late!" she lied "Jogged all of Brightmoon this morning."

A tension came over the room and Adora obliviously began to eat without realizing it.

Glimmer glared at her and stood up "Excuse me, I need to plan for the meeting. See you all later." She said getting up. Bow looked at Adora with a worried expression before getting up to follow her. With a confused look coming over Adora's face she asked anyone in the room to answer, "Is something wrong?"

Perfuma and Mermista looked at Casta for an answer. The Aunt of the Princess replied "Glimmer is just a little stressed right now. She'll cool off soon."

Catra smirked at all this going on—to witness the gossip and scandalous side of Brightmoon. To be in a room filled with people so fragile they couldn't just speak what was on their minds made Catra relieved to not be in their inner circle of people, but now she was mad for Adora—who innocently just asked if everything was okay. It wasn't Adora's fault that Glimmer jumped to a conclusion and had a temper tantrum overseeing her mom in a picture with Adora.

This wasn't going to sit well with Catra. Perfuma and Mermista were supposed to be her best friends too and they were being

tight lips over what just happened. Catra sat up and excused herself. "I'll be right," she said to her wife before heading down the hall.

Turning left she walked down the hall only realizing she should of went right to find Glimmer's room. Heading to the bedroom she didn't bother to knock. Pushing the door open she looked up in surprise to see what Glimmer slept on, without thinking she just shouted, "What the hell kind of bed is that!?"

Glimmer and Bow peaked from over the edge and shot her a look.

Glimmer yelled back "Why are you in here?"

Catra just shrugged and walked to smugly reply "I did what I want and I gotta say, Sparkles, you make one hell of a dining guest. To think all you need to do is have a tantrum over rumors that make you give Adora the cold shoulder is priceless." She then did a dramatic twirl before pointing to Glimmer on the bed "And not even one of the other *friends* is going to say a word. We had a phrase for that in the Horde. We called it being two-faced."

Glimmer teleported down and got in Catra's face "You saw the photos too Catra! you know what everyone is going to start to say! Do you think that's fair for Adora or my mom?"

Catra stepped closer and smiled at the shorter girl. "Talk about fair? You don't like the idea of your mom being in the spotlight.

Bad enough Adora steals people's thunder—now mommy is going to be the talk of the town. What does that leave you?”

Glimmer growled and balled her fists “I’m not upset over the imaginary spotlight you think I am, Catra! I’m worried about my mother being talked about!”

Catra raised a brow “Like what you just did this morning?”

Glimmer’s eyes went wide as a flush came over her face and her shoulders became limp.

Catra reminded Glimmer “You got mad at the sight of Angella being next to Adora. Only you are freaking out. Does it bother you that Adora has butt-kissed her way into Angella’s good graces or that your mommy has found the ideal young adult to listen to her?”

Glimmer’s throat went dry as she stood her ground “I’m not insecure over any of that Catra! but I don’t like being lied to!”

Catra crossed her arms and reminded her “Adora was right next to you before your little hissy fit. You should have asked her.”

“In front of the whole alliance?” Glimmer questioned.

Catra tilted her head "How is any difference then your little fit in front of the alliance? You think your little tantrum won't get back to your mom and Adora now?"

Glimmer stepped back and put her hands on her head "Catra, I have no idea what to do, I have a bad feeling and I think I know or saw something and I can't talk to anyone about it."

Catra relaxed her crossed arms and softened her expression for a moment. Glimmer was upset over this and needed help. In a moment of wanting to do something helpful. She reached an arm out and asked "Sparkles, what's up with you? What did you see?"

Glimmer shifted away from her "I can't talk to you about this. Anyone."

Catra didn't say anything but just reminded her "Okay, but I'm here for Adora and if you got an issue with her—you need to say something. It's not like she'd keep secrets from you for too long."

Glimmer snarked "Wanna bet?"

Catra then repeated, "Keeping secrets for *not* too long."

Glimmer then confessed to what her notion of fear was to Catra "Did something happen between them? In the Scorpion Kingdom? Anything?"

Bow let out an audible sound of discomfort from the bed while Catra explained "Aside from a one-sided crush. Nothing that I know of."

Glimmer wanted to fall back "Adora has feelings for me mom?"

Anger instantly took over and Catra held out a hand to stop Glimmer "Before you go off and lose your shit on Adora, remember she isn't like the rest of you princesses in the alliance, she grew up with a messed-up view of adults. To her, Angella is high ranking bachelorette, not just someone's mom. Adora isn't going out of her way to hurt anyone. Neither is Angella for rejecting her nor for being nice to her. Let them be and sort out stuff alone. If you make another scene, you'll lose Adora forever! She was ready to die to save Etheria, you think being shunned by her former friends won't send her off a cliff?"

Glimmer frowned and began to pace around "I—I saw someone in my mom's room—And—and—Adora! Has a red anklet now, and I just want to know if my mom gave it to her?"

Catra rolled her shoulders "Probably, Adora's outfits suck so you can't expect your mom to not help her not dress like crap."

Glimmer let out a small laugh and explained "Gift giving is sometimes romantic in Brightmoon customs."

Catra asked her “Would it be so bad if it was?”

Glimmer raised her hands “Yes! The age gap, the history, people will be so cruel, can you just imagine what they will say?”

Catra joked “Maybe they’ll question who’s on top?” The feline Queen looked over Glimmer’s head to see Bow’s clear discomfort at her saying that and restated “Who cares though? Two of Etheria’s biggest heroes besides me and Scorpia—Let them do their own thing. It’s not like they’re gonna smooch in public every chance they get. And we don’t even know if they are romantic or not. You could have just been overthinking about the picture.”

Glimmer frowned “Someone was still in her room this morning. In her bed.”

Catra asked, “Did you see them?”

“Only afoot with a red anklet on it.” Glimmer replied.

Catra turned to walk to the door “Well, confront Adora in private and then your mom. Just don’t have another hissy fit over it. Because now, everyone is going to start talking. In my short time here in Brightmoon, I figured out it’s a gossip Kingdom,” she turned to smirk at Glimmer and Bow as she teased “I don’t even know half the alliance members' names—but I know who is cooch-smooched by who.”

A sour look from Glimmer and Bow was Catra's sign to leave and with that Glimmer sighed and looked at Bow. He couldn't think of anything to say, but he looked saddened at her.

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All while this took place, no one dared say anything to Adora. Catra's words about word getting around were not an understatement. Casta and Juliet openly talked in front of other guards over Glimmer's anger over Adora being photographed with Angella. The guards whispered about it in the stables and the horses heard it and told Swift Wind. Not to mention the princesses talked amongst each other and other people. Soon Adora was innocently making her way to see Angella. She assumed she would either be in her study or her bedroom and made her way down the North Wing of the castle to see her. None the wiser to who she would run into she was a little taken back by the uneasy look she received from one of the guards as she walked past them. In a purple puff of glitter, Glimmer appeared and stood in Adora's way. Taking a step back she greeted her "Uh, Glimmer, Hi. You didn't come back to breakfast."

Glimmer narrowed her eyes at the blonde and asked her "Are you going to see my mom?"

Adora rubbed the back of her head and didn't look at Glimmer as she replied "Yeah, I didn't see her this morning, so I wanted to be polite and say hello."

Glimmer took Adora's right arm to spin her around and calmly asked her "I gotta talk to my first, okay?"

Adora frowned but nodded and walked down the hall. She wanted to speak with Angella after the whole ordeal from this morning, for Glimmer to act so cold to her made her worry that Glimmer knew something. Did she see her in bed? She hoped not. That would not be how she wanted her to figure them out.

In the Queen's study, Glimmer teleported to the front door. Hesitant she knocked and received a no answer. Meekly calling out "Mom?"

Instantly she heard the urgent movement of Queen Angella coming to open the door. In a higher and more panicked voice than desired, Angella greeted her daughter "Glimmah! Sweetheart comes in, please."

Glimmer saw her mother's discomfort in her face and entered the office, rubbing the back of her head as she did she felt so uncomfortable around her mom right now. Looking at her mother's office table she saw that Angella had copies of all the current papers for the morning. Seeing the photos Glimmer saw earlier. Glimmer frowned and asked, "I guess your up to date on the news?"

Angella nodded and frowned as she made her way to sit in her fancy office chair "Yes, and Juliet informed me that you were unhappy with my presence in the coverage. Media censorship is something I don't take part in, I don't think the gossip column implied Adora and I was an item—if anything it made me look like I am out on the party scene. That would be something I'm not partially pleased with. But then again, the Plumeria Royal family has been subjected to gossip columns for their wild after-war parties too."

Glimmer kept a serious face on as best she could as her voice cracked when she spoke up "Can we—talk about this morning?"

A nervous flush came over Angella's face and she cleared her throat and replied "Yes, we can. What would you like to discuss?"

Glimmer sat down in the office chair facing her mother and asked "Someone was with you in your room this morning?" she questioned. Regretting her words. She knew someone was in her bed this morning.

Angella could have lied with that question but instead chose to honestly reply "Yes, I did spend….. the evening with someone last night." Her face burned with embarrassment. That was not easy to admit to her daughter. Having an adult conversation was not as easy with Glimmer. She still was a baby to Angella and admitting to your adult daughter to having someone in your bed was not something any mother should need to say out loud to their child.

Glimmer could pick up on how uncomfortable her mother was and looked away and replied "I only saw their foot. But, can I know who it is?"

Angella felt nervous. She was being asked to out Adora. This was something she didn't plan on doing at all this morning. Angella looked down and softly explained, "I really would like to let the person I was with about you know before I tell you who they are."

Glimmer's face soured "So you're asking me to wait?"

Angella nodded and before she could say anything else, Glimmer stood up and bid her mother a very cold farewell. "Very well. I will speak with you at your leisure. Your majesty." Before teleporting Angella stood up and declared "Please wait. I don't want to ruin how well you and I have been getting along. If you want to know, I will tell you now."

Glimmer saw the panic in her mom's face and felt bad. It was Adora, it was hard to question it. Adora was the only white girl with a size 10 foot in Brightmoon and was the one in Angella's bed. Seeing Angella so worried made Glimmer feel bad for her.

Glimmer gave her mother her full attention as Angella tried to explain herself. "This person—it wasn't ever planned. No, we grew close over a short amount of time. A lot of stress and tension with everything going on in the war and we grew close.

The dynamic isn't as conventional as it could be. There is a class and age difference and it will be difficult for us if others know…. We—we just don't know what to make of our relationship at this moment and we don't want to anger anyone with what has happened—escaping you." Angella's voice cracked.

Glimmer froze when she saw her mom was on the verge of tears. Not wanting to upset her any further Glimmer raised her arms out. Walking over to Angella to hug her. The two embraced and Glimmer calmly stated "Maybe you should talk to your friend then, I'll wait until it's a better time to talk about it."

Angella softly thanked her and Glimmer teleported out of the room.

The Princess of Brightmoon wanted to avoid Adora at all costs. Keeping herself busy all day with mundane chores with Bow. Adora was none the wiser as she made her way to Angella's quarters to meet the awkward gaze of several guards. Everyone looked at her—not that it wasn't normal for Adora t to get odd looks sometimes, but today felt different. Tensions felt high.

Knocking on Angella's study door she heard no sound and knocked again "Angella?" she questioned.

Slowly opening the door she didn't see Angella. She entered the room slowly and called out "Angella, it's Adora, can we talk?"

She heard the clacking of high heels and saw Angella come from around the corner to reply "Adora, good to see you," she stopped when she saw how happy Adora was to see her. The bright blue eyes looked at her the way only Micah used to. Her frown tried to return to her face, but it couldn't. She was just happy to see her. "Adora…." Angella trailed off and gave her a soft smile. Adora's face was painted with worry "Are you okay?"

Angella bit her lip and gestured for Adora to sit down. Angella made her way to the other side of the table and held her hands out. Leading for Adora to clasp on to them in concern. The warmth of feeling Adora's hands on her own made her smile. But the frown came back and she softly spoke "Last night was wonderful, it truly was. But Glimmah saw too much and has questioned me about you. She doesn't know it was you, but she had drawn a worrying conclusion after seeing photos of us at the party last night. I can't risk upsetting Glimmah," She looked into Adora's eyes with sadness. The blonde knew what was going to be said next and braced herself for the words.

"We can't—" before Angella could say anything else, Adora nodded and sat up, removing her hands from Angella "I know. I always knew it wouldn't work." Adora said with hurt spilling out of her words. Both women looked at each other with tears in their eyes, Adora left the room and politely called to her "I enjoyed our time together, your majesty."

"As did I Adora," Angella called while her voice cracked.

Distressed was an understatement at this moment for the two of them. Angella's first true romantic connection since Micah was too taboo for her to enjoy and it had to be broken off. Adora experienced her first love and heartbreak all in less than 48 hours. The remaining day before the meeting had Adora in her room sobbing.

The night of the final meeting was successful, Angella wanted as few speaking roles as possible and let Castaspella and Juliet talk the most.

Everyone had mission assignments.

Mermista had the support of the former Horde soldiers to clean up any ship pollution or debris from the seas of her Kingdom.

Perfuma had the help of Brightmoon's army for Plumerian efforts.

Glimmer, Bow, Catra, Scorpia, and Adora were off to the Fright Zone for damage assessment, and Spinerella and Netossa were off to the ice Kingdom to regroup with Frosta to get support from the ice Kingdom army for other small village support.

A small party happened after, and everyone said their goodbyes before heading off.

Juliet and Casta went back to Mystacor together that night.

As depressed as Adora was, she tried to keep a brave face on when seeing Angella.

As the night winded down Catra knew something was wrong with Adora and Glimmer knew why too. The feline shot the Brightmoon princess a glare before ushering Adora off to her bedroom to talk.

Leading Adora out with little attention made Adora feel somewhat better. Catra knew Adora far too well to know that Adora was on a verge of a breakdown. These used to happen back in the Horde if she didn't get something perfect. It didn't happen much but when it did, Adora would be crushed. With everyone distracted by another party, Catra was able to slip Adora out back to her room. The blonde flopped on her bed and began crying again. Catra sat beside and rubbed her back to comfort her. Adora buried her face into her pillow. Catra softly talked to her "It's cool, let it out, no one else is here."

Adora cried and cried until she finished and looked up to Catra with a puffy face and red eyes.

Catra remarked "Your such an ugly crier."

Adora whipped her eyes and sat up "I never felt like this before….."

Catra shrugged “Yeah, heartbreak sucks.”

Adora turned to Catra and asked, “Have you ever felt like this before?”

The feline queen gave Adora a look and the blonde looked down sadly “Oh…”

Catra scooted closer to her “Yeah, I’ve cried into a pillow over you before. It sucked for me, but I don’t want you to go through this alone. Tell me what you need right now, besides wanting to see her.”

Adora sulked “All I want is to see her, but we can’t. Glimmer almost found out—we can’t be around each other right now.”

Catra replied “Well, she just put you on a mission with me and Glimmer to the Horde, you won’t see her for at least two months. But you stuck with Sparkles.”

Adora rubbed her eyes and explained “I can deal with seeing Glimmer I’m just upset that it’s over. I cared about Angella. We had a good time, last night meant a lot to me and now it’s over. I knew it wasn’t going to last, but I didn’t realize it would end so soon.”

Catra blinked in confusion and asked “Wait? Last night like at the party or….”

Adora looked away for a second before replying “After the party….”

Catra gasped and clasped her hand over her mouth. Adora slept with her?!

Catra regained composure and asked the burning question on her mind “Who was on top?”

Adora glared and swatted her arm “Catra!”

The feline giggled “I wanna know.”

Adora rolled her eyes “We took turns.”

Catra snickered.

Adora rolled her eyes and laid back down on the bed. Clutching her sheets and Catra asked her “Are you going to be okay?”

Adora nodded and curled up on her bed "I'll be okay, I just need to get over this heartbreak…."

Catra frowned and left the room. It annoyed Catra to know end that Adora was sulking. Instead of enjoying being the hero like Adora always liked to be—she was crying over a woman double her age because the *princess* didn't want her mommy to have dates. She understood Glimmer's vises more than she led on. It must be weird to have a friend pine for your parent. Catra and Adora never knew maternal love and the feeling was unrelatable. She did know Adora's feelings all too well. Catra spent nights crying over Adora when she left the Horde and it physically felt like her chest was collapsing in on itself from the pain of missing her.

Adora won't survive being around these people after the mission to the Fright Zone. I got to make sure Scorpia is cool with Adora living with us after this is all said and done. Catra thought to herself. She knew Scorpia would hate the idea of Adora being a housemate or neighbor. It wasn't that Scorpia hated Adora—she just hated the history between Adora and Catra and didn't want the blonde to seduce her wife away from her.

Those were Scorpia's exact words.

The night winded down and Adora remained restless. Crying and sleeping all afternoon made her tired and hungry. Angella was very well aware that Adora didn't come to dinner and Glimmer knew it too. At the last dinner party of the Alliance members before restoration missions began Adora was a missed sight. Everyone asked about her, but no one wanted to bother her. Assuming she had been exhausted by the war.

Angella had asked the chef to prepare a large plate of all Adora's favorite foods to send to her room. As the chef assembled it all on the room service cart, Glimmer teleported in and awkwardly looked away from her mother. Angella knew the prior events from earlier in the day were laying on Glimmer and this scene of Angella preparing food for Adora was suspicious. Not that Angella wouldn't make sure people ate. Angella had made it a point to make sure guards working late extended shifts or castle staff she hadn't seen take a break in a while had some leisure time and food.

The chef called to the Queen. "Adora's food is ready your majesty, shall I send a maid to her room to deliver it?"

Before Angella could say no, Glimmer offered "I'll do it!"

Pulling the cart closer to her and giving her mom a look "It will bring it to her."

Angella stepped closer and offered "I can do that Glimmah," trying to reach for the cart.

Glimmer pulled it closer to her and reminded her mother "That's okay mom—Adora been in her room all day upset about something and I just want to check on her and make sure she is okay."

Angella replied, “As do I Glimmah.”

The princess shot her mother a look and coldly remarked “I don’t think you're going to help her.”

Angella narrowed her eyes and pulled the cart to herself and chastised her “What do you mean by that?”

Glimmer glanced behind her mother to see the chef looking uneasy by the tension and Glimmer grabbed her mother’s wrist and the cart to teleport them outside into the main hall leading to the bedrooms.

Glimmer exhaled before explaining “Mom! I know something is up with you and Adora!”

Angella gasped and looked around to make sure no one heard her say that.

The queen snapped back “Glimmah! This is not the place to have this discussion!”

Glimmer yelled “When will it be? Just let me talk to Adora alone, okay! She’s probably really messed up about this and she needs me right now.” Glimmer placed her hand over her chest and angrily scolded her mother “You weren’t supportive of Adora and first! You made her feel like she needed to constantly prove

herself! You were so cold and off-putting that all she ever did was try to please you and whatever happened between being a bodyguard and—and—" she pointed to her mother "Whatever I saw this morning only proves that Adora isn't okay right now!" she grabbed the dinner cart and pulled it close "So I'm going to make it right!" she shouted before going down the hall.

Angella felt her chest ache at what Glimmer was accusing her of. To make her think that she was at fault for all that had happened hurt her. It made her worry more for Adora now and all she wanted to do was comfort her.

As Glimmer approached Adora's room she heard muffled talking coming from the bedroom. She knocked on the door and called to her, only to be met with Catra's voice calling back "Adora needs rest! Come back later."

Glimmer angrily opened the door "Catra! I need to talk to her!"

She froze when she saw Adora's face. Red and puffy from all her crying. Catra had her arm around Adora's shoulder and her tail was wrapped around one of her legs as extra comfort. Glimmer's face fell when she saw Adora she tried to rush over to her "Adora!" she called.

Before she could make contact; Catra angrily raised her hand to stop her "Not right now Glimmer!" Catra roared "She's really upset right now and she doesn't need any more reasons to be hurting!"

Glimmer protested "I want to make sure she's okay!"

Catra narrowed her eyes “No, you want to interrogate her.”

As true as Catra was it still hurt and Glimmer lied and pointed to the food cart outside the door “I was bringing her food!”

Catra then took herself away from Adora and yelled to Glimmer “Then bring it in and leave!”

Glimmer looked to Adora and the blonde meekly nodded and pleaded “I just want to be with Catra right now, Glimmer…..”

Hurt by this, but understanding the situation made Glimmer just bring the food cart in and leave. Teleporting back to her room to sulk. Adora was heartbroken. Whatever Angella did or said or made Adora feel destroyed her and it made her angry. Too angry to just sulk in her room for too long. She made her way to her mother’s room and knocked on the front chamber doors to see her. With no answer, she decided to barge in the same rude way she did in the morning. Scanning the room for her mother she called out to her “Mom?”

The clicking of high heels came from around the corner of the bedroom. A very emotional Angella came into the scene of Glimmer and she shouted at Glimmer “Why are you in here? Didn’t you make it clear moments ago you were upset with me!?”

Glimmer ran her hands through her hair and sighed "Mom, I just need to talk."

Angella crossed her arms as her wings slightly fluttered in anger "About?"

"Adora." Glimmer tried to stand taller than she was since Angella flared her wings at her "We need to talk about Adora."

Angella approached her and asked "What about Adora? Have you spoken to her?"

Glimmer glared at her "No, Catra and her and talking right now. I still need to talk to her because I know she's upset."

Angella was visibly hurt by this information.

Glimmer frowned and offered "You upset too."

Angella's lip quivered and she nodded.

Glimmer looked down at her feet and bit her lip before speaking "This morning, someone was in this room with you…. I saw the ankle bracelet…... Adora had the same one on when I saw her

earlier today. I know she was here; I just don't know what is going on. Can you please explain this to me?"

Angella gestured for Glimmer to come to sit with her. This was a story needing to be told and sat down.

Angella began to explain "Adora and I worked well together in the Scorpion Kingdom…. We became more than just a working relationship, and we grew close as friends. As friends, Adora pined for me and I thought the gestures of her affection were cute," she couldn't stop herself from smiling at remembering the flustered ways Adora charmed her. Her smile turned to a frown again when she saw Glimmer's mortified face at the idea that Adora was crushing on Angella. The Queen cleared her throat and explained "It became more than pining after a while and, we knew it wasn't anything to pursue, but….. we are lonely people and we wanted connection….." Angella's voice cracked "Last night was the last of our encounters. It's best for both of us to not pursue this, right now we're both just saddened by all this."

Glimmer saw her mother's pain and asked her a very deep personal question she had thought of before and never dared asked "Is Adora the only person after dad?"

Angella nodded yes. "I grieve for Micah to this day, no one can replace him, No man or woman has ever made it past the guards at the beginning of the hall."

Glimmer nodded and asked "Why Adora though? If she had some crush on you—couldn't you have just ignored it."

Angella crossed her arms and looked away “I’m not as cold as you think I am. I did enjoy the companionship and that we were friends. Things develop over time and under the stress we both had—it made sense at the time to confide in each other. I wasn’t going to ignore her kindness to me.”

Glimmer asked cautiously “Was Adora. *Pushy*. With her feelings”

Angella shook her head “No,” then angrily added, “You know her better than that.” Angella sighed and put her hands out to touch Glimmer’s “Darling, I wish I had a better explanation for you but Adora and I grew close. We know we can't continue to be close, so we called off our time working together so our feelings wouldn’t get more involved. Neither of us regrets it, but I don’t this is going to be hard. If she’s talking to Catra she should feel comfortable with her. It’s hard for both of us. I will miss our time together.”

Glimmer looked down at Angella’s hands and saw the visible sadness in Angella’s eyes, she was clearly in pain over all this.

It surprised her to see Angella like this. It was obvious why she was so upset over dad dying, but to break off a fling with Adora had her almost grief-stricken didn’t seem right.

Glimmer pulled her hands away from Angella and nervously fidgeted around before asking “Why—why can't you and Adora remain platonic?”

Angella offered “We will, but it’s best to have space right now.”

Glimmer frowned and reminded Angella “Catra’s going to probably offer for Adora to come to stay with her. Now that she’s some magical destined princess with two Kingdoms.” Glimmer rolled her eyes.

Angella nodded “Yes, this was new I was aware of, Catra has always wanted Adora with her and they do have a strong friendship history—”

“Adora and I are best friends to mom!” Glimmer snapped.

Angella narrowed her eyes and explained, “Adora is a grown adult and can go anywhere she can go!”

Glimmer looked down “Mom I don’t want Adora to go.”

“Neither do I, but we can’t expect Adora to do anything she doesn’t want to do.”

The conversation didn’t last much longer after that. Glimmer wasn’t happy that Angella wasn’t going to fight for Adora to stay. As unhappy she was to find out her mom slept with her best friend, she would have worked to let that go. It’s hard to

separate Angella from just being another adult. Queen Angella was also her mom and as such she still saw her differently than the way others did. Adora doesn't know what maternal love is, so to conflate Angella as a possible romantic partner made things hard. She didn't want Adora and Angella together romantically—what would people say? But how would they feel moving forward?

Glimmer left and returned to see if Adora was free. Only to see Catra leaving Adora's room. Glimmer narrowed her eyes to the feline Queen and Catra did the same as she approached her. Glimmer took her arm and teleported her into Glimmer's bedroom to talk to Catra in private. The pink and purple-haired princess asked, "Are you going to take Adora from us?"

The feline gave her a puzzled look before snorting out a laugh and remarking "Wow, so selfish. Adora doesn't belong to you or anyone else in Etheria. The offer is out there for her but I'm not dragging her with me."

Glimmer snarled "Then what are you doing?"

Catra raised a brow and smirked "Being a good friend. Since you were too busy being mad over your mom and Adora having some action—you failed to ever account for anyone's feelings but your own. No wonder they freaked out and called off all their plans. They knew you would freak out if you figured it."

Glimmer furrowed her brow and demanded, "What were their plans?"

Catra shrugged "To just hang out. Do missions together, probably —" Catra stopped to make a dirty gesture with her hands to imply the scissoring position and Glimmer cringed and shivered at the insinuation."

The shorter girl placed her hands up in front of her "Okay I got it, Catra."

Catra chuckled at her discomfort while Glimmer just rolled her eyes. Knowing the feline Queen was having a good time makes Glimmer uneasy.

With jokes aside, Catra's eyes softened as her voice calmly brought to Glimmer's attention "The two of them aren't hurting anyone, and they won't hurt each other. Adora isn't looking to be your stepparent and Angella is planning on running off with the Princess of Power. Let them be companions if it lasts weeks, months, or even years. The two want their privacy, but they feel they must be apart because of how you'll react. Just understand their position before saying anything to either of them, okay?"

Glimmer nodded and remarked that "It's so weird to hear you be the voice of reason."

Catra took it as a compliment and grinned "I know, besides being a Queen of one Kingdom, saving Etheria, and being a princess in another I still have time to lend my services to other little

princesses.” Condescendingly patting Glimmer’s shoulder. Then backing away to leave “I’m going back to my room now.”

Glimmer exhaled loudly before sitting down for a moment before sitting down. Thinking about how to speak with Adora. Regretting ever teleporting into her mom’s room in the first place, she was upset beyond words that Adora was with her mom. It had nothing to do with Glimmer wanting her in that way, but more about why a friend would fall for a person’s mother. She didn’t know how the dynamic would change now after all this. Was she just overreacting? How cruel would be to her mother if word got out that Angella was dating a woman younger than her?

Taking a breath before teleporting to Adora’s door, she knocked on it and asked Adora if she could come in. She heard some movement make its way to the door and Adora opened it. Her hair was down, and she was in her grey underclothes for sleep. Glimmer frowned and asked her “Is it okay if we talk now?”

Adora looked exhausted from all the emotions she was going through but still nodded and let Glimmer come in. The shorter princess asked her “How are you feeling?”

Adora shrugged and walked over to her bed “I’m going to be alright. I’ve been thinking a lot today……” she looked saddened at Glimmer and asked her “I guess you know and you're mad at me?”

Glimmer sat next to her on the bed and explained “I put two and two together, talked to mom and Catra about some things. So…. I

guess you and my mom were close?”

Adora was so ashamed to look at Glimmer. How could she? Adora fell in love with Glimmer’s mom—never thought about how it would work or how Glimmer would feel and still pursued and quested for Angella’s love and affection. Glimmer had every right to be angry with Adora.

Adora nodded “Yes, I—I do love her.” She looked and Glimmer with an almost panicked expression “I know it’s not going to work and we can’t see each other again! But, I just fell in love with her.”

Glimmer kept her eyes on Adora as the blonde started to tear up and apologized “I’m sorry Glimmer. I am, but after the recovery mission, I can’t stay here. It will be too awkward and I need to get over these feelings. So, I am going to take Catra up on her offer and go back with her to the Scorpion Kingdom to work on rebuilding it.”

Glimmer gasped and grabbed Adora’s hand “Adora! I wish you didn’t feel you would need to do that.” Glimmer didn’t want to be selfish and pleaded for Adora to stay to only satisfy her wants of needing her best friend around. All of Catra’s smart remarks made it clear that Adora would put others before her and for her to even entertain the idea of leaving Brightmoon to get over her heartbreak, meant Adora was putting herself first.

Adora gulped as she tried to hold back tears and explained “I know it’s crazy, Glimmer but I—I don’t know how to explain it, but I really—care about Queen Angella.”

Glimmer asked her "You love?"

Adora nodded and sputtered out another incoherent explanation "I think I do, I know I'm attracted to her and I want to be near her. I wish I could give you a better explanation."

Glimmer stood up and asked her "Do you want to see my mom with me?

Adora shook her head and waved her arms "No—no I can't it would be too weird now. Wh—what would we even say. She—she told me we needed to stop seeing each other and—and I agreed so I can't intrude on her right now. It's close to bedtime!"

Glimmer asked Adora out right "If I was okay with you two—dating—would you consider not leaving, or at the very least not be so upset?"

Adora's face turned bright red "We weren't dating." The blonde then turned to pretend to look at something on the wall as she answered, "We're friends and stuff."

Glimmer didn't want to think about the *stuff* part. She just nodded and offered to Adora "If you want to talk to me later or in the morning, let me know. I'm going to bed now."

In a lavender sparkling poof of smoke, she was gone and back in her bedroom. Sitting on her bed she thought about what to do? Two people she loved were in love with each other. Even if they both haven't said it in that many words, she knew they were going through a lot. The two still want to be with one another. Glimmer thought about how she could do that. Not because she loved the idea of Adora romping with her mother—but because she loved them both and didn't want them to be hurting.

The Next Morning

The Queen of Brightmoon didn't look forward to it. Requesting breakfast to be delivered to her room so she could avoid Adora, and the others is a cowardly approach to her distress. Even with it being obvious to the limited amount of people in her business, she was undeniably avoiding them. It would have been easier to do so if Glimmer didn't barge in again.

"Mom?"

The Queen growled "I could have been dressing, Glimmah! What is it?"

Glimmer was a bit taken back by Angella's snappiness. "Mom, I just wanted to see how you were. Besides I had some good news for you."

Angella waved her hand "I don't want to hear it. Today is going to be hard, I'm to sit and watch everyone leave the castle again—including you and—"

"Adora?" Glimmer finished.

Angella sighed and looked down at her tea "Is that what you want to hear?"

Glimmer offered "What if my news meant you didn't have to stay behind?"

Angella looked up at her "I'm listening,"

Glimmer clasped her hands together and explained "I think, maybe I should stay back in Brightmoon with Aunt Casta and General Juliet. Run Brightmoon while you and—anyone you choose to travel with, work on diplomacy during all the recovery missions."

Angella gave her a puzzled look "That would mean you would remain in Brightmoon for at least two months?"

Glimmer nodded "Yeah, and you and Adora can do diplomacy stuff and take the time to…I don't know what is with you two, but it will give you time to work with each other."

Angella looked away for a moment in embarrassment, it was bad enough that Glimmer was an adult that knew what sex was—it was even worse than Glimmer knew that Angella has sex—namely with Adora. *Even if it was just the one time*. Glimmer knew Angella was uncomfortable and offered "Did you want me to tell Adora my plan—or just leave it for the meeting?"

Angella offered back "The meeting might be more suitable; it would be nice if you lead since now I presume you will be ruling Queen for this duration of time."

"Queen Glimmer?" the young woman scoffed.

Angella nodded and smiled "Queen Glimmah does have a good sound to it."

Glimmer looked a little nervous and chuckled "Let's not go too crazy—you have not abdicated the throne over Adora now are you?"

Angella rolled her eyes "Can your mum just go on maybe *one* date before you spiral into a panic?"

Glimmer smiled "I'll manage that."

Angella asked, “You're okay about Adora and me?”

Glimmer averted her eyes and explained “I don’t get it, but I don’t want you or her unhappy. I don’t want people to judge you. But, I’m not stopping you.”

Angella sat up to hug her daughter.

Glimmer smiled and returned it.

At the Meeting

Adora’s expression was drained and exhausted, a whole night of crying and loathing over all her feelings made her feel sick and weak. Skipping breakfast was not an option with Catra banging at her door. A large plate of food in hand. She whistled as she walked into Adora’s room and remarked “This castle is insanely lavish. Not only do you have cooks, and maids, but butlers for everything. The folded underwear thing is a bit much but all the other stuff is super nice.”

That managed to put a smile on Adora’s face. The plate of food was presented to her and she began to eat. Catra sat next to her and reminded her “The meeting is only in two hours. Glimmer

has made some changes to the original plan. Whatever you don't like you need to say no to her."

Adora nodded "If something like that happens, I'll try to do that in private with her. I won't make a scene in front of people."

Catra agreed with her and just left her to be by herself. Adora finished her breakfast and then showered to get ready for the final meeting. This would be the last time everyone would be seeing each other until the first steps in Etherian recovery missions were completed. It made her think that she would be alone for months now. She wouldn't be alone—she'd be with Glimmer or Catra, but those two had partners. Bow and Glimmer are dating and Catra is married to Scorpia. They had someone special to be with, not Adora. All her energy was wasted on loving a woman double her age that she couldn't be with. In reality, she knew Angella and her could never work, but it still didn't make the pain of losing the first love. Angella wasn't even dead—she just couldn't date her. Several kisses and a romantic night of passion were all she had from her time with Angella…. That and a really good friendship. Every time she tried to make herself stop thinking about a happy *"what if"* moment she kept remaindering herself that it wouldn't happen.

Entering the old war room, she sat next to Catra and Scorpia. The Scorpion queen looked less enthused with how close she was to Catra. in a noticeably jealous move, she moved Catra's chair closer to her and made an audible creek that made Perfuma and Spinerella giggle since they knew exactly why she did that. A sheepish smile came over Scorpia as she looked at her wife who just gave her a smug look back.

The meeting started the moment Glimmer and Angella walked in together. Adora's eye went wide before she cast her gaze down to not look at Angella directly. Picking up on this, Angella frowned. Glimmer picked up on this too and didn't say anything.

She cleared her throat and lead the meeting, not missing a beat and being as confident and elegant as she could being beside her mother, she had gone through all the mission plans.

Who was going where was discussed first, then who would be going with who? On that note, Angella stood up and declared "I will be working on more diplomacy missions with Adora—in my absence from Brightmoon, my daughter Glimmah will be Queen in action for now."

A few stunned faces looked at Glimmer—who was beaming a smile but still looked nervous with this news. The focus fell off Angella completely when Castaspella jumped up and squealed for her niece's new role.

Catra and Scorpia joined in on the cheering with everyone else. Adora was happy for her friend and didn't know how to show it. If she ran up to hug her—it might be taken as her just being happy to be on a mission with Angella. She didn't have to think too hard about it, as Glimmer teleported over to embrace Adora tightly. Softly telling her she loved Adora which almost brought the blonde to tears. Returning the embrace, everyone else got their hugs in as the meeting ended. The only three remaining in the war room were Angella, Adora, and Glimmer.

Glimmer asked the two of them "Are you two okay with the plans? You both are heading back with Scorpia and Catra in the Scorpion and Magicat Kingdoms, you both know those other royals, so I figured it's a good start to get those Kingdoms acclimated to the ways things are changing with you two being a bridge to the diplomats for them."

Adora looked to Angella with a nervous glance of anticipation for what the Queen would have to say. Angella cleared her throat and assured Glimmer "I feel this is right, we've all worked together before. This mission will be successful."

Adora and Glimmer's faces burned from embarrassment as the purple-haired princess sputtered "Great deflection mom! But I think I can just be honest and say it was so you and Adora could be together."

Angella's face burned with embarrassment at that and looked to Adora who was also still bright red.

The Queen couldn't figure out what to say in this situation, looking back and forth between the blonde young adult and her daughter made this situation more embarrassing since she would be the one for better words at this point. Glimmer realized the two were being awkward and told them "I don't know what to say either, I just want you both to be happy. I don't get it, I don't get how you two became a thing—but I'm not questioning it."

Both Angella and Glimmer looked at each other before looking at Adora at the same time. The blonde was just as red as her jacket

and speechless.

After all, that fear of Glimmer knowing—the result was nothing to what they expected, Glimmer was calm about the whole situation—obviously in disbelief in comfort over the whole thing and the discomfort didn't shy away when she and Angella were alone letter that night. Glimmer and her mother were in Angella's private spa chambers. The Queen slipped into the warm water and looked to see her daughter wearily look at her and ask "Did you and Adora *do it* in this tub?"

Her mother's face turned red in an almost comedic way that Glimmer found humorous—although her question was honest.

"Glimmah!" Angella scolded "Why would you ask such a thing!" clearly embarrassed by the question.

Glimmer slowly went into the water "It was just a question. I guess you didn't. I just didn't want to swim around if you did."

Angella narrowed her gaze and looked away from Glimmer and remarked "I'm not vulgar Glimmah—I wouldn't do that." She tried to splash her daughter in the face. Glimmer giggled and moved closer to her and sighed "This is going to take time to get used to. But, I kind of wanted you to find someone after dad. Even if it was just a friend. Granted, I wish it wasn't my best friend—but I guess I can live with this."

Angella shot her a worried look “Are you sure your okay with this?”

Glimmer nodded “Yes, I promise I’m okay, I just want you and her to be happy.” Before letting herself sink into the water.

Angella looked up at her marble ceiling and thought to herself about what was to come next. Her romantic feelings for a woman —*a younger woman*—were allowed to be recognized. She and Adora could be together and continue to work together. She enjoyed this new thrill for life. Her daughter and Kingdom were safe and now she could adventure and do good for Etheria outside the castle walls of Brightmoon. Finishing up her bath; she was beginning to brush her hair at her vanity with Glimmer. This was going to be one of the very times the two would be able to see each other. Even if it was a month or more, it wasn’t like the two liked being apart.

When the morning came, a large banquet was held in Angella’s honor—Adora remained in the crowd to cheer for her Queen’s departure and Glimmer’s new role of Queen for the restoration of Etheria.

After the people left the banquet room, Angella returned to her room to gather up all her belongings and leave with Adora, Catra, and Scorpia by large carriage to Scorpia’s traveling ship.

With a sigh of relief as Scorpia drove them out of Brightmoon’s territory—the unusual couple held hands and smiled at each other.

Adora looked at Angella's hand and continued to smile. A small crush turned into so much more. She was and the Queen had something special.

The Queen and I are together. She thought to herself as this new adventure in her life began.

Chapter End Notes

Epilogue to come

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